

Nick Trost's
SUBTLE CARD CREATIONS
Volume 2



Illustrated by
Tony Dunn

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special thanks to proof readers Jen and Mike Vance

"In an attempt to relegate to the morgue the mundanely trite 'Take a Card,' I am trying to develop something more along the lines of the truly magical, something that will take card magic out of the parlor mountebank's class and elevate it to the level of art."

—Brother John Hamman, *M-U-M*, May 1963

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Foreword

by Peter Duffie

I first encountered the name Nick Trost while I was still at school. I don't know if Nick was much older than me, but he was creating miracles—breaking new ground with gaffed cards and clever handlings, while I was only learning my trade. I had just mastered Dai Vernon's "Twisting the Aces" and had started using it in my impromptu performances, when my friend Gordon Bruce showed me a different version. It puzzled me greatly as there were no extensive counts used. The effect just seemed to happen! Gordon told me it belonged to Nick Trost and was on sale. I hurried along to Roy Walton's magic shop and bought a set.

After this, I kept a close watch for anything by Nick Trost. His booklet entitled *Card Problems* (Hades, 1964) had a huge influence on me. I bought this at an IBM convention in the early 70's and was fascinated by the principles and diabolical ruses employed by the author. It wasn't until some years later that I came to appreciate the significance of some of the principles that Nick offered in this early-sixties publication. Nick was ahead of the game then, and continues to push the boundaries of card magic, as you will discover in this latest tome.

Nick is able to create beautiful routines using minimal sleights and maximum subtleties. Pay particular attention to the way he constructs his routines—it is always a learning experience—regardless of how experienced the reader may be! For a modest man with a huge talent—it has been an honour and a privilege to write these few words. So, start turning the pages and enjoy the unique thinking of Nick Trost.

Glasgow, Scotland, May 2007

MEMORANDUM

TO THE PRESIDENT

1. The Department of the Interior has the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your letter of the 10th inst. in relation to the proposed extension of the public lands in the State of California. The Department is pleased to hear that you are so interested in the public lands and are so anxious to see that they are properly managed and preserved for the benefit of the people of the State.

2. The Department is also pleased to hear that you are so anxious to see that the public lands are properly managed and preserved for the benefit of the people of the State. The Department is also pleased to hear that you are so anxious to see that the public lands are properly managed and preserved for the benefit of the people of the State.

3. The Department is also pleased to hear that you are so anxious to see that the public lands are properly managed and preserved for the benefit of the people of the State. The Department is also pleased to hear that you are so anxious to see that the public lands are properly managed and preserved for the benefit of the people of the State.

Very respectfully,
Your obedient servant,

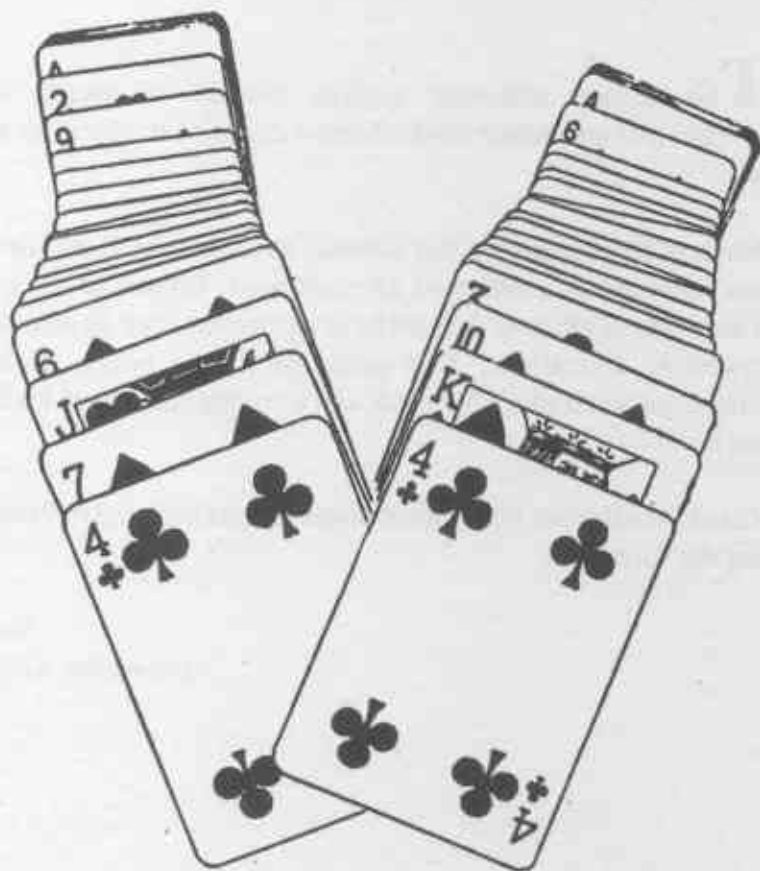
Introduction to Volume 2

This second complete volume contains a wealth of new material—effective and subtle card effects—designed to entertain and fool spectators.

Much of the material in this volume, as in *Volume 1*, was developed from ideas recorded in a series of 21 notebooks. Effects of all types are included here. There are over 100 tricks in categories such as coincidences, hotel mysteries, divinations, four aces, gambling, poker, predictions, transpositions, packet tricks, ESP cards and a unique chapter on tricks using a Pinochle deck.

Thanks to all those who contributed material here and to Peter Duffie for writing the foreword.

Nick Trost
Columbus, Ohio, 2008



Paul Curry's "The Power of Thought"

From *Holden's Catalog No. 15*, 1948

12

More Coincidences

"Coincidence or 'matching card' effects always have an impact on the layman, possibly because of the element of surprise when two previously selected cards are produced simultaneously."

—Robert Findlay, *Abracadabra*, No. 1252, January 24, 1970

This chapter offers some of the strongest coincidence-type effects. The chapter opens with "Quadruplication," a four-way matching effect. In "Suit-ability," a spectator somehow—beyond all odds—matches every suit in a packet of cards. Several very strong coincidence effects follow. Then the chapter closes with a four-phase routine and handling for Eddie Joseph's powerful "Staggered" effect.

QUADRUPLICATION

This effect is a variation of what has become known as Belchou's ace trick by Steve Belchou, which appeared in Oscar Weigle's column in *The Dragon*, June 1939. My effect was inspired after reading "The Dragon Prediction" in Jerry Lucas' book *Championship Card Tricks* (1973), ghostwritten by Harry Lorayne.

Effect: After the deck has been shuffled, the performer lays four prediction cards face down in a row on the table. A spectator cuts the deck into four piles, then carries out a dealing procedure. The top card of each pile is turned up, and they are mates to the four prediction cards.

Method: Have the deck shuffled and returned. Here is Al Thatcher's system for locating mates to the top four cards: Turn the deck with the faces to you and find four cards, preferably of different values, alternating red, black, red, black, from left to right. Say you spot the 3H, 9C, 10D and 8C together. All you need to remember is 3, 9, 10, 8. Cut these to the top (rear) of the deck.

Now run through the deck and find the mates to the four memorized values and lay them into a left-to-right row face down on the table. The first value memorized is three, and you know it is red because the top four cards are in red, black, red, black order. Find the other red three and table it face down for the first card of the row. Next locate the second card, a nine (you know that it is black), and lay down the other black nine for your second card. Continue in the same way, laying down the mates to the third and fourth cards.

Now place the deck below the card at the left end of the four-card row. Have a spectator cut the deck to the right so there are four piles that we'll call A, B, C and D. Your setup is on top of pile D. (See Figure 1.)

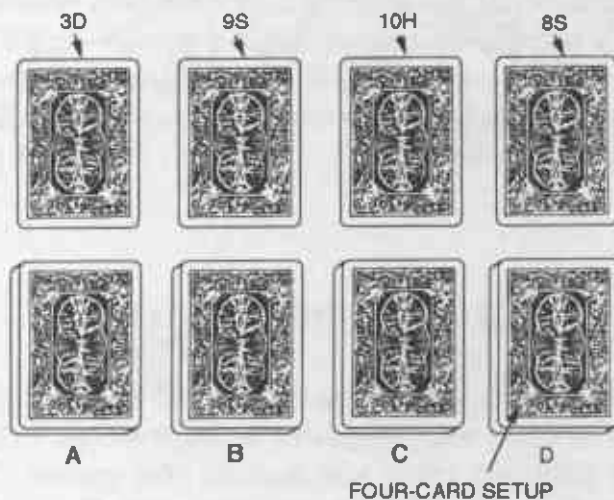


Fig. 1

Have the spectator pick up pile A and deal the top three cards face down on the table at position A. He is then to deal one card face down on top of piles B, C and D, respectively. He then replaces the rest of the cards he is holding on top of the three cards he dealt at position A.

The spectator now picks up pile B and deals the top three cards face down at position B. He then deals one card face down onto piles A, C and D, respectively, then drops the rest of his cards on top of the three cards dealt at position B.

The same procedure is repeated with pile C, then pile D.

Now turn your four prediction cards face up. Then, beginning with pile A, turn over the top card and deal it face up overlapping your first prediction card to show that the two cards are mates—both are red threes. Continue to turn over the top cards of piles B, C and D in the same manner to show each matches the prediction card above it. See Figure 2.

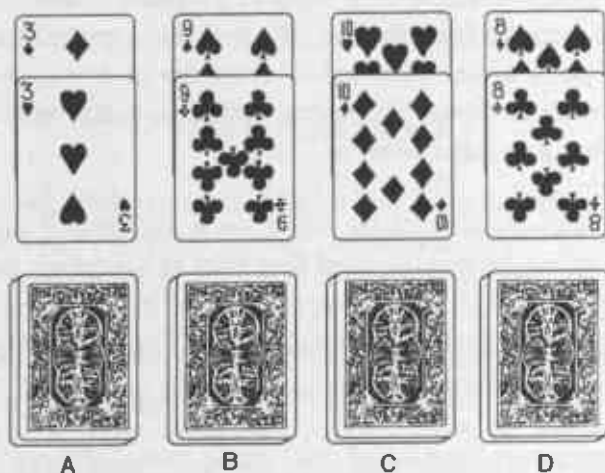


Fig. 2

TEMPLE PATTON'S COINCIDENCE

Temple C. Patton's excellent mathematical effect, which is titled "Counterespionage," appeared in his book *Card Tricks Anyone Can Do* (1968). I have added the "synchronicity" presentation that Robin Robertson used in his trick "Synchronicity," which appeared in *The Linking Ring*, July 2000, and later in his and Peter Duffie's book *Card Conspiracy, Vol. 2* (2003).

Effect: The performer invites a married couple to assist and explains that he will try an experiment in "synchronicity." The woman and man

choose a number and remember the card at their number. This done, the man cuts the cards in half and turns half face up. The performer deals cards simultaneously from each half until a selected card appears on the face-up pile. The card face down on the other pile is the other selection, showing synchronicity is at work.

Method: Use a married couple. Situate the woman on your left, the man on your right. Have the woman shuffle the 52-card deck as you patter about "synchronicity," a word for coincidence. Explain that you want each of them to select seemingly unrelated cards and bring them together by synchronicity.

Ask the woman to think of a number *between* 1 and 8. As you turn away, she is to remove that number of cards and conceal them. Now she is to hand the deck to her husband who thinks of a number *between* 12 and 20, removes a corresponding number of cards and conceals them. Each spectator now has a number in mind.

Face front, take the remainder of the deck and hold it face down. Ask each spectator to remember the card that falls at his secret number as you show the top 20 cards. Lift off the top card, show it, and count "*One*." Take the next card under the first, show it and count "*Two*." Maintain the original order of the cards, counting to 20.

Once the spectators have noted their cards, casually spread over another six cards and cut the group of 26 cards to the bottom of the packet.

Set the packet face down on the table. Ask the man to cut the packet as close to the center as he can and place the top half to your right. Ask the woman to put her hand on the man's hand or hold his wrist before he cuts. This is to intensify the synchronicity. He must cut the packet within four cards of the center.

Pick up the packet on the left, the original bottom half, turn the packet face up and casually double cut the card on the face to the back. Replace this packet face up next to the face-down pile.

Deal cards in unison from the top of each pile, laying the cards above the piles as shown in Figure 1. Ask the spectators to stop you when either sees their selected card. The man will call "stop" at some point. Turn to the

woman and ask if she has seen her card yet. She will say no. Ask her to name her card, then turn over the face-down card that was dealt when the man's card appeared. It will be her card. "*That's synchronicity!*" you conclude.

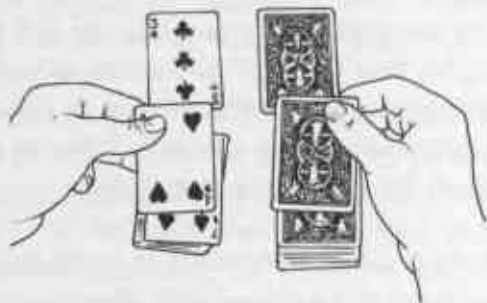


Fig. 1

SUIT-ABILITY

This effect was inspired after reading Roy Walton's trick "Noah's Lark," which appeared in "The Card Corner" column by Larry West, *The Linking Ring*, June 1986.

Effect: The performer holds a packet of 16 cards and has a spectator mix the cards, switching any number of pairs (or triplets) he wants. The cards are shown in pairs—and each pair has cards of differing suits. Now a second spectator mixes the cards by calling switches. When the cards are dealt, all the pairs consist of matching suits. Somehow the second spectator has managed to match every pair.

Method: Fan the deck, remove a pair of clubs and place them face down on the table. Then remove a pair of hearts and place this second pair face down onto the clubs. Next place down a pair of spades and a pair of diamonds. Repeat the above sequence once more so you end up with a pile of eight pairs in cyclical suit order—C, H, S, D, from bottom to top. Discard the rest of the deck.

Pick up the 16-card packet and hold it in the left hand with the faces toward you. To complete the setup, you now reverse count the cards from the left hand to right, not singly but in groups of 3-2-2-2-2-3. Here is the procedure: With the right thumb and fingers, draw off the first three cards as a unit from the face of the packet into the right hand; next, draw off two

cards as a unit onto the face of the first three cards; continue to draw off two cards as a unit until you have three cards remaining in the left hand. Draw off these last three cards as a unit onto the face of the others.

Begin by holding the packet face down in the left hand. Deal single cards into a tabled pile, then "switch" two cards as you demonstrate the Curry Swindle Switch procedure. (See Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for details.) Have a spectator call for a switch of two or three cards at any point. Continue until all the cards have been dealt.

Now show the pairs in the packet consist of mixed suits and patter to the effect that the suits in none of the pairs match. Here's how: Hold the packet face down in the left hand and get a left little-finger break beneath the top three cards. With the left thumb, push the top card to the right about an inch. The right hand lifts off the top three cards as two in Biddle grip, fingers at the outer end, thumb at the inner end. Turn the right hand palm up to display a spade and diamond—two different suits.

Place the cards face down on the table as a pair; the cards are still overlapped. With the left thumb, push the top card of the packet to the right about an inch, but this time the right hand lifts off just two cards and shows the pair. These cards are placed face down directly on top of the tabled cards.

Repeat by showing the next four pairs legitimately and placing them, still overlapped, onto the tabled cards. You have reached the last three cards. Push over the top card with the left thumb, holding the last two cards squared as one. The right hand shows these three cards as the last "pair" and places them on top of the others. Pick up the packet, square it and hold it face down in the left hand.

Now have the second spectator mix the packet by calling "switch" or "deal." Again you use the Curry Swindle Switch procedure. The spectator can call for a "switch" of any number of pairs (or triplets) he wants.

After the pile has been dealt, turn it face up and deal matching suit pairs around the table in random order to show that somehow the second spectator was able to match all the suits.

AL THATCHER'S "QUADRUPLE MATCH-UP"

This is my handling of Al Thatcher's trick "Quadruple Match-Up," which appeared in *Precursor*, No. VIII, June 1985.

Effect: The performer lays a face-down card on the table as a prediction. A spectator then cuts off a group of cards from the rest of the deck. The performer now deals a face-down row of 20 cards. The spectator counts his cards. Say there are 14. The performer counts over to the fourteenth card in the row and turns that card face up. It is, say, the KH. The performer's prediction card is turned face up; it is the KD, its mate. Finally, the two remaining piles are turned face up to reveal the other two kings.

Method: Cull the four kings (or any four of a kind) to the face of the deck. Retain them on the bottom with a false shuffle.

Hold the deck with the faces toward you and spread it, explaining that you need a prediction card. Spread off seven groups of three plus two (23 cards) into the right hand and cut the deck at that point. Spread to the kings and slide three of them to the face of the deck. The right hand removes the odd-colored king of the three kings at the face of the deck and tables it face down in front of you as a prediction.

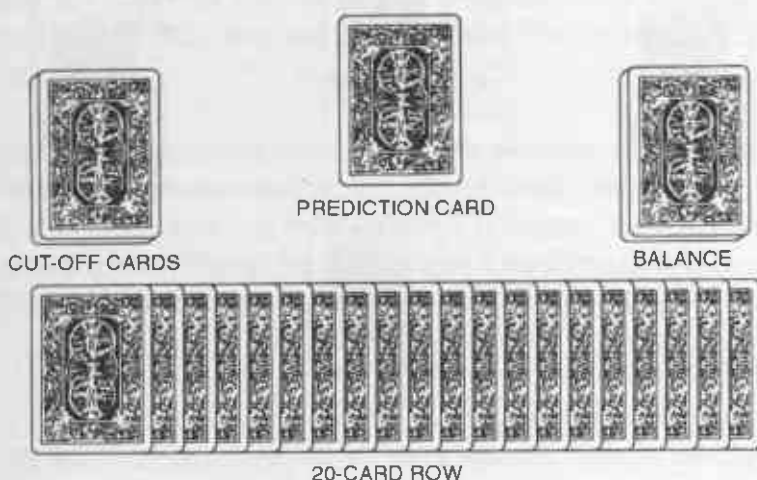


Fig. 1

Get a left little-finger break beneath the king at the face of the deck and double cut it to the top (rear) of the deck. There is now one king on top, one twenty-first from the top and one on the bottom.

Hold the deck face down in the left hand and have a spectator at your left cut off a small packet (less than 20 cards) from the top and table it face down.

Explain that you will deal a row of cards. Deal an overlapping row of 20 cards face down on the table; deal from *right to left*. Lay the balance of the cards face down to the right, above the dealt row. See Figure 1.

Have the spectator count his cut-off packet, dealing the cards singly into a face-down pile on the table. Assume he has 12. Count a corresponding number of cards (12 in this case) from *left to right* in the row and push the card at that number forward. Square up the row, then turn the selected card face up on top of these cards. It is a king. Next, turn your prediction card face up to show the king of the same color—its mate!

"What I don't understand is how these kings got here," you say as you turn over the two outside piles to reveal two more kings (Figure 2).

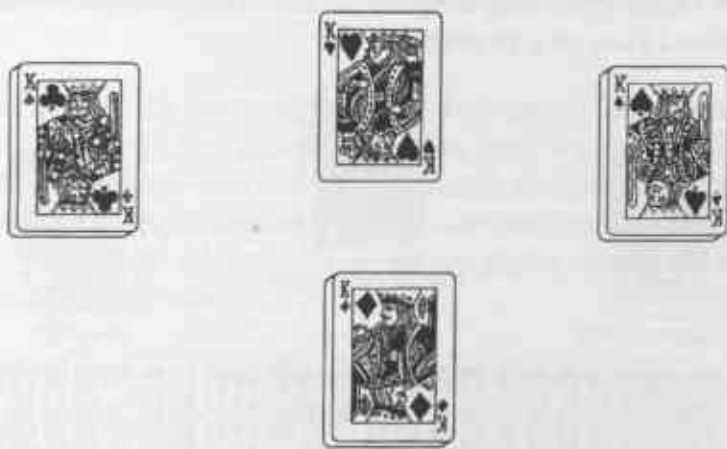


Fig. 2

FOUR OF A KIND

Effect: A card is selected and laid aside face down on the table. Now the deck proper is cut into thirds. The performer and two spectators each take a

third. They each cut their cards in half and mark the cut. The card originally selected is shown to be a queen. Then the cards cut to by the performer and the spectators prove to be the other three queens.

Method: The four queens are on top of the deck. False shuffle: Undercut half, injog the first card and shuffle off. Form a break below the injogged card with the right thumb. Shuffle to the break and throw. The queens remain on top.

Force the top queen using the Cut-Deeper Force: Cut off less than half the deck, turn it face up and replace it face up on top. Have a spectator cut deeper (into the face-down cards), turn over the cut-off portion and replace it on top. Spread off the face-up cards and the first face-down card into the right hand. Move the right hand forward and lay the face-down card (a queen) on the table. As this is done, get a left little-finger break beneath the top three cards of the deck proper. The right hand replaces its cards face down on top of the deck. Double cut at the break. Three queens are now on the bottom.

Hold the deck for an overhand shuffle. Strip off the top and bottom cards with the left thumb and fingers and shuffle off about a third of the cards into the left hand. Place this packet face down on the table in front of spectator A. Strip off the top and bottom cards again and shuffle off about half of the remaining cards into the left hand. Place this packet face down on the table in front of spectator B. You hold the remaining third of the deck face down in the left hand.

Have each spectator pick up his packet and hold it face down. Demonstrate with your cards what each spectator is to do. Cut off about half of your cards and slap them face down on the table, then crisscross the remainder on top of the tabled cards. (This is the Criss-Cross Force.) Each spectator follows your actions with his cards, so now there are three crisscrossed piles on the table.

"Let's see the card cut to originally," you say as you turn over the single card, displaying a queen. Now turn over the top, crossed portion of each pile, disclosing a queen on the face of each.

FOUR OF A KIND—ANOTHER VERSION

Effect: The performer shuffles the deck, then deals eight cards face down on the table. A spectator selects one of the eight cards by placing a coin on it. The other seven cards are returned to the deck. The spectator then selects another card from the deck. This card and the original selection are turned up—they are both red kings. The spectator inserts one of the red kings into the center of the deck. The cards on either side of it are now shown. They are the two black kings, completing four of a kind.

The first part of the effect is similar to Victor Farelli's "The Mystic Eight" from his booklet *Lend Me Your Pack* (1936).

Method: The setup from top down is: four kings (the two reds together and two blacks together), four queens (the two red queens together and two blacks together) and the rest of the deck.

Begin with a jog shuffle, retaining the top stock of eight cards.

Deal two face-down rows of four cards each, the kings in one row, queens in the other. The kings and queens are paired in color (Figure 1).

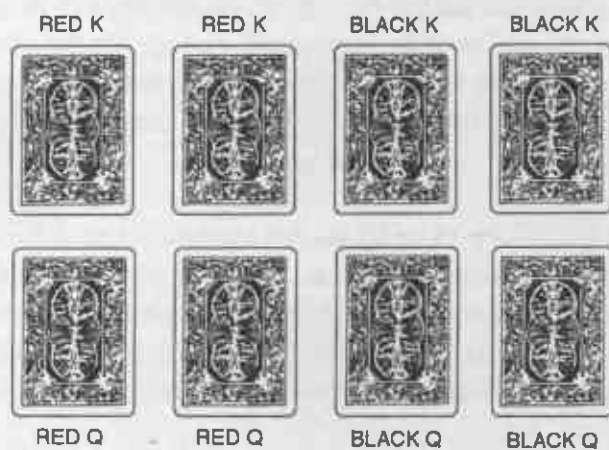


Fig. 1

Ask a spectator to touch one of the two rows, explaining that the one not selected will be eliminated. Assume the king row is touched. Pick up the queen row and insert these cards into the center of the deck.

Now hand the spectator a coin (or other small object) and have him place it onto one of the remaining four cards, telling him that the ones not selected will be eliminated. (Say he selects a red king.)

This done, pick up the remaining three cards so the king of the same color (the other red king, in this case) is on *top* of the three. Drop these cards on top of the deck.

Jog shuffle, retaining the top three cards. Now perform the first part of the Cut-Deeper Force yourself by cutting off less than half the cards from the top; turn them face up and place them face up on top. The spectator then cuts off a group from the top, cutting into the face-down cards, turns over his cut-off portion and replaces it on top.

Spread over the face-up cards into the right hand plus the first face-down card. The right hand moves forward and deposits the face-down card (a red king) on the table; as it does, get a left little-finger break beneath the top card (a black king) of the deck proper.

The right-hand cards are replaced face down on top of the deck, then the deck is double cut at the break. There is now a black king on top and bottom of the deck proper.

Turn over the spectator's original selected card, a red king. Now turn over the card you laid face down—to reveal the other red king, its mate.

Now have the spectator pick up either red king and insert it face down near the center of the deck as you spread it face down in your hands. Hold the deck so the card is outjogged and not pushed flush. Now perform the Simon Prophecy Force, turning the red king face up; the deck is unobtrusively cut, which places a black king above and below the face-up red king.

Ribbon spread the deck from left to right face down on the table. Remove the red king and the card above and below it. Turn over the two face-down cards to reveal the black kings, completing the four of a kind.

ANOTHER PHONE NUMBER TRICK

Revealing a spectator's telephone number with cards is a novel and surprising effect. This version was inspired by "Right—and Right Again!" in Jerry Lucas' book *Championship Card Tricks* (1973).

Effect: Pattering about numerology, the performer asks a spectator to name a number between 10 and 20. Say 15 is named. Fifteen cards are dealt. Now the 1 and 5 are added, getting 6, and six cards are dealt back onto the deck proper. The card arrived at by numerology is a seven-spot—a lucky number. Seven cards are dealt on the table and these correspond to the spectator's telephone number.

Method: To set up, remove any seven-spot plus seven cards that correspond to a spectator's telephone number, which is, say, 488-8142. The first three digits are red spot cards and the last four digits, black spot cards. Set up the top 17 cards, from top down: nine X cards, seven-spot, 4, 8, 8, 8, A, 4, 2, rest of the deck.

Jog shuffle, retaining the top stock, then false cut, using the Ose cut. (See Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for a description.) Perform for a spectator seated on your side of the table so the final layout of cards is oriented for him to read.

Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Patter about numerology and have the spectator name any number *between* 10 and 20. (He cannot name 10 or 20.) Suppose he names 15. Deal a pile of 15 cards face down on the table and set the deck proper aside. Pick up the dealt pile, explaining that in numerology the digits are added. In this example of 15, 1 and 5 are 6. Deal that number of cards (six in this case) onto the deck proper; the last card—the seven-spot—is turned face up onto the cards in the left hand.

"A seven! That's a lucky number," you say. Table the packet with the face-up seven-spot on top and pick up the deck proper. "Let's deal seven cards." Deal the top seven cards from left to right into two face-down rows, a row of three and below it a row of four. (See Figure 1.) Set the rest of the deck aside. "Let's see if any of these numbers mean anything to you." Turn over the seven cards at random until all seven are face up. Name them in order until the spectator realizes that they correspond to his telephone number.

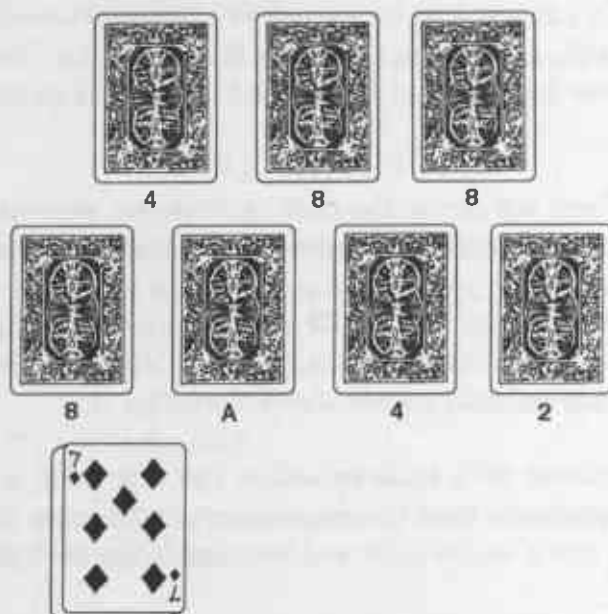


Fig. 1

Notes: If the spectator is across the table from you, deal the seven cards representing the phone number into two right-to-left rows, so that when they are turned up, they are oriented from the spectator's point of view.

This same method could be used to force the spectator's birth year. If the birth year is, say, 1935, the setup from top down would be: nine X cards, four-spot, A, 9, 3, 5, rest of the deck. When the four-spot turns up, remark that four is a significant number, then deal the next four cards into a face-down row on the table. Finally, turn the four cards face up to reveal the spectator's birth year.

THE NINES I

This effect was inspired by Steve Pressley's trick called "WAD Perfected" in his book *Endless Possibilities* (1991).

Effect: A card is selected from a shuffled deck and tabled aside face down. Now another card is chosen and placed with the first. Both turn out

to be nine-spots. Pattering about how nine is a very significant number, the small packet of cards left in the performer's hands is counted. There are exactly *nine* cards, and the last card is the third nine-spot. Nine more cards are counted from the deck, and the last card turns out to be the fourth nine-spot.

Method: From top down, the deck is arranged: nine-spot, nine-spot, eight X cards, nine-spot, eight X cards, nine-spot, rest of the deck.

Jog shuffle, retaining the top 20 cards. Hold the deck in right-hand Biddle grip and swing cut the top half into the left hand. Place the right-hand cards on top and hold a break above the setup.

Use the standard riffle force procedure (see Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for details) to force the top nine-spot in the setup. Thumb off the nine-spot face down on the table and reassemble the deck so the setup is back on top.

Now ask a spectator to name a number *between* 10 and 20. Say 15 is named. Deal a tabled pile of 15 cards. Set the deck proper on the table and pick up the dealt pile.

Explain that in numerology everything is converted to a single digit. Add the digits of the spectator's number, in this case 15, getting 6. Deal six cards onto the deck proper and lay the last card (the sixth) face down beside the first tabled card. Turn both tabled cards face up, disclosing both are nine-spots.

"Nine is a very significant number," you say. *"And even though you named any number, I am left with . . . nine cards."* As this is said, reverse count the cards in your hand face down on the table into an overlapping row to show there are nine.

"And the ninth card is also a nine," you say, turning up the last card dealt to reveal the third nine-spot. Deal it face up beside the other two nines.

"If we add these three cards," you say, indicating the three nine-spots, *"we get twenty-seven. And, as you know, in numerology the digits two and seven are added, getting nine."* Pick up the deck proper, deal (count) nine

cards and turn up the last card, revealing the last nine-spot, which is dealt face up beside the other three nines.

THE NINES II

This is the second routine in which the four nine-spots are located by a spectator himself. The routine was inspired by "The Nines" in Jean Hugard's *Card Manipulations*, No. 5 (1936).

Method: From the top of the deck down, the cards are set: 9D, 9H, eight X cards, 9C, 9S, rest of the deck.

Begin with a jog shuffle, retaining the 12-card setup on top. Double cut the top card (9D) to the bottom.

Patter about the mysterious properties of the number nine, then ask a spectator to name a number between 10 and 20. Say 15 is named. Deal a pile of 15 cards face down on the table. Table the remainder of the deck and pick up the dealt pile.

"Numerologists add the digits of a two-digit number. One and five are six," you say. Deal six cards onto the deck proper and lay the last card (the sixth) face down above the deck. Isolate the in-hand cards by placing them on top of the card case.

Pick up the deck proper and have the spectator cut off less than half the cards, turn over his portion and replace it on top. He now cuts deeper, cutting into the face-down cards, turns over the cut-off portion and replaces it on top. (This is the Cut-Deeper Force.) Ribbon spread the deck from left to right on the table and push out the first face-down card, placing it next to the first tabled card.

Turn the face-up cards face down on top and pick up the deck proper. Now perform the Criss-Cross Force as follows: Hold the deck in right-hand Biddle grip and dribble the cards into the left hand. As you do, ask a spectator to call "stop." When stopped, the right hand drops its portion face down on the table, then takes the left-hand cards and angles them onto the tabled half. Figure 1 shows the layout.

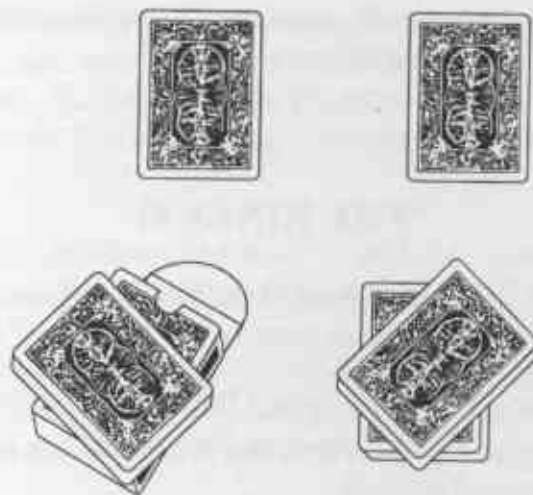


Fig. 1

"Over the centuries, the number nine has gained the reputation of having mysterious properties . . . it is the last single digit in our numerical system. Let's see if it is a sympathetic number," you say. Pick up the packet on the card case and reverse deal the cards into a tabled pile, counting them aloud. There are nine cards. The top card of the pile is turned over to reveal a nine-spot. Next, turn up the two cards at the top of the layout, disclosing two black nines. Finally, turn over the top (crossed) portion of the crisscrossed deck to disclose the last nine, the 9D—the Curse of Scotland.

COINCIDENTAL CUT

This trick was inspired by Henry Bosworth's "How Many Cards Did You Cut?" from *The Linking Ring*, December 1970.

Effect: The deck is mixed, then a spectator cuts off less than half and covers his packet with the card case so the performer cannot judge the number of cards cut. The performer spreads the deck, and the spectator selects a guide card, which is turned face up. The cards on either side of the guide card are turned up, and the values add to, say, 15. The spectator's cards are counted, and coincidentally, there are exactly 15 cards.

Method: The setup has been attributed to Bernard Bilis. The top 28 cards are arranged from top down: X, X, A, A, 2, 2, 3, 3, 4, 4, 5, 5, 6, 6, 7, 7, 8, 8, 9, 9, 10, 10, J, J, Q, Q, K, K, rest of the deck.

Hold the deck face up and spread the bottom half only to show the cards mixed. Now hold the deck for an overhand shuffle. Undercut less than half, injog the first card and shuffle off. Form a right-thumb break below the injogged card, shuffle to the break and throw.

Have a spectator cut off less than half the deck proper and cover his packet with the card case to prevent you from seeing the size of his packet.

Due to the setup, the top two cards of the deck will now correspond to the total of the cards cut off. If he has 15 cards, for example, the top two cards will be a seven and an eight, totaling 15.

Double cut the top card to the bottom. Now spread the deck proper face down in the hands and have a second spectator touch the back of a card near center to be used as a guide card. As you turn the touched card face up, perform the Aronson Mark-a-Place Move (see Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for details). This places the guide card face up between the original top and bottom cards of the deck.

Ribbon spread the deck face down on the table and remove the guide card, together with the card on either side of it. Turn over all three cards so the two cards surrounding the guide card can be added. In this case, they will total 15. Have the original cut-off cards counted. There will be 15.

Notes: The Simon Prophecy Force can be substituted for the Aronson move.

The revelation of the two cards can be performed without the double cut by using the Criss-Cross Force: The two cards are on top. Hold the deck face down and riffle down, asking a spectator to call "stop." When stopped, cut the top half to the table and cross the bottom half on top. Have the spectator count his cards, say 15. Now lift off the crossed half and turn up the top two cards of the original top half. They total 15.

A COINCIDENCE COMBINATION

Effect: The deck is shuffled, then the performer tables two packets of 13 cards each. A spectator selects a card and reverses it in one of the packets. The performer turns up cards in unison from both packets, showing each pair consists of different cards. The reversed card and its counterpart in the other packet are shown to be the only *matched* pair.

Both packets are now turned face down. The performer demonstrates a deal-and-switch mixing procedure with one packet, then the spectator calls out how one of the packets should be mixed. Cards are dealt face up from both packets in unison, and now every pair matches.

Method: Phase One is based on Paul Curry's "The Power of Thought," a two-deck effect, which was issued in a manuscript dated 1947. Phase Two is also based on a Paul Curry concept—his "Swindle Switch"—which was first described under the title "A Swindle of Sorts" in his book *Paul Curry Presents* (1974).

Here is the setup: Fan the deck with the faces toward you and upjog one card of each value from ace through king of mixed suits. Strip these out, making sure they are mixed, then ribbon spread them from left to right face up on the table. Make sure there is a good mixture of colors and values. Now ribbon spread the rest of the deck face up on the table, remove the mate of each card in the 13-card spread and form another 13-card spread. When finished, each spread should be in the same left-to-right order of mates. Square each spread, drop both onto the face of the deck proper and you are ready to begin.

Start with a false overhand shuffle, using the Bottom Stock Control (see Appendix, *Volume 1* of this work) to retain the order of the bottom 26 cards. Explain that you will use only about half the deck. Fan the deck face up, remove the bottom 26 cards and discard the rest.

The packet can now be Charlier shuffled and cut any number of times. It maintains its cyclic order.

Phase One: Hold the packet face down, spread off the top 13 cards and table them face down to your right. Hold the remaining 13 cards in the left

hand, getting a left little-finger break beneath the top two cards. Double cut these to the bottom.

Explain to a spectator that you need him to touch the back of one card as you spread the packet. Spread the cards slowly from left to right, allowing the spectator to touch the back of a card, preferably one above center. Outjog his selection. In squaring the packet, get a left little-finger break beneath the *second* card below his selection. Ask him to remove his card and turn it face up. As he is turning the card face up, the right hand lifts off the cards above the break; extend the left-hand cards so he can drop his card face up on them. Drop the right-hand cards on top, then table this packet to the *left* of the tabled packet.

Begin by turning the top card of each packet face up in unison and dealing them face up above the packets. Continue turning up the cards in unison and dealing them face up above the face-down packets (Figure 1). Comment that each pair consists of entirely different cards. Keep dealing until you reach the face-up card in the left-hand packet. Pick up the face-up card, along with the face-down card on top of the right-hand packet, and set these two cards aside. Continue turning up the rest of the cards in pairs to show that none match.

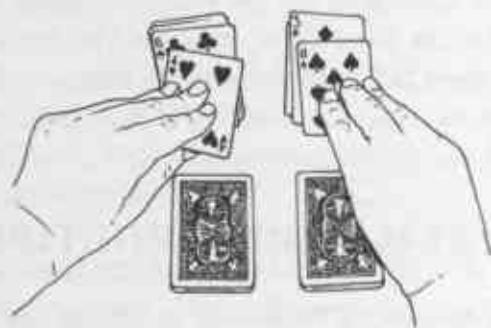


Fig. 1

Finally, turn over the face-down card of the pair laid aside to reveal that these two cards are perfect mates—the same value and color.

Set these two cards aside.

Phase Two: Turn the right-hand packet face down in place and pick up the left-hand packet. Get a break under the two cards at the face and double

cut them to the top (rear) of the face-up packet, then turn the packet face down.

You now demonstrate the Curry Swindle Switch with the in-hand packet: Slowly deal, say three cards, one at a time face down into a tabled pile. The right hand deliberately takes the top card, slides it under the next top card, then drops the pair onto the tabled cards. Continue dealing singly and "switch" any additional cards. This procedure does not actually switch any cards; the order of the cards is simply reversed.

Now have the spectator select either packet, explaining that you now want him to call out the switches. Pick up the selected packet and deal and "switch" as before except the spectator tells you when to make a "switch." Once the packet has been dealt, both packets are now in the same order.

Slowly deal cards from the packets face up in unison as before, and now every pair will match—a very startling effect! Congratulate the spectator on his success.

Note: This routine is very effective using two duplicate sets of 13 tarot cards. You will need to obtain two identical tarot decks and remove the same 13 cards from each deck for the routine. One of the most colorful tarot decks is the Pointer Tarot Deck, published by Piatnik & Sohne. It is currently available from U.S. Games Systems, Inc.

A "STAGGERED" ROUTINE

Eddie Joseph's "Staggered" was sold in manuscript form in 1949 by Abbott's Magic Novelty Company. The original effect used two decks, while this routine uses just one. The routine and handling get the maximum effect from Joseph's fine principle.

Effect: There are four phases: A spectator shuffles the deck, then the spades and hearts are removed to form one half, the clubs and diamonds the other half. The performer removes a prediction card from one half and tables it face down. A spectator removes a card from the other half and lays it face up onto the performer's card. Cards are now dealt face up from each half-deck until the mate to the spectator's card appears. The card that turns

up at the same time in the other half-deck is, say, the JC. The card originally tabled is shown to be the mate, the JS.

The second phase is essentially a repeat of the first. In the third phase, the spectator cuts each half, and two face-down cards are laid above the half-decks. The performer deals pairs in unison from each half, stopping on "impulse." The next two cards match the spectator's two face-down cards. In the fourth phase, the spectator mixes either half with a "deal or switch" procedure. Now cards from both halves are dealt in unison and all the pairs match.

Method: To set up, remove all the spades and hearts, mix this half-deck thoroughly and spread it from left to right face up on the table for reference. Now arrange the clubs and diamonds in the same order as the spades and hearts, placing the mates face up into a separate spread. Reverse the order of either half-deck, then drop one half onto the other and you are set.

Phase One: To begin, spread the deck face up in the hands to briefly show that the cards are mixed. As you square it, get a left little-finger break between the halves; this will be between the pair of mates at the center. Divide the deck at the break, turn the halves face down and have a spectator riffle shuffle them together.

Spread through the deck from face to back and upjog all the spades and hearts. It is best to count them to yourself, making sure that you have all 26. Strip them out as a block, without disturbing their order. Lay the halves next to each other face down on the table.

Pick up the left-hand half and fan it with the faces to you as you explain that you will remove one card. The right hand removes the right half of the fan and lays the top (leftmost) card of this group face down on the table. This can be any card, say the 2D. Table it about 12 inches away from you. The right hand places the rest of its cards behind those in the left hand. This half has been casually cut at the point where the card was removed. Table the half face down in its original position.

Have a spectator cut the other half-deck and complete the cut. (He can cut it again if he likes.) Turn over the top card (the card he cut to) and place it face up onto your single face-down card.

Patter about how “significant” his card might be. Using both hands, deal the top card of each half face up in unison to start two face-up piles just above the face-down halves. Continue to deal in pairs until the mate to the spectator’s card appears on pile A. See Figure 1. Point out that by fate, the 2H turned up at the same time on the other pile, pile B. Turn up the card you laid face down originally, showing it is the mate to the 2H—the 2D.

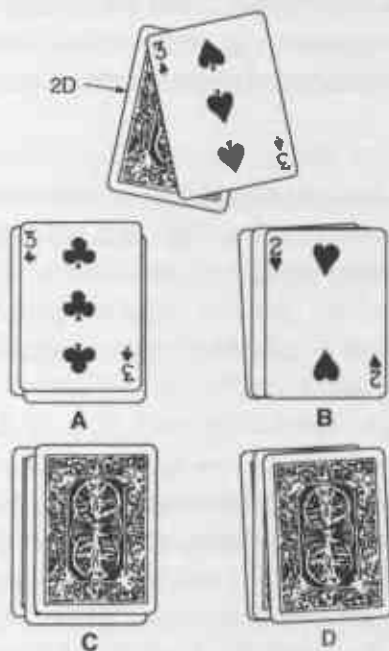


Fig. 1

Place the two matching pairs, the 3C-3S and 2D-2H, aside, face up. Pick up the four piles, as follows: The left hand picks up pile C, while the right hand picks up pile D. Turn both piles face up. The right hand drops its pile face up onto pile B. The right hand then picks up pile A and drops it face up onto pile C, which is in the left hand. (Note: This same pickup is used after the second and third phases as well.)

Turn both piles face down side by side on the table and you are ready for—

Phase Two: This is essentially a repeat of Phase One except that the spectator selects both cards that are laid forward:

Pick up the left-hand half and fan it face down, asking the spectator to touch the back of any card. Once done, the right hand moves forward with

the top half of the fan, the spectator's touched card being the bottom card of this group. The spectator's card is tabled face down about 12 inches in front of you; the right-hand cards are returned *below* those in the left, once again cutting this half unobtrusively. Table this half face down to the left.

Now pick up the right-hand half and repeat by having the back of another card touched. This card is laid forward with the first, but the right fingers lever it face up onto the first tabled card. The right hand places its cards below those in the left hand, so that this half has also been cut. Set the half face down to the right of the first half.

Deal cards face up in unison until the mate to the face-up card shows, then stop. Show that the original face-down card matches the face-up card on pile B. Lay both matching pairs aside.

Assemble the halves as explained above, then place the halves face down side by side once more.

Phase Three: Have the spectator cut the left half and complete the cut. Lay the top card forward of this half, face down. Repeat the same procedure with the right half: The spectator gives it a complete cut, then you lay the top card of this half forward, face down on the table. The spectator has selected both of these cards, and they remain unknown to you.

Now begin dealing cards face up in unison from both halves. Explain that you will stop on "impulse." As you turn the first pair face up, note the face-up card on the left. This is your key card. Continue to turn up cards in pairs until the mate to your key card appears on the right-hand half, then stop.

"*I felt inclined to stop here,*" you say as the left hand picks up the top card of pile C; the right hand picks up the top card of pile D and places it squarely on top of the left hand's card. Both cards are turned face up together and fanned. Place a face-up card onto each of the face-down cards on the table, the leftmost card of the fan face up onto the face-down card at the left and the rightmost card of the fan face up onto the card at the right (Figure 2). Show that each is a matched pair, then place them aside.

Assemble the halves as before and place them face down side by side.

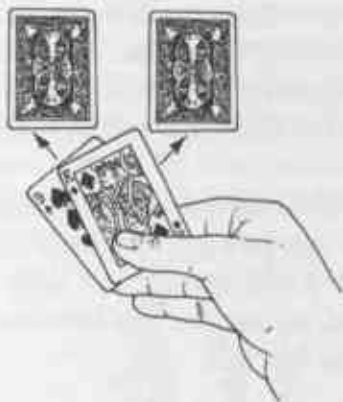


Fig. 2

Phase Four: This last phase employs Paul Curry's clever Swindle Switch concept.

Have the spectator designate either half, which you say will now be mixed according to his directions.

Pick up the designated half and hold it face down in the left hand. Explain that you will deal cards slowly, and at any point the spectator calls "switch," you will switch the next two cards. As you explain, take cards one *under* the other from the top of the left-hand half into the right hand. (You are keeping the cards in the same order.) Now demonstrate a switch by exchanging the next two cards but immediately move them back to their original positions. Square up the cards.

Now begin to slowly deal the cards one by one face down into a tabled pile. When the spectator calls "switch," the right hand takes the next card, slides it under the next top card, which has been thumbed over to the right, then both cards are deliberately dropped as a unit onto the dealt pile. (This is the Curry Swindle Switch, and the cards appear to have been switched but actually remain in the same order.) Continue dealing singles and "switching" as called for until all the cards have been dealt. Emphasize that the spectator has determined the order of the cards.

Each hand picks up a card from the top of each pile and deals them face up above the piles. They match! Continue to deal into vertical overlapping rows, showing that every pair matches. After about six pairs have been dealt, each hand picks up the remaining face-down cards and spreads them vertically toward you, showing that the rest of the pairs match (Figure 3).

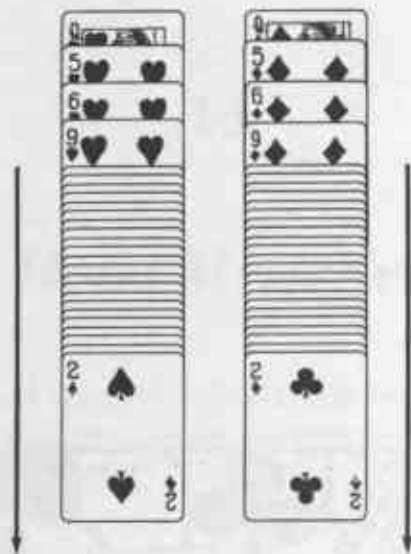


Fig. 3

Notes: When dealing the face-up piles watching for a mate, if no mate shows, then the two selected cards *are* mates. They are then shown and laid aside.

In Phase Three, if the mate to the key card shows on the *last* pair turned up, then the two face-down cards are mates. Show them and lay them aside.

In Phase Three, if the mate to the key card *does not show* after dealing all the pairs, then turn both face-up piles face down, remove the top two cards and deal them, as explained, face up onto the two face-down cards. Show the matched pairs, then lay them aside.

At the beginning of any of the first three phases, the halves can be cut or Charlier shuffled, which adds to the deceptiveness of the routine.



The King Can Do No Wrong

From *Abbott's Magic Novelty Company Catalog No. 4, 1937*

13

Hotel Mysteries

"This effect [The Hotel Mystery] is the kind that lends itself beautifully to a story and your version of the story may be more or less spicy depending on the kind of audience you have."

—Ed Marlo, *Let's See the Deck*, 1942

The "Hotel Trick" plot dates back at least to 1859 when W. H. Cremer, the editor of *The Secret Out*, titled it "Like with Like, or How to Keep a Hotel." It appears that the first to popularize the plot was Ed Marlo. He published it as "The Hotel Mystery" in his booklet *Let's See the Deck* (1942). The modern Hotel Trick is an unpublished version by Persi Diaconis using four kings and two queens, suggested by Ken Beale about 1967, who wanted to apply the Thieves and Sheep plot to playing cards. This chapter offers five versions of the effect.

THE FIRST HOTEL MYSTERY

Effect: Two queens and four kings are shown. The queens are tabled face down side by side. Two kings are added to each queen to form two three-card packets. At the finish, the queens and kings are found in separate packets. The actions are accompanied by a story: Four gentlemen (kings) are out on the town. Two ladies of the evening meet them, and each lady retires to a hotel room with two male admirers. The hotel detective intercedes and checks each room. To his surprise, he finds the four gentlemen in one room and the two ladies in the other.

Method: Arrange these six cards from left to right in a fan: QS, QH, KC, KH, KD, KS.

The actions are accompanied by the patter story outlined in the description of the effect.

Hold the face-up packet in Biddle grip in the right hand. Count the four kings one by one into the left hand, Biddling the second king, the KD. Turn the left hand palm down, tabling its three cards. The left thumb peels off the QH into the left hand, and the QS (double) is laid face up onto the QH, jogged to the right, and displayed. These three cards are squared and dropped face down onto the tabled cards.

Pick up the packet and hold it face down in the left hand. Deal the top card (QH) face down to the left on the table (it can be flashed), then the next card (KD), supposedly the QS, is dealt face down to the right of the QH.

Take the top card into the right hand. The left thumb pushes the next card to the right; this card is scooped under the QH as the right hand's card goes on top of the QH. The top and bottom cards are outjogged about an inch. Make sure that all three are squared, as shown in Figure 1. Tilt the three-card sandwich face up to show the QH, apparently between two kings. Actually, only the KS and the lower end of the QH are visible.

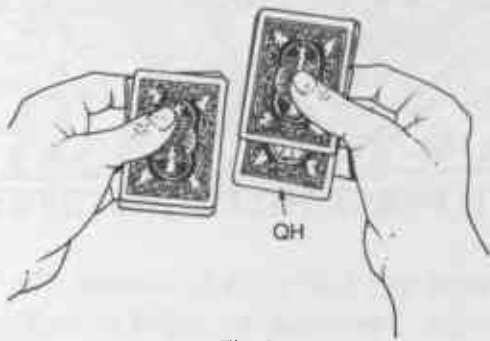


Fig. 1

Rest the three-card packet face down on top of the two cards in the left hand momentarily; the QH is injogged from the rest. The right thumbtip lifts up on the inner end of the QH as it is pushed flush. The top two cards only are lifted off with the right hand and placed on the table to the left of the tabled card. Supposedly this is a sandwich of three cards.

The right hand takes the three-card packet in Biddle grip. The left fingers drag the bottom card of the right-hand packet to the left about half its width. The right hand turns palm up to display two kings (Figure 2). The right hand turns palm down, the bottom card is taken into the left hand and scooped under the tabled card on the right as the right hand's double card is placed on top. Apparently, a king is being placed below and above the queen at the right. Square these cards and drop them on the table.

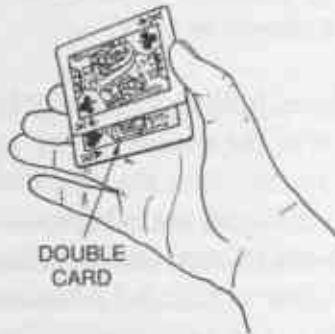


Fig. 2

All that remains is to show the two queens are together at the left and the four kings are together at the right.

THE SECOND HOTEL MYSTERY

The storyline is the same as outlined in the first mystery.

This handling was inspired by Jon Racherbaumer's "Let Om (First Approach)" in *The Looking Glass*, Winter 1996.

Method: To set up, remove the QH, QC and the four kings. Discard the rest of the deck. Arrange the six cards from top down in a packet: QH, QC, KH, KC, KS, KD.

To perform, hold the packet face down in the left hand and fan it to show just six cards. As you square, get a left little-finger break beneath the fourth card. Now push over the top two cards (queens) and flip them over so they land face up on top. Perform the Braue Addition as two queens are shown: The right hand lifts off the four cards above the break, two face-up queens

and two face-down cards. The left thumb pulls the QC to the left, then it is levered over face down onto the top of the two face-down cards in the left hand; immediately drop the right-hand cards on top. Flip the QH face down on top.

Deal the QH face down on the table and the next card (supposedly the QC) face down to the right of the QH.

Turn the packet face up and Elmsley Count to show what appears to be the four kings. (The KD is shown twice.)

Turn the packet face down, holding it in the left hand. You now apparently place two kings with each of the queens. Scoop up the QH, using the top two cards of the packet, like this: Take the top card into the right hand, then push over the next card to the right; the left-hand card that was pushed over scoops under the QH as the right-hand card is slid on top of the QH. Both of these cards are outjogged about an inch. All three cards are squared from side to side, as shown in Figure 1. The right hand tilts the three-card sandwich to show the QH, apparently sandwiched between two kings. Actually, only the KS and the lower end of the QH are visible.

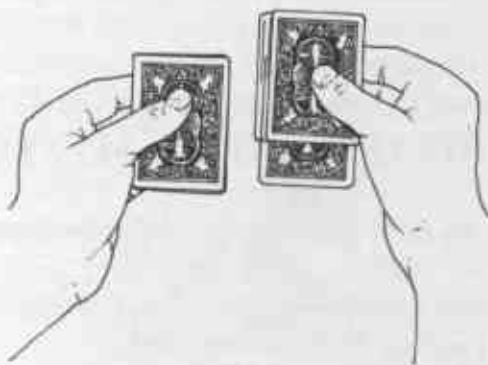


Fig. 1

Lay the three-card packet face down onto the left-hand cards; the QH is still injogged. The right thumbtip lifts up on the inner end of the QH as it is pushed flush. The top two cards are immediately lifted off and tabled to the left of the tabled card. Supposedly this is the sandwich of three cards, but actually it is only two cards.

The right hand holds the remaining three cards in Biddle grip. The left fingertips now pull the bottom card of these three into the left hand. Both

hands rotate to show two kings; the king in the right hand is a double card (Figure 2).

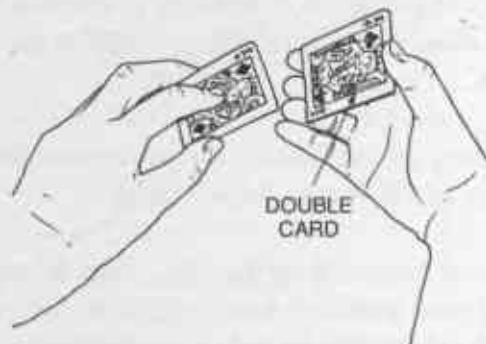


Fig. 2

Turn the cards face down and slide the KD under the tabled card at the right while the right hand places its double face down on top. Square the packet and table it in its original position.

All that remains, according to the story, is to show the two ladies in one room and the four gentlemen in the other.

THE THIRD HOTEL MYSTERY

The storyline is the same as outlined in the first mystery.

Method: Arrange a packet from top down: QH, KC, KH, KS, KD, QS. Discard the rest of the deck.

This handling uses a sequence similar to the Diminishing Count: Hold the six-card packet face down in the left hand. Pick it up in right-hand Biddle grip. Peel off four cards one by one into the left hand. The right hand shows the face of the double card, the QS, drops the double on top of the packet, then deals the top card (KD) face down to the *right* on the table.

The left thumb peels off four more cards one by one into the left hand; the right hand shows the QH (single) and deals it face down on the table to the *left* of the tabled card.

Fan the remaining four cards face down and take the top two into the right hand. Each hand “squiggles” its two cards by moving the top card of each pair back and forth with the thumbs to emphasize there are just two cards in each hand. Place the left-hand pair on top of the right, then square the four-card packet.

Turn the packet face up and Elmsley Count to show four kings, then turn the packet face down and hold it in the left hand.

Spread over the top two cards to the right. Take the top card in the right hand and the second card at the left-hand fingertips. Slide the left-hand card under the QH, which is tabled to the left; the right-hand card, the QS, is slid on top of the QH. Both of these cards are outjogged about an inch as shown in Figure 1. Square all three cards from side to side, then tilt the three-card sandwich to show the queen apparently sandwiched between two kings. Rest the three-card packet face down momentarily on top of the two cards in the left hand; the QH is injogged from the rest. The right thumb then lifts up on the injogged QH and holds a thumb break below it as it is squared with the other cards. The right hand lifts off the top two cards (supposedly three) and sets them on the table to the left of the tabled card. Supposedly this is a sandwich of three cards.



Fig. 1

The right hand holds the three-card packet in Biddle grip. The left fingers now drag the bottom card (KH) to the left, and both hands rotate to show the KH in the left hand, the KS (double) in the right (Figure 2). Rotate the hands so the cards are face down, then sandwich the right-hand tabled card, sliding the KH under the card and placing the KS (double) on top. Square the cards and drop the packet on the table.

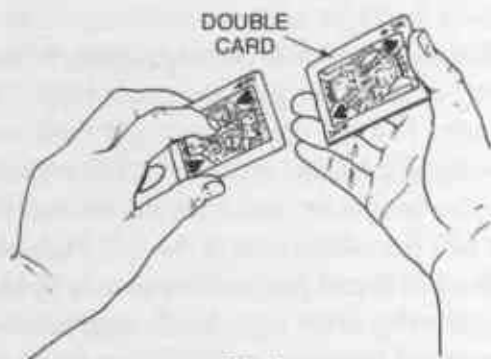


Fig. 2

To finish the story, all that remains is to show the two ladies in the room at the left and the four gentlemen in the room at the right.

THE FOURTH HOTEL MYSTERY

The storyline is the same as outlined in the first mystery.

Method: Arrange a packet from top down: QS, QH, KC, KH, KS, QC, KD. The JS in on top of the deck to later serve as the hotel detective.

Hold the seven-card packet face down in the left hand. Spread over the top cards to the right; the left little finger gets a break under the third card as the right hand flops the top two queens face up onto the packet.

Use a mini Braue Addition: With the right hand, lift off the top three cards in Biddle grip. With the left thumb, pull the face-up QH to the left and lever it face down on top of the packet; at the same time, drop the right-hand cards on top. Now flip over the QS face down on top.

Deal the top card (QS) face down to your left on the table and the next card, supposedly the QH, but really the KC, face down to the right.

Get a left little-finger break under the top two cards of the packet and cut them to the bottom.

To check, the packet now reads from top down: KS, QC, KD, QH, KH.

Now use the Diminishing Count (see Appendix, *Volume 1* of this work for a full description) to show the packet as four kings: Hold the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off three cards one at a time into the left hand, leaving a double in the right. Show the face of the double to be the KH. Drop the double on top of the packet and thumb the top card face down onto the QS, the tabled card at the left. Hold the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off two cards one by one into the left hand. Show the KS (double) in the right hand, drop the double onto the left-hand cards, then thumb off the top card (QC) face down onto the two tabled cards at the left. Grip the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off one card into the left hand. Show the KH (double) in the right hand and the KS in the left. Place the double face down onto the single and drop all three cards face down onto the tabled card at the right.

Apparently two queens were originally dealt on the table, then two kings were dealt onto each queen.

Pick up the JS from the top of the deck, referring to it as the hotel detective—Jack Spade, the son of the famous Sam Spade. Say, *"Jack heard a commotion from both rooms and went to inspect. He knocked on the door of the first room."* Use the JS to flip over the three cards on the left face up. *"Nothing was going on. The two ladies and their sister were all sitting around knitting."* The QC, QH and QS are displayed.

"While in the other room, the men were playing poker," you say. Use the JS to flip over the four cards at the right to display the four kings.

THE FIFTH HOTEL MYSTERY

This is the storyline for this version: Four ladies (queens) and four gentlemen (kings) are shown. The ladies retired to the only four rooms left in the hotel. The four gentlemen were seen sneaking into the ladies' rooms by the hotel clerk. Later, the clerk, who was a "Peeping Tom," looked through the keyhole to discover the ladies sharing two of the rooms and the gentlemen sharing the other two rooms.

Method: This is a simplified version of Gene Maze's trick "Peeping Tom" in the e-book *Virtual Miracles* (2000), compiled and edited by Peter Duffie.

From *face to back* the cards are set: QC, QH, QS, QD, KC, KH, KS, KD, JS. Discard the rest of the deck.

Hold the packet face down in the left hand. Deal the top card, the JS, face down to one side. Turn the packet face up and hold it in right-hand Biddle grip. Count the cards one by one into the left hand: Pull off the QC, then the QH; as the QS is pulled off, hold a left little-finger break beneath it, then pull off the QD. Pause. Now, as the KC is pulled into the left hand, pick up the two queens above the break (QS and QD); continue by pulling off the KH and the KS. Lay the KD and the two cards hidden beneath it as one onto the face of the left-hand packet.

Square the packet and turn it face down. The four queens are supposedly on top of the packet. "*The four ladies each went into a separate hotel room,*" you say. Deal the top four cards (apparently queens) onto the table into a square formation at positions A, B, C and D as shown in Figure 1. The first two cards (queens) can be flashed.

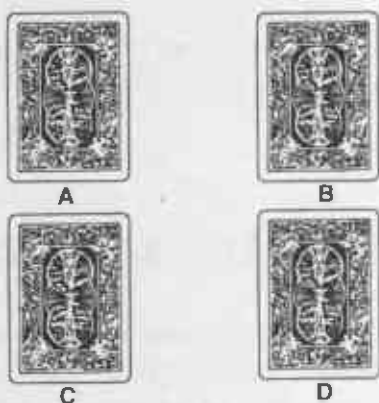


Fig. 1

"*The four gents had to share the rooms with the ladies . . .*" Here you push over the top card of the left-hand packet to the right, then flash the face of this card and the bottom card of the packet as shown in Figure 2. Square the packet, then deal the four cards clockwise, starting with position C (lower left corner). Lay the JS face up in the center of the layout, referring to it as a "Peeping Tom."

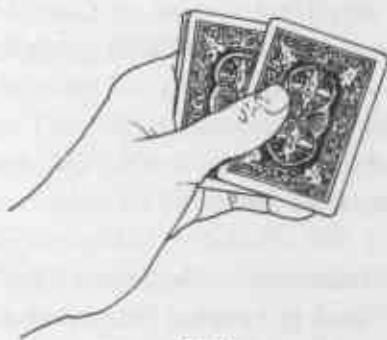


Fig. 2

"Everything was as it should be—the ladies were in their two rooms knitting, and the men were in the other two rooms playing poker," you say. Use the JS to flip over the pairs at positions A and B to show four queens. Then flip over the pairs at C and D to reveal the kings.

14

Divinations

"Among the marvels of the conjurer, ancient or modern, feats of divination have always held a prominent place. Indeed, to many persons, they seem the most magical of all."

—Professor Hoffmann, *More Magic*, 1890

Tricks wherein the number of cards, their color, suit or value is "divined" are always intriguing to spectators. This chapter contains several divination-type effects, concluding with three very impressive routines.

TROST ON "SCARNE'S \$1,000 CARD TRICK"

Effect: The deck is divided into two groups. Cards are shuffled face up and face down, forming a totally random mixture. The performer holds the deck under the table, attempting to feel which cards are face up and which are face down. He cuts the deck into two groups and tables them. He bets that he can correctly name which group has the most face-up cards and exactly how many more face-up cards it contains than the other group. Upon examination it is found that he is absolutely correct! The effect is immediately repeated with a different result—and the performer again wins the bet.

Method: This is my method and handling for John Scarne's trick titled "Scarne's \$1,000 Card Trick," which appeared in *John Scarne's Newsletter*, January 1976. He said that its secret had never appeared in print previously. Scarne claimed that he baffled many of America's top gamblers and magicians with this card trick and that he later sold the secret to the legendary Nick "The Greek" for \$1,000.

The method that I came up with is much simpler than Scarne's. Scarne had to spread the deck, glimpse and remember the number of face-up and face-down cards on top, then when the deck was out of sight, reverse certain noted cards. The system was involved. In my method, you do not have to spot and remember any cards; you simply divide the deck into two groups. Also, there is no preset deck as in Scarne's method. The setup is made as part of the trick.

I have also added the very baffling "Equalizer" shuffle, which gives the impression that the cards are randomly mixed face up and face down. The Equalizer shuffle is Harry Lorayne's term he used in his book *Trend Setters* (1990) for the shuffle first described by Simon Aronson in his *Shuffle-Bored* (1980) and later popularized by Aldo Colombini in his marketed trick "Pre-Deck Ability" (1996).

Use a complete deck of 52 cards. Begin by explaining that you will need about half the deck. Hold the deck face down in the left hand and spread off 26 cards into the right hand, counting eight groups of three plus two more cards. You may want to patter about how this trick baffled Nick "The Greek" and that he paid John Scarne \$1,000 for its secret.

Table the halves face down about seven to eight inches apart. We'll call the left half, A, and right half, B. Now carry out the "Equalizer" shuffle with the two halves: Have a spectator cut off a packet from half A and place it between the halves at C. Turn this packet face up and riffle shuffle it face up into half B. Now the spectator cuts off a packet from B and drops it between the halves at C. Turn over this packet and riffle shuffle it into half A.

This procedure can be repeated any number of times, cutting off a packet from either A or B, turning over the cut-off packet and riffle shuffling it into the opposite half. Finally, turn over either A or B and riffle shuffle it into the other half so the entire deck is together.

There appears to be no way you could control the number of face-up and face-down cards, but at this point, there will be 26 cards face up and 26 face down.

Have the spectator give the deck an additional overhand shuffle and a complete cut, if he likes, then he hands you the deck under the table.

With the mixed-up deck held under the table, explain that you will try to feel which cards are face up and which are face down. Then say that you are going to cut the deck into two groups, and you will not only name the group which has the most face-up cards but will also announce how many more face-up cards it contains than the other group.

With the deck in the left hand, quietly spread off (count) 29 cards into the right hand and place the 29-card group to your right on the table, as you say, *"This group has more face-up cards than the other group—exactly three more cards than the one I still have hidden under the table."* With both hands under the table, turn over the remaining group, then bring it out and table it to the left of the first group.

While both groups are on the table say, *"I'll bet anyone that the right-hand group has three more face-up cards than the left-hand group."*

Pick up the left-hand group and spread it slowly, counting aloud the face-up cards. Say there are ten. *"I said there are three more face-up cards in the right-hand group—that should be thirteen."* Replace the left-hand group on the table and pick up the right-hand group. Slowly spread and count aloud the face-up cards in this group, showing there are indeed 13. You win the bet and leave the spectators stunned! Table the right-hand group.

The Repeat: If you want to repeat, you are all set. Go directly into the Equalizer shuffle with the two groups on the table. For the last shuffle, turn over either group and shuffle it into the other one. (There will now be 26 face-up and 26 face-down cards in the deck at this point.)

Take the deck under the table. Spread off 27 cards into the right hand and table these to your right. Turn over the remaining cards and table them to your left.

"This time, I'll bet that the right-hand group has one more face-up card than the left-hand group." Pick up and count aloud the face-up cards in the left-hand group. Say there are 11. Then count the face-up cards in the right-hand group, showing it contains 12 in this case.

Notes: If you spread off 26 cards into the right-hand group, then turn over the left-hand group, the two groups will contain the same number of face-up cards. Any difference over 26 in the right-hand group will equal the number of additional face-up cards in this group than in the left-hand group.

The Scarne effect appears to be related to Bob Hummer's trick "The Magic Separation," which appeared in Hummer's pamphlet *Half-A-Dozen Hummers* (1940).

WEIGHING THE COLORS

Effect: The performer separates the red cards from the blacks and tables them face down in separate piles. While he turns away, spectator A draws a total of seven cards, taking some of each color. Both piles are then turned face up, and spectator B draws seven cards from the faces of the piles. The remaining cards are set aside. The performer "weighs" each packet and divines the number of reds and blacks in each.

Method: Pick up the deck and openly separate the red cards from the blacks, shifting all the red cards to the top. When this has been done, secretly move *four* black cards above the reds. Fan the cards to show the colors separated (without exposing the four black cards on top). As you spread the cards, remember the *seventh* black card from the face of the deck (the 5C, for example) as your key card. Apparently split the colors but actually include *three* red cards above the blacks. Place the halves side by side face down on the table.

The situation at this point is that you have a packet of red cards with *four blacks* on top; also there is a packet of black cards with *three reds* on top, and you are remembering the seventh card from the face of the black packet, the 5C in this example.

Turn away while you instruct spectator A, as follows: Ask him to draw a face-down card from either packet and place it face down in front of himself on the table; then he is to continue drawing cards from either packet until he has *seven* cards in front of him. Encourage him to mix up his draws.

Face front and turn the packets face up. Ask spectator B to draw seven cards while the packets are face up. Turn away as he does so. When he has drawn his cards, ask him to hold them face down.

Face front once more. You begin drawing *black* cards until you have drawn the key card (the 5C in this case). As you do, explain that the black cards are a bit heavier than the red ones, and that you will attempt to "weigh" the packets to determine how many reds and blacks are in each. Drop your cards back onto the black half and set both piles aside.

The number of black cards you held (including the key card) tells you how many *red* cards spectator B holds. If you removed *six* blacks, then he holds *six* reds. (Note: If your key card is on the face of the black packet, the spectator holds one red.) Pretend to weigh spectator B's packet and announce how many reds and blacks it contains. Have him count his reds and blacks, proving that you are correct.

Spectator A will *always* have *three reds and four blacks* due to this variation of the Gilbreath principle. You now pretend to weigh his cards and announce the number of each color in his packet. He verifies that you are correct.

Notes: To dress up the effect, a two-compartment plastic card tray can be used. These are generally available where playing cards are sold.

This effect first appeared in my book *Subtle Card Magic, Part Two* (1976).

ROUGE ET NOIR DIVINATION

Effect: A deck is riffle shuffled by a spectator, and two ten-card piles are dealt on the table. The spectator selects either pile and hides it from view by placing it in the card case. The performer assembles the rest of the deck,

shuffles it, then removes ten cards at random, forming a ten-card pile of his own. He says that he will attempt to place his cards in exactly the same color order as the spectator's cards. When the cards from the two piles are turned up in unison, it's seen they match color for color, throughout.

Method: The trick depends on the Gilbreath principle. Set up the deck in alternating red-black-red-black order.

To perform, cut the deck in half so there is a red card at the face of one half, a black card at the face of the other. Have a spectator riffle shuffle the halves together and square the deck. Pick it up and alternately deal two piles of ten cards each face down on the table. The spectator now selects either pile and places it in the card case. The right hand picks up the other ten-card pile and places it face down onto the cards in the left hand; hold a left little-finger break beneath it. Double cut the ten cards to the bottom. Use the Bottom Stock Control to retain the order of the bottom ten cards.

Explain that you will now try to divine the color order of the cards in the spectator's packet and arrange another packet of cards in the same color order.

Due to the Gilbreath principle, the stack of ten cards on the bottom of the deck proper is now in *reverse* color order of the spectator's ten cards in the card case. By referring to the order of the bottom ten cards, you build a ten-card packet that will be in the *same* color order as the spectator's packet. Here is the procedure:

Hold the deck with the faces to you, fan over ten cards at the face and note the eleventh card, say the 3S, as your key card. Figure 1 shows an example of the color order of the ten cards at the face of the deck. Remember, you want to switch every black card for a red and every red card for a black. Use as many of the ten cards on the face of the deck as you can to build a ten-card packet (from bottom to top) in *reverse* color order of the bottom ten cards. For example, note that there is a red-black pair on the face. With the right thumb, peel off the 6S into the right hand, then peel off the JD on top of it. (This switches the colors of the first two cards.) Drop these cards face down on the table to begin building your ten-card packet. The next card (the 4C) is black; it needs a red card in its place, but there is no red card next to it to switch it with. Peel it off into the right hand and transfer it to the top

(rear) of the deck. Remove any red card (to the left of the bottom stock) and deal it face down onto the tabled cards.

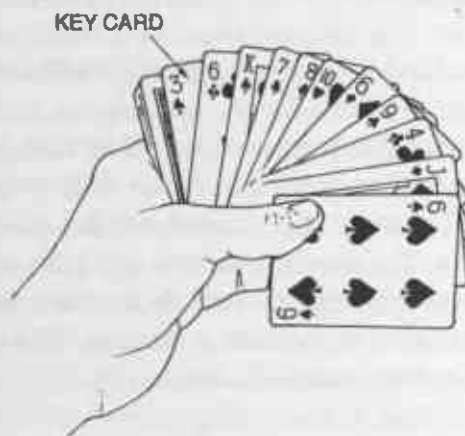


Fig. 1

Continue. The next two cards, the 9S and 6D, are a black-red pair, so reverse their order as you peel them off one by one into the right hand; add them to the tabled stack. Repeat with the next black-red pair (the 8S and 10H). The last three cards (the 7S, KS and 6C) are all black and have no red card counterparts, so simply remove any three red cards and add them to the top of the tabled stack. (There is no need to shift the three black cards to the back of the deck since they are the last three cards to be used.) You have reached your key card, the 3S, so you know automatically that you have exactly ten cards in your tabled stack. Set the deck proper aside.

The work is all done now; the rest is buildup. Explain there would be no way of knowing the color order of the spectator's cards since they are hidden in the card case. Before removing his cards, gaze at the card case, then pretend that you were just struck with an idea. Say, "*Wait, I want to make one change.*" Remove the top card of your packet and exchange it for any other card of the *same* color from the deck proper. You have not changed anything, but it appears that this "adjustment" is important to the outcome of the effect. You now have a ten-card pile on the table that is in the same color order as the pile in the card case. Place the two piles side by side and turn up cards in unison, showing you have matched the spectator's cards color for color—perfectly!

Notes: As you look at the color sequence at the face of the deck, look for red-black and black-red pairs, of course, for these are easily spotted and

switched. Also look for four-card sequences that can be switched—red-red-black-black or black-black-red-red. Reversing the order of either of these flip-flops the color sequence.

Another idea that can be used—if you feel it will add to the effect—is to deal four piles instead of two for the spectator to choose his pile from. What you would do is deal four piles of ten cards each, dealing in rotation just as for a card game. If the piles are viewed A, B, C and D, from left to right, then piles A and B are in *opposite* color order, and piles C and D are in *opposite* color order. The spectator selects any pile (say C) and places it in the card case. Now simply assemble the deck so the matching pile (pile D in this case) is double cut to the bottom of the deck. The other two piles are dropped on top. Proceed as described above.

A presentational idea is to obtain a glass eye (or any kind of fake eye) as Al Koran used in his trick “The Eye of the Beholder” in his book *Al Koran’s Legacy* (1972), written by Hugh Miller. The eye is slipped into the card case to “read” the order of the colors.

This effect was first published in my “Conjuring with Cards” column in *The New Tops*, October 1994.

DR. RHINE, OUTDONE!

Effect: A spectator riffle shuffles the deck. Several cards are dealt face up on the table. Now the performer says that he will attempt to match the face-up cards color for color by dealing an unknown face-down card onto each. He does so, turns up the pairs and every pair matches—color for color. The spectator now tries to match some cards, but fails to match more than two or three. The final portion of shuffled cards is taken by the spectator, who steps away so the performer cannot see his cards. The spectator then looks at the top card of his packet and concentrates on its color. Immediately the performer names the color, then correctly names the color of all the other cards in the packet.

Method: This routine uses the Gilbreath principle. Set up the deck so the colors alternate red-black-red-black, throughout.

As you begin the routine, false shuffle the deck and still keep the cards in alternate color order. One method is to give the deck a series of complete cuts, simulating an overhand shuffle. Another method is to overhand shuffle by running an *odd* number of cards into the left hand and throwing the balance on top. Repeat this procedure any number of times.

Cut the deck in half so the card on the face of one half is red and the card on the face of the other half is black. Have a spectator riffle shuffle the halves together and square the deck.

Phase One—Matching Test: Pick up the deck and deal a left-to-right row of four piles of ten cards each, dealing in rotation as for a card game. Place the remainder (12 cards) aside. View the piles as A, B, C and D, from left to right. From top to bottom, piles A and B are in *opposite* color order. For example, if the top card of A is black, the top card of B is red, and so on, throughout the piles. Also, piles C and D are in opposite color order.

Have a spectator select one of the four piles to be dealt. Suppose he selects B. Pick up pile B and deal five cards face up into a left-to-right row on the table, then a second row of five from left to right below the first as shown in Figure 1. Now pick up the pile that matches in opposite color order (pile A in this example). (Note: Of course if the spectator selects pile A, C or D, deal the selected pile face up, then pick up the pile matching in opposite color order and use it for the matching test.)

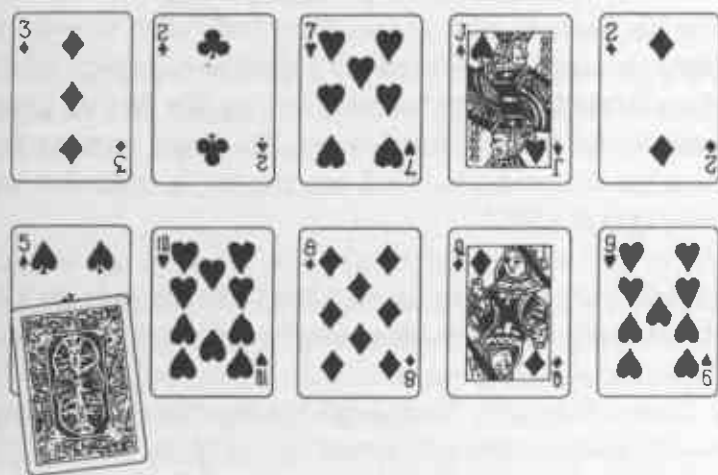


Fig. 1

"I'll now attempt a matching test—trying to match the face-up cards with a card of the same color," you say. *"By chance alone, I should get three or four correct—but more than that could indicate ESP at work."*

Deal cards randomly face down onto the layout. Deal a red card onto any face-up red card and a black card onto any face-up black card. All you do is "read" the colors in the layout from left to right, recalling that the card dealt is the *opposite* color. For example, if the first card in the layout is *red*, you know the top card of your packet is *black*. Deal your first card face down onto any face-up *black* card, overlapping the dealt card, as in Figure 1, so that you can still see the color of the face-up card.

Continue this procedure, dealing all your cards face down onto various face-up cards, matching the colors. You may end up with several cards face down on a single face-up card and none on another face-up card; it makes no difference. When finished, turn up all the face-down cards, showing that you have matched the colors perfectly! Now sweep all these cards aside.

Phase Two—Spectator's Test: *"Just for fun, I'd like you to try the same test,"* you say to the spectator. Pick up one of the two remaining piles (C or D, in this case) and deal out two face-up five-card rows as before. *"Try to match cards color for color."* As you patter, casually pick up the balance of the deck (12 cards) laid aside earlier and hand it to the spectator. He proceeds to deal these cards face down as you did yours.

When he has finished, turn up each face-down card, showing the result. His "matches" you leave face-up on top of the face-up card in the layout. If the cards do not match, discard his card, leaving the face-up layout card in place. Sometimes he will match one or two, but rarely, no more than four or five. Address him accordingly: *"Well, you are just average (above average or below average) in ESP."*

The spectator's outcome in the matching test can provide a humorous situation, but is really meant to set up the final phase of the routine.

Phase Three—Telepathy Test: Hand the spectator the remaining pile. Ask him to step away so that you cannot see his cards. Position yourself so that you can see the cards in the face-up layout on the table.

Ask the spectator to hold his packet face down in his hand, then he is to peek at the color of the top card and concentrate on it—trying to project that color to you. By glancing at the color of the first card in the layout, you will know the color of the top card of his packet; it is *opposite in color* of one glimpsed.

"I get the impression you are thinking of . . . a black card, I believe . . . Is that right?" When he acknowledges that you are right, have him discard that card and look at the next. To name this card, glance at the second card in the layout and name the opposite color. Proceed, naming the colors of all the other cards. When there are, say three cards remaining, state that you will try to determine their color without the spectator looking at them—a kind of clairvoyance test. Name the colors, such as, *"Black, red, red . . . in that order. Will you check?"* The spectator does and finds that you are correct.

Notes: This trick was marketed as a separate manuscript in 1964. As far as I know, it was the first trick in print based on the Gilbreath principle where one half of the deck keyed the color sequence of the other half. In 1963, I marketed an ESP card effect that had the same effect as "Dr. Rhine, Outdone!" but worked on a different principle. It was called "Telespo" and can be found in my book *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997).

MENTAL FINGERTIPS

In this double-barreled effect, the performer hands the deck to a spectator and turns his back. A spectator removes a small number of cards and slips them into his pocket. A second spectator then selects a card at random, which he pockets. The deck is shuffled and dropped into the performer's pocket.

Explaining that he has "mental fingertips," the performer removes two cards from his pocket. When the values of the two cards are added, their total corresponds to the number of cards hidden in the first spectator's pocket. For the second climax, the performer produces from his pocket the exact mate to the second spectator's card.

Method: Set up 28 cards on top of the deck as shown in Figure 1. The first two cards are indifferent ones; the next seven pairs are mates (matching

in color and value) and are in numerical sequence from aces through sevens, as shown; the last six pairs are mates, but are in no particular order.

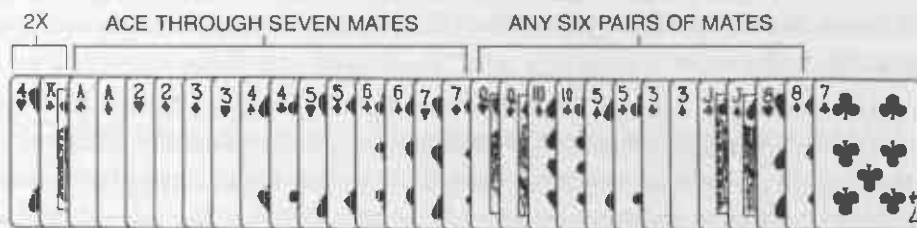


Fig. 1

Start with the deck face up. Spread the bottom half, showing the cards mixed. Square the deck and hand it to a spectator, saying, "*I want you to think of an odd number from say, three to thirteen. You could think of three, five, seven, nine, and so on. Don't tell me what number you've selected.*" Turn your back and continue. "*Do you have an odd number? Now deal off that number of cards from the top of the deck and slip them into your pocket. Have you done that? Fine!*"

Turn around, take the deck from the spectator and approach a second spectator. Request him to name aloud an *even* number from 4 to 14. We will assume he names 8. Deal off the top eight cards one at a time face down into a pile on the table. Hand him the eighth card, directing him to slip it into his pocket.

Drop the remainder of the deck onto the dealt cards. Pick up deck, square it, then give it a riffle shuffle, retaining the top card and the bottom two cards. Finally, drop the deck backs out into your coat pocket.

Announce that you will now attempt to divine the number of cards the first spectator removed. Ask him to concentrate on that number. Reach into your pocket and slowly produce, one at a time, the *bottom* two cards of the deck. Show their faces and exclaim, "*My mental fingertips are in fine shape this evening.*"

Add the values of the two cards, declaring their total corresponds to the number of cards he has in his pocket. Ask the spectator to count the cards in his pocket, showing that you are correct.

Again reach into your pocket, and after hesitating a bit, pull out the *top* card of the deck and drop it face down on the table. Point out to the second spectator that you have matched his card as closely as you can. Request him to remove his card and turn it face up on the table. It is, say, the KS. Dramatically flip over your tabled card. It is the KC. A miracle!

Note: I published "Mental Fingertips" as a separate manuscript in 1964.

RED AND BLACK ROUTINE

Effect: Ten red and ten black cards are removed from the deck and shuffled, then two spectators each note a card. A spectator mixes the packet, cutting the cards and turning some face up. The performer then deals four tabled piles and flops them over one onto another, further randomizing the face-up and face-down cards. When the cards are spread, one spectator's card is the only red card among the blacks, and the other spectator's card is the only black among the reds.

Next, with sensitive fingertips, the performer is able to separate the red cards from the blacks while holding a group of cards under the table.

For the finale, the spectator is able to pair up red and black cards and unknowingly separates the colors while holding the cards out of sight.

The tricks used in order of appearance are:

- 1) The Bob Hummer Cut-And-Turn-Over (CATO) procedure and Kuniyasu Fujiwara's "Automatic Triumph" roll-over ending from *Genii*, May 2000.
- 2) Warren Wiersbe's "Double Separation" from his booklet *Mental Cases with Cards* (1946). (This trick is based on a Bob Hummer concept.)
- 3) Karl Fulves' "Unmatched," which appeared in *The Pallbearer's Review*, September 1971.

- 4) A variation of Oscar Weigle's "Color Scheme," a trick he published in manuscript form in 1949.

These last two phases were inspired by Martin Gardner's red and black routine, which appeared in his "Mathematical Games" column in *Scientific American*, July 1972.

Method—Phase One: Explain that you will remove certain cards from a shuffled deck. Fan the cards with the faces to you and upjog ten red-black pairs—that is, each pair consists of a red card as the left card of the pair, a black as the right. Strip out the upjogged cards. This packet will alternate in color red-black-red-black, throughout. Discard the rest of the deck.

Give the packet a Charlier shuffle. The cards can be overhand shuffled by running an *odd* number of cards (three, five or seven) and throwing the rest on top. And the cards can be cut any number of times without changing the red-black rotation.

Place the packet face down on the table and have a spectator give it a complete cut. With the left hand, lift off the top card and ask spectator A to remember it. The right hand lifts off the next top card for spectator B to remember. Replace A's card on top, then B's. (The order of the two cards has been switched.)

Now demonstrate Hummer's Cut-And-Turn-Over (CATO) procedure, which you will ask a spectator to perform: Cut the packet, complete the cut and turn the top two cards face up as a unit. Then cut the packet, turn the top two cards face up and cut again. A spectator CATOs any number of times.

Now deal a left-to-right row of four piles, dealing in rotation as for a card game. We'll call the piles A, B, C and D, from left to right. Beginning at the left end of the row, roll over pile A onto B, both onto C, then all three onto D.

Ribbon spread the cards. All the face-up cards will be one color except for one card—one of the selections. Have it confirmed as one of the selected cards, then slide it out and set it aside. Have the other spectator name his card. Scoop up the spread, turn over the cards and respread them to show all face-up cards of the opposite color and the other spectator's card as the only odd-colored card. Remove it and set it aside also.

Phase Two: Scoop up the 18 cards and have a spectator give them an overhand shuffle.

Hold the packet under the table, explaining that you will attempt to separate these cards into two packets so there will be the same number of face-up cards in each. Spread off nine cards into the right hand, turn over the left-hand cards, bring both packets forward and set them on the table.

Pick up the left-hand packet. Spread it in the hands and deal the face-up cards into a separate pile, counting them aloud. Drop the face-down cards below these face-up cards. Repeat with the pile on the right: Spread it, then deal and count aloud the face-up cards into a pile. Drop the rest face down onto the first group of face-down cards (Figure 1.) Point out that you have placed the same number of face-up cards in each packet.

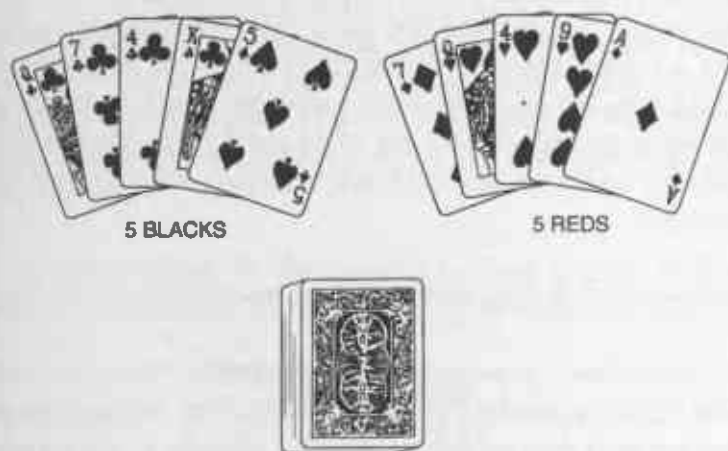


Fig. 1

Pick up the face-down cards. Emphasize that all the cards have been shuffled. Explain that you will now attempt to separate the colors. Take the packet under the table and spread off half of the cards. Half is determined by noting how many cards are in one of the face-up piles and subtracting that number from 9. For example, say there are five cards face up in one pile. Subtract 5 from 9, getting 4. In this case, spread off four cards from the hidden packet.

Drop the spread-off cards face down below the left-hand face-up cards. The others are dropped face down below the face-up cards on the right.

Turn over the face-down cards and show that these colors have also been separated.

Drop one color onto the other and proceed with—

Phase Three: False shuffle to keep the colors separated. A good, easy method is to shuffle off nine cards in two runs, say five, and throw, then four and throw. Then repeat the shuffle.

Hold the cards face down and fan them. Have a spectator pull any nine cards slightly forward from the fan. With the right hand, deal the nine outjogged cards, beginning with the top one, face down into a tabled pile. This dealing reverses the order of these cards. Square the other nine cards and place them face down beside the tabled pile.

Explain that the spectator has selected cards so that the colors in each pair are opposite—one red and one black. Turn over the top card of each pile to show a red and black card. Place the face-up red card under the face-up black card, turn the pair face down and drop it aside to start a new pile. Repeat the same procedure with the other eight pairs, always placing the face-up red card under the face-up black, then lay each pair face down onto the common pile.

The cards laid aside, alternating red and black, are now ready for—

Phase Four: Give the packet a Charlier shuffle. Now have a spectator perform the CATO procedure as explained earlier, cutting the cards and turning various pairs face up at random. This done, he is to take the 18-card packet under the table. He is to place the top card to the bottom of the packet and deal the next top card on the table. He repeats the same procedure: He places the top card on the bottom and deals the next top card on the table. He places each card brought forward into one of two piles, the face-up cards into one pile, the face-down into another. Silently count the cards dealt. When he has dealt nine cards, stop him and have him mix the remaining nine (without turning over any). Now he is to turn over the entire packet and continue to place the top card on the bottom of the packet and deal the next top card onto the two tabled piles.

When he has finished, show that all the red cards are in one pile, the blacks in the other.

A DIVINATION ROUTINE

This is a three-part routine, a blending of three effects in which the performer divines first, the *number* of cards in a packet cut off by a spectator, then the *colors* of cards in a packet and finally the *suits* in a group of cards.

The first effect in this routine is titled "As Many As You" in Walter B. Gibson's book *Magic Explained* (1949). J. N. Hilliard in *Greater Magic* (1938) referred to it as an ancient feat but did not know who to credit for the effect.

The second effect is also published in Gibson's *Magic Explained*, titled "Color Sense." It appears that this effect was invented by Gibson himself. He wrote in an article titled "Magidata" in *The Conjurors' Magazine*, May 1949, that the trick first appeared as "Pay Off" in *The Phoenix*, No. 1 (January 31, 1942) but dates to an unpublished Houdini book he was working on in 1928. The idea, he says, came when he was pondering over an old puzzle involving a glass of water and a glass of wine. He tested the puzzle using red and black cards and out of that demonstration, the red and black trick evolved.

And the third effect in the routine is Paul Flory's brilliant "Suit Discernment," published in *The Linking Ring* for January 1979.

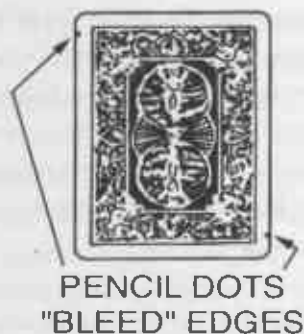


Fig. 1

Method: To prepare, you will need a full deck of cards, including a joker. The 5D is made into a bottom-cutting breather, which is also dotted on the back as in Figure 1. (See Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for directions on making a breather card.)

Phase One—As Many As You: Have a spectator thoroughly shuffle the deck as you explain you will demonstrate your powers of divination with cards.

Take back the deck and cut the breather card (the 5D) to the bottom. Hold the deck with the faces to you and, counting the 5D as 1, spread off 26 cards into the right hand as you look for the joker. Upjog the joker when you reach it, and if it is in the bottom half, continue to count to 26. Lay the joker aside and cut the deck so the 5D is twenty-sixth from the top.

Now say to the spectator, *"You have shuffled the deck thoroughly. Now I would like you to cut off a packet and hold it in your hand."* Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Have the spectator cut off less than half the deck. As he does this, appear to study his cut-off packet.

"Neither you nor I know how many cards you have in your hand until you count them—later." As this is said, the right hand cuts below the breather and tables its packet. This leaves 26 cards in the left hand. *"I have also cut a packet,"* you say. *"I have as many cards as you have, enough to make you have twenty-three and I'll still have three left over."* Repeat the patter.

(You always make this same statement no matter how many cards were cut off by the spectator.)

"Count your cards please on the table." Let's say the spectator has 16. Once the spectator has counted his cards, slowly count aloud 16 cards from your in-hand packet to the table. *"Here are my sixteen cards—as many as you have. And I said I'd have enough to make you have twenty-three."* (Here deal the next seven cards onto the spectator's packet, beginning with 17 and counting aloud to 23.) *And here (fan the three cards remaining) are the three cards left over, just as I predicted."*

Casually drop the three extra cards onto the spectator's pile (this makes 26). Place these cards into the left hand. Place your counted pile onto the pile with the breather on the bottom and drop these (26) cards onto the left-hand cards. The breather is now again twenty-sixth from the top.

Phase Two—Color Sense: False shuffle, using the Bottom Stock Control (see the Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for a description). The 5D remains twenty-sixth from the top.

Hold the deck face down in the left hand and have the spectator cut off about a third of the deck. Pretend to weigh your cards, then spread over some cards at the top. Say, "*Obviously, I have more cards than you.*" (Silently count the dotted card and those above it.) Say there are nine cards. Now say, "*But I can tell you that I have nine more black cards than you have reds. The black cards are heavier.*" Whatever number of cards you count, tell the spectator that you have that many more black cards than he has reds.

Have the spectator spread and count his red cards or you count them. Say that he has seven. "*I said I would have nine more blacks. You have seven reds—so if I have nine more blacks, I should have sixteen blacks.*" Spread your cards face up, counting the black cards and show you have 16.

Assemble by dropping the spectator's cards face down on top of your half—again bringing the 5D to the twenty-sixth position from the top.

Phase Three—Suit Discernment: False shuffle using the Bottom Stock Control. The 5D remains twenty-sixth from the top. Place the deck face down on the table and cut it in half at the breather. Lay the joker face up next to the halves.

Explain that you will now try to determine suits. The spectator is to think of any one of the four suits. Say that he thinks of hearts. Turn away so that you cannot see what he does.

Have him pick up either half-deck, remove all the cards of his selected suit (hearts in this case) and place them into his *left* coat pocket. Ask him to check to make sure he has removed all the cards of his suit, then he is to put the remaining cards he holds into his *right* coat pocket.

Now he is to pick up the other half-deck from the table, remove all cards of his selected suit (hearts in this case) and place them into his *right* coat pocket with the cards already there. Have him check to make sure that he has removed all the cards of his suit. He then places the remaining cards he holds into his *left* pocket with the cards already there.

Remind the spectator that at this point the selected suit is unknown to you.

Finally, the spectator is to place the joker into either pocket, the left or the right, adding it to the cards already in the pocket.

Still with your back to the spectator, ask him to remove all the cards from either pocket and shuffle them. Face the spectator. Now the spectator is to deal the cards one at a time onto your outstretched hand. Turn your head aside as he does so. As he deals, count the cards silently. When you reach 13, start the count at 1 again and remember the final number. (This is an Al Thatcher idea and saves a subtraction step.)

If the final number is even, you know the joker is not present. To determine the number of cards of the spectator's selected suit, divide by 2. For example, say you ended the count on 12, an even number. You know the joker is not present. Divide 12 by 2, getting 6. This tells you there are six cards of the selected suit.

If the final number is odd, the joker *is* present; subtract 1 from the number for the joker and divide by 2. For example, if you end the count on 15, an odd number, you know the joker is present. Subtract 1 for the joker, getting 14. Divide 14 by 2 getting 7, the number of cards of the selected suit.

Ask the spectator to name his selected suit. He says hearts, for example. Say, "*Yes, as you were dealing I detected seven hearts . . . I also detected the joker in that group. Please remove the hearts and the joker.*" He will count seven hearts, and the joker is present.

A COINCIDENCE AND DIVINATION ROUTINE

Effect: The deck is shuffled and divided in half. A spectator reverses a card in one half. Both halves are placed side by side face down on the table. The performer takes the top card of each half, turns both cards face up and deals them above the halves. The dealing continues. All the pairs are different. When the spectator's card is reached, the card of the same color and value—its mate—turns up in the other half!

The spectator now riffle shuffles the halves together. The performer holds the deck out of sight under the table, then with his sensitive fingertips, he is able to produce at will—red and black cards, cards of each suit, then certain values.

The remaining 26 cards are dealt into two piles of 13 cards each. The spectator takes either pile, leaving the performer the other. The performer openly separates his cards into two piles; the spectator blindly separates his cards, following the performer's lead. Both the spectator's and the performer's cards are shown. All the cards have somehow been separated into reds and blacks.

Method: This routine was inspired by Geoffrey Scalbert's effect called "Application of Gilbreath" from his book *There's a Trick in It* (1987).

Here are the credits for each phase of the routine:

- 1) Eddie Joseph's "Staggered" principle is the basis for Phase One. "Staggered" was published by Abbott's Magic Novelty Company in 1949.
- 2) Phase Two is based on the Gilbreath principle and my use of it in a trick titled "Blind-Sight," which I marketed in 1992 and later published in *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997).
- 3) The third phase is also based on an application of the Gilbreath principle. This application was first published in Tom Ransom's trick "You Did It!!!" in *Ibidem*, No. 6, March 1959, and later in J. W. Sarles' effect "Posi-Negative Cards" in *The Pallbearer's Review*, May 1967. The subtle spreading of the colors is a Martin Gardner idea. He published it as "Color Thot" in *The Pallbearer's Review*, February 1972, and later in his book *Martin Gardner Presents* (1993) as "Another Out of This World."

This routine could be presented after any effect that leaves the deck in Si Stebbins order, such as "Automatic Lie Speller" from *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997).

Phase One: The deck is in Si Stebbins order. An easy way to set up is described in the Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work.

False shuffle, using the G. W. Hunter shuffle, then give the deck any number of complete cuts.

Reverse deal 26 cards into a face-down pile on the table. (The halves are now in reverse order of mates.)

Have either half set aside to your right. A spectator picks up the other half and holds it face down in his hands. He cuts off about half of his cards and tables them. He turns over the top card of his in-hand packet, deals it face up onto the tabled cards, then drops the rest of his cards face down on top. His card is buried face up in this half-deck.

Move the other half to the right of the half with the selected card. Patter about how coincidences sometime happen. Deal the top card of each half in unison face up above each half as is shown in Figure 1. Patter about the mixture of cards as they are turned up. Continue to deal cards face up until you reach the spectator's face-up card on the left half. Turn over the top card of the right-hand half to show its mate, then deal the two cards face up onto the face-up piles—quite a coincidence! See Figure 1.

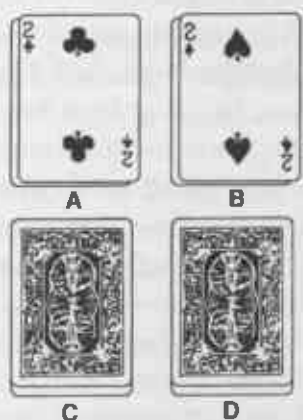


Fig. 1

(Note: It is possible two mates will show before reaching the face-up card, but this does not detract from the effect.)

To set for the next phase, the right hand picks up the top face-up card of pile A, scoops up pile A, turns it face down and places it into the left hand. Pick up pile C and drop it face down on top. Now, using the right hand, turn

pile B face down on top of pile D. Both halves are in reverse order of each other.

Phase Two: Have the spectator riffle shuffle the two halves together and square the deck.

Patter about being able to divine the colors of the cards. Take the deck under the table and hold it face down in the left hand.

Say that you will attempt to find a red and a black card. Pretend to be searching through the deck, then bring out the top two cards and deal them face up—a red and a black. Repeat, by bringing out the top card. It is, say, red. You can state that the next card will be black. Deal the second card face up.

Now explain you will find one card of each suit—a club, heart, spade and diamond. Bring out the top four cards and deal them face up. There is one of each suit. Repeat, but this time bring out the top three cards, then state that you still need to find say a club (or whatever suit is missing suit from the group). Finally bring out the next top card, a club, and deal it face up.

Quickly note the missing *value* from the 12 face-up cards. Say that it is a deuce, as shown in Figure 2. "*Finding a certain value is very difficult, but I'll try to find . . . say a deuce,*" you say. Finally, bring out the top card—the missing value and table it face up.



Fig. 2

To finish this phase, explain that you will attempt to locate one card of each value—an extremely difficult feat. Remove the top 11 cards and

spread them face up on the table. Point out that the two missing values, as shown in Figure 3, are the seven and ten. Bring out the top card and deal it face up. It will be either a seven or a ten. Then deal the next top card, naming this value exactly.



Fig. 3

This leaves 26 cards. Set these face down on the table as you sweep aside the face-up cards.

Pick up the 26 cards and overhand shuffle an *even* number and throw. Repeat two or three times.

Phase Three: Alternate deal the 26 cards face down on the table into two piles of 13 cards each. The spectator picks up either pile and holds it face down in his hands. Pick up the other pile and hold it face down in the left hand.

With the right hand, lift off the top card, and glimpse its color. If it is *red*, deal it face down to your *right* (red-right) on the table. If black, deal it face down to your left. The spectator deals his top card (without looking at its face) face down above your card. Now note the color of your next top card. If red, deal it to the right; if black, deal it to the left. The spectator again deals his top card face down above the card you just dealt.

Continue the procedure with the rest of your cards. At this point, there will be four face-down piles: A, B, C and D (Figure 4).

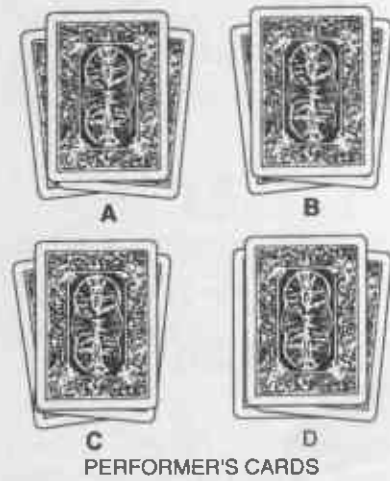


Fig. 4

Pick up pile B and ribbon spread it face up above the piles as shown in Figure 5. Pick up A and ribbon spread it below B, as shown. The colors will be separated. Now pick up C and spread it face up as a continuation of B, then turn D face up and spread it as a continuation of A. The black and the red cards have somehow been separated.

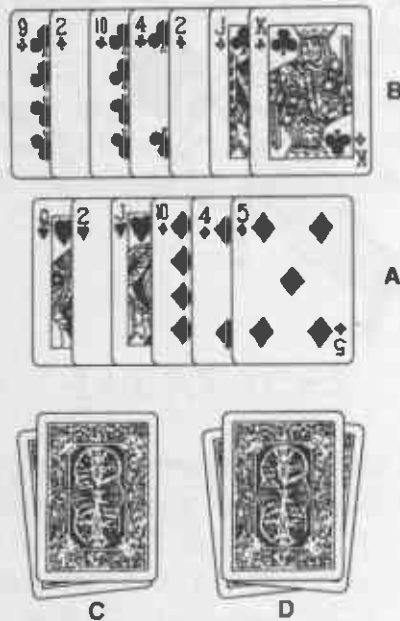


Fig. 5



Nelson Hahne Illustration

From *Holden's Catalog No. 15*, 1945

15

The Four Aces

"How to deliver out foure aces, and to convert them into foure knaves."

—Reginald Scot, *The Discoverie of Witchcraft*, 1584

Because the aces are the highest cards in a deck, tricks with them are instantly appealing to laymen.

This chapter contains a variety of ace effects. There are several ace locations—different ways that the performer and a spectator find the aces, an ace Triumph effect and a four-ace location that ends with the rest of the deck separated by suit. The chapter ends with a three-phase ace routine that I find very effective!

LUCKY ACES

Effect: The performer and a spectator each take half a deck. They each cut off a packet and place it face up on top, then cut deeper and turn over the cut-off packet. Then they each lay aside the card cut to. Both repeat the entire procedure, so they each have two face-down cards. These four cards turn out to be the four aces.

Method: Cull two aces to the top of the deck and two to the bottom.

Riffle shuffle, retaining the top and bottom stock. Have a spectator cut off half the deck. You spread your cards, commenting that you each have about half a deck. Get a left little-finger break above the bottom two cards, then reverse double cut them to the top of your half.

You and the spectator each perform the Hamman Flip-Flop Force: Briefly, hold your half-deck face down in the left hand. The left thumb spreads over a few cards; the right hand grasps them at the center of the right edge. Drag the group a little to the right and flip it face up onto the left-hand cards. Now the left thumb pushes over any amount greater than the face-up block, and the right hand flips over all these cards. Spread off your face-up cards and place them to the bottom of your half, then deal your top card face down on the table. The spectator does the same with his half-deck.

Now, you each repeat the Flip-Flop Force and table another card.

Turn up the tabled cards and show the four aces.

QUICK ACE OPENER

This is a quick and easy method for finding the four aces. In effect, a spectator indicates at what point the deck is cut in half. He then cuts each half into two portions. The performer shows an ace on each portion.

Method: Beforehand, place one ace on top of the deck, one on the bottom and the other two next to each other in the center.

Fan the deck with the faces toward you and downjog the right-hand ace of the two near the center. Square the cards from side to side, leaving the ace downjogged, then turn over the deck sideways so it is face down in the left hand. With the right thumb, press down on the injogged ace and get a left little-finger break above it. The break is between the center aces.

Begin by riffling down at the outer left corner of the deck with the left thumb, asking a spectator to call "stop." When stopped, lift off all the cards above the break with the right hand. (This is the same procedure used in the riffle force.) Drop this half-deck face down on the table at position A. Place

the other half face down on the table at position C, about six inches to the right of the cards at position A. (There will be an ace on the top and bottom of each of these halves.)

Now have the spectator cut off about half the cards from packet A and place them at B. He then cuts off about half the cards from packet C and places them at D (Figure 1).

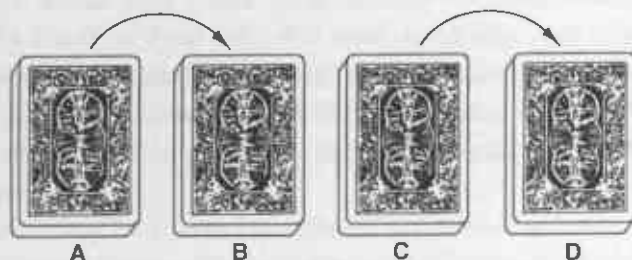


Fig. 1

All that remains is to disclose the four aces as follows: Turn over the entire packet at A, the top card of B, the entire packet at C and the top card of D. An ace shows on each packet.

Note: This effect first appeared in my column in *The New Tops*, June 1966.

TOPSY-TURVY ACES

Effect: The performer splits the deck in half, turns over half and shuffles it face up into the face-down half so the cards have been mixed face up and face down. The deck is cut and turned over to disclose an ace on the bottom. The ace is laid aside. Now the deck is shuffled in this topsy-turvy fashion again and a second ace is located. A third ace is found in the same manner. Now the deck is spread on the table and it's seen that all the cards have magically righted themselves except one card—the fourth ace.

Method: Beforehand, have the four aces reversed on the bottom of the deck.

Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Casually spread it to show that the cards are face down, without exposing the reversed aces on the bottom. Square the deck in the left hand. Now perform the Tenkai Move (see Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for working). Riffle shuffle the packets together, retaining the four face-down aces on top.

Square the deck and double cut the top card (an ace) to the bottom. Remark that some cards are now face up, some face down. Grip the deck from above with the right hand, then riffle the deck with the left thumb for effect. The right hand, with the deck, turns palm up, revealing an ace on the bottom. The left hand removes the ace and tosses it face up on the table. Turn the right hand palm down.

Double cut another ace to the bottom, reveal it and toss it aside, face up. Repeat with the third ace. Now give the deck one complete cut, order all the cards to right themselves, then ribbon spread the deck face up on the table, revealing the single face-down card in the center. Turn it face up, disclosing the fourth ace.

Note: This effect was first published in my column in *The New Tops*, December 1968, and later in my book *Subtle Card Magic, Part One* (1976).

THE MAGNETIC ACES

Effect: The performer and a spectator each hold a shuffled half-deck. The spectator follows the performer's actions: They each remove a card from their half-deck, rub it on their sleeve to "magnetize" it, then replace it face up into their respective half-decks. Each half-deck is spread to show that each "magnetic" card has attracted two aces.

This effect was inspired by Karl Fulves' "Magnetic Force" in his book *My Best Self-Working Card Tricks* (2001). The principle used here comes from a trick by Fulves titled "Parity Prophet," which appeared in his magazine *Rigmarole*, No. 4, 1993.

Method: To set up, remove the four aces. Cut the rest of the deck in half, place an ace second and fourth from the top of each half, then drop one half onto the other.

To begin, fan the deck with the faces toward you. Split the deck in half so there is an ace second and fourth from the top of each half. Jog shuffle each half, retaining the top four cards of each. Give a spectator a choice of either half.

The spectator follows your actions: Begin dealing off pairs from the top of your half into a face-down pile on the table and stop after you have dealt say five or six pairs. The spectator does the same with his half, stopping where he wants.

Lift up the top card of those dealt, turn it face up and rub it on your sleeve to "magnetize" it, then place it face up onto the cards remaining in your hand. You call this your magnetic card. Finally, pick up the dealt cards and drop them on top of the magnetic card. The spectator follows the same procedure with his cards.

Now deal off pairs into a tabled pile as before, making sure you deal somewhere past the face-up magnetic card and stop. This done, drop the rest of your cards (the undealt ones) on top. Again the spectator follows your actions with his cards, stopping past his magnetic card where he wants, then he drops his undealt cards on top.

Ribbon spread your cards face down on the table, and the spectator ribbon spreads his. You each remove your magnetic card and the face-down card on either side of it. These face-down cards are turned over to reveal the four aces.

ANOTHER VERSION

This version has an all red and black finish. To set up, remove the four aces from the deck. Set the rest of the deck so the red cards are on the top, blacks on the bottom. Insert the *black* aces second and fourth from the top of the red-card half. The red aces are inserted second and fourth from the top of the black cards.

Go through the same routine as explained in the original version above. For the finish, ribbon spread your half-deck face down on the table, remove your magnetic card along with the face-down card on either side of it, then turn over your three-card sandwich to show the magnetic card has found two aces of the same color—say black. The spectator ribbon spreads his half-deck face down, removes his three-card sandwich and shows two aces of the same color—say red. Finally, turn over the rest of your cards to show they are all red while the rest of the spectator's cards are all black!

THE MAGIC THRUST REPEATED

Here is a method for producing the four aces using Orville Meyer's force twice.

Meyer's force, called "The Magic Thrust," originally appeared in Jean Hugard's *More Card Manipulations, Series No. 1* (1938).

Method: The setup from top down is: red ace, black ace, the deck proper, black ace, X, red ace, X.

False riffle shuffle, retaining the top two cards and the bottom four cards. Spread the deck face down between your hands, asking a spectator to touch the back of any card near the center of the deck. Upjog the card, remove it and place it face up on top of the deck. Refer to it as a "marker" card.

Demonstrate what you want the spectator to do by taking the marker card and inserting it face up into the outer end of the deck, retaining your hold on the card. When he understands his role, replace the card face up on top of the deck. You are holding the deck in the left hand, which takes it under the table and hands it to the spectator. Before he takes the deck, use the left thumb to flip the deck over.

While the cards are out of sight, the spectator actually inserts the face card of the deck into the center and not the marker card. Now ask him to give the deck a complete cut, then hand it back to you while the deck is still under the table. Once you have it in your left hand, turn the deck over so it is again face down, then bring it into view.

Immediately hand-to-hand spread to the marker card. The right hand lifts off all the cards above the three-card sandwich (including the sandwich), moves forward and lays the three-card sandwich on the table (Figure 1). The rest of the right-hand cards are placed *beneath* the left-hand cards.

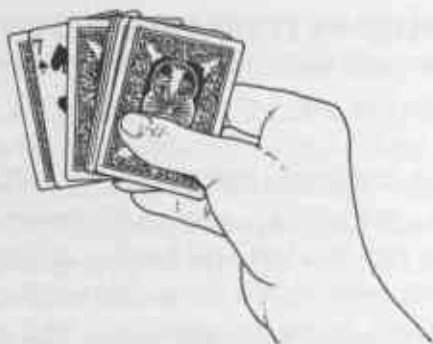


Fig. 1

To check, there is now a black ace on top of the deck and the other black ace second from the face.

Have another marker card touched near the center of the deck, place it face up on top, then have the same spectator (or a second spectator) repeat the same procedure to select two more cards.

Lay this second three-card sandwich on the table, then discard the rest of the deck. Turn over both three-card sandwiches to disclose the four aces—the red aces are in one sandwich, blacks in the other.

A VARIATION

Remove the four queens then set up the deck from top down: black queen, 23 reds, black queen, any red card, red queen, 23 blacks, red queen, any black card.

Fan the deck with the faces toward you. Cut it in half so that one half consists of the two red queens and all black cards, and the other half consists of the two black queens and all red cards.

Pick up the "red" half, spread it face down and have the back of one of the red cards touched. Pull it out and drop it face up on top. Demonstrate to

a spectator how he is to insert the card face up into this half-deck, then hand him this half under the table, turning it over. He inserts the card on the face, then gives the half a complete cut. He hands the cards to you under the table, and you turn over this half as it is brought into view.

Spread the half face down in your hands so the face-up marker card is visible. Table the three-card sandwich face up and drop the rest of the cards below the sandwich.

Repeat the entire procedure with the other half-deck and a second spectator: He selects a marker card, apparently inserts it while holding the cards under the table, cuts this half and hands it to you. You turn over this half as you bring it into view, set the three-card sandwich on the table, then drop the rest of the cards below the sandwich. The situation is shown in Figure 2.

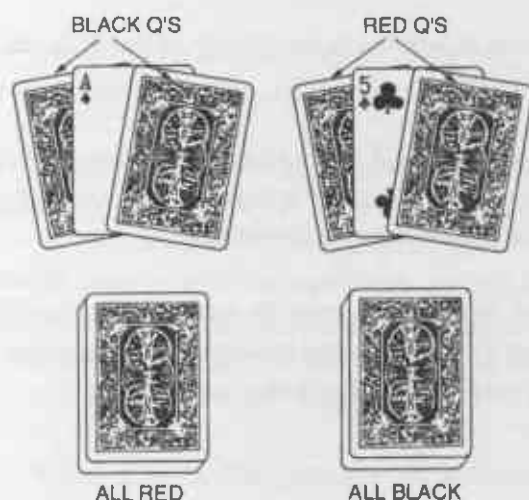


Fig. 2

For the climax, remove the red marker card and use it to flip over the two black queens. Drop the red marker face down onto its pile. Repeat the same procedure to show the red queens.

"What I don't understand is how you selected the black queens here since all the other cards are red," you say as you pick up the pile below the black queens, turn it face up and ribbon spread it on the table to reveal all red cards.

"And you selected the red queens from these cards which are all black," you say as the black cards are ribbon spread face up below the red queens.

DOUBLE DETECTION DOUBLED

As the spectators see it, the deck is shuffled and cut in half. A spectator places one half under the table, cuts off a portion from the top, turns it face up and places it on the bottom. He repeats the same procedure with the other half-deck. When each half is spread, the cards face to face in the center are aces. He has cut to all four aces.

Method: The principle comes from a trick attributed to Richard Himber titled "Double Detection." It appears in *The Tarbell Course in Magic, Volume II* (1942).

Place the red aces face to face and also the black aces face to face. All four are on top of the deck.

To begin, jog shuffle, retaining the setup on top. Double cut the top two cards to the bottom. Set the deck face down on the table and lift off half the cards. Double cut the top two cards to the bottom of this half.

Demonstrate what the spectator is to do: He is to cut off about half the cards from the top of the half-deck, turn them face up and place them face up on the bottom.

Hand a spectator this half-deck and ask that he hold the cards under the table when he performs this operation. He brings the half into view and sets it on the table.

Hand the other half to the same spectator (or a second spectator) to repeat the same procedure. When he has finished, this half is set on the table.

Pick up either half-deck and spread it to where the cards are face to face near center. Turn the face-down cards face up to disclose an ace on the face of each portion. Thumb off the two aces face up on the table. Repeat with

the other half-deck to disclose two more aces. Thumb off these two face up on the table.

ROLL-OVER ACES

Effect: The performer removes about a third of the deck, cuts it in half and riffle shuffles the cards face up and face down. The cards are mixed further, and more cards are turned over. Now the cards are dealt into four piles, and the piles are rolled over one onto the other. When the cards are spread, only the four aces are face up.

Method: This is based on Kuniyasu Fujiwara's "Automatic Ace Triumph," in *Genii*, May 2000. I have tried to make the handling appear less mechanical.

Cull the four aces to the bottom (face) of the deck. Hold the deck for an overhand shuffle. Run 12 cards to the bottom in two or three runs.

Spread the deck with the faces toward you, getting a left little-finger break beneath the aces; the right hand spreads over the 12 cards in front of the aces and flops them face down. The deck squared, then the right hand lifts off all the cards above the break. Discard the rest of the deck.

You now hold a packet of 16 cards. The top 12 are face down and the four aces are face up on the bottom. Spread the cards to show the backs, without exposing the reversed aces. Square up.

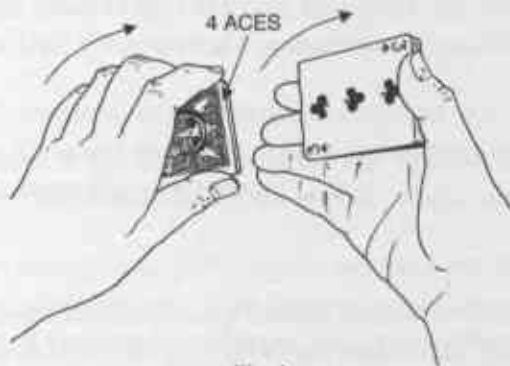


Fig. 1

The right hand now cuts off about half the cards, and the Tenkai Move is performed (see Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for details): The right hand turns palm up as the left hand turns palm down. Both packets are face up, but the left-hand cards appear to be face down since the aces are face down on top (Figure 1). Place the packets on the table in position for a riffle shuffle. Riffle shuffle them together at the corners. Cut the cards in half and riffle shuffle again. The four aces are distributed in the packet and are the only cards face down.

Now (and this is a strong feature), give the packet an overhand shuffle. "Let's turn over more cards," you say as you deal the cards one by one into a tabled pile, turning over every other card. For the last shuffle, give the packet a Charlier shuffle.

Hold the packet in dealing position in the left hand. Deal the top four cards of the packet one at a time from left to right into a horizontal row on the table. Continue to deal the cards in rotation from left to right, forming four piles. At the conclusion, each pile will contain four cards.

To finish, roll over the first packet onto the second, both of these onto the third and all three of these onto the fourth. Turn over the assembled packet, if necessary, so the aces are face up. Ribbon spread the packet from left to right on the table to reveal that only the four aces are face up.

ROLL-OVER POKER

This is quite similar to the above routine but reveals a royal flush at the finish.

Cull a royal flush, say in hearts, to the bottom of the deck. Overhand shuffle 11 cards to the bottom in two runs. Spread the deck with the faces toward you and get a left little-finger break beneath the royal flush; the right hand flops the 11 cards in front of the flush face down onto the flush. The deck is squared, then the right hand lifts off all the cards above the break. Discard the rest of the deck.

The packet you hold consists of 11 face-down cards and a royal flush face up on the bottom. Spread over a few of the top cards to show backs. Square up. The right hand cuts off half the cards, and the Tenkai Move is

performed: The right hand turns palm up as the left turns palm down. The left hand packet appears to be face down.

Riffle shuffle the packets together at the corners. Five face-down cards (the royal flush) will be shuffled into the face-up cards.

Now let a spectator overhand shuffle the cards. (This is a strong feature.)

Take the packet and deal the cards into a tabled pile, turning over every other card.

Now have the spectator perform the Hummer Cut-And-Turn-Over (CATO) procedure. You can demonstrate this so he knows how to perform it: Cut the packet and complete the cut, turn over the top two cards together (as a unit), then repeat the cut and turnover of two cards any number of times.

When he has finished with the CATO procedure, deal the cards from left to right on the table rotationally into four piles. A mixture of face-up and face-down cards will show. To finish, roll over the first packet onto the second, both of these onto the third and all three of these onto the fourth. Turn over the combined packet, if necessary, so the royal flush is face up. Ribbon spread the packet from left to right on the table to reveal the face-up royal flush; the rest of the cards are face down.

ANOTHER ROLL-OVER ACES

This uses the same lead-in procedure as in the preceding trick "Roll-Over Aces," plus the CATO procedure and a "Paradox Papers" layout.

Effect: The performer spreads off about a third of the deck and discards the rest. Half of the packet is turned face up and riffle shuffled into the face-down cards. Then several more cards are turned over. Now the cards are dealt on the table into a four-by-four layout. A row (or column) is folded over onto an adjacent row (or column), exactly as dictated by a spectator, until all the cards are in one packet. The packet is spread and only the four aces are face up.

Method: To set up, place the four aces on the bottom of the deck.

Begin by overhand shuffling 12 cards below the aces. Spread the deck with the faces to you and get a left little-finger break beneath the aces. The right hand flops the 12 cards in front of the aces face down, then lifts off all the cards above the break. Discard the rest of the deck.

The right hand places the 16-card packet in the left hand. (The packet consists of 12 face-down cards, then the four aces face up on the bottom.) Spread the cards to show the face-down condition of the packet but do not expose the reversed aces. Square up.

The right hand cuts off about half the cards, then the Tenkai Move is performed: The right hand turns palm up as the left hand turns palm down. The right-hand packet is face up while the left-hand packet consists of four face-down aces, then the rest of its cards face up.

Riffle shuffle the packets together at the corners and square them. Repeat the riffle shuffle. Apparently you have shuffled a group of face-down cards into face-up. Actually, the aces are distributed in the packet and are the only cards face down.

Briefly overhand shuffle. This is effective.

"Let's reverse more cards," you say as you now deal cards one by one into a pile on the table, turning over every other card. Now the CATO procedure is carried out: Give the packet a complete cut and turn over the top two cards as a unit. This procedure can be repeated any number of times.

Now deal the cards on the table in the order shown in Figure 1. Some cards will be face up, some face down. Using the "Paradox Papers" principle, have a spectator tell you how to fold the outer rows or columns inward. He can, for example, tell you to fold the top row down. In this case, fold the top four cards over onto the second row. Then he may elect to have you fold the right column. Fold the right column over onto the column to its left. Continue the same procedure until all 16 cards are in one packet.

Ribbon spread the packet on the table to reveal that only the aces are face up.

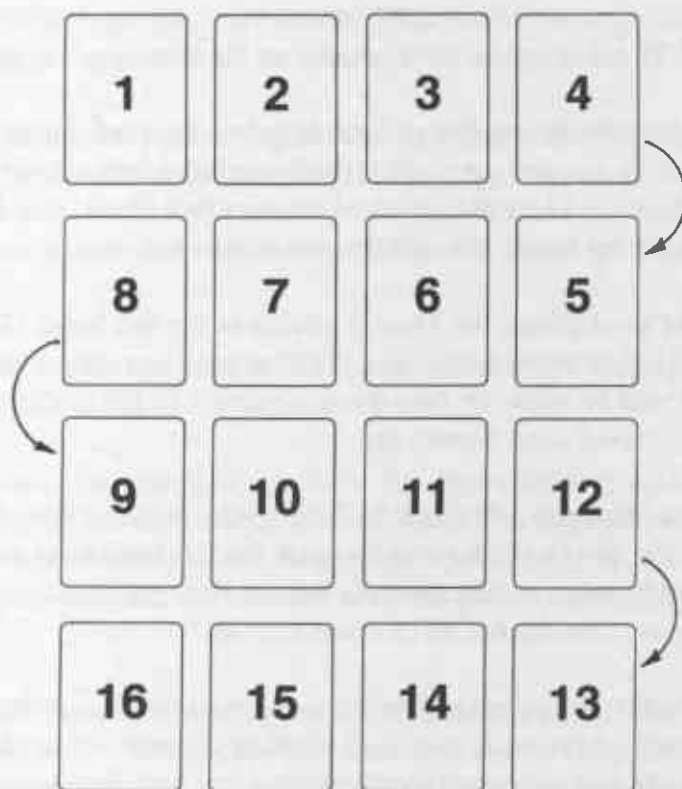


Fig. 1

A POKER PLAYER'S PUZZLER

This effect was inspired directly by Roberto Giobbi's "The Poker Player's Royal Flush," which appeared in his book *Card College, Volume 5* (2003). Roberto alluded to Steve Belchou's four-ace effect but featured an entirely different method. I have applied Steve Belchou's original method, which first appeared in Oscar Weigle's column in *The Dragon*, June 1939.

Effect: A shuffled deck is cut into four packets by a spectator. The spectator then picks up a packet, deals three cards to the table, then deals a card onto each of the other three packets. He then drops the rest of his cards onto the three dealt cards. He repeats the same procedure with the other three packets. The performer turns up the top card of each packet and shows the spectator he has luckily located the four aces—almost. The fourth card is not an ace but a five-spot. Five cards are dealt and the fifth card is the

missing ace. A final surprise comes when the last five cards dealt are shown to form the top poker hand, a royal flush.

Method: From top down, the setup is: A, A, A, five-spot, KS, QS, JS, 10S, AS, rest of the deck.

Jog shuffle, retaining the setup on top. Table the deck face down and have a spectator cut it from left to right into four nearly equal piles. These are shown as A, B, C and D in Figure 1. The nine-card setup is on top of pile D.

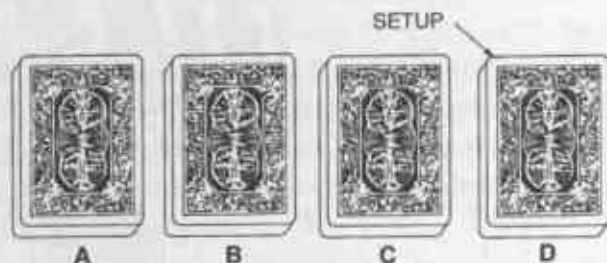


Fig. 1

Have the spectator pick up pile A, deal the top three cards face down on the table (at position A), then deal a card onto each of the other three piles, piles B, C and D. Finally, he drops the remainder of pile A face down onto the three cards at position A.

The spectator now picks up pile B and repeats the same procedure: He deals three cards face down at position B, then one card onto each of the other three piles, piles A, C and D. He then drops the rest of his cards face down onto the three cards at B. He repeats the same procedure with pile C and finally pile D.

At this point, there is an ace on top of piles A, B and C and a five-spot on top of D. Patter about poker and ask the spectator if he plays poker. Whatever he says, turn up the top card of piles A, B, C and D in that order. Pretend not to notice the five-spot at D, just comment that he has done well in cutting to the four aces. When the five-spot is "discovered," pick up pile D, turn the five-spot face down and place it on the bottom of the pile.

"The five must mean something . . . It could mean I should deal five cards," you say. Deal four cards above the packets into an overlapping

diagonal row toward you. Turn up the fifth card, revealing the AS, the fourth ace.

To finish, say, "*Of course, this is the best poker hand—the royal flush.*" Drop the rest of packet D to its original position, then the right hand uses the AS to flip over the four-card spread sideways to the left. Drop the AS onto these cards for the final display as shown in Figure 2.

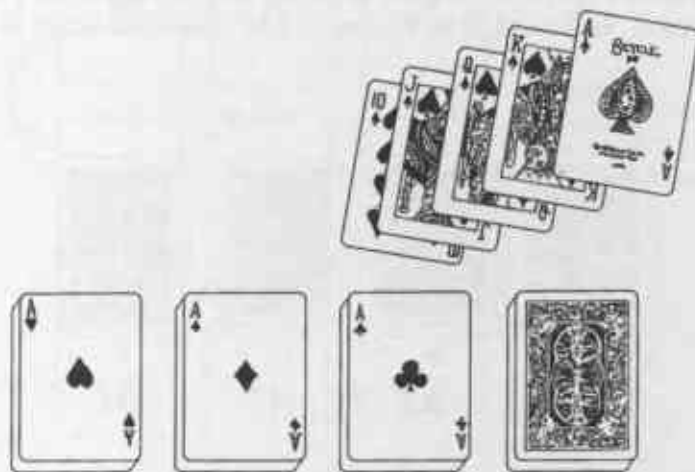


Fig. 2

Note: Paul Gordon published an almost identical version of this effect, titled "Picnic Time for Poker Players" in his book *Cardistry* (2007).

SHUFFLE TRACKING THE ACES

The effect is intriguing: The aces are laid out face up on the table, and the rest of the deck is divided into four piles. A spectator loses the aces by covering each with a group of cards. A pair of dice is handed to each of four spectators. Each spectator rolls his dice and covers them with his hands. The performer deals off a number of cards corresponding to the first spectator's number and lays the last card in front of the spectator. The same procedure is repeated with each of the other three spectators. The card in front of each spectator is turned up to reveal the four aces. Surprisingly, the rest of the deck is found separated into the four suits.

Method: The trick was inspired by Jim Swain's "Shuffle Tracking" in *Genii*, April 2003 and May 2005. It uses the Free Cut principle, popularized by Gene Finnell, and Terry LaGerould's Countdown Force as used by John Mendoza in his manuscript "A Reading" (*The Mendoza Series of Personal Instruction: No. 2*, 1979).

Set up the deck from top down: 12 clubs, any ace, 12 hearts, any ace, 12 spades, any ace, 12 diamonds, any ace. You will also need four pairs of dice.

To perform, hold the deck with the faces to you. Spread off three-quarters of the cards into the right hand, leaving the clubs, with the ace on the face in the left hand. The left thumb then thumbs off the ace face up on the table and sets the 12 clubs face down on the table below the ace. Repeat the same procedure three more times so you end with the four aces in a face-up row and 12 cards of one suit below each ace. The piles are lettered A, B, C and D, from left to right (Figure 1).

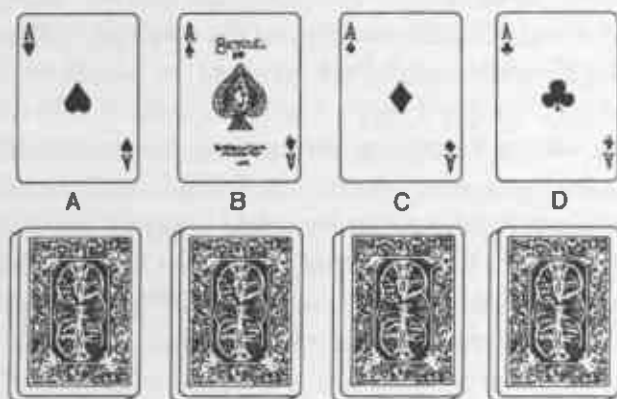


Fig. 1

Have a spectator cut off a few cards from A and hand them to you. He puts the first ace face down on top of pile A and cuts off some cards from B and drops them onto pile A. He then puts the next ace face down on top of pile B, cuts off some cards from C and drops them onto pile B. Now he puts the next ace face down on C and cuts off some cards from D and drops them onto pile C. The last ace is put face down on top of D. Overhand shuffle the cards you hold, counting them to yourself as you shuffle. Drop them face down on top of D.

Gather the piles one onto the next from right to left. Shuffle off the number of cards you are remembering and throw. Double cut the top card (an ace) to the bottom.

Perform an up-the-ladder false cut. The aces are now at positions 13, 26, 39 and 52 from the top of the deck.

Hand out a pair of dice to each of four spectators. Each spectator rolls his dice and covers them with his hands. Ask the first spectator to stop you on his number as you deal a face-down pile, counting aloud backward from 12 to 1. Say he stops you on 7. He uncovers his dice, showing his number. Reverse deal a corresponding number of cards face down into the right hand (seven cards in this case), dealing the last card above the dealt pile. Drop the right-hand cards face down onto the dealt pile.

Repeat by dealing directly onto the pile already dealt, counting aloud backward from 12 to 1. When stopped on a number by the second spectator, count that number of cards into the right hand and lay aside the last card (an ace). Drop the right-hand cards onto the dealt pile. Repeat the same procedure, using the third spectator's number.

You are left with a 13-card packet with an ace on the face. Drop this packet onto the dealt pile and pick up all these cards. Ask the fourth spectator to stop you on his number as you now deal a tabled pile, counting aloud backward from 12 to 1. When stopped, count that number of cards into the right hand and lay the last card (an ace) aside. Drop the right-hand cards onto the dealt pile, then drop the rest of the deck on top of all.

Disclose the four aces, then ribbon spread the deck from left to right face up on the table to reveal it is separated into the four suits for the final surprise.

THE TROST FOUR-ACE ROUTINE

Effect: The four aces are displayed. The black aces are dealt face down on the table only to appear back in the performer's hand. The tabled aces are shown to be red. A spectator picks up the red aces while the performer holds the black. The reds and blacks are alternated, yet when they are turned

face up, the two black aces are together as well as the two reds. The effect is repeated twice, the last time with the two red aces being face up. Still they separate. For the finale, all four aces are placed face down into the rest of the deck. The deck is spread and the aces have all turned face up.

Method: The first phase—"The Transposed Aces," is a very convincing and easy-to-do version, using some of the same handling as for the Diminishing Count. The second phase—"Japanese Aces," is a sequence shown to me by Shigeo Futagawa and was described in my book *Subtle Card Magic, Part One* (1976). The third phase—"Flapjack Aces"—appeared in my manuscript *Nick's 4-Ace Trix* (1965) and later in my book *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997).

Phase One—The Transposed Aces: The four aces are arranged from top to bottom: black ace, red ace, X, red ace, black ace. The rest of the deck is set aside, face down. Hold the packet face up and perform an Ascanio Spread to show the four aces. Square up and turn the packet face down.

Hold the packet face down in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off three cards one by one into the left hand; the right hand shows a black ace at the face of its double card. Place the double on top of the left-hand cards, then thumb off the top card face down on the table. Hold the cards in right-hand Biddle grip. Peel off two cards singly into the left hand; the right hand shows the other black ace at the face of the double. Place the double onto the left-hand cards, then thumb off the top card onto the tabled card. Apparently the black aces have been dealt to the table.

The right hand holds the packet in Biddle grip. Rub the face of the packet on the left sleeve. With the left thumb, peel off the top card into the left hand and flip it over face up with the double. The left-hand card and the double are shown to be black aces. Flip the single ace face down and place the double face down on top. Hold these cards in the left hand as the right hand turns over the two tabled cards to show the red aces.

Phase Two—Japanese Aces: Lay the two red aces face up in front of a spectator; you have the two black aces face down in the left hand with an X card on top.

The spectator picks up the red aces. The aces are now alternated in color into a single tabled pile: The spectator deals a red ace face down on the

table; you deal your top (X) card face down on top. The spectator deals a red ace face down onto the two tabled cards; you lay the double face down on top and pick up the packet.

"The colors are alternated," you say. Twist the packet, then deal the top two cards face up on the table. Both are black aces. Hold the remaining three cards in right-hand Biddle grip; the left thumb peels off the top card into the left hand. Rotate both hands to show a red ace in each hand. Rotate the cards face down and place the double on top of the single. Hold these cards in the left hand.

The spectator picks up the black aces. To repeat, alternate the cards face down as before, but the spectator begins with a black ace this time; you deal the X card on top, he deals the other black ace on top of the tabled cards; flash the face of the double, showing a red ace, then lay the double face down on top of the tabled cards and pick up the packet.

Twist the packet, deal the two cards (red aces) face up on the table, then show the two blacks as before, ending with the X card on top. These cards are held face down in the left hand.

This last time, the spectator deals his cards *face up*: He goes first, tabling a red ace face up, you deal the X card face down on top, the spectator deals the other red ace face up onto the two tabled cards, then you lay the double face down on top and pick up the packet.

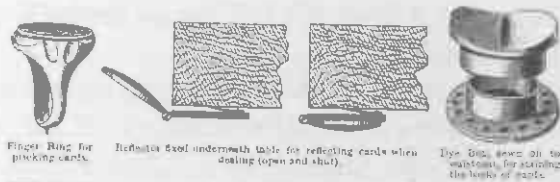
Twist the packet, spread off the top two face-down cards and deal them face up on the table—the black aces. Hold the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. The left fingers draw the bottom red ace into the left hand as you display the two face-up red aces. Replace the double *under* the single and hold these cards face up in the left hand. The right hand scoops up the black aces and drops them face up on top of the left-hand cards. The packet from face to back reads black aces, red aces, all face up, and the face-down X card on the bottom.

Phase Three—Flapjack Aces: Hold the packet face up in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off the first three cards face up one at a time into the left hand, which holds them in a fan; the last card—a double—is placed on the face of the fan. You are displaying four face-up aces. Square

the packet and turn it face down. Elmsley Count to show four face-down cards. Then hold the packet in left-hand dealing position.

Ask the spectator to cut off half the deck. As the deck is cut, the left hand casually turns palm down, bringing the bottom (reversed) card into view.

The right hand takes the packet from the left and sets it on the lower half-deck, then the spectator drops the upper half on top. Pick up the deck and hold it face down in the left hand. Riffle the deck for effect, then immediately ribbon spread it from left to right on the table. All four aces appear face up in the center. Finale!



Some Devices for Cheating at Cards and Dice

From Peter Arnold's *The Encyclopedia of Gambling*, 1977

16

More Gambling Tricks

"The passion for play is probably as old, and will be as enduring, as the race of man. Some of us are too timid to risk a dollar, but the percentage of people in this feverish nation who would not enjoy winning one is very small."

—S. W. Erdnase, *The Expert at the Card Table*, 1902

With the tricks in this chapter, the performer demonstrates some of the stratagems of the card hustler, mechanic and card cheat. Few things have more fascination to spectators than a glimpse behind the scenes with the green-baize gentry.

Most real gamblers' sleights require long hours of practice. Not so with the subtleties described in this chapter. With each gambling trick or deal, the spectator credits the performer with great skill, but each is accomplished by simple means.

The chapter includes demonstrations of false dealing, stacking and the dealing of top hands in bridge, Brag, poker, blackjack and Gin Rummy. All of these further the performer's reputation as a skillful card handler.

IMPROVED JACK-JACK-JACK

Effect: The performer shows three jacks on top of the deck, then deals two hands of three cards apiece to a spectator and himself. Claiming that he performed a second deal, the performer shows he has dealt the spectator the three jacks. The deal is repeated two more times, then he deals two five-card hands. The spectator receives all four jacks, but the performer has the better hand—four aces.

Method: The following fraudulent exhibition of second dealing is based on the old trick usually titled "Jack-Jack-Jack." According to Dai Vernon in *The Vernon Chronicles, Volume III* (1989), he witnessed a performance of the Three-Jacks Deal in New York City in 1913. The earliest published version I have found is Walter B. Gibson's write-up called "The Ever Present Jacks" in *The Magic World* (Pierce), August 1923. What I have added to the trick is the dealing of the four jacks and aces at the climax.

To set up, remove the four jacks and the four aces and arrange them in the following order from the top of the deck down: black jack, red jack, black jack, ace, red jack, ace, X, ace, X, ace, rest of the deck.

Patter about some gamblers' sleights and offer to demonstrate the second deal. Show the top three jacks and replace them on top. Now deal the top card to a spectator, the next to yourself, the third to the spectator, the fourth to yourself and the fifth to the spectator. Slide the next card, the sixth, *under* your two cards, pick up all three and replace them on the deck.

"*Did you see the second deal? I gave you three jacks,*" you say. Turn the spectator's cards face up on the table, showing three jacks—two black and one red. Slip the top (black) jack face up under the other two jacks, pick up all three and place them face down on top of the deck.

Repeat the deal, and the spectator will again have two black jacks and one red. Since the red jack is below the two blacks each time, it is not evident that it is the other red jack. Again slide the top black jack face up under the other two jacks and replace them face down on the deck.

Repeat the deal once more. Show that the spectator has the three jacks, then pick them up and drop them face down on the deck.

"*This time I'll deal five cards,*" you continue. Deal five cards to each hand in the regular manner. The spectator has four jacks, but you turn up the top four cards of your hand, showing four aces. "*Your jacks just aren't good enough this time,*" you conclude.

Note: The above version was first published as "Triple-Jack False Deal" in my book *Gambling Tricks with Cards, Part One* (1975).

FOUR JACKS DEAL AND ELEVATOR FINISH

Effect: The performer places the four jacks on top of the deck and alternately deals two four-card hands. The first hand is replaced on the deck. The second hand is shown to contain the four jacks. The deal is repeated: Two hands are dealt once more. This time the jacks are in the first hand while the four aces are in the second hand.

For the finish, the aces are dealt into a face-down row. The first ace travels from the bottom of the deck to the top, the next from top to bottom. The third and fourth aces travel from the center of the deck to the top.

Method: This is an extension of the old "Three-Jacks Deal."

Set up the four jacks and the four aces. Arrange them from top down: JC, AD, JS, JD, AH, AC, AS, JH. These eight cards are on top of the deck.

Spread off the top four cards into the right hand and table the deck proper. "*Using the second and third deals, a gambler can deal himself, say, the four jacks,*" you begin. Turn the four cards face up and Elmsley Count, showing four jacks. Drop the packet face down on top of the deck proper, then pick up the deck and hold it face down in the left hand.

First Deal: Alternately deal two four-card hands side by side next to each other on the table so the cards overlap downward toward you. See Figure 1. The right hand picks up the top *three* cards of hand No. 1, uses them to scoop up the remaining card and drops all four cards on top of the deck. Table the deck face down.

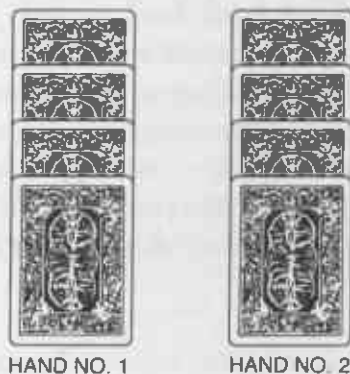


Fig. 1

The right hand picks up hand No. 2 (supposedly your hand in a game). Square it, turn it face up and Elmsley Count to show four jacks. Drop the cards face down onto the deck.

Second Deal: Explain that you will deal yourself the jacks again. Pick up the deck and deal two hands as before. This time the right hand picks up the top *two* cards of hand No. 1, uses them to scoop up the two remaining cards and drops all four on top of the deck. Table the deck.

With the right hand, pick up hand No. 2, turn it face up and Elmsley Count to show four jacks, placing the last card *under* the packet. Drop these cards face down onto the deck.

Third Deal: "This time I'll try to deal the jacks to the first hand," you say. Alternately deal two face-down hands of four cards each as before. Table the deck. The right hand picks up the top *three* cards of hand No. 1 and uses them to scoop up the remaining card. Turn these cards face up and Elmsley Count to show four jacks. Drop these cards face down onto the deck.

Now pick up the top card of hand No. 2 and use it to scoop up the other three cards. "Of course, I have dealt myself the better hand," you say, "I have the aces." Turn the hand face up and Elmsley Count to show four aces.

Elevator Aces: A nice cleanup to the routine is this: Drop the supposed four aces face down on top of the deck, then pick it up and deal the top four

cards into a face-down row from left to right on the table at positions A, B, C and D (Figure 2).

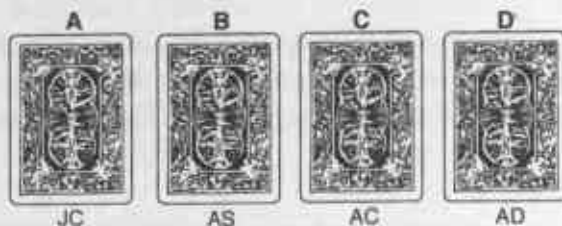


Fig. 2

Working from right to left, drop the deck proper face down onto the card at D. Riffle upward at the inner end of the deck with the right thumb. Pick up the deck and deal the top card (AH) face up at position D. Pick up the card at C, drop it on top of the deck and riffle downward with the left thumb. Remove the bottom card (AD) and deal it face up at C.

Holding the deck in the left hand, the right hand picks up the card at B and inserts it into the center of the deck from the inner end. The right thumb presses down on it as it is pushed into the deck; get a left little-finger break above it. Riffle the outer end of the deck with the right fingers, then turn over the top card (AC) and deal it face up at B.

For the last ace, the right hand cuts off the cards above the break and tables them. Place the card at A (JC) face down onto the tabled half, then drop the bottom half-deck on top. Pick up the deck, riffle upward again, then turn up the top card (AS) and deal it to position A.

End of routine! The jacks wind up together in the center of the deck.

THREE JACKS AND A FULL HOUSE

Effect: In this routine, the performer shows three jacks on top of the deck, then deals two three-card hands, one to a spectator and one to himself. The spectator receives all three jacks. The performer repeats the three-jacks deal once more. For the finale, he shows a full house (three jacks and two aces) and mixes these cards with five indifferent cards. Claiming he can deal

seconds, thirds, fourths, and so on, he rapidly deals off five cards, showing them to be the same full house—three jacks and two aces.

Method: The routine was inspired by Dai Vernon's trick "Vernon's Three-Card Assembly" from *Scarne on Card Tricks* (1950) and Vernon's "A Straight Deal" from *Genii*, April 1964, and *The Vernon Chronicles, Volume III* (1989).

The setup at the face of the deck, reading from left to right is: AC, AH, JD, JC, JS, AD, JH. The JH is on the face. Now double cut the two cards at the face of the deck to the top (rear).

To begin, drop the three jacks at the face of the deck face up on the table as a group—the JD, JC and JS. Use the JS to scoop them up so the red jack is in the center and drop them face down on top of the face-down deck. Alternate deal a spectator and yourself three cards apiece. Use the last card to scoop up your two cards and drop all three face down on top of the deck. Turn over the tabled hand to show three jacks, the JH, JC and JS.

To repeat, use the JS to scoop up the other two jacks, then drop all three face down on top of the deck. Deal three cards per hand again, scoop up your hand with the last card and drop all three face down onto the deck. Turn up the jacks to show them again.

For the full-house finish, turn the deck face up, remove the two aces at the face (the AC and AH) and deal them, as a pair, face up onto the three jacks to show a full house. Use the AH to scoop up the other four cards, then turn them face down on the table.

Reverse deal five cards from the top of the deck face down about six inches to the left of the full house. Place the rest of the deck face down between the two five-card hands. (The hand on the left reads from top down: three indifferent cards, JH, AD.)

Now deal alternately from the two poker hands onto the deck proper, left, right, left, right, and so on. Flash the faces of the first six cards dealt. (Actually you can flash all the cards except the last two from the left-hand pile.)

Pick up the deck and hold it face down in the left hand. Claim that you will deal seconds, thirds, fourths and fifths to deal the full house. In a contrived-looking deal, deal the top five cards one by one rapidly into a face-down tabled pile. Turn over the pile, showing a full house: three jacks and two aces.

A STACKING DEMONSTRATION

Effect: The performer shows how a gambler would stack the four jacks in a *two-handed* poker game: An indifferent card and a jack are “milked” and put to the top (rear) of the deck four times so the X cards and jacks are alternated. Then he explains that if *two* more players joined the game, the stack would not work and he would have to start over. The jacks are shown now on top of the deck!

The performer then proceeds to show how to stack for a four-handed game by dealing three cards onto each jack and cutting them into the deck. He pauses and points out that if a fifth player joined the game, he would have to start over. The four jacks appear in the last pile of four!

To finish, the performer demonstrates the bottom deal of the jacks to himself in a five-handed game. But, what if he wanted to deal all the cards from the top? Five more hands are dealt, but instead of jacks, the performer now has the four aces.

Method: The first phase comes from an idea by Lee Asher, published as “Milking the Boards” in Steve Beam’s book *Semi-Automatic Card Tricks, Volume IV* (2002). This is followed with a version of Lin Searles’ “Quick Watson, the Aces” from *Ibidem*, No. 24, December 1961. Finally, the third phase is a version of Martin Gardner’s “The Surprised Gambler” in his booklet *Cut the Cards* (1942). This is the original Gardner poker deal that inspired the “Gardner-Marlo Poker Routine” in Ed Marlo’s booklet *Let’s See the Deck* (1942).

You can begin with a shuffled deck. Fan it with the faces toward you, remove the four jacks and place them face up on the table. As you remove the jacks, cull the four aces to the face of the deck. Once the jacks are on the table, spread over the four aces plus the next four X cards and get a left

little-finger break beneath them. Double cut at the break. From top down, the cards read: four X cards, four aces, rest of the deck.

Phase One: Openly place the four jacks on the face of the deck and display them. *"If I were cheating, here is how I would stack the four jacks to fall to myself in a two-handed game of poker,"* you begin. *"I would use the Milk Build Overhand Shuffle."*

Hold the deck for an overhand shuffle with the faces to the left so the jack on the face of the deck is visible. The left thumb and fingers "milk" a jack and the X card at the top (rear) of the deck so the pair falls face up into the left hand. The right-hand cards are dropped onto the pair. Repeat by milking the next jack and top card and dropping the rest of the deck onto this pair. Repeat the same procedure with the other two jacks. Perform this very slowly and deliberately. As each pair is milked, keep the pair squared as much as possible so the face of the top (X card) is not flashed; the same X card is milked each time. The illusion that the jacks are being alternated with indifferent cards is perfect. Actually, from top down, the cards read: X, then four jacks.

Hold the deck face down in left-hand dealing position. *"Now the cards are set to deal the four jacks to myself in a two-handed game of poker."* Here the right hand lifts off the X card on top, then a jack, displays the two cards briefly, then replaces them face down on top of the deck.

"But, at this point, what would I do if two more players wanted to join the game?" you continue. Pause, slip cut the top card to the center of the deck and say, *"I would just start all over again."* Deal the four jacks face up on the table into an overlapping row.

Phase Two: *"If there are now four players in the game, here's how I would stack the jacks,"* you explain. Turn the four jacks face down and arrange them in a face-down row on the table. Spread over the top three cards of the deck proper (as a group), take them in the right hand and drop them face down onto the jack at the left end of the row. The right hand picks up all four cards, flashes the face of the jack and drops the four cards on top of the deck. *"The first jack is now set fourth down to fall to the dealer."* As this is said, double cut the top card to the bottom or slip cut the top card to the center. (All of this is illogical, but the patter seems to make sense!)

Fan off three more cards into the right hand and drop them face down onto the second jack. Square these four cards, flash the face of the bottom jack if you like, then drop all four cards on top of the deck proper. Again lose the top card with a double cut or a slip cut. Repeat the same procedure again with the third jack. Finally, spread off three cards from the deck, drop them face down onto the fourth jack, pause, then say, "*But what would I do if a fifth player now wanted to join the game?*" Pause, then riffle the end of the deck toward the four tabled cards. "*I would start all over again,*" you say as you turn over the tabled cards to show the four jacks together once more.

Phase Three: The four aces are now on top of the deck ready for Gardner's "The Surprised Gambler."

"If there were five players in the game, I would deal myself the jacks by dealing off the bottom, like this," you say.

Place the four jacks on the face of the deck. Clearly show that they are on the bottom, then turn the deck face down and deal five hands of five cards each for poker, dealing the fifth hand to yourself. Openly deal a jack from the bottom to your hand on the first four rounds. Deal the fifth round of cards from the top. Set the rest of the deck aside.

Gather the first four hands one onto another in any order and drop them on top of the deck proper. (The four aces are now every fifth card, ready for the final deal.) Pick up your hand, turn it over and spread it, showing that you have dealt yourself the four jacks.

"But, let's say I wanted to deal those jacks to myself off the top of the deck. Here's what I'd do," you say. Drop your five-card hand face down on top of the deck, which you then hold for an overhand shuffle. Undercut about half the deck with the right hand, injog the first card and shuffle off. Shift the deck to dealing position in the left hand. The right thumb lifts up on the injogged card as you get a left little-finger break beneath it. Cut at the break and complete the cut. The top 25 cards have been preserved.

Deal five more poker hands of five cards each in the regular manner, dealing the fifth hand to yourself. Say, "*That is how I would deal myself the jacks—with no cheating—right from the top of the deck.*" As you say this, lay the rest of the deck aside, pick up your hand, square it and turn it face

up, showing the jack on the face. Slowly spread the hand, revealing the four aces. "*Oh well, aces are better anyway!*" you say as you spread the hand face up on the table.

Note: This routine could be preceded with a version of the Three-Jacks Deal.

THE PERFECT BRIDGE HAND—REVISITED

Effect: The deck is divided into four sections, which are shuffled by four spectators. The performer assembles the deck, shuffles it briefly, gives it a cut, then deals four bridge hands. None of the hands show much promise. The hands are gathered and the deck is given a series of cuts. Four more bridge hands are dealt, and this time the performer has dealt himself a grand slam in spades.

Method: The deal was inspired by Brother John Hamman's "The Perfect Bridge Hand" from his booklet *The Card Magic of Bro. John Hamman S. M.* (1958), written by Paul LePaul.

I feel that my method of setting up the spades for the final deal is easier and more deceptive than the one explained in Brother Hamman's book.

Discard three indifferent cards and the 2S. This leaves a 48-card deck. Place the remaining 12 spades on the bottom of the deck.

To begin, overhand shuffle 12 cards below the spades in two or three runs. Glimpse the bottom card and remember it as a key card (say it is the 2H), then shuffle 12 more cards to the bottom.

Use four spectators. Assume they are spectators A, B, C and D, from your left to right. Hold the deck with the faces to you and spread off the 12 cards below the key card (the 2H in this case) into the right hand. Hand these to spectator D; spread off all the cards below the spades (12 X cards) and hand them to spectator C. Spread off the 12 spades for spectator B and finally hand the rest of the deck (12 cards) to spectator A. Each spectator shuffles his cards.

Take spectator A's cards, shuffle them briefly, then hold them face down in the left hand. Extend the left-hand cards for B to drop his group (the spades) on top. Shuffle four cards to the bottom and hold the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. Extend the *empty* left hand, taking C's cards. Drop your cards onto his and shuffle four cards (spades) to the bottom. Hold your cards face down in the left hand. Extend the left-hand cards for spectator D to drop his cards on top of yours. To check, the deck is arranged from top to bottom: 12 X cards, 4 spades, 12 X cards, 4 spades, 12 X cards, 4 spades.

Give the deck a false cut. I prefer to use Ose's cut.

Deal four bridge hands, dealing the fourth hand to yourself. Patter about how difficult it is to get a good hand, and that bridge is one of the biggest gambling games, and so on. Show the hands in turn, commenting about their lack of high cards. Stack the hands one onto another in any order.

Perform an up-the-ladder false cut and finally double cut the top card of the deck (a spade) to the bottom.

Deal four more bridge hands and show you have dealt yourself a grand slam in spades.

Hearts Deal: Discard the 7H, 6H, 5H and 4H. This leaves a 48-card deck. Place these 12 cards, in any order, on the bottom of the deck: AC, AD, AH, AS, KS, QS, KH, QH, JH, 10H, 9H, 8H.

Use the same procedure described for the bridge deal to deal yourself the 12 cards listed above in a four-handed game of Hearts. Show that whatever is lead, you can take the trick with an ace and get the lead. Table the AC, AD, AH and AS face up, then the KS and QS to show that you will definitely take the QS. Finally, lay down the KH, QH, JH, 10H, 9H and 8H to show you can "shoot the moon"—take the QS and all the hearts to put you way ahead in the game.

Fan Tan Deal: Discard any four cards except a six, seven or eight. This leaves a 48-card deck. Place the sixes, sevens and eights, in any order, on the bottom of the deck.

Use the same procedure described for the bridge deal to deal yourself an unbeatable hand in a four-handed game of Fan Tan—all the sixes, sevens and eights.

GILBREATH PLAYS BRIDGE

Effect: The deck is mixed and the four kings are removed. The performer gives a brief demonstration of bottom dealing—a method for cheating at poker. Then he explains that to cheat at bridge, it is almost impossible. A spectator riffle shuffles the deck, then the performer deals it into four bridge hands, none of which amount to much. He gathers the hands, cuts them, then deals four more bridge hands in regulation manner. He has dealt himself a perfect hand—a grand slam in spades.

Method: As alluded to in the title, this deal is based on the Gilbreath principle.

To set up, remove the four kings and set them aside, momentarily. From the top down, the rest of the deck is set: spade, X, X, X, spade, X, X, X, and so on, throughout. Now insert three of the kings at different locations throughout the deck, then put the KS on the face.

Start by performing an up-the-ladder false cut and any number of straight cuts.

With the faces of the cards toward you, spread through the deck until you reach the KS. Cut the deck, bringing the KS to the face. Deal it face up on the table. Upjog the other three kings, strip them out and drop them face up onto the KS.

Begin by explaining there is a way of cheating in poker—bottom dealing. Place the kings on the face of the deck. Hold the deck face down in dealing position. Now deal four hands of poker, dealing the fourth hand to yourself. On each of the first four rounds, openly deal yourself a king from the bottom. On the fifth round, deal each card from the top of the deck. Set the rest of the deck aside. Turn the first three hands face up and spread them. None will be worth much. Spread your hand to show the four kings.

Stack the hands face up counterclockwise by dropping your hand (the kings) onto hand No. 3, both onto No. 2 and all three onto No. 1. Turn all 20 cards face down and drop them onto the deck proper. (The spade-X-X-X rotation has been maintained.)

Hold the deck face down in the left hand. With the right thumb, riffle up at the inner end until a spade is spotted on the face of the upper half. Cut the deck in half at that point. Ask a spectator to riffle shuffle the halves together and square the deck.

If you want to emphasize the shuffle, have the spectator leave the deck unsquared. Ribbon spread it face down on the table to show how fairly the cards are interlaced, then square the cards slowly, using both hands.

As you scoop up the deck say, *"With a deck fairly shuffled, as you just did, it would be very difficult to come up with a good bridge hand."* As this is said, turn the deck with the faces to you and supposedly spread off four bridge hands. What you actually do, however, is to spread off packets of 12, 12, 12 and 16 cards and table them face down. As it is now, due to the Gilbreath principle, there is one spade in every set of four cards. You will shift the spade so it is fourth from the face of each set of four cards, like this:



Fig. 1

Fan over the four cards at the face of the deck. If the fourth card from the face is a spade, take all four cards together (as a group) into the right hand; if the spade is third from the face, take three cards together, then a single card into the right hand; if the spade is second from the face, take two cards together, then two more into the right hand; and if the spade is on the face,

take it singly, then three X cards together as a group. It is quite easy, and the four cards always end up: spade, X, X, X, the spade being the leftmost card of each set of four (Figure 1).

This "count" of four cards into the right hand is repeated two more times so you have 12 cards in the right hand, reading from left to right if you fan them: spade, X, X, X, spade, X, X, X, spade, X, X, X. Table this packet face down to your right.

Form two more 12-card packets, using the same procedure and table them face down to the left of the first tabled packet. Arrange the last 16 cards in the same manner and lay this packet face down at the left end of the row. The piles are A, B, C and D, from left to right as shown in Figure 2.

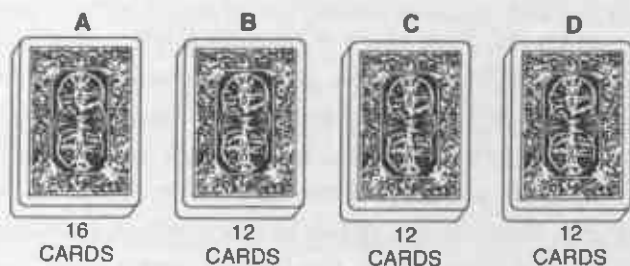


Fig. 2

Patter that to get a good bridge hand after a good shuffle is almost impossible. Pick up pile B, show it to be mixed (not a good bridge hand) and drop it face down onto pile A. Pick up pile C, show it as a poor bridge hand and drop it onto pile B-A. Show pile D to be a random mixture of cards and drop it face down onto pile C-B-A.

To check, from top down, the deck is set: spade, X, X, X, spade, X, X, X, and so on. To finish, double cut the top card (a spade) to the bottom. Give the deck an up-the-ladder false cut, then deal four bridge hands in the regular manner, a card at a time. Deal the fourth hand to yourself.

Turn over the first three hands to show them mixed, then ribbon spread your hand face up to show a grand slam in spades.

BRAG AND POKER DEAL

In the following deal, the performer demonstrates that he can deal himself a winning hand of Brag. Then he gathers the cards, shuffles them and deals three hands of poker. He deals all good hands, but his is the best—a royal flush.

Method: Brag, the British ancestor of poker, was England's most popular game in the 1700's, and it is still widely played there today. It is like poker, but there are only three cards dealt per hand. The most common variation of Brag does not accept straights and flushes. Dealing and betting is the same as in draw poker, and three of a kind and a pair are recognized as winning hands. There are three wild cards, or "braggers": the AD, JC and 9D. Natural three-of-a-kind or paired hands rank over those using braggers.

There is a 15-card setup. From top down the order is: 7H, 7S, 7D, AD, AS (this is a full house), 3C, 7C, JC, QC, AC (this is a flush), 10H, JH, KH, QH, AH (this, of course, is a royal flush). The setup can be memorized easily if you think of it as three poker hands. The values in each individual poker hand run from low to high with one exception: the KH and QH are switched. These 15 cards are on top of the deck.

Begin by patterning about how the game of Brag is played. False shuffle by undercutting half the deck, injog the first card and shuffle off. Form a right-thumb break below the injogged card, shuffle off to the break and throw. The 15-card setup is again on top.

Deal five face-down hands of Brag, dealing cards one at a time until each hand has three. Show the hands in order from the left. Hand No. 1—nothing. Hand No. 2—pair of sevens. Hand No. 3—JC bragger and a king equals a pair of kings. Hand No. 4—two queens with AD bragger, equals three queens. Hand No. 5—three natural aces, the winning hand.

Drop the hands one onto another in any order. Turn the packet face down and double cut the top card to the bottom of the packet.

Now give the packet a reverse faro shuffle: Outjog the first card and those at odd numbers, then strip out the injogged cards and drop them on top. You can repeat the reverse faro any number of times. Now deal three five-card poker hands, dealing the third hand to yourself. Your two opponents will

receive a club flush and a full house respectively, while you will have the winning hand, a royal flush in hearts.

BLACKJACK, GIN AND POKER I

Effect: The deck is shuffled and the performer deals five hands of blackjack. Some of the other players have high counts, but the performer wins with blackjack. The deck is shuffled again and the performer deals two Gin hands. His opponent has 72 unmatched points while he has gin. The cards are gathered, shuffled once more and four poker hands dealt. The three other players have good betting hands—three of a kind, a straight and a flush. The performer wins, however, with a royal flush.

Method: The setup from top down, reads: 10C, 10H, 10D, QS, AD, KD, 6S, 9H, 7D, QH, KS, QC, JH, QD, 7C, 9S, JD, 8S, 2S, 7S, rest of the deck.

Phase One—Blackjack: Jog shuffle, retaining the top 20-card setup. Deal five hands of blackjack, the fifth to yourself: Deal one card face down to each player and one face up to yourself. Then deal another card face down to each player and one to yourself, this time face down and under your face-up AD. Set the rest of the deck aside.

Starting with hand No. 1, turn each of the first four hands face up, revealing counts of 20, 16, 19 and 17. Turn over your hole card, the QH, and drop it face up onto your AD, showing you have blackjack.

Gather the hands face up counterclockwise: Drop your hand onto No. 4, these onto No. 3, these onto No. 2 and all onto No. 1. Turn these ten cards face down and drop them on top of the deck proper.

Phase Two—Gin: Jog shuffle again, retaining the top stock, then announce you will deal two Gin Rummy hands. False cut, then alternately deal two face-down hands of ten cards each. Set the rest of the deck aside.

Pick up the opponent's hand and ribbon spread it face up on the table, explaining that he has no matched sets or sequences. "Actually," you say, "I have dealt him seventy-two unmatched points, which count against him."

Ribbon spread your hand face up on the table to show that you have gin: a 7S, 8S, 9S sequence, four queens and three tens.

Pick up your hand and use it to scoop up the opponent's hand, turn all 20 cards face down and drop them face down on top of the deck proper. (Your hand ends up on top of the deck.)

Phase Three—Poker: Again jog shuffle, retaining the top 20 cards. False cut, then deal four hands of five-card poker, the fourth hand to yourself. Set the rest of the deck aside.

State that in order to get a big pot, you needed to deal the other players good betting hands. Name the kind of hand dealt to each player, in turn, then show the hands:

Hand No. 1 has three of a kind—sevens.

Hand No. 2 has an eight-to-queen straight.

Hand No. 3 has a spade flush.

Hand No. 4 has a royal flush in diamonds.

BLACKJACK, GIN AND POKER II

Effect: In this version, the deck is shuffled and two Gin Rummy hands are dealt. The performer holds a perfect gin hand while his opponent has 82 unmatched points. The deck is reshuffled and four blackjack hands are dealt. The performer wins with a ten and ace—blackjack. The last game is poker. The deck is shuffled and five hands of poker are dealt. The performer wins easily with four eights, but the other players have very poor betting hands. The performer shuffles and deals four hands of poker. Now the other players hold very good betting hands—a high straight, a flush and a full house. The performer wins, however, with a royal flush.

Method: The setup, from top down, reads: 7H, 8D, JH, 9D, AC, 10D, 8S, 6C, 6S, 7C, QH, 8C, 10S, 9C, KD, JS, QD, JD, KC, JC, KS, 3C, 6H, AD, 8H, rest of the deck.

Phase One—Gin Rummy: Begin with a jog shuffle, retaining the top stock of 25 cards, then give the deck a false cut. Patter about the game of Gin Rummy being a favorite with Nick the Greek, who bet heavily on this game.

Deal two face-down hands of ten cards each and set the rest of the deck aside. *"What I've done is deal my opponent a lot of unmatched points,"* you say. Turn over the opponent's hand and ribbon spread it face up on the table. He has 82 unmatched points. Then ribbon spread your hand face up as you say, *"This is gin!"* (See Figure 1.)

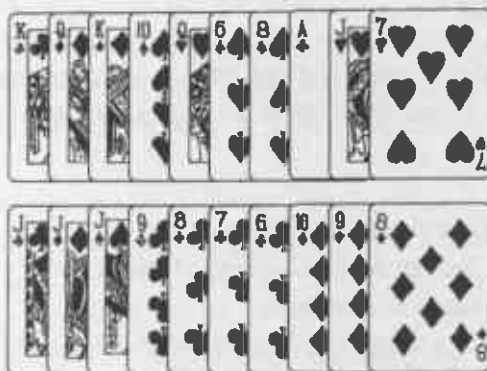


Fig. 1

The rule in stacking the hands after each deal is to drop one hand face up onto the next working from right to left, beginning with your hand. So, after the Gin deal, your hand is dropped face up onto the opponent's and both are dropped face down on top of the rest of the deck.

Phase Two—Blackjack: Jog shuffle and false cut. Patter about the popular game of blackjack. Explain that the players whose hands total 21 win. If no one has 21, then it is the nearest total that wins. *"Court cards count ten, aces are one or eleven, and the other cards count at face value,"* you explain.

Deal four hands of blackjack, the fourth to yourself. Deal one card face down to each player and one face up to yourself. Then deal another card face down to each player and one to yourself, this time face down and under your face-up 10S. Set the rest of the deck aside.

Turn up each of the first three players' hands in turn: Player A has a count of 20; player B, 16; and player C, 18. Turn up your hole card, the AC, and drop it face up onto your 10S, showing that you have blackjack (Figure 2).

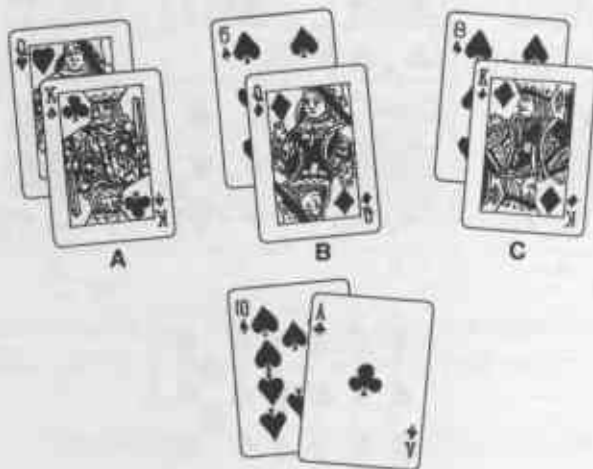


Fig. 2

Gather, placing your hand face up onto C; the left hand scoops A *under* B at the same time, then the right-hand cards are dropped onto the left-hand cards. All are dropped face down on top of the deck proper.

Phase Three—Five-Handed Poker: "The last game is poker—a very popular game." False shuffle and cut. Then deal out five hands of five cards each in rotation face down, dealing the fifth hand to yourself. Set the rest of the deck aside.

Turn up your hand, displaying the four eights. "It's a great poker hand," you say, "but if the other players have poor hands, the pot will not amount to much." Show players A, B, C and D's hands. Name each hand. Player A will have a pair of kings; B, nothing; C, a pair of sixes; and D, a pair of nines (Figure 3).

Gather the hands as before, using both hands. These cards are dropped face down on top of the deck proper.

Phase Four—Four-Handed Poker: False shuffle and cut as before, then deal four face-down hands, the fourth to yourself. Set the balance of the deck aside. Say, "I've dealt the other players very good betting hands."

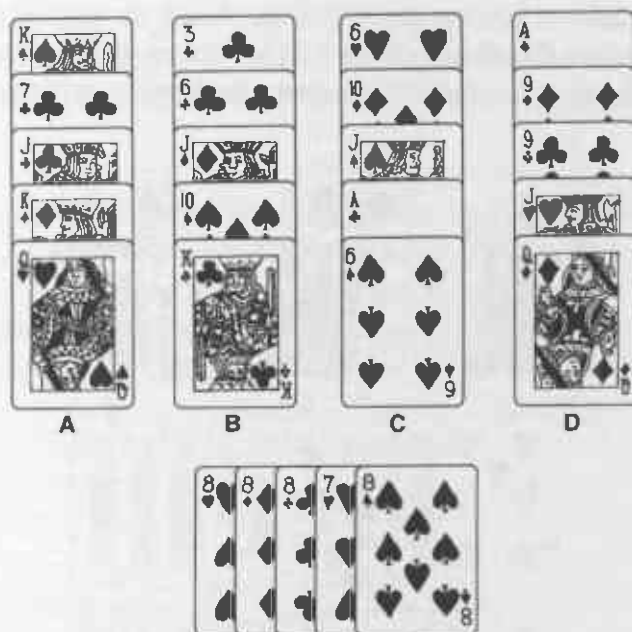


Fig. 3

Turn up player A's hand to show a nine-to-king straight. Player B's hand is shown—a club flush, and C's hand is shown to be a full house—sixes and jacks. Finally, turn over your hand to show the winner—a royal flush in diamonds. (See Figure 4.)

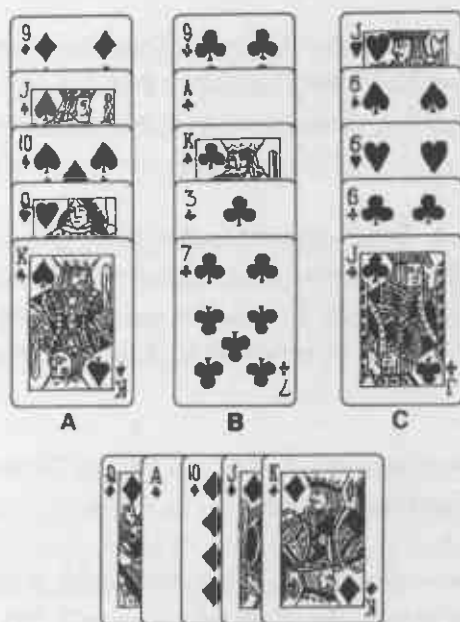


Fig. 4

17

Poker Deals

"Can you deal a good poker hand?" is a question which is almost certain to be asked after you have shown your prowess with cards.

—Hugard and Braue, *The Royal Road to Card Magic*, 1948

This chapter offers several very effective poker deals, including four versions of "Exchange Poker," a Karl Fulves concept wherein a spectator designates which player exchanges his cards for the performer's after various rounds are dealt. The performer, of course, always ends up with the winning hand. I think you'll find them fascinating!

DEAL AND DUCK POKER

This poker deal was inspired by Bill Simon's "Four Queens" in his book *Mathematical Magic* (1964).

Effect: The deck is shuffled and ten cards are removed. Two hands of poker are dealt, one to a spectator and one to the performer. The spectator decides how each card is dealt, either by dealing the top card and ducking the next, or vice versa, ducking the top card and dealing the next. All ten cards are dealt as the spectator directs. When the spectator's hand is shown,

it contains five indifferent cards while the performer's hand is a royal flush in spades.

Method: To set up, place a royal flush in spades on top of the deck.

False shuffle, then reverse deal ten cards into a tabled pile. Discard the rest of the deck. Pick up the ten-card pile and overhand shuffle, as follows: Run five cards and throw. Run two cards and throw. Run four cards and drop these four back on top of the packet.

Explain, "*There are two ways cards can be dealt, either deal and duck . . .*" Deal the top card to a spectator to begin his poker hand, then duck the next card under the packet. "*. . . or duck and deal.*" Duck the top card and deal the next card to start your poker hand.

The spectator gets the next two cards. He can choose "deal and duck" or "duck and deal" for each card.

You get the next two cards, the spectator choosing how to deal.

He gets his fourth card, then you get your fourth card. Again the spectator chooses.

This leaves two cards. Ask him how the next card is to be dealt. The top card must be dealt to the spectator, so if he says "deal and duck," *he* gets the top card and you get the last card. If the spectator says "duck and deal," duck the top card and deal the next card to yourself, then the spectator gets the last card.

Show he has a "Mickey Mouse" hand—nothing. You have a royal flush in spades. "*Isn't Duck Poker just ducky?*" you conclude.

DOUBLE POWER POKER

Here is a two-phase poker baffler: The performer shows a packet of ten high cards that will be dealt into two poker hands according to the choices of a spectator. The performer holds two cards face down. A spectator selects one card for his hand, and the other card is placed to the bottom of the

packet. The procedure is repeated until the performer and spectator each hold five cards. The spectator has two pair, while the performer wins with a royal flush. Phase Two is a repeat of the effect, except that this time, the spectator looks at the faces of the cards before choosing. Still the performer ends up with the winning hand.

Method: Phase One was inspired by Alex Elmsley's trick "Power Poker," which appeared in his 1996 lecture notes *Floating Ladies . . . and Other Mysteries* and in *Genii*, October 1996. It was published again in his 1997 lecture notes titled *Alex Is at It Again*. ("Power Poker" was a variant of Elmsley's red-black effect called "It's a Small World" from *New Pentagram*, June 1974. This was later published in *The Collected Works of Alex Elmsley, Volume II*, 1994.)

Phase Two is based on Paul Curry's "Cider!" from his book *Paul Curry Presents* (1974). It was subsequently published in *Paul Curry's Worlds Beyond* (2001).

To set up, arrange an 11-card packet from top to face: two queens, two kings, two aces (these six cards can be in any order), then AS, KS, QS, JS, 10S. The rest of the deck is not used.

Phase One: Begin by holding the packet face down in the left hand. With the right hand, lift and show a few of the cards, explaining you will use ten high cards to make up two poker hands. Give the packet a False Charlier shuffle, retaining its order.

Explain that a spectator will make all the decisions as to which cards he will choose for his hand and which will end up in your hand. He will choose the cards without seeing their faces. Spread off the top two cards, holding them face down in the right hand. The spectator selects one of the two for his hand. Place his choice face down in front of him on the table. Place the unwanted card to the bottom of the packet. Repeat the same procedure two more times, offering him a choice of one of the top two cards. The spectator now has three cards face down in front of him.

Do a short shuffle: Run five cards and throw. Offer him a choice of the top two cards, then deal the one selected to his hand and place the unwanted card to the bottom of the packet.

One more short shuffle: Run one card and throw, then run five cards and throw. The spectator selects his last card from the top two. One card remains in your right hand. The spectator can switch this card for any of his five cards, sight unseen. Switch per his instructions, then drop the unwanted card on *top* of the cards in the left hand. Table these cards.

Pick up the spectator's hand and turn it face up to show he has two pair. Pick up your cards, turn them face up and hold them face up in right-hand Biddle grip. With the left thumb, peel off the cards one by one into the left hand so they are held in a fan; the last two cards are placed as one onto the face of the fan. You will show an in-order 10, J, Q, K, A of spades—a royal flush, to win the first round.

Phase Two: Square your cards and hold them face up in the left hand. Pick up the spectator's five cards and drop them face up onto your six cards. At this point, the 10S and JS will be at the top (rear) of the packet.

This second phase works on the Ten Card Poker principle and is patterned after Paul Curry's "Cider!" effect where there are *two* Jonah cards; in this case, the Jonahs are the 10S and JS.

Overhand shuffle the 10S and JS to the face of the packet and shuffle off the rest of the cards on top of them in any order. Shuffle again, stripping off the 10S and JS with the left fingers so they remain on the bottom. Finally, run *one more card* below the 10S and JS so they are second and third from the bottom of the packet.

Explain to the spectator that he will choose the cards he wants, leaving the others for you, but this time he will see the faces of the cards.

Fan off the top two cards and lift them so the spectator can see the faces. You do not see the faces. The spectator indicates which one he wants. Deal it face down in front of him on the table and place the other card to the bottom of the packet.

Continue the same procedure until the spectator has five cards. The last two cards he chooses from are the 10S and JS; either one that he takes will be a Jonah card and kill his hand. Place the remaining card on *top* of your cards as you did in Phase One.

As before, turn the spectator's hand face up. The best he can get is three of a kind. Show your hand as before, putting the last two cards as one onto the face of the fan, hiding the other Jonah card. Your hand will always be the winner. If the spectator has one pair, you will have two pair; if he has two pair, you will have three of a kind; and if he has three of a kind, you will have a full house.

TWENTY-CARD POKER I

Effect: The deck is shuffled and 20 cards are removed for a four-handed poker deal. The first round of four cards is dealt, the performer receiving the last card. Now he fans off a few face-down cards, and a spectator selects one card from the fan to be dealt to the first player. This procedure is repeated again and again until the spectator has selected five cards for each hand. When the hands are turned up, the first player has four jacks; the second, four queens; the third, four kings; and the performer, as dealer, wins with four aces.

Method: The plot for this effect was inspired by Paul Green's "Everyone In Poker" in his lecture notes *Nothing Up My (Green) Sleeves!* (1997).

The dealing procedure used in this routine comes from a trick titled "Magical Sucuba" by Jack Avis in his book *Vis à Vis* (1998). His trick involved totaling a four-by-four matrix. I applied his concept to the following poker deal. In a letter from Jack, he told me that as far as he knew the handling was his and that it was probably worked out by him about 1993.

I discovered later that Reinhard Müller published a similar concept in his trick "Out of Escorial II" in *Arcane*, No. 11, 1984. In a letter, Reinhard could not pinpoint the development of his idea but stated that he may have thought of it as early as 1976. I credit both of these magicians, dubbing this concept the Müller/Avis dealing procedure.

From the top down, the deck is set: four aces, four kings, four queens, four jacks, rest of the deck.

False shuffle, retaining the top 16 cards. Explain that poker used to be played with 20 cards back in the days when it was first invented.

Spread off four cards as a group and drop the group face down on the table. Spread off four more cards as a group and drop that group onto the tabled cards. This is repeated three more times until you have a packet of 20 cards on the table. Discard the rest of the deck. Use the False Charlier shuffle, retaining the order of the packet. Now deal out four poker hands using the Müller/Avis dealing procedure:

Deal a round of four cards face down. We'll call the positions 1, 2, 3 and 4, as shown in Figure 1.

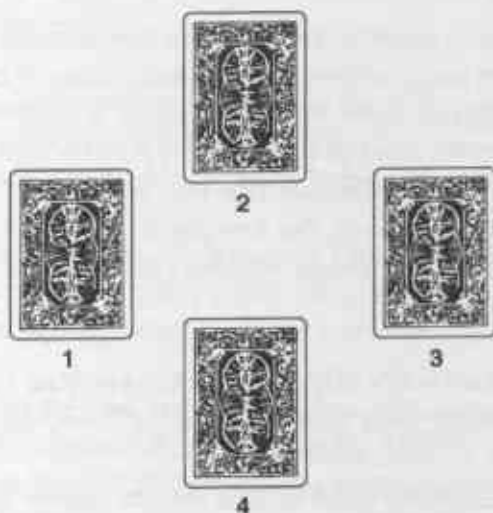


Fig. 1

Fan off four cards from the top of the packet into the right hand. Hold the cards face down in a fan over position 1. Have a spectator pull out any one of the four cards from the fan and deal it face down onto the card at position 1. Duck the other three cards under the left-hand cards.

Fan off four more cards and hold these over the card at position 2. The spectator deals one of these cards onto the card at position 2. Place the other three cards to the bottom of the packet. Repeat the same procedure at position 3, then position 4.

This procedure is repeated exactly by offering *three* cards at a time for each selection, the selections being placed at positions 1, 2, 3 and 4 and ducking two cards to the bottom of the packet each time.

Once more, repeat the procedure at all four positions by fanning off just *two* cards each time; one card is placed at each position and a single card is ducked each time.

This leaves you holding four cards. Deal one card to each position in order. Each hand now consists of five cards.

Turn up your hand and show that you have received four aces. "*Of course,*" you say, "*the other players have good betting hands to keep the pot growing.*" Turn up the other three hands to show four jacks, four queens and four kings.

TWENTY-CARD POKER II

This routine uses the Müller/Avis dealing procedure as in the previous version, "Twenty-Card Poker I."

Effect: The deck is shuffled. Twenty cards for four hands of poker are removed, and the rest of the deck is discarded. The performer deals the first round of four cards to four hands, dealing himself the fourth card. From here on, he holds a face-down fan of cards above hand No. 1; a spectator selects one card and deals it to that hand. The procedure is repeated over and over until each player has five cards. The hands are shown, in turn: The first player has a Lollapalooza (nothing); the second, a Woolworth (fives and tens); the third, a Wild West (three kings and two jacks); while the performer has the winner—a royal flush in spades.

Method: Lay out four poker hands face up at A, B, C and D, as shown in Figure 1:

A: 2D, 3C, 4S, 6H, 8D	(Lollapalooza)
B: 5S, 5D, 10C, 10D, QC	(Woolworth)
C: KH, KC, KD, JC, JH	(Wild West)
D: 10S, JS, QS, KS, AS	(Royal Flush)

The right hand picks up a card from the face of each hand, in order, laying them one by one face up into the left hand: 8D, QC, JH, AS. These four cards are dropped face up onto the cards at A. These are all dropped

face up onto those at B, then C and finally D. From top down, the 20 cards read: 10S, JS, QS, KS, KH, KC, KD, JC, 5S, 5D, 10C, 10D, 2D, 3C, 4S, 6H, 8D, QC, JH, AS. Drop these cards face down on top of the deck proper.

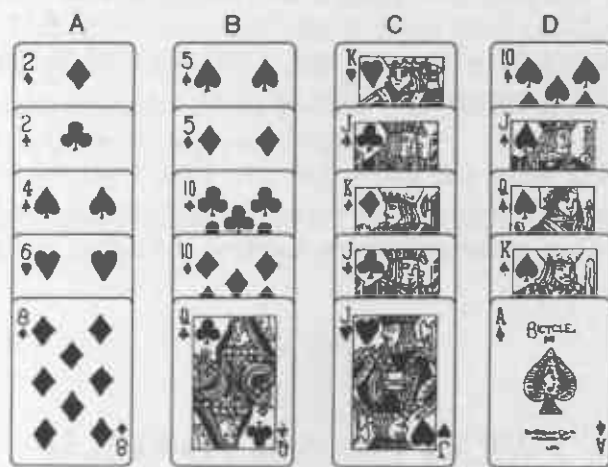


Fig. 1

To begin, jog shuffle, retaining the top 20-card setup. Patter that poker used to be played with just 20 cards and that you will demonstrate that old version.

Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Spread off a group of four cards and drop them face down on the table. Continue by dropping off four more groups of four onto the first group for a total of 20 cards. Discard the rest of the deck.

Deal the first round of four cards for four hands of poker: Deal the first three cards from left to right into a face-down row and the fourth in front of you as in Figure 2. Say to one of the spectators, *"I'll let you choose the cards for each hand."* Spread off the next four cards, holding them in a fan face down over the first player's card (hand No. 1). Have the spectator remove a card from the fan and deal it face down onto hand No. 1. Flash the faces of the other three cards and place them to the bottom of the cards in the left hand.

Repeat by fanning off four more cards and hold them face down over the second player's hand (hand No. 2); the spectator removes a card and deals it face down onto hand No. 2. (Do not flash the faces of any more cards from here on.) Replace the other three cards below the left-hand cards. Repeat the

same procedure for hand No. 3 and then for hand No. 4 (your hand). Every player now has two cards.



Fig. 2

Cards are now selected by the spectator for the third round. For this round, fan off groups of *three* cards for each selection. That is, fan off three, hold them face down over hand No. 1, have the spectator select one card and deal it onto that hand. Duck the other two cards to the bottom of the left-hand cards. Then fan off the next three cards for the spectator to select a card for hand No. 2. Repeat the same procedure for hand No. 3 and then for hand No. 4. At this point, peek at the last card dealt to you and remark, "*I was hoping that you would have dealt me a better card.*"

For the fourth round, fan off *two* cards each time for the spectator to select from. Duck the unwanted single card under the left-hand cards each time.

This leaves you with four cards. "*All we have left are the cards you didn't select,*" you say as you deal one card in rotation onto each hand. Every player now has five cards.

Beginning with hand No. 1, show each hand in turn and lay it face up on the table. Hand No. 1 is the Lollapalooza. "*This hand is only good once a night. It contains one card of each suit and no pairs,*" you say as you spread it face up on the table.

Pick up hand No. 2 and look at it. *"This is what's called a 'Woolworth'—fives and tens."* Lay it face up.

Pick up hand No. 3 and look at it. *"This hand is called a 'Wild West'—three cowboys and two Indians."* Show three kings and two jacks and lay it face up on the table.

"Of course, you know what this is—a royal flush. This must count for something!" you say as you lay down the royal flush in spades.

REPEAT TWENTY-CARD POKER

Effect: The performer riffle shuffles the deck, removes the 20 high cards and discards the rest of the deck. The packet of 20 cards is mixed, and four poker hands are dealt, the performer receiving the fourth hand. The first and second hands each have a pair of jacks; the third hand has two pair. The performer wins with the four aces, but because the others have poor hands, the pot is small.

Again the cards are shuffled. The first round of four cards is dealt. Then the performer fans off a few cards, and a spectator selects one of these cards to be dealt to the first player. The procedure is repeated until the four players each have five cards. This time, the first player has three jacks, and the second and third players each have a full house—good betting hands. The performer rakes in the large pot with a royal flush in spades.

Method: Again, this poker deal is based primarily on the Müller/Avis dealing procedure. To set up, remove the tens, jacks, queens, kings and aces (20 cards) and arrange them from top down: AC, QC, QS, 10S, AH, 10C, JD, JS, AD, QH, JH, JC, AS, 10D, KC, QD, KS, KH, 10H, KD. Place these cards on top of the deck proper. The bottom 32 cards can be used for any other effects such as Oil and Water, Follow the Leader, and so on.

Jog shuffle the deck, retaining the top 20 cards. Now cut off at least 26 cards, cutting below center, and riffle shuffle the halves together. Use the waterfall to emphasize the fairness of the shuffle.

Explain that you will use just the high cards. Turn the deck face up and, working from face to back, remove the tens, jacks, queens, kings and aces *one by one*, reversing their order as you deal them into a face-up pile on the table. The AC will be on the face of this group. Discard the rest of the deck.

Phase One: Explain that poker used to be played with 20 cards, four players being the limit. Say that there was no draw and that the game was mostly bluff.

False Charlier shuffle, retaining the order of the packet. Explain that this was the shuffle of the day. Deal four hands of five cards each, dealing the fourth hand to yourself. Turn each hand face up in turn. Hands No. 1 and No. 2 each get a pair of jacks; hand No. 3 gets two pair and you get the four aces. No competition.

Gather the hands face up one onto the next counterclockwise: Drop hand No. 4 onto No. 3, both onto No. 2 and all three onto No. 1.

Turn the packet face down and double cut the top two cards to the bottom. False Charlier shuffle, retaining the order of the cards.

Phase Two: Deal a round of four cards, the fourth card to yourself. Remark that you will not deal in the regulation manner but will give a spectator a choice of which cards to deal to each hand.

Spread off the top *four* cards and hold them face down for a choice of a card for hand No. 1. The spectator selects a card and deals it to hand No. 1. Duck the other three cards to the bottom of the packet. Repeat by spreading off four more cards for hands No. 2, 3 and 4, ducking the unwanted cards to the bottom each time.

Now spread off *three* cards for hands No. 1, 2, 3 and 4 for a selection, ducking the unwanted cards each time.

The same procedure is repeated for all four hands by spreading off *two* cards for a selection, then ducking the unwanted card to the bottom each time. You are left with four cards. With the left hand, casually thumb off a card onto each hand in rotation.

Hand No. 1 will have three jacks; No. 2, a full house, queens over tens; No. 3, a full house, aces over kings; and No. 4, your hand, will win with a royal flush in spades.

FLUSHED WITH SUCCESS

The Müller/Avis dealing procedure, as described in the previous three effects, is the basis for this routine.

Effect: To begin this poker deal, a section of the deck is handed out to three spectators for shuffling. The deck is assembled, then the performer cuts off a packet. He fans off three cards. A spectator selects one of these cards for hand No. 1, and the other two cards are ducked to the bottom of the packet. The same procedure is repeated until three cards have been dealt to each of the five hands. Another packet is cut off, shuffled, then two more cards are dealt to each of the five poker hands. The first four hands are shown to be average. The performer's hand is the winner—a heart flush.

Method: Place the 13 hearts on the face of the deck.

Shuffle 12 cards to the bottom of the deck. Hold the deck with the faces to you, spread off the bottom 12 cards and hand them to a spectator at your right, spectator C, for shuffling. This leaves the 13 hearts on the face. Spread off the 13 hearts and hand them to spectator B (to the left of C) for shuffling. Spectator A (at your left) shuffles the rest.

Take A's cards and hold them face down in the left hand. Take B's cards (hearts) and drop them on top of the left-hand cards. Get a left little-finger break under the top three cards. Take C's cards and drop them on top. The right hand takes the deck in Biddle grip, the right thumb taking over the break. Table the deck; at the same time, lift off all the cards above the break with the right hand. Use the Bottom Stock Control to retain the three hearts at the bottom of this 15-card packet.

Now use the Müller/Avis dealing procedure to deal three cards to each of the five hands: Fan off three cards. Have a spectator select a card for hand No. 1; duck the other two cards under the packet. Repeat by having the spectator select a card for hands No. 2, 3, 4 and 5, which is your hand. Now

spread off two cards. Have the spectator select one and deal it to hand No. 1. Duck the unwanted card under the packet. Repeat the same procedure so a card is dealt to hands No. 2, 3, 4 and 5. You are left with five cards. Deal one to each hand in turn. Every hand now has three cards.

Pick up the balance of the deck, fan off the top ten cards and have them shuffled. Deal the last two rounds from these shuffled cards. (Every hand will receive two hearts.)

The four players can each draw if they want. You will invariably have the best hand—a heart flush.

EXCHANGE POKER

I consider this an outstanding poker deal. In effect, the performer deals five hands of poker, the fifth hand to himself. A spectator decides which player exchanges his cards for the performer's after various rounds. Each player is allowed to exchange cards once. At the conclusion, the performer wins with four of a kind. Another deal is made and this time he wins with a royal flush.

Method: The inspiration for the following effect was David Britland's "The Last Game," which was published in *The New Talon*, February 1986, and later in *Virtual Miracles* (2000), an e-book compiled and edited by Peter Duffie. The principle used is Karl Fulves' and first appeared in his trick called "According to Hoyle" in *The Pallbearer's Review*, November 1968, and later in his book *The Magic Book* (1977). It is a fascinating principle; you will likely fool yourself with it.

The setup from top down is: 8H, 7S, 6D, 5C, 4H, AC, KC, QC, JC, 10C, AH, KH, QH, JH, 10H, AS, KS, QS, JS, 10S, AD, KD, QD, JD, 10D, rest of the deck. You will also need four poker chips. (Note: The first five cards in the setup can be in any order.)

Phase One—Four of a Kind: Hold the deck for an overhand false shuffle. Undercut less than half, injog the first card and shuffle off. Form a right-thumb break below the injogged card, shuffle to the break and throw. The top 25 cards have been maintained. False cut.

Explain that this is a new form of poker in which *every* player gets a chance to exchange his cards for the dealer's. A spectator will determine which player switches with the dealer after various rounds.

Deal a round of five cards for a five-handed game of poker as shown in Figure 1. The first four cards are dealt into a left-to-right row, and the fifth card is dealt in front of you, the dealer.



Fig. 1

Deal a second round of five. Now ask one of the spectators which player switches with the dealer. Say that he indicates player No. 2. Place a poker chip above player No. 2's hand, and then switch his two cards for your two cards. (A chip indicates that that player has made a switch.)

Deal another round, giving all five players a third card. Have the spectator select another player who switches. Say player No. 4 is selected. Place a chip above that player's hand and switch his three cards for your three cards.

Deal a fourth round of five cards and have another player selected to make the switch. In this example, the spectator has a choice of either player No. 1 or player No. 3. Say he elects that player No. 3 switches. Place a chip above player No. 3's hand and switch his four cards for your four.

Finally, deal the last round of five cards. Lay the rest of the deck to one side. Place a chip above player No. 1's hand (the only hand left that has not switched), then switch player No. 1's five cards for your five cards.

Turn each of the first four players' hands face up and spread them vertically on the table. Call out the rank of each—a pair, two pair or three of a kind. Explain that you would need, say, four of a kind to win. Turn your hand face up and spread it as shown in Figure 2. You are the winner—always with four of a kind.

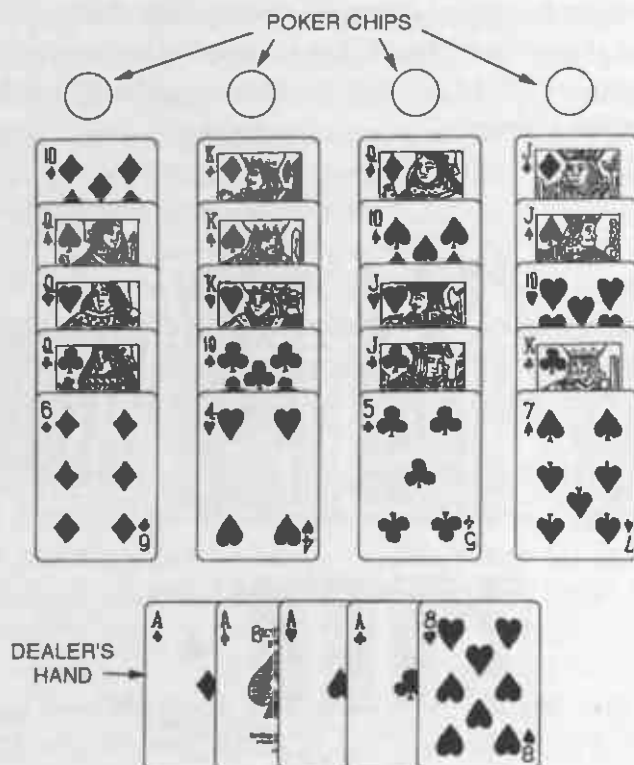


Fig. 2

Gather the hands, dropping one face up onto the other in any order.

Phase Two—Royal Flush: Reverse faro the 25-card packet, outjogging the first card and all the cards at odd numbers. The left hand strips out the outjogged cards. The right-hand cards are dropped on top. One of the low spot cards remains on the face of the packet. Now give the packet a False Charlier shuffle, retaining its order.

Explain that you will repeat "Exchange Poker" so that everyone has a fair chance of winning. Gather the four poker chips.

Deal and exchange hands exactly as in Phase One, and again mark each hand that has been exchanged with a poker chip.

You now pick up the first four hands in turn. Look at each hand yourself before showing it. The idea is to disguise any royal-flush cards as each hand is shown. For example, you may lay down, say a pair, face up, show the other three cards to be of no value and lay them face down, overlapping the face-up pair as shown in Figure 3. Try to separate any royal-flush cards so they are not that evident. Finally, lay out your royal flush in order face up as in Figure 3 for the winner!

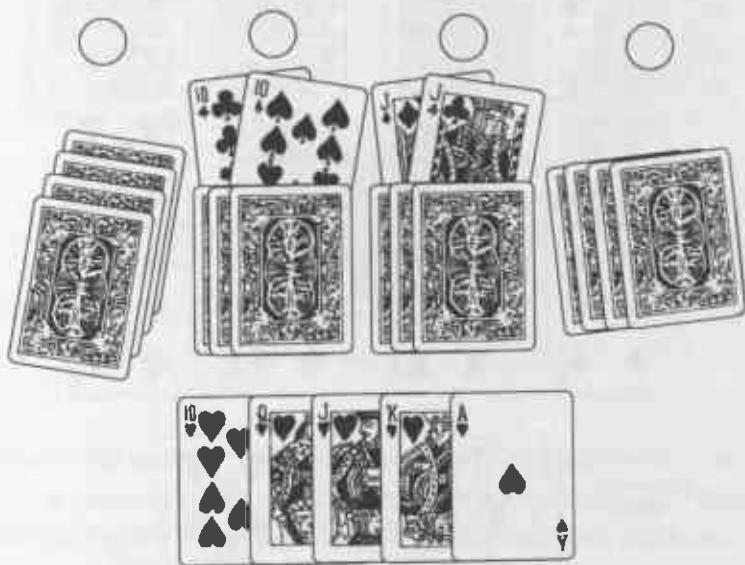


Fig. 3

Notes: In Phase One, after the first five cards have been dealt, you can explain that in “Exchange Poker” *everyone* exchanges hole cards with each other. Any player can exchange his hole card with any other player.

After Phase One, the hands can be gathered in any order and dropped on top of the deck proper. Now give the deck a jog shuffle, retaining the top 25 cards, and proceed with Phase Two.

EXCHANGE POKER—MY ORIGINAL VERSION

Effect: In my original version, the deck is shuffled, and the performer explains a new type of poker called "Switcheroo Poker." Every player gets one chance to switch his cards for the dealer's. The performer tells the story of playing against four players in the World Series of Poker. He deals a round to five players, including himself. A spectator decides who switches cards with the performer. This is done, then two more rounds are dealt, and the spectator designates who switches with the performer. The last two rounds are dealt, and the spectator designates on which round the last player switches with the performer. Everything is so fair! The hands are shown, and the performer wins with four of a kind.

Now, without any switching, one more deal is made for the big jackpot. Five hands are dealt in regulation manner and shown. Four players each have a royal flush, but because the performer claims that deuces are wild, the performer wins with five of a kind—four threes and a deuce.

Method: As stated in the previous version of "Exchange Poker," the principle is Karl Fulves', and the inspiration was a poker deal published by David Britland in the *New Talon*. The inspiration for using the five-of-a-kind finish came from Mel Lamden's "Royal Poker Deal" in *Apocalypse*, August 1994.

The setup from top down is: AC, KC, QC, JC, 10C, AH, KH, QH, JH, 10H, AS, KS, QS, JS, 10S, AD, KD, QD, JD, 10D, 3, 3, 3, 3, 2, rest of the deck. You will also need four poker chips.

Phase One: Jog shuffle and false cut, retaining the top 25 cards.

Explain that this is a new kind of poker called "Switcheroo Poker" at the World Series of Poker in Las Vegas. You say you were playing against four of the best: Amarillo Slim, Bobby Baldwin, Cadillac Jack and Doyle Brunson. (The order is easy to remember since their first names begin with the letters A, B, C and D.) Deal a hole card face down to each of the five players, the fifth card to yourself. Ask a spectator which player should exchange his hole card for yours. Say he selects player No. 1, Amarillo Slim. Place a poker chip above player No. 1's card, then exchange it for yours.

Deal a second round of five cards. Another player's cards are exchanged for yours. Say that player No. 3, Cadillac Jack, is selected. Place a poker chip above his hand and exchange his two cards for yours.

Deal a third round of five. This leaves Bobby Baldwin and Doyle Brunson, players No. 2 and No. 4 to exchange. Say that Bobby, player No. 2, is selected. Place a chip above his hand and exchange his three cards for yours.

Deal a fourth round of five. Now you must exchange with Doyle, player No. 4, but the spectator can elect to switch now or switch after the fifth round is dealt. Say he elects not to switch on the fourth round, but the fifth. Deal the fifth round, place a chip above Doyle's hand, and then switch his hand for yours.

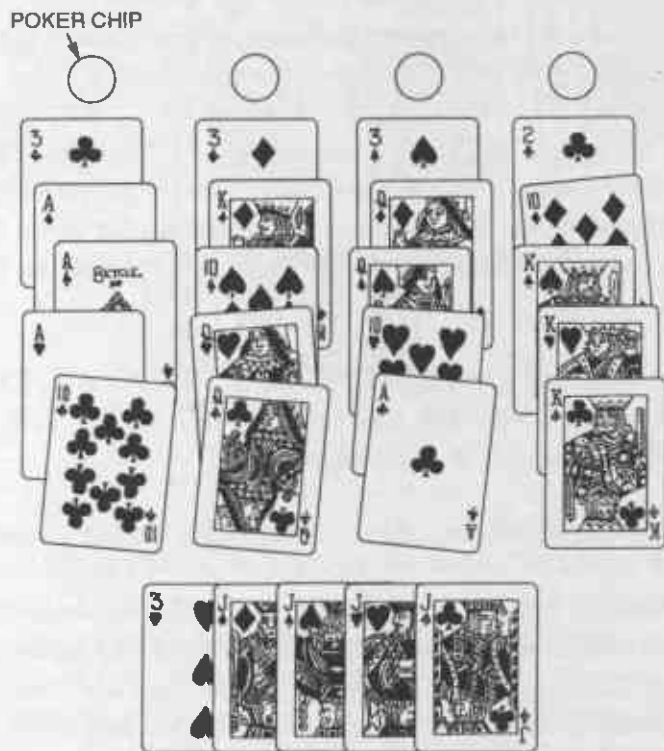


Fig. 1

Recap how fair the procedure has been. Turn up each of the first four hands in turn, spreading each face up in a downward spread. Call attention to the rank of each hand. No one will have better than three of a kind.

Spread your hand face up, showing that you have won with four of a kind (Figure 1).

Phase Two: Scoop the four poker chips aside. Gather the hands one onto another in any order. Give the packet a Charlier shuffle and a reverse faro, if you like. Turn the packet face up and spread it briefly to show the cards are mixed. As you square the cards, get a left little-finger break above any three-spot or the two-spot, then cut (or double cut) at the break. Turn the packet face down. There will be a three-spot or a two-spot on the bottom of the packet.

Explain that for the last deal of "Switcheroo Poker," there are no switches. *"All the players now played for the big jackpot,"* you say.

Deal out five hands of five cards each in the regular manner. Turn up the first four hands in turn, spreading each face up in a downward spread on the table. Each is a royal flush. *"How about those great hands! But remember, the last hand of 'Switcheroo' is always deuces wild,"* you say.

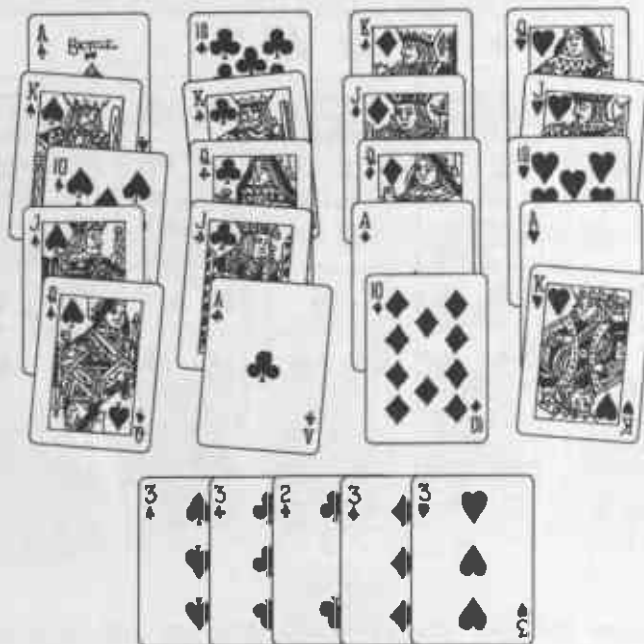


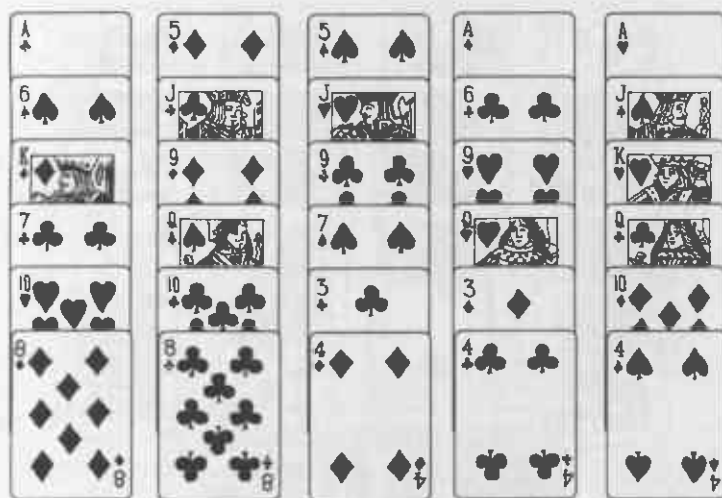
Fig. 2

Turn up your hand and spread it face up to show four threes and the wild deuce. "I've won with five of a kind—the five threes!" you conclude. Figure 2.

FIVE-CARD STUD EXCHANGE

This is another effect using Karl Fulves' poker-hand switching concept, first recorded in his trick "According to Hoyle" in *The Pallbearer's Review*, November 1968.

Effect: The deck is shuffled, then the performer proposes to deal six hands of five-card stud with a switch of hands after each round. A player is allowed to switch only once with the dealer. A spectator determines who switches after each round. Despite the freedom the spectator has in selecting who switches each time, the performer always ends up with the winning hand—a full house.



SETUP

Fig. 1

Method: Lay the four deuces aside; they are not used in the setup. (These are avoided since a spectator could declare that deuces are wild and beat your hand.) Now lay out six full-house hands, each into a separate pile. Mix the values: aces and fives; jacks and sixes; nines and kings; queens and sevens; tens and threes; fours and eights. That is, the first hand consists of,

say, three aces and two fives; the second, three jacks and two sixes, and so on. Pick up one full house and deal these five cards face up into a horizontal row on the table. Deal another full house face up onto the tabled cards. Continue by dealing each full house onto the horizontal row. See Figure 1, which only shows the first four columns. Square each vertical column of six cards, drop the piles one onto the other in any order, then drop these 30 cards face down on top of the rest of the deck (22 cards). You also need five poker chips for markers.

To begin, propose a game of five-card stud, calling it "Pass the Garbage" (also called "Pass the Rubbish" in Britain).

Jog shuffle, undercutting 22 cards or less from the bottom, injog the first card and shuffle off. Form a right-thumb break below the injogged card, shuffle to the break and throw. Give the deck a false cut.

You will deal six hands of five-card stud with a switch of hands after each round. A player is allowed to switch only once with the dealer, and each player gets a chance to switch. A spectator determines who is to switch after each round, and this player's hand is marked by placing a poker chip above it.

Deal a round of six face-down cards, you as the dealer receiving the sixth (hole) card. A spectator designates who switches with the dealer by placing a poker chip above that card. We'll say he elects player No. 4 to switch, so a chip is placed above card No. 4. (See Figure 2.) Switch No. 4's card for your card, the dealer's.



Fig. 2

Now another round is dealt, this time face up. (This is five-card stud.) The spectator places a chip above another hand, say No. 2. Switch No. 2's two cards for your two cards. (The entire hand is switched each time.) Another round is dealt face up. The spectator places a chip above another hand and another switch is made. Say hand No. 3 this time.

Again deal a face-up round. Say the spectator places a chip above hand No. 1, and a switch is made. This done, the last face-up round is dealt. The remaining chip is placed above hand No. 5—the only hand left to be switched. It is exchanged for the dealer's.

The first five players' hole cards are turned face up. Call out the rank of each of these five hands—one pair, two pair, or whatever. Turn over your hole card and show that you have the winning hand—a full house. (Figure 3.)

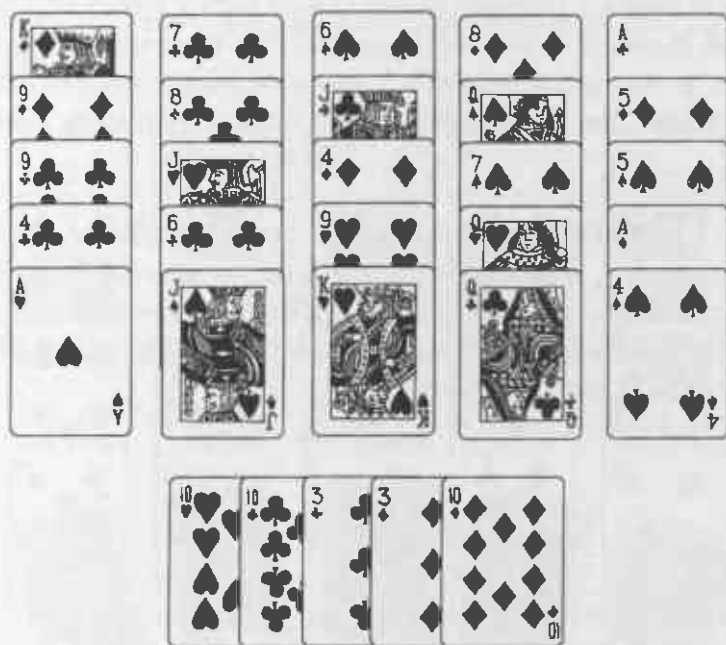


Fig. 3

SEVEN-CARD STUD EXCHANGE

This is the last of the four "Exchange Poker" routines based on Karl Fulves' clever poker-hand switching procedure.

Effect: The performer proposes a new version of seven-card stud in which each player gets a chance to exchange his cards for the performer's after various rounds. The performer deals two face-down hole cards and one upcard to five players and himself. A spectator indicates which of the five hands will be exchanged for the performer's. This done, the performer deals four more rounds, switching the other players' hands for his in the order selected by the spectator. The five players' hands range from one pair to a full house. The performer ends up with the winner—four of a kind.

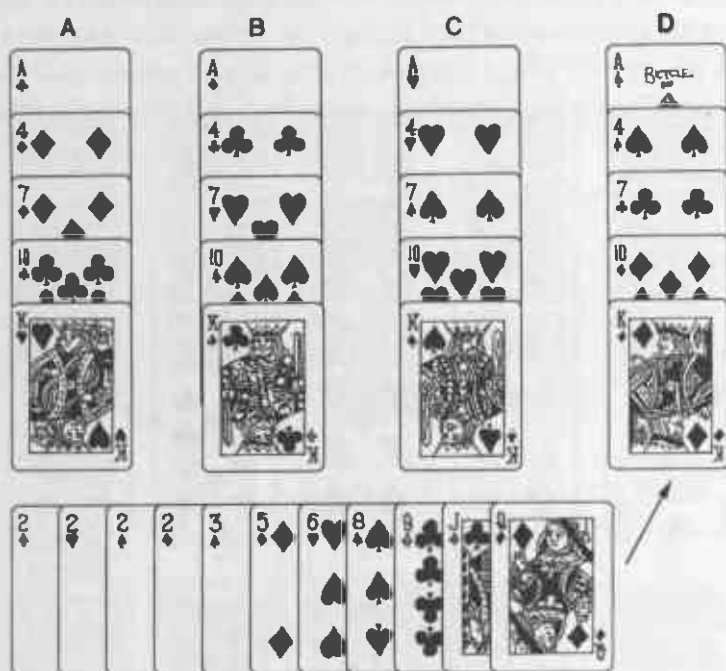


Fig. 1

Method: Remove the aces, fours, sevens, tens and kings and set them into four face-up columns (A, B, C and D) on the table, as in Figure 1. There is an A, 4, 7, 10, K in each column, with the suits mixed. (The values are easily remembered; they are the same three-part values used in the Si Stebbins System.) Below the four columns, lay out an overlapping row of these 11 cards: 2, 2, 2, 2, 3, 5, 6, 8, 9, J, Q. Refer to Figure 1. Drop these cards face up onto column D. (Note: Only the first card of this group—a

2—will be dealt; the rest are out of play, preventing another player from getting four of a kind which could beat your final hand.) You will have 21 indifferent cards left. Drop any seven of these face up onto each of the columns A, B and C. Gather the piles one onto the other from right to left: Drop pile D onto C, both onto B and all three onto A. The deck is ready. You will also need five poker chips for markers.

To begin, patter about a new way to play seven-card stud, one of America's most popular poker games. Call it "Pass the Garbage Stud," or whatever. Explain that each player gets a chance to exchange his cards for the dealer's. Give the deck a false shuffle.

You will deal six hands of seven-card stud. In seven-card stud, each player is dealt two cards face down, four face up, then one face down. Deal five cards into a left-to-right row face down on the table and the sixth card face down to yourself below the row of five. Deal a second face-down card to each player, then a face-up card to each. Figure 2 shows the layout.

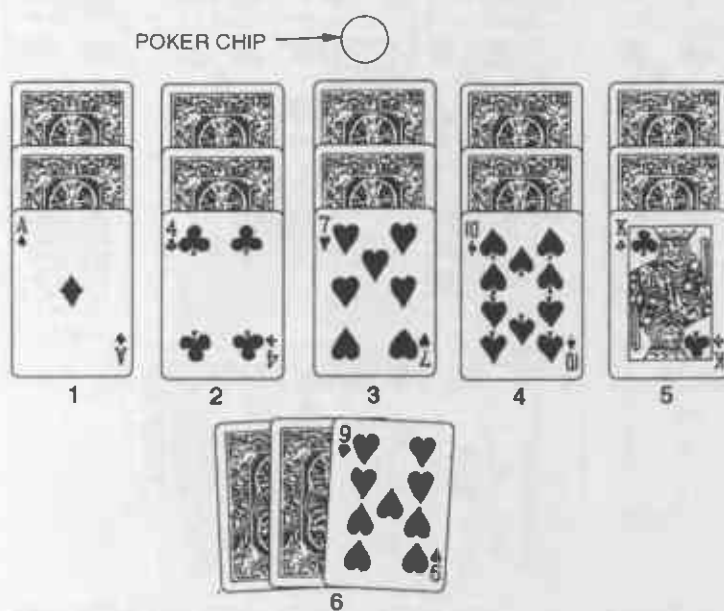


Fig. 2

Have a spectator indicate which hand will be exchanged for yours. Say he selects hand No. 3. Drop a poker chip above hand No. 3 to mark it (as shown in Figure 2), then exchange all three cards of hand No. 3 for your hand.

Deal another face-up card to each hand and switch another hand for yours, letting the spectator make the choice of one of the other four hands (not hand No. 3) to switch for yours. Say he selects hand No. 5. Drop a chip above it (to show that it is being switched), then exchange hand No. 5 for yours.

Deal another card face up to each hand, mark the hand to be switched, then make the switch. Repeat the same procedure. Each player now has six cards.

Deal the last card face down, giving each player seven cards. Lay the rest of the cards aside. Mark the last hand, then switch it for your hand. The layout now is shown in Figure 3.

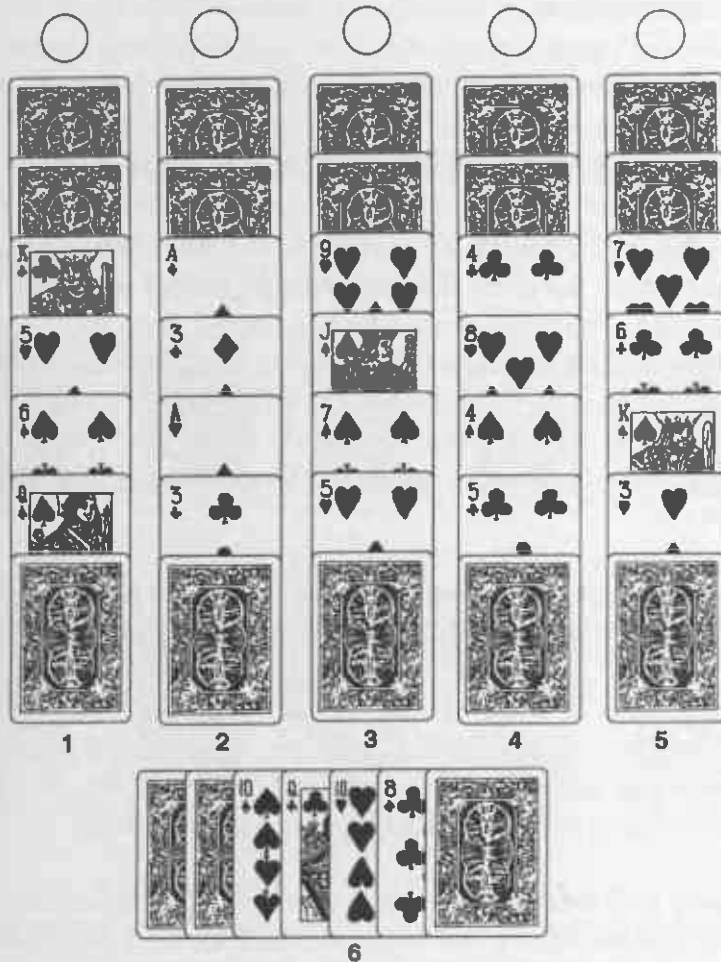


Fig. 3

Turn up the three face-down cards in hand No. 1. Leave the best five cards face up on the table and discard the other two. Call out the rank of the hand, say two pair—fives and kings. Repeat the same procedure with hands No. 2, 3, 4 and 5. The hands will range from a pair to a full house.

For your hand (which is always four of a kind), turn up your first two hole cards. Discard two cards, leaving three of a kind showing. Now explain that the final face-down dealt could give you four of a kind. Dramatically turn it face up and show you have the card necessary to give you the winning hand.

Note: An alternate switching sequence could be: Deal two face-down cards, switch; two face-up, switch; then a switch after *each* of the next three rounds of one card each.

FULL-DECK TEN CARD POKER

Effect: The deck is shuffled. A spectator shuffles a group of ten cards, drops them back on the deck, then deals the performer and himself a five-card poker hand. The same procedure is repeated three more times. The performer shuffles and cuts the remaining 12 cards but has the spectator deal the last pair of hands and discard the leftovers. Each of the five pairs of hands is shown. The performer wins every round. The spectator holds a straight flush on the last round, but the performer betters him with a royal flush.

Method: The working is based on the Ten Card Poker Deal, first described in Arthur Buckley's book *Card Control* (1946).

Bee brand cards look good for this poker deal. Place these four cards in this order into a face-up pile: 10D, 4C, 2H, 9S. Next, place these eight cards into a face-up pile in this order: AD, 8C, KD, 7C, QD, 6C, JD, 5C. Also place the four threes into a separate face-up pile in any order.

Now form four face-up sets, each set consisting of three each of three values. For example, upjog and strip out the following four sets of nine cards each: three fours, three eights, three queens; three fives, three nines,

three kings; three sixes, three tens, three aces; three sevens, three jacks, three twos. The values within each set should be mixed. Place a three-spot on the face of each set.

Now set up the deck in this order, laying all cards into a face-up pile: 10D, any ten-card set, 4C, any ten-card set, 2H, any ten-card set, 9S, the last ten-card set, AD, 8C, KD, 7C, QD, 6C, JD, 5C. You will also need five poker chips.

To perform, ribbon spread the deck face up on the table to show it mixed. Now false shuffle and use an up-the-ladder false cut, maintaining the order of the deck.

Choose a spectator seated across from you to do all of the following shuffles and deals. Hold the deck face down in right-hand Biddle grip. With the left thumb, peel off the top ten cards one at a time face down into the left hand, counting them aloud as you do so. The first card counted (the 10D) is Biddled under the deck. Hand the nine-card packet to the designated shuffler to mix. When he has finished, he drops his cards on top of the deck, which you hand to him to alternately deal a five-card poker hand to you and himself. (These two hands are shown as the first deal in Figure 1.) He will be dealing himself a Jonah card on the tenth card.

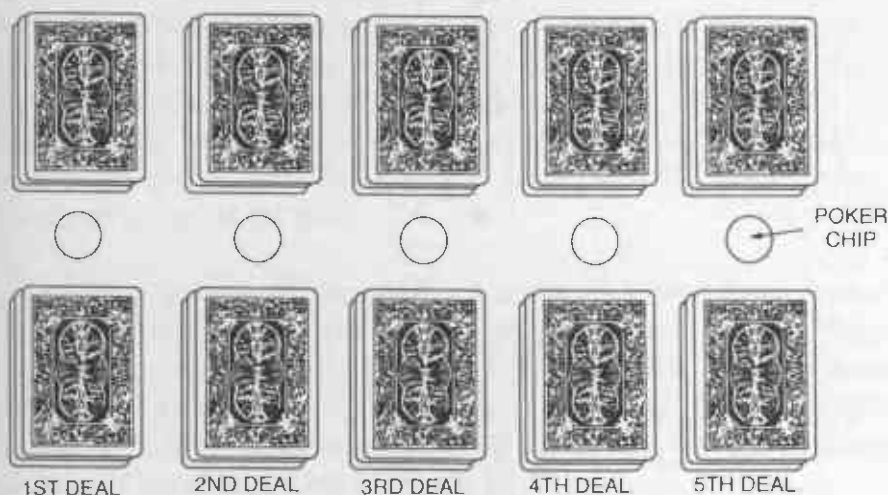


Fig. 1

Count off ten cards aloud into the left hand as before, Biddling the first card (the 4C) to the bottom. Hand the spectator these nine cards for shuffling.

He drops these back onto the top of the deck, which you then hand to the spectator for dealing two more poker hands (as shown in Figure 1).

The same procedure is repeated two more times, Biddling the 2H for the third deal and the 9S for the fourth deal. This leaves 12 cards. Shuffle these yourself. Use a False Charlier shuffle, retaining their order. Hand them to the spectator for dealing two five-card hands as before. He tosses the last two cards aside.

Place a poker chip between each set of hands as shown in Figure 1.

Turn over the spectator's hand from the first deal and spread it face up into a vertical spread toward you. Call out its rank, say two pair—fours and eights. Explain that you would need three of a kind to beat him. Pick up your hand and lay your three queens face up on the table, then table the rest of your hand face down (Figure 2). (For all the deals, always remove and show *only* the cards from your hand needed to beat his hand.) Pick up the chip and pocket it.



Fig. 2

Repeat the same procedure with the hands from the second, third and fourth deals. At times, the spectator may have three of a kind, say fives. You will have a full house, but you may not need to expose it if your three of a kind is higher than his, say nines. Just show the nines. Or the spectator may show a pair, while you have two pair. Just show one of your pairs if it is a higher pair than his.

On the fifth deal, the spectator will have a four-to-eight straight flush in clubs. Say, "*The only hand that will beat it is a nine-high straight flush ... But I went a step better—a royal flush.*" Show you have a diamond royal flush.

Note: The idea of using the Biddle Move in the Ten Card Poker Deal comes from Bert Allerton's trick "Ten Card P.S.," published in *The Phoenix*, No. 170, February 11, 1949.

ANOTHER HANDLING

First, remove these 16 cards and lay them face up into an overlapping row on the table in this order: 3, 3, 3, 3, QD, 7C, KD, 8C, AD, 4C, 10D, 5C, JD, 6C, 2H, 9S. Form four sets, each set consisting of three each of three values. For example, upjog and strip out the following four sets of nine cards each: three fours, three eights, three queens; three fives, three nines, three kings; three sixes, three tens, three aces; three sevens, three jacks, three twos. The values within each set should be mixed. The deck is set from top down: four nine-card sets, then the 16 cards laid aside earlier. The 9S is the face card of the deck.

To begin, false shuffle the deck. Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Pretend to spread off ten cards into the right hand, counting aloud by twos, but take only *nine* cards, like this: Spread off a pair of cards, counting, "*two*," spread over one more card, counting, "*four*," then continue, spreading off three more pairs, counting, "*six, eight, ten.*" Place the nine-card packet face down at position A. (See Figure 3.)

Now count off three more packets of nine cards, counting each as ten, and place them at positions B, C and D. This leaves you holding 16 cards with the four threes on top.

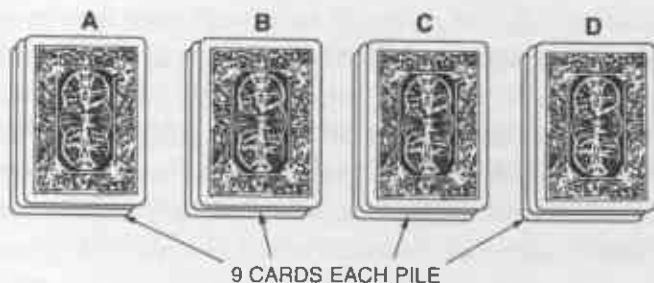


Fig. 3

Have a spectator seated across from you pick up the packet at position A, shuffle it, then drop it on top of your 16-card packet. Hand him your cards and have him alternately deal you and himself a five-card poker hand. The tenth card he deals to himself is one of the threes—a Jonah card. Take the remaining cards from him.

Repeat the same procedure three more times, using the packets at B, C and D.

You will have 12 cards left after the first four deals. Overhand shuffle like this: Run five cards and throw, five more and throw, then two and throw. Hand the packet to the spectator and have him alternately deal two more five-card hands. He discards the last two cards.

Now show that each of your hands beats his as explained in the original version.

Note: The only other full-deck Ten Card Poker routines of which I am aware are Bud Thomas' "Ten-Card Poker Revisited and Revised" in *M-U-M*, November 1980, and Lee Freed's "Ten-Speed Re-Cycle," which is unpublished.

POKER AND BRIDGE ROUTINE

Effect: Three ten-card packets are each shuffled by a spectator who then deals each packet into two poker hands, one to the performer and one to himself. The performer's hand beats the spectator's hand in all three cases! The deck is assembled and four bridge hands are dealt, but the performer's

hand is a poor one. The cards are gathered, shuffled and redealt. This time the performer ends up with a perfect bridge hand—a grand slam in spades.

Method: The first phase of the routine is a multiple version of the Ten Card Poker Deal, which uses one of the subtlest of card principles, that of a single Jonah card controlling the winning and losing hands. The second phase was inspired by Brother John Hamman's trick "The Perfect Bridge Hand" from his booklet *The Card Magic of Bro. John Hamman S. M.* (1958) written by Paul LePaul.

To set up, discard the four deuces. Only a 48-card deck is used. Place the remaining 12 spades in a face-up pile on the table. Now form four face-up sets, each set consisting of three each of three values. Upjog and strip out the following four sets of nine cards each: three threes, three sevens, three jacks; three fours, three eights, three queens; three fives, three nines, three kings; three sixes, three tens, three aces. The values within each set should be mixed.

Pick up the 12 spades and drop them face up onto any nine-card set; drop these cards face up onto another nine-card set, and so on, until all five piles have been combined. From top down, the deck reads: four nine-card sets, then the 12 spades on the bottom.

Phase One—Poker: Hold the deck face down in the left hand and pretend to spread off ten cards, but really take only nine: Spread off pairs into the right hand, counting aloud by twos but take only one card on the count of "four." Table this packet (nine cards) face down to the left. Repeat by counting off two more packets of nine (supposedly ten) and tabling them face down to the right of the first packet. From left to right, the packets are lettered A, B and C (Figure 1). Hold the balance of the deck face down in the left hand.

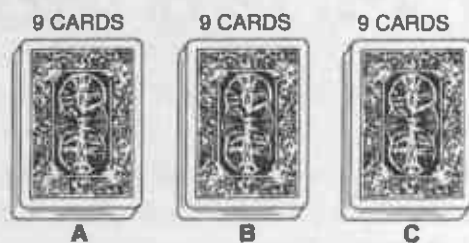


Fig. 1

Have a spectator pick up packet A, shuffle it, then drop it face down onto your left-hand cards. Hand him your cards and have him alternately deal two five-card poker hands, one to you and one to himself. Take the balance from him and have him pick up packet B and shuffle it. He drops his cards face down onto yours, takes the combined packet and alternately deals two more poker hands. Take the balance from him.

Have the spectator pick up packet C and shuffle it. He drops his cards onto yours, takes the combined packet and alternately deals the last two poker hands. This done, take the rest of the cards and set them aside.

Turn up the spectator's first hand and spread it vertically face up on the table. Pick up your hand and spread it with the faces toward you. Remove and show only the cards needed to beat his hand as shown in Figure 2. Scoop together all ten cards, turn them face down and table them.

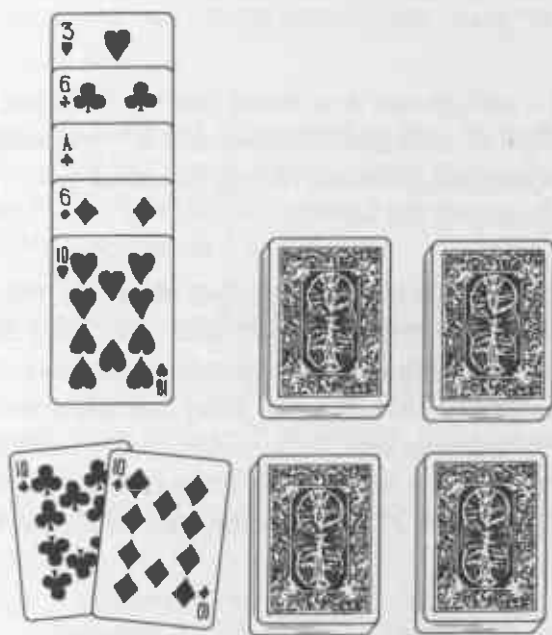


Fig. 2

Repeat the same procedure with the next two hands: Remove and show only the cards needed to beat his hand, then scoop together all ten cards, turn them face down and table them.

Again, repeat the same procedure with the last two hands. You will end with three ten-cards piles face down in a row on the table.

Pick up the balance of the deck (18 cards) that was laid aside earlier. Casually deal two cards onto each ten-card pile in random order, then say to the spectator, "*You have shuffled all of the cards so far, so you may as well shuffle the rest.*" Hand him the remaining cards (12 spades) for shuffling. This done, take his cards and distribute them two at a time in random order, dealing four cards onto each of the three piles. The mixing process is very convincing.

There are now three piles of 16 cards with four spades on top of each. Stack the piles one onto the other in any order.

Phase Two—Bridge: Patter about the odds of dealing yourself a perfect bridge hand as you deal out four hands of 13 cards each, dealing yourself the fourth hand.

Pick up your hand, showing what may be a few high counters, but nothing more. Drop the hands one onto the other in any order. Perform an up-the-ladder false cut, retaining the order of the deck.

"It has been said that cheating takes place at bridge more than any other card game. However, it is very difficult to cheat in bridge since you have to control so many cards," you say. Finally, deal four bridge hands again. Spread the other three hands face up to show a lack of good cards, then spread your hand to show that you have a grand slam in spades. The odds of getting all the spades, you point out, is over 158 billion to 1.

Note: The reason for shorting the deck of the deuces is to prevent a spectator from claiming that deuces are wild in the poker phase.

ALTERNATE HANDLING—POKER PHASE

To set up, discard the four deuces. Only a 48-card deck is used. Place the remaining 12 spades in a face-up pile on the table. Now form three face-up sets, each set consisting of three each of three values. Upjog, strip out and lay down the following sets of nine cards each: three threes, three sevens, three jacks; three fours, three eights, three queens; three fives, three nines,

three kings. The values within each set should be mixed. Also place two aces face up on the table. Now set up the deck from top down: nine-card set, ace, nine-card set, ace, nine-card set, seven X cards, 12 spades.

Method: Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Pretend to spread off ten cards but take only nine: Spread off pairs, counting aloud by twos, but take only one card on the count of "four." Table this packet (nine cards) face down to your left on the table. This is packet A. Now spread off two more packets so each packet actually contains ten cards. Table them face down to the right of the first packet. These are packets B and C. Table the balance of the deck (19 cards) face down at the right end of the row. This is packet D. See Figure 3.

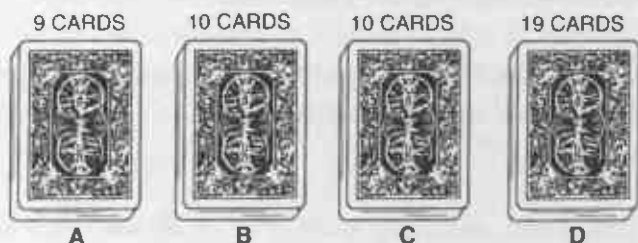


Fig. 3

A spectator picks up packet A, shuffles it, drops it onto B, picks up the combined packet and alternately deals two poker hands, one to you and one to himself.

He shuffles the cards he holds, drops them onto packet C, picks up the combined packet and alternately deals two more poker hands, one to you and one to himself.

He shuffles the rest of the cards he is holding, drops them on top of packet D, picks up these cards and alternately deals the final two poker hands. The rest of the cards are laid aside to the right. Beginning with the first two hands dealt, show the hands as explained in the original method. From here, the working is the same as outlined above.

18

More Predictions

"The future is as elusive to magicians as it is to anyone else, of course, but they have developed any number of ingenious tricks which make it seem that the opposite is true."

—Paul Curry, *Magician's Magic*, 1965

This chapter contains some novel and strong prediction effects. One of my favorites is "The Eleven Routine," a subtle, three-part combination.

CHOICE AND CHANCE— A DOUBLE PREDICTION

Effect: From a shuffled deck, the performer lays out two prediction cards face down on the table in front of two spectators. Two cards are selected—one by choice and one by chance. These selections are placed with the prediction cards. When shown, the prediction cards match the selections.

Method: Have the deck shuffled and returned. Run through the cards with the faces toward you and lay any card (the 10D, for example) face down on the table as the first prediction card. For the second prediction card, lay its mate (the 10H in this case) face down to the right of the first tabled card.

Ribbon spread the deck face up on the table in front of a spectator and ask him to think of any card. This card, you say, was arrived at entirely by "choice."

Gather the cards and ask him to name his thought-of card. When he does, run through the deck with the faces toward you until you spot the mate to his card, then cut the deck, bringing the mate to the top. For example, if he names the 5C, cut the 5S to the top. Find the card he named (the 5C in this case), pull it out, flash it briefly, then drop it face down onto the prediction card on the left.

Next, explain that the second card will be selected entirely by chance. Hand another spectator the deck face down. (The mate to the thought-of card is on top.) Force the top card, using the Cut-Deeper Force.

Once this spectator has made the cuts, take the deck and spread off the face-up cards. Remove the first face-down card and drop it face down on top of the prediction card on the right. Point out that this card was selected purely by chance.

Lay the rest of the deck aside. Casually pick up the pair at the left and drop it face down onto the pair at the right. Hold the packet face down in the left hand in position for a glide.

With the right hand, pull out the bottom card of the packet (the second prediction card) and deal it face up on the table. Perform the glide and deal the next card face up onto the prediction card, stating this is the card selected by chance. The 10H and 10D will show.

Deal the bottom (glided) card face up on the table, stating that this was the prediction for the card selected by "choice." It is the 5S. Finally, turn the last card face up—the 5C—and deal it onto the 5S. Again another match. Two predicted cards—one selected by choice and one by chance.

Note: This effect was first published in my column in *The New Tops*, July 1982.

DOUBLE WHAMMY PREDICTION

Effect: Here is a very direct prediction effect that can be performed without any setup at all. The performer removes two prediction cards, openly shows they are, say, the KD and 5C, and tables them. Now a spectator freely selects two cards from the deck, which are placed with the two prediction cards. The performer's two cards and the spectator's two cards are shown to be mates.

Method: Have the deck shuffled and returned to you. Fan the cards with the faces to you. Note the two cards at the face. Say the cards are the KH and 5C, the 5C being the card on the face. Spread through, upjogging the two mates, in this case the 5S and KD, which you openly transfer to the face of the deck.

The four cards at the face now read: KH, 5C, 5S, KD, from left to right, the KD being on the face. As you square the deck, get a left little-finger break beneath the three cards at the face. The right hand takes the three cards above the break in Biddle grip and lifts them off; at the same time, the left hand sets the deck proper face down on the table.

Explain that you have made two predictions. Hold the three cards squared face down in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off the top card into the left hand. Rotate both hands to the right at the same time; the right hand turns palm up to show the KD (double), the left hand turns palm down to show the 5C. Rotate the hands to the left so both cards are face down. Place the KD (double) onto the 5C and drop all three cards face down on the table.

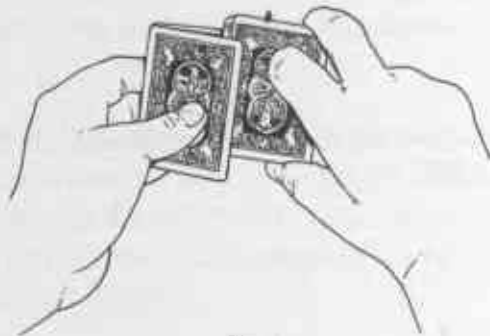


Fig. 1

Pick up the deck proper. Cut off half the deck from the top and discard it. The card you will now force is on the bottom of the remaining half. Force it using Remo Inzani's forcing procedure: Hold the half-deck face down in right-hand Biddle grip. With the left thumb on top and fingers beneath, draw off the top and bottom cards into the left hand (Figure 1), then place this pair to the bottom of the right-hand cards. (Note that the KH remains on the bottom.) Again draw off the top and bottom cards and place the pair to the bottom. (The KH remains on the bottom.) Repeat the procedure, asking a spectator to stop you at any point. When he does, the bottom card of the pair stopped on will be the KH, the force card.

Set the rest of the cards aside and drop the chosen pair face down onto the tabled prediction cards.

Pick up the tabled packet, turn it face up and hold it in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off the 5C then the KD into the left hand in fanned condition. "*There are my two prediction cards,*" you say, "*and these are your two cards . . . They match!*" As this is said, pull the 5S into the left hand, then lay the double card on top. All four cards show as in Figure 2.

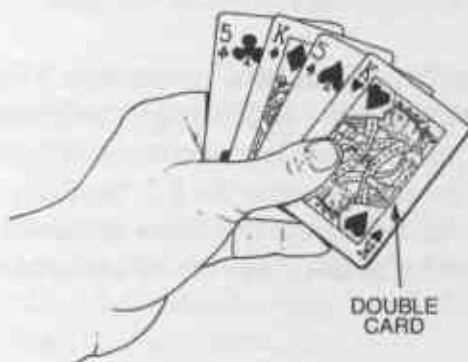


Fig. 2

Note: This prediction effect was first published in my column in *The New Tops*, January 1992.

GILBREATH VALUE/SUIT PREDICTION

Effect: The performer lays two prediction cards face down on the table, explaining that the two cards are a composite of a card to be selected. A spectator riffle shuffles the deck, then selects a card. Say his card is the 10D. The performer's two cards are a ten and a diamond, fulfilling the prediction.

Method: Have the deck shuffled. Note the top two cards as you fan the deck with the faces toward you. Say the two noted cards, preferably a red and black card, are the 5S and 10D. Upjog, remove and table face down the 5D and 10S, two cards of the same values but opposite suits. These two cards, you explain, are your prediction cards.

Hold the deck proper face down in the left hand. The right hand lifts off about half the cards; as it does, use the left thumb to slip cut the top card onto the bottom half. The right hand replaces its cards on top of the bottom half. A left little-finger break is held between the halves.

Cut the deck in half at the break and lay the halves side by side on the table in position for a riffle shuffle. (The 5S is on top of one half, the 10D on top of the other half.) "*Here, you riffle shuffle the cards,*" you say to a spectator. He does so. Due to the Gilbreath principle, either the 10D or the 5S will be on top of the deck after the shuffle.

Now have the spectator execute the Hamman Flip-Flop Force: He picks up the deck, spreads off less than half the cards and flops them face up on top. Now he spreads past the face-up cards into the face-down cards and flops over the group, then spreads off the face-up cards, places them face down on the bottom, then tables the first face-down card. The rest of the deck is discarded.

Recap how fair the spectator's selection was—he shuffled and cut the cards himself—then selected a card at random(?). He turns over his card, which could be either the 5S or the 10D. Turn over one of your prediction cards to show that one of your cards matches the *value* of the selection and your other card matches the *suit*.

TROST ON HAMMAN'S VALUE/ COLOR PREDICTION

Effect: The performer lays two pairs of cards face down on the table. He explains that each pair will be used to predict two freely selected cards. A spectator now selects any card, which he places next to one of the performer's tabled pairs; he selects another card and places it next to the other tabled pair. The performer's first pair is shown (say a six and a red card). The spectator turns over his card and it is a red six! The same procedure is repeated with the performer's second pair—again the two cards predict the value and color of the spectator's selection.

Method: The effect was inspired by an unpublished Brother Hamman effect shown to me by Gary Plants. The Hamman method used some involved calculations and the bottom deal. I worked out this version, which, coincidentally, employs the Hamman Switch.

Alex Elmsley published a similar idea based on the Mexican Turnover. It's called "The Mexican Prediction" and appears in *The Collected Works of Alex Elmsley, Volume II* (1994). Peter Duffie has a variant of Elmsley's version titled "Down Mexico Way" on his website, dated February 2, 2005.

Set up the deck from top down: all reds, all blacks.

Begin by explaining that you will lay out two pairs of cards, with each pair forming a prediction of a card. You say that all will be clear momentarily. Run through the deck from face to back and upjog a black six-spot and a red six-spot. Strip them out and table them face down in front of you. The red six is the *top* card of the pair. Repeat the same procedure by upjogging another pair, say a black king and a red king. Strip them out and table these face down to the right of the first tabled pair. The red king is the top card of this pair.

Now false shuffle the deck proper, using the Bottom Stock Control (as explained in the Appendix, *Volume I* of this work). This maintains all the red cards on top and the black cards on the bottom.

Spread the upper half of the deck and have a spectator remove any (red) card and lay it face down above the pair of sixes. Continue to spread into the bottom half of the deck, have another card removed (a black one this time) and placed face down above the pair of kings (Figure 1). Set the rest of the deck aside.

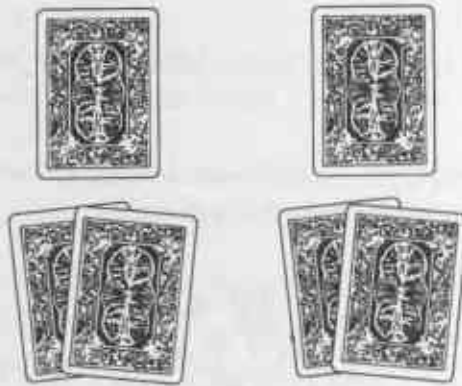


Fig. 1

Pick up the pair of sixes. Take a card in each hand. The *left hand* takes the card of the same *color* as the spectator's tabled card. In this case, the spectator's card is *red*, so take the red six of the pair into the left hand. The left hand's card will now be switched for the spectator's tabled card, using the Hamman Switch, as follows:



Fig. 2

The right hand slides its card under the right edge of the spectator's card as the left hand slides its card on top (Figure 2). Raise all three cards off the table. The right hand turns its card face up endways toward you and replaces it face up on top of the other two cards; at the same time, the left thumb fans the three cards to the right (Figure 3). The right hand grips all three cards momentarily as the left hand turns over the bottom card endways toward you and replaces it on the *bottom* (Figure 4).



Fig. 3

It appears as though you never touched the spectator's card, and this is what you emphasize as you perform the switch.



Fig. 4

Call attention to the top card of the three, saying that you predicted the selected card would be a six. Then state that the bottom card is red, which indicates it will be a red six. Have the spectator remove the face-down center card (supposedly his selected card) and turn it face up. It is a red six (See Figure 5.) Table your cards.

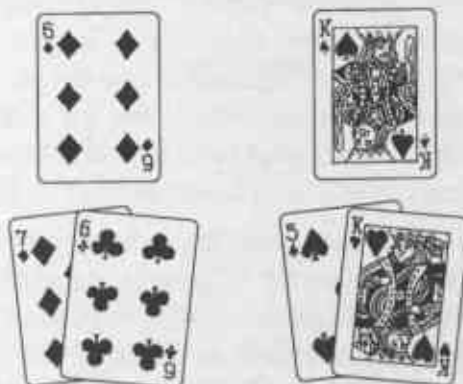


Fig. 5

Now repeat the same switch with the pair of kings. Since the spectator's card is black, the left hand takes the bottom (black) king. Perform the Hamman Switch exactly as before. This time your two cards are seen as a king and a black card. Have the spectator remove the face-down center card and show it. It is a black king, just as you predicted. Figure 5 shows the final layout.

Notes: Of course, any matching values can be used as a prediction pair, just make sure there is one of each color.

Any card may be selected by the spectator, and both cards can be the same color. All you must know is the color of the spectator's card.

THE ELEVEN ROUTINE

Effect: The performer writes a prediction, and a spectator drops it onto any one of nine tabled pairs. The pairs not selected are shown to add to different totals. The prediction reads "The mysterious total is 11," and the spectator's pair totals 11! The cards are shuffled, then the performer deals pairs one by one on the table and has a pair selected. The other pairs show different totals again. The selected pair totals 11! The cards are mixed thoroughly and dealt into two piles. The spectator eliminates either pile. The procedure is repeated until one pair remains. Again, just as predicted, the pair totals 11!

The tricks used, in order of appearance are:

- 1) A variation of Bob Mason's marketed trick "Brain Blaster," (1974) in which you predict the total of a pair of numbered Zodiac cards. Mason's trick is a version of Stewart James' "Figgerow," first published in *The Linking Ring*, August 1969, and later in *Stewart James in Print: The First Fifty Years* (1989).
- 2) The second phase was inspired by Peter Duffie's "Eleven Plus" from his book *Imagine* (1992); it also appeared in his book *Card Compulsions* (1995).

- 3) The third phase comes from Peter Duffie's concept originally published in a trick called "The Ninth Card" in *Abracadabra*, No. 2590, September 16, 1995, and later in his trick titled "All the Fives!" in his *Effortless Card Magic* (1997). I learned of this concept from "Cash Cards," a trick marketed in 1997 that used 16 cards with different amounts of money printed on them. Cards were eliminated until two remained. The total of these two cards was predicted.

Method: To set up, remove all the black spot cards (20) and arrange them in pairs from top down: A-10, 3-8, 6-5, 9-2, 7-4, 10-A, 3-8, 6-5, 2-9, 7-4. (All the pairs total 11.) Reverse faro the packet (or deal it into two piles and combine them), then put the 20 cards on the face of the deck properly.

Phase One: Cut off the top half of the deck, cutting shallow. Riffle shuffle the halves together, then give the deck a cut. With the faces of the cards toward you, upjog all 20 black spot cards; silently count them to make sure you have all 20, then strip them out. Discard the rest of the deck.

Show the packet contains all black spot cards from ace to ten. Turn the packet face down and perform a Charlier shuffle. Now deal a face-down row of nine cards from *right to left* on the table. Lay the rest of the packet aside, face down. Write a prediction on a card: "The mysterious total is 11," fold the prediction and hand it to a spectator, who drops it above any card in the row.

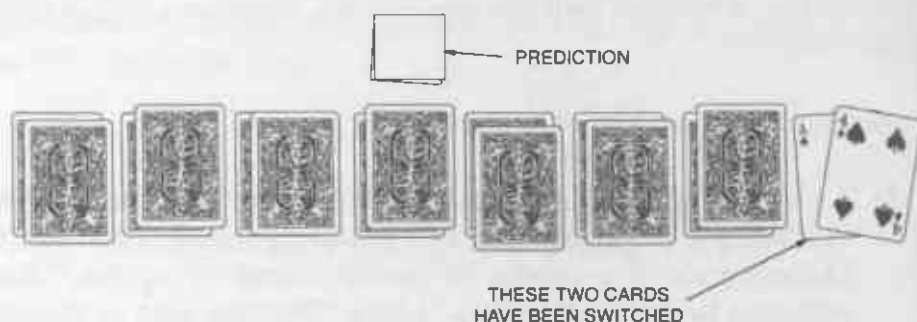


Fig. 1

Pick up the rest of the packet and hold it face down in the left hand in position for the glide. The right hand deals a card from the bottom face down onto each of the nine cards in the tabled row. Deal from *left to right* and, when you reach the card marked with the prediction, perform the glide, dealing the next bottom card onto the marked card. Continue by dealing

the glided card and any other cards needed to complete the row of pairs. You will have two cards remaining in the left hand. Turn the left hand palm up. The right hand takes off the face card of the pair as you announce the total of these two cards. Place the right hand's card under the left (so the positions of the two cards are switched), then lay this pair, fanned, face up at the right end of the tabled row (Figure 1).

Turn the non-selected pairs in the row face up, in place, to show that their totals are different. The prediction is shown and it reads: "The mysterious total is 11." The pair selected by the spectator is turned face up to show that it totals 11. Your prediction is correct.

Lay the selected pair aside, face up. Gather the nine tabled pairs from right to left face up, one onto the next. Use the face card of the pile to scoop up the nine pairs. You have casually moved a card from the face of the packet to the top (rear). All of the pairs in the packet now total 11. (Note: Instead of scooping up the packet with the face card, you can pick up the packet and double cut the face card to the top.)

Phase Two: Turn the packet face down and False Charlier shuffle, so the pairs still total 11. Deal the cards a pair at a time face down on the table into a pile and ask the spectator to indicate any pair *before* it is dealt. Lay the selected pair aside, then deal the rest of the pairs one by one onto the tabled pile.

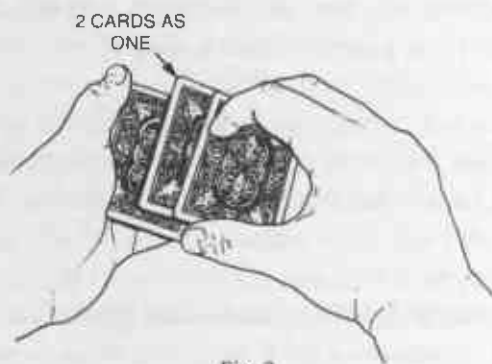


Fig. 2

Pick up the pile, getting a left little-finger break beneath the top three cards. With the left thumb, push over the top card to the right; the right hand lifts off the top three cards as two in Biddle grip (Figure 2). Turn the right hand palm up to show the total of the two cards; place these cards face down

to the bottom of the packet. The right hand then deals the top pair face up on the table and continues to deal the rest of the pairs face up onto the first. Point out that all of the pairs are different totals. Finally, turn up the selected pair to show that it totals 11, just as you predicted. Lay this pair aside, face up.

Phase Three: Pick up the face-up tabled pile and give it a face-up Charlier shuffle. This is very deceptive and appears that the cards are really mixed. At the end of the shuffle, cut the packet if necessary to bring a pair totaling 11 to the face of the packet. At this point, all pairs in the packet will total 11.

Turn the packet face down and reverse faro once, then, if you want, Charlier shuffle and cut any number of times. Still holding the packet face down, deal two face-up piles with eight cards in each. Deal alternately left then right as you would in a two-handed game of cards. The values of the cards will appear mixed. Explain to the spectator that he will choose a pair this time through the process of elimination. Have him select the pile to be eliminated. When he does, drop the selected pile aside, face down.

Pick up the other pile, turn it face down and Charlier shuffle. Now alternately deal the cards into two face-down piles of four cards each. Have the spectator eliminate one of these two piles, which is dropped onto the first cards eliminated. This will leave four cards, which can be Charlier shuffled and cut. Alternately deal the four cards into two face-down piles of two cards each. Have one pile eliminated; drop it onto the cards eliminated earlier.

Pick up the cards that were eliminated, turn them face up and spread them to show the values are mixed without exposing the last (top) pair, which will add to 11.

Show that the pair selected by elimination totals 11!

MIRASKILL WITH THE EQUALIZER SHUFFLE

Effect: The deck is divided into two halves, then the performer writes a prediction for a spectator to hold. The spectator lifts off a packet from the

first half. The packet is turned over and riffle shuffled face up into the second half. Then the spectator lifts off a packet from that half, which is turned over and riffle shuffled into the first half. The procedure is repeated several times, forming a totally random mixture of face-up and face-down cards.

The performer deals pairs of face-down cards into one pile, face-up pairs into another and discards the mixed pairs. The prediction says there will be four more face-up than face-down cards. When the piles are counted, the prediction is absolutely correct. The effect is immediately repeated with a new prediction, which also proves correct.

Method: This is a version of Stewart James' trick "Miraskill." It was inspired by Bob Longe's "Simple Miraskill" in his book *The Magical Math Book* (1998). My effect uses the "Equalizer" shuffle. The Equalizer shuffle is Harry Lorayne's term in his book *Trend Setters* (1990) for the shuffle first described by Simon Aronson in his book *Shuffle-Bored* (1980) and later popularized by Aldo Colombini in his marketed trick "Pre-Deck-Ability" (1996). Colombini's trick also appeared in his video *Lasting Impressions, Volume 1* (2000).

Phase One: Make sure you have a 52-card deck. Begin by explaining that you will need about half the deck. Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Spread off 24 cards in eight groups of three from the left hand to the right. Table the 24-card half to your right, the 28-card half to your left. We'll call the left half, A, and the right half, B.

Say, "I'm going to make a prediction." Write on a piece of paper: "Four more face-up cards than face-down cards." Let a spectator hold the prediction.

Now carry out the Equalizer shuffle with the two halves: Have the spectator cut off a group of cards from, say, half A and place it between the halves at C. Turn this group face up and riffle shuffle it into B. Now have him cut off a group from B and drop it between the halves. Turn over this group and riffle shuffle it into half A.

This procedure can be repeated any number of times, cutting off a group from either A or B, turning over the group and riffle shuffling it into the opposite half. Finally, turn over the remainder of A and riffle shuffle it into B.

There appears to be no way for you to control the number of face-up and face-down cards. At this point, there will be 28 cards face up, 24 face down.

Have the spectator give the deck a complete cut. (Actually, he can shuffle the cards if he wants.)

Pick up the deck. You will now spread off cards in *pairs* from the top and deal the pairs into three piles on the table: If the two cards are both face down, put them into a pile to the left. If they are both face up, put them into a pile to the right. If one is face up and one face down, put the pair into a discard pile in front of you. See Figure 1. Continue until all pairs have been dealt.

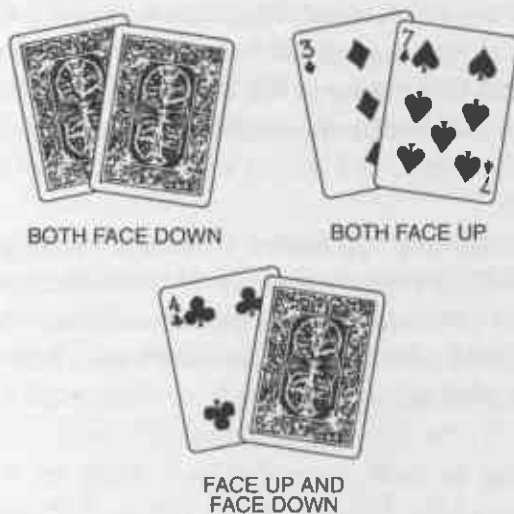


Fig. 1

Have the prediction read. It states there will be four more face-up cards than face-down. Pick up the face-down cards and count them aloud. Say there are 14. "*I predicted there would be exactly four more face-up cards,*" you say. Pick up the pile of face-up cards and count off 14, then spread the remaining four face-up cards to show your prediction is correct.

Take two of the four face-up cards in each hand. Drop two face-down onto the pile of face-down cards and the other two face up onto the pile of face-up cards. Riffle shuffle these two piles together, mixing face-up and

face-down cards. Table this pile to the left of the other pile. (Actually it makes no difference which half is placed where.) You are now ready for—

Phase Two: Write a second prediction: “The two piles will be equal” and hand it to one of the spectators to hold.

Now go through the same procedure with the Equalizer shuffle. For the last shuffle, turn over *either* pile and shuffle it into the other. (There will be 26 face-up and 26 face-down cards in the deck at this point.)

Deal the pairs into three piles as in Phase One. Have your second prediction read, which states that the piles will be equal. Count the face-down cards aloud. Say there are 20. Count the face-up cards—again there are 20. The piles are equal and again your prediction is correct.

Notes: Stewart James’ “Miraskill” was first published in *The Jinx*, No. 24, September 1936. The first to use face-up and face-down cards instead of reds and blacks were Joseph K. Schmidt and Karl Fulves. Their version was published in Karl Fulves’ book *More Self-Working Card Tricks* (1984) under the title “Miraskil.” Fulves also published a version called “Future Vision” in his book *New Self-Working Card Tricks* (2001).

MIRASKILL AND PSYCHIC ABILITY

Effect: The performer begins by handing out a prediction. A spectator repeatedly mixes cards, forming a random mixture of face-up and face-up cards. The performer deals pairs of face-down cards into one pile, pairs of face-up cards into another and discards the mixed pairs. The prediction reads: “There will be four more face-up cards than face-down.” The two piles are counted and the prediction is correct.

The spectator again mixes cards randomly face up and face down. There would be no possible way for anyone to keep track of the mixture, yet the performer correctly divines the number of face-down cards, the number of red-suited cards and, surprisingly, detects the exact odd-suited card among the blacks.

Method: A version of "Miraskill" using face-up and face-down cards was described by Karl Fulves in his book *New Self-Working Card Tricks* (2001) under the title "Future Vision."

The shuffling procedure is attributed to several, including Simon Aronson in his "Shuffle-Bored" effect; but the main part of the routine was inspired by Aldo Colombini's "Pre-Deck-Ability," a separate item published by him in 1996.

To set up, remove any 15 red cards. Then remove any eight clubs and the 4S. These 24 cards are shuffled together. This packet is dropped face down on top of the rest of the deck.

Phase One: Write a prediction: "There will be four more face-up cards than face-down." Have a spectator hold the prediction.

Give the deck a jog shuffle: Undercut less than half, injog the first card and shuffle off. The right thumb forms a break beneath the injogged card, shuffle to the break and throw.

Spread off the top 24 cards, counting eight groups of three into the right hand and table these cards about eight inches to the right. Table the rest face down to the left. We'll call the left half, A, and the right half, B. Half B is the key half.

Now a spectator is to cut off some cards from either half and drop them at C, a position between the halves. Say he cuts some from A to C. Point out there is no way to know exactly how many cards were cut off. Turn over the cards at C and riffle shuffle them into half B. Now have him cut off some from the face-up and face-down cards from B and place them at C. Turn over the cards at C and riffle shuffle them into A.

Now the spectator cuts off any amount from A and places them at C. You turn over these cards and riffle shuffle them into B.

This shuffling procedure can be continued as long as you want. (The spectator can cut off cards twice from the same packet if he wants.) When you have convinced the spectators there is no way you could tell how many face-up or face-down cards are in each packet, finish this way:

Turn over the rest of packet A and riffle shuffle it into B, the key packet. Packet B is *never* turned over for the final shuffle.

Give the entire deck an additional riffle shuffle if you wish.

Now deal three piles of pairs as shown in Figure 1. If the top two cards are face down, deal this pair to the left; if both are face up, deal the pair to the right; and if the pair contains one face-up and one face-down card, deal the pair near you to begin a pile of discards.

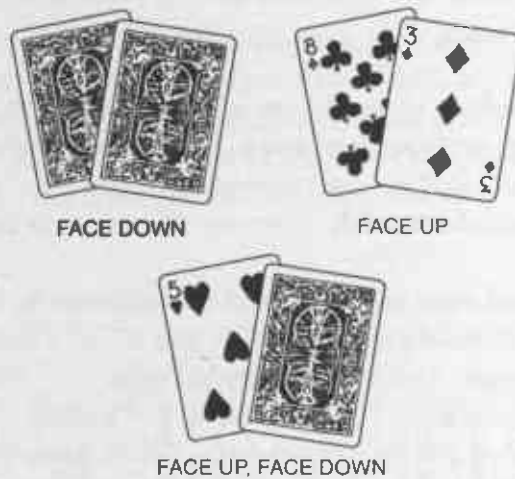


Fig. 1

Go slowly, dealing pairs into three piles as they come from the top of the deck. As you deal, patter about how the spectator himself determined how the cards were shuffled and that you had no control over how they would pair up.

Have the prediction read: "There will be four more face-up cards than face-down." Pick up the pile of face-down cards and count them aloud. Say there are 12. Pick up the pile of face-up cards and count off 12, then show there are four more face-up cards, proving your prediction is correct.

Stack the three piles one onto the other in any order. Square the deck and hold it in the left hand.

Phase Two: Offer a further test of your psychic abilities.

The right hand cuts off about half the deck and tables it to the right. (This again is the key packet.) The left hand turns palm down, *turning over* its half and tables it to the left. Again, half A is on the left, half B on the right.

Now the same shuffling procedure as outlined above is carried out: The spectator cuts off some cards from either half A or half B and places them between the halves at C. Turn over the cards at C and riffle shuffle them into the *opposite* half. Continue the procedure until you have convinced the spectators that you could not possibly know how many cards are face up or face down. Finish as before: Turn over the rest of packet A and riffle shuffle it into B, the key packet.

Explain that instead of predicting a number of cards, you will try to "divine" how many cards are face down. Set the deck on the table and place your hand on top of it. *"I get the impression there are . . . twenty-three . . . no, twenty-four face-down cards,"* you say. (You always say 24.)

Pick up the deck, and as you spread through, lay the face-down cards into a tabled pile, counting them aloud as you do so. There will be exactly 24, just as you thought. Discard the face-up cards.

Lay your hand on the face-down pile. *"I have been able to determine the colors—the red cards—yes, I believe I detect fifteen red cards,"* you claim. Pick up the packet, turn it face up and deal the red cards face up into a tabled pile, counting them as you do so. There will be 15 reds. Table the rest, the black cards, face down.

Place your hand on the face-down black cards. *"That's strange,"* you say, *"all the black cards are clubs!"* Pick them up and fan them with the faces to a spectator. *"Am I right?"* you ask. When he hesitates, say, *"Well all clubs except one—the four of spades!"* Tilt the faces of the cards toward you, remove the 4S and table it face up. This ends the routine with a final punch.

Note: Here are two alternate methods that can be used: In the initial setup, make the 5D a bottom-cutting breather and include it as part of the 15 red cards removed. Place the 5D on the face of the 24-card packet and drop the packet onto the rest of the deck. Now, after the jog shuffle, instead of fanning off 24 cards, simply cut at the breather and set the 24-card packet to the right.

Also you can pencil dot the back of the 4S. At the finish, when the faces of the cards are toward a spectator, say, "*They are all clubs except this one . . .*" Spot the pencil dot on the back of the 4S, remove it and deal it face up on the table. The spectator will wonder how you were able to detect it.

PSYCHIC ABILITY WITH GILBREATH

Effect: A spectator riffle shuffles the deck, then mixes the cards, forming a random mixture of face-up and face-down cards. By laying his hand on the deck, the performer gets an impression there are 20 face-down cards. He is correct. Of those, he announces, exactly 13 are red. Once more he is correct. Finally, he states the rest are all clubs . . . wait . . . except for the 6S. Correct again!

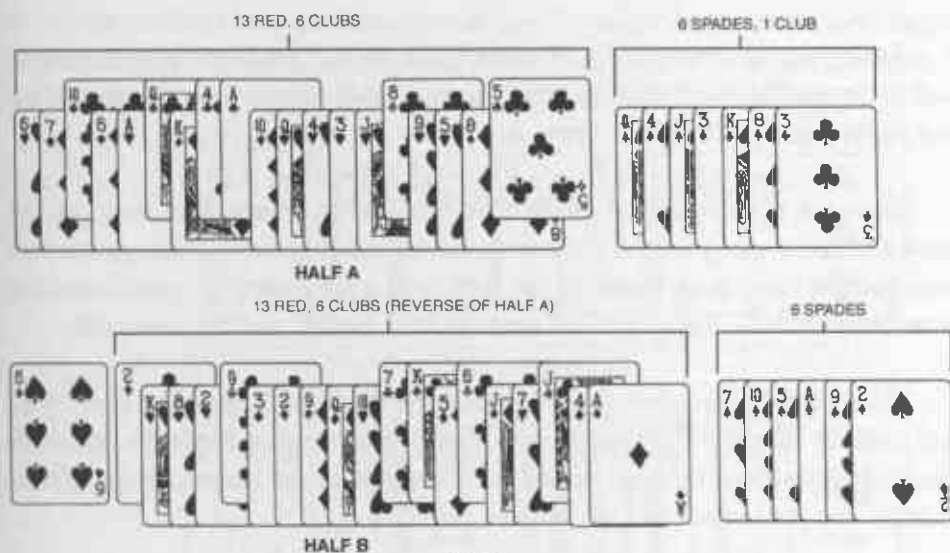


Fig. 1

Method: Set up two half-decks: Half A: Lay 13 reds and six clubs in mixed order face up into a tabled spread. In a separate spread to the right, lay six spades (minus the 6S) and one club in any order. See Figure 1. Half B: Lay out the 6S, then 13 reds and six clubs *in reverse order* of the 13 reds and six clubs in half A, then, in a separate spread to the right, lay out six spades in any order. Gather half A so the six spades and one club are on the

face. Gather half B so the 6S is on top and the six spades on the face. Place half B face up onto half A and the deck is set.

Begin by fanning the deck face up to show it mixed. Get a left little-finger break beneath the 6S as you square. Cut the deck in half at the break, turn the halves face down and have a spectator riffle shuffle them together.

Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Spread over the top 20 cards into the right hand, counting them in six groups of three, plus two more cards. Get a left little-finger break beneath these 20 cards as you square.

Cut off the top 20 and table them face down to the right. Table the rest of the deck face down to the left. Now have the spectator go through the Equalizer shuffle procedure: He cuts off a group from the left packet. Turn these cards face up and riffle shuffle them face up into the right packet. Now he cuts off some from the right packet. Turn these over and riffle shuffle them into the left packet.

Again, the spectator cuts off some from the left packet. Turn these over and riffle shuffle them into the right packet. Finally, turn over the rest of the left packet and riffle shuffle these cards into the right packet.

Have the spectator give the deck a straight cut. Place your hand on the deck and announce you "feel" there are 20 face-down cards. Pick up the deck and deal the face-down cards on the table into a separate pile, counting them aloud as you deal. There will be exactly 20. Discard the face-up cards.

Place your hand on the face-down cards. Announce there are exactly 13 red cards in the pile. Pick up the pile, turn it face up and count the red cards aloud, laying them face up on the table as you count them. There will be exactly 13. Table the black cards face down.

Lay your hand on the black cards, saying, "*And I think all the black cards are clubs!*" Pick them up and fan them with their faces to the spectator to check. Before he says anything, say, "*All clubs . . . except for the six of spades. Is that right?*" All the cards are clubs except for the 6S. Remove the 6S and deal it face up on the table.

LINEUP AND PSYCHIC ABILITY

Effect: The performer shows the deck is a mixture of face-up and face-down cards. He cuts the deck in half, ribbon spreads the two half-decks on the table and pushes the cards into each other, mixing them even further. Now two small piles are dealt, and a spectator covers either pile so the performer cannot see it. The performer holds the other pile under the table, attempting to arrange these cards into the same face-up, face-down order as the hidden pile. When the piles are checked, both are in the same exact order.

The spectator now repeatedly riffle shuffles the cards, forming a random mixture of face-up and face-down cards. The performer correctly divines that there are exactly 20 face-down cards, that 13 of these are red, and finally, that all the black cards are clubs—except one. He declares it is the AS—and he is correct!

Method: This is a combination of my “Lineup” from *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997) and a version of Aldo Colombini’s “Pre-Deck-Ability,” which he marketed in 1996.

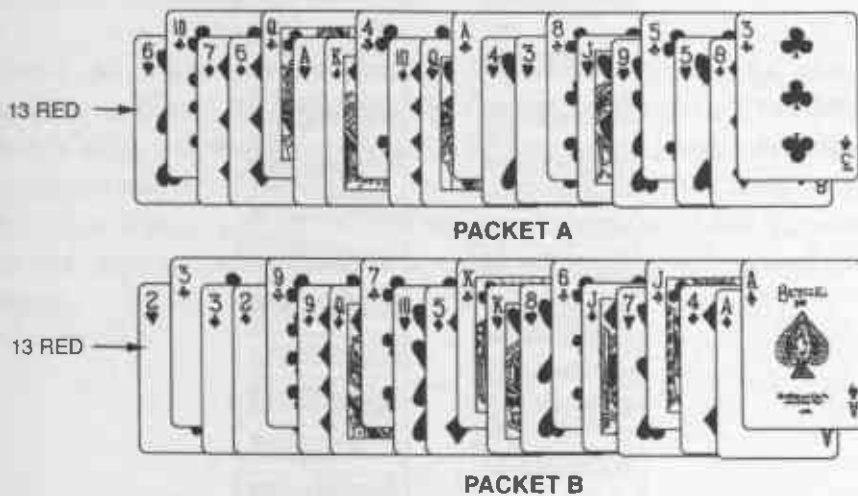


Fig. 1

To set up, separate the red cards from the blacks. Ribbon spread 13 red cards face up on the table. Insert a *club* every third card in the spread, working from right to left. Now place a *club* at the face of the spread. (See

packet A in Figure 1.) Now set up packet B in the same sequence except that the AS is placed at the face of this spread. You are left with 12 spades.

You will now deal all the cards into a common pile on the table as follows: Scoop up packet A and hold it face down in the left hand. Deal the top card face down, the next face up, the next face down, and so on. (The last card will be face up.) Hold the 12 spades face down. Deal these onto packet A, randomly face up and face down. Now scoop up packet B and hold it face down in the left hand. Deal the top card *face up* onto the tabled pile, the next face down, the next face up, and so on, ending with the face-down AS on the top of the completed deck. Case the deck.

Phase One: Remove the deck from its case. Casually spread the deck face down in the hands to show it to be a mixture of face-up and face-down cards. Remark that after last using it, someone really mixed the cards. Perform an up-the-ladder false cut if you want.

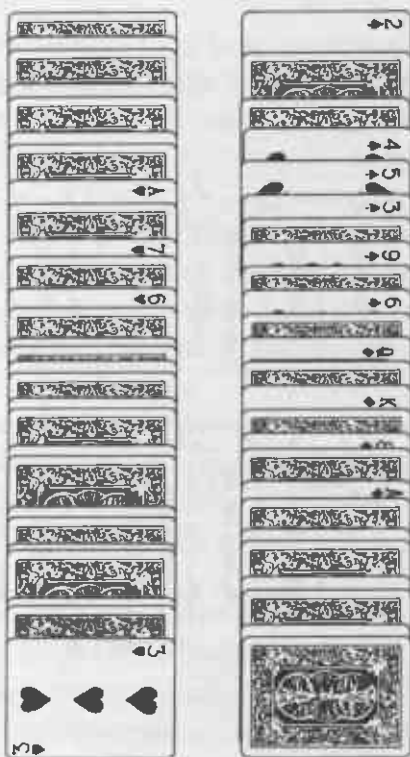


Fig. 2

Hold the deck face down in the left hand. The right hand cuts off the top half, cutting somewhere into the 12-card spade group near center. The left hand turns palm down (turning over its cards) and ribbon spreads its half toward you on the table. At the same time, the right hand (without turning over its cards) spreads its half about one inch to the right of the left-hand half (Figure 2).

You now perform Paul Curry's so-called "spread shuffle" explained in his trick "Don't Lie to Me" in *Paul Curry Presents* (1974) and later in *Paul Curry's Worlds Beyond* (2001): Start at the inner ends of the spreads and, using both hands, push the spreads into each other, intermixing the cards. Once the cards have been interwoven, square the deck and hold it in the left hand.

Alternately deal two tabled piles of ten cards each from the top of the deck. Lay the rest of the deck aside to your left. Have a spectator cover either one of the ten-card piles with the card case.

Explain that you will attempt to arrange the cards in the other pile in the same *exact* face-up and face-down order and, "To make it more difficult," you say, "I will not look at the cards."

Hold the other ten-card pile under the table. Turn over the pile, then reverse the order of the cards. Finally, turn over the *second* card from the top, then bring the pile into view and hold it in the left hand. Lay your right hand on the pile covered with the card case, then place the hand on top of your pile as if to pick up the aura from the cards. Explain that you need to make one adjustment of your cards. Openly turn over the *second* card of your pile.

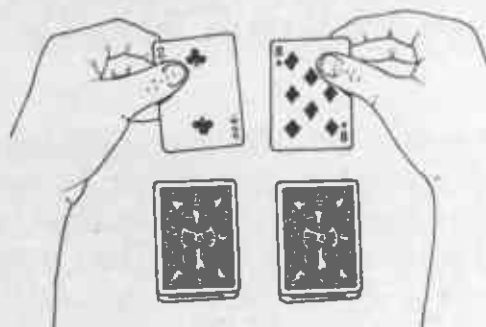


Fig. 3

Now set your pile beside the one covered with the card case. Remove the card case. Using both hands, deal the top card of each pile above the piles as in Figure 3. Continue to deal the pairs above the piles, pointing out that the cards in each pile are in the same face-up and face-down order. You have successfully completed the first task.

Drop one ten-card pile onto the other, pick up this packet, then outjog the face-down cards and strip them out. Turn the face-up cards face down and combine these with the face-down cards. Set these 20 cards face down to your *right* on the table. We will refer to this as packet B, the key packet.

Pick up the other half-deck laid aside earlier, upjog the face-down cards in this half and strip them out. Turn the face-up cards face down and combine these with the face-down cards. Set this packet (packet A) face down to your *left* on the table.

Phase Two: Have the spectator cut off cards from packet A and drop them in between the packets. Turn this cut-off portion face up and riffle shuffle it into packet B. Now have the spectator cut off cards from B and table them between the packets. Pick up this cut-off portion, turn it over and riffle shuffle it into packet A. Repeat the procedure by having the spectator cut off a portion of either A or B. You turn over this portion and riffle shuffle it into the opposite packet. As the last step, pick up packet A, turn it over and riffle shuffle it into B. The entire deck has been assembled.

Lay a hand on the deck, pretending to pick up the aura from the cards. *"I get the impression there are nineteen—no, there are twenty face-down cards,"* you say.

Pick up the deck and deal the face-down cards into a separate pile on the table, counting them aloud as you do. There will be 20. Set the face-up cards aside.

Place your hand on top of the 20 face-down cards and announce that you get the impression there are 13 red cards. Pick up the packet, turn it face up and count 13 red cards aloud into a pile. Set the black cards face down on the table. Lay your hand on the black cards. *"That's strange,"* you say, *"all the black cards are clubs."* Pick up the black cards, fan them with the faces to a spectator, asking, *"Was I right?"* When he spots the AS, quickly add, *"Except for the ace of spades!"* Remove the AS and show it.

Note: The back of the AS can be pencil-dotted in the upper left and lower right corners so as the black cards are fanned with the faces to the spectator, you can spot the pencil dot on the back of the AS; remove it and deal it face up on the table. The spectator will wonder how you knew which card was the AS.

TRIPLE CLIMAX CLOCK TRICK

Effect: The performer places a prediction card on the table, then pockets one other card without showing it. The rest of the deck is shuffled as a spectator thinks of any hour from 1 to 12. He removes a corresponding number of cards from the deck and conceals them. If he thought of 8, for example, he removes eight cards. A clock dial is formed. While the performer turns away, the spectator notes the card at his thought-of hour, eight o'clock in this case.

The performer faces front and removes the card he pocketed earlier. It is an eight, corresponding to the spectator's hour. Now the card at eight o'clock is shown to be the KH. The prediction card matches perfectly—it's the KD. The odd thing is the KH and KD are both red, but the rest of the cards in the clock are black!

Method: Set up the deck from top down: 12 blacks, KH, ace to queen (all black), 2 blacks, 25 reds.

To begin, fan the cards with the faces to you, remove the KD and place it face down at the upper left corner of the table as your prediction card. Openly place any other red card, without showing it, into your right trouser pocket.

Jog shuffle, retaining the order of the top 27 cards. Ask a spectator to think of any hour from one o'clock to twelve o'clock. Hand him the deck; ask him to remove a corresponding number of cards from the top to equal his hour and conceal them under the card case, which is at the upper right corner of the table. Say he thinks of eight o'clock and conceals the top eight cards.

Take the rest of the deck and reverse count 12 cards into a face-down pile on the table. Set the rest of the deck aside. Pick up the 12 cards and deal a clock formation face down on the table, beginning at one o'clock and ending at twelve o'clock. The twelve o'clock card should be outjogged from the others to mark that hour (Figure 1).

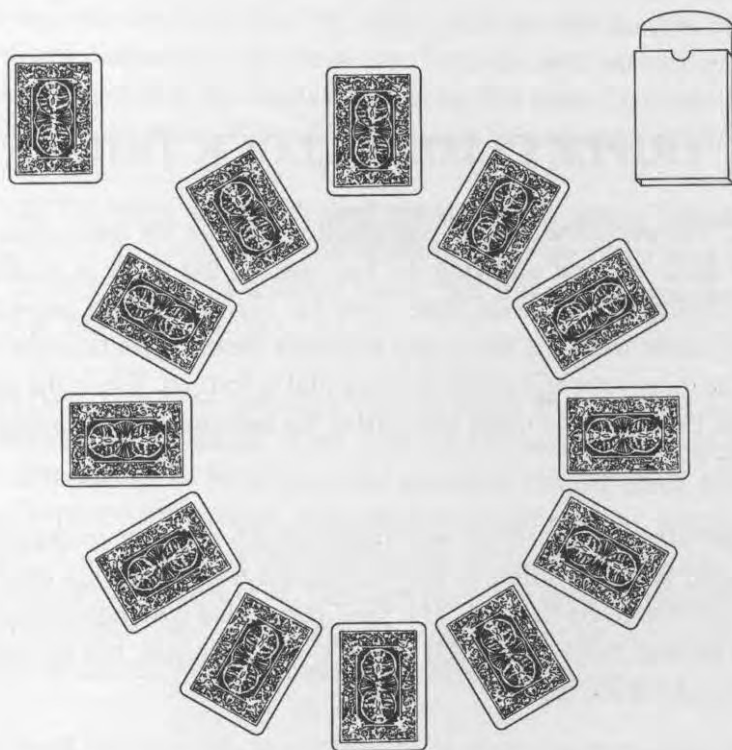


Fig. 1

As you turn away, the spectator notes the card at his hour on the clock. In this case, since his hour is 8, he would note the card at eight o'clock. He will note the KH.

Face front and pick up the deck proper. Palm the top card of the deck proper and apparently remove it from the right trouser pocket. Show it is an eight, corresponding to the spectator's hour. Drop the card onto the deck proper and set it aside. Pick up the cards concealed under the card case and deal them into a tabled pile in front of you as you count them aloud to verify that 8 was the selected hour and that your prediction was correct. This is the first climax.

Now count in the clock to the hour indicated—8, in this case—and push the card at that hour to the center of the clock layout.

Sweep together the other cards in the clock and drop them face down onto the pile in front of you. Turn up the selected card, showing the KH. Now turn over your prediction card to show its mate, the KD. Lay it face up beside the KH—second climax.

"Here's the odd thing," you say as you pick up the cards in front of you and square them. *"We both picked red cards and the rest of these are black."* At this, ribbon spread the cards face up on the table below the red kings to show they are all black—third climax!



Mechanical Rising Deck

From *National Magic Co. Catalog No. 6*, 1945

19

More Transpositions

"When cards begin to hippity-hop about the table top, you have an eye catching plot."

—Brother John Hamman, *Legerdemain*, August 1977

Some of the best card effects possible are of the transposition variety. The first effect in the chapter, "The Sub-Trunk Mystery," I find to be a very effective story-type trick. The next three effects all employ jacks. I think that you will find them intriguing. The last two effects in the chapter were inspired by two of Milt Kort's excellent tricks.

THE SUB-TRUNK MYSTERY

Effect: The performer explains that he will present a version of the famous Substitution Trunk Mystery using a deck of cards. The KS represents the magician and the QH, the assistant. The QH (assistant) is placed face down between the two black eights, which represent handcuffs. The three-card sandwich is cut into the deck. The KS (magician) is placed on the face of the deck (trunk), which is then cut. The QH escapes from between the black eights (handcuffs) and is found on top of the deck, while the KS is in the center of the deck between the black eights.

Method: The handling for this effect comes directly from Al Leech's trick "Ace Sandwich," which appeared in his booklet *Card Man Stuff* (1953). In Leech's effect, the AS, which is sandwiched between the two red aces, changes places with the AC. This handling fits in perfectly for use in a story-type trick about the Substitution Trunk Mystery.

Remove the KS, QH and two black eights from the deck, dropping them face up on the table.

Explain that you will demonstrate the famous Substitution Trunk Mystery. Hold the deck face down in the left hand. The right hand displays the KS, calling it the magician, and tables it aside, face down. Now pick up the QH, calling it the magician's assistant, and place it face down between the two face-up black eights. The eights you refer to as the "handcuffs." Turn the eights horizontally, showing how the number 8 appears to be a pair of handcuffs. (This idea comes from Paul Cummins.) Show the fan of three cards on both sides, then place the three cards on top of the deck with the eights face up. Refer to the deck as the "trunk." Hold the deck face down in the left hand, show the sandwich once more, then square, getting a left little-finger break beneath the black eight on top. Perform a double cut, which takes the top black eight to the bottom. Apparently the handcuffed assistant is inside the trunk. The QH is actually on top of the deck.

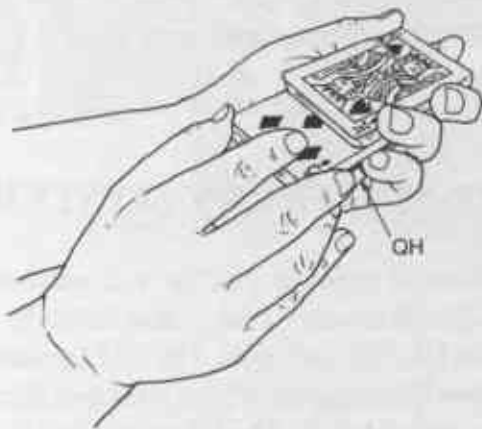


Fig. 1

"The magician now stands on the trunk," you say. Place the KS (magician) face down on the bottom of the deck, then turn the deck face up, showing the KS on the face. With the left little finger, pull down the QH at the inner right corner and get a break above it. (Another way to get in

position is to riffle off the QH with the right thumb to get a break above it with the left little finger.)

Grasp the deck at the inner end between the right thumb at the left side, right second finger at the right side, as for the Hindu shuffle. Without disturbing the QH, pull the bottom half of the deck toward you (Figure 1). As soon as it clears the top half, slap it onto the face of the deck, burying the KS. "*The magician disappears,*" you say.

Turn the deck face down in the left hand and riffle it. "*Believe it or not, the substitution has taken place!*" you say. Show that the top card, the QH, has escaped from between the black eights (handcuffs). Deal the QH face up on the table. Ribbon spread the deck face down on the table to show there is still one card face down between the face-up black eights (handcuffs). Show that it is the KS, the magician.

THE JACKS COME BACK AGAIN

This is based on Brother Hamman's trick called "The Jacks Comes Back" in his book *The Secrets of Brother John Hamman* (1989).

Effect: The performer deals the two black jacks face down on the table, one to his left, the other to his right. A red jack is dealt onto each black jack. But, the black jacks are inseparable—they both appear together on the right. The effect is repeated, but this time the black jacks appear together on the left. The four cards are now shown to be all black jacks, but it was only an illusion, for now the jacks have vanished, and in their place are the four aces.

Method: The setup from top down is: two black jacks, two red jacks, two black aces, AD, rest of the deck.

Phase One: Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Fan over the top four cards, but get a left little-finger break beneath the seventh card. The right hand flops over the top four cards face up on top. The right hand takes all seven cards (those above the break) in Biddle grip and lifts them off.

Point out that you have two red jacks followed by two black jacks as you perform the Braue Addition: The left thumb peels off the top three jacks one by one, levering them face down onto the top of the deck with the edge of the right-hand packet. As soon as the third jack has been levered face down, drop the right-hand cards on top, then flip the last black jack face down on top. Spread over the top four cards to the right, but get a left little-finger break under *five* cards; square the five cards, then lift them off with the right hand. Set the rest of the deck aside. (Apparently you have taken off the four jacks but you actually hold five cards.)

Spread over the top two cards of the packet (supposedly the two black jacks) and grip them in right-hand Biddle grip (Figure 1).

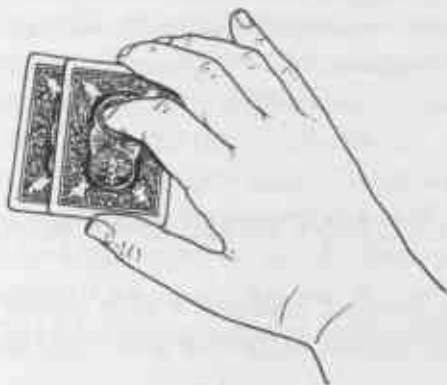


Fig. 1

Drop the bottom card of this pair to your left on the table, flash the face of the other card (a black jack) and drop it face down on the table about six inches to the right of the first card.

The right hand deals the top card of the remaining three on top of the left-hand tabled card. The right hand then takes the double from the left hand and sets it overlapped onto the right-hand tabled card. These cards are gripped in the right hand as shown in Figure 1. "*The jacks always come back,*" you say as the right hand rubs the three cards (supposedly two) on the table, then turns palm up to show the two black jacks (Figure 2).

Square the right-hand cards, then drop them on top of the two tabled cards (the black aces). Pick up the packet and place it face down in the left hand.

Phase Two: Spread over the top two cards of the packet and grip them in the right hand as shown in Figure 1. These are supposedly the black jacks again. Drop the bottom card of the pair to the left and the top card to the right, face down on the table.

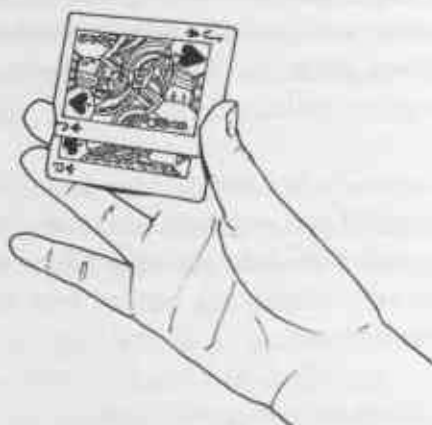


Fig. 2

Now deal the next top card onto the left-hand tabled card, then place the double onto the right-hand card, overlapped momentarily; then pick up these three cards, square them and rub them on the table. The right hand drops these cards on the table, then picks up the two cards at the left and displays them as in Figure 2. "*The jacks always come back,*" you say.

Take a jack in each hand. The left hand's card is used to scoop up the cards at the right as the right hand's jack is added to the top of the packet. (The order of the packet from top down is: black jack, black ace, black ace, red ace, black jack.)

Phase Three: You now perform the Diminishing Count to show four black jacks: Hold the packet face down in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off *three* cards one by one into the left hand. The right hand shows the face of the double (a black jack) and drops it face down onto the left-hand cards. Use the left thumb to thumb off the top card face down to the left on the table.

The right hand takes the packet in Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off *two* cards one by one face down into the left hand; the right hand shows

another black jack (double). The double is dropped onto the left-hand cards, then the top card is thumbed off onto the tabled card.

The right hand takes the packet in Biddle grip; the left thumb peels off *one* card into the left hand; the right hand shows the double (a jack), then the double is used to lever over the left-hand card to show another jack. This jack is levered face down; place the double face down onto the single, then drop all three cards onto the tabled pair.

"And I know what you're thinking," you say. *"You think I have four black jacks."* The right hand picks up the tabled pile. Then say, *"That would be cheating, and I wouldn't do that. Actually I have four aces."* Perform a through-the-fist flourish, turning the packet face up. Now perform an Elmsley Count to show four aces.

Drop the packet face down on top of the deck.

Note: You could go into the Elevator trick at this point. (If this is the case, you need to have the AH on the face of the deck from the outset.) Deal a left-to-right row of four face-down cards; these are supposedly the four aces. We'll call these cards A, B, C and D, from left to right.

Work from right to left: Drop the deck proper face down onto D, riffle up, pick up the deck and show an ace on top. Deal it face up at D. Pick up the card at C, place it on top of the deck, riffle down, remove the bottom card (without turning over the deck), show the second ace and deal it face up at C.

This leaves an ace on top and bottom. Pick up the card at B (a jack) and insert it into the center of the deck. Ask the spectator if he wants to make the ace rise or descend. Whatever he says, show the ace either on top or bottom. Deal it face up at B.

Pick up the face-down card at A and insert it into the center of the deck, riffle the deck and show the last ace either on top of the deck or on the bottom (the opposite position of the third ace). Deal the fourth ace face up at A to conclude.

THE AMBITIOUS JACKS

This is a three-phase routine: The performer places the deck proper on the table between a pile of four random cards and a pile of four jacks. Cards from each pile are dealt alternately onto the deck proper. The four jacks are shown to have assembled on top. The effect is repeated very slowly and deliberately with the flashing of the face of nearly every card. Again the jacks assemble on top.

In a third phase, the jacks are dealt face down into a tabled row and three cards are dropped onto one of the jacks. It rises to the top of the packet. The other three jacks also work their way to the top—they are quite ambitious!

Phase One: Set up right in front of the spectators. Fan the deck with the faces to you and cut a red jack *third* from the top. Now cull the two black jacks and other red jack to face of the deck so the red jack is on the face. Slide any card between the black jacks. From the face, the cards read: red jack, black jack, X, black jack, rest of the deck with the other red jack third from the top.

Fan off the bottom four cards into the right hand; table the deck proper face down in front of you.

Elmsley Count the four cards face up, placing the last card under the packet (underground Elmsley) to show four jacks. Flip the packet face down and table it. Pick up the deck proper and spread the top four cards into the right hand. Table the deck face down to the left of the "jack" pile. Flash the indifferent card on the bottom of the in-hand packet and then table the packet to the left of the deck proper. Figure 1 shows the arrangement.

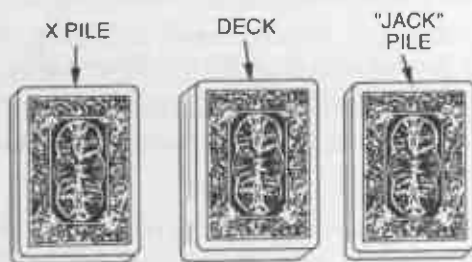


Fig. 1

Now cards from each pile are dealt alternately onto the deck proper, beginning with the pile on the *left*. Pick up the top card of the pile on the left. Flash the face of the indifferent card and place it face down onto the deck; pick up the top card of the pile on the right, flash the face of the jack and place it face down onto the deck. Continue dealing the rest of cards alternately without any further flashing.

Pick up the deck, spread off the top four cards into the right hand and table the deck proper. Turn the four-card packet face up and Elmsley Count (last card to the bottom) to show the four jacks.

Turn the packet face down and table it to the right side of the deck proper.

Phase Two—The Repeat: Pick up the deck proper, spread off four cards into the right hand and replace the deck on the table. Flash the face of the indifferent card on the bottom of the packet, then table the packet to the left of the deck proper. The arrangement is shown in Figure 1.

Again, deal cards from each four-card packet alternately onto the deck, beginning with the left packet. This time, you flash the face of the first three and last three cards, not the fourth and fifth cards.

Pick up the deck, spread off the top four cards into the right hand and table the rest of the deck. Turn the packet face up and Elmsley Count (last card to the face). Four jacks will be shown.

Phase Three—The Elevator Finish: Turn the “jacks” face down and deal them into a left-to-right row face down on the table. We’ll call them A, B, C and D, from left to right. (The card at A is an X card.)

Pick up the deck proper and deal the top three cards face down onto D, reversing their order as they are dealt. Discard the rest of the deck. Pick up the four cards at D, riffle them, turn over the jack on top and deal it face up at position D.

Reverse count the remaining three cards onto the card at C. Pick up the four cards, riffle them, then turn the top card face up, revealing the second jack. Deal it face up at C.

Reverse count three cards onto B. Pick up the four cards at B, riffle them, show a jack on top and deal it face up at B.

Finally, reverse deal the three cards onto the card at A, pick up the four cards, riffle them and show the jack on top. Deal it face up at A.

The last three cards are dropped on the table face up.

THE MYSTERY OF THE PENTHOUSE

Effect: This is an effect with a story: The four jacks (the burglars) are shown. The deck is cut into four piles, each pile representing a floor of a building the burglars plan to rob. One jack is placed onto each pile (floor), and the piles are stacked one on the other. An alarm sounds, and all four burglars appear on the roof (the top of the deck) and escape.

Method: This is an easy-to-do variant of Daryl's "Rising Crime," which appeared in his book *For Your Entertainment Pleasure* (1984).

The four jacks are on top of the deck, reading from top down: JD, JS, JC, JH.

To begin, hold the deck face down in the left hand. Spread over the top four cards, but get a left little-finger break beneath seven cards as the right hand flops over the four jacks on top. The right hand lifts off all the cards above the break—the four face-up jacks and three face-down cards.

Perform the Braue Addition: The left thumb peels off the top three jacks one by one, levering them face down onto the top of the deck with the edge of the right-hand packet. As soon as the third jack has been levered face down, drop the right-hand cards on top, then flip the fourth jack face down on top.

Spread over the top four cards and, as you square them, get a left little-finger break beneath the fifth card. The right hand lifts off the five cards above the break; flash the JS on the face of the packet and set the packet face down in front of you on the table.

Table the rest of the deck face down above the "jack" pile and cut it from left to right into four tabled piles. There will be two jacks on top of the right-hand pile (Figure 1). Patter about each pile being a floor in a building and about how four burglars each started out on a different floor.

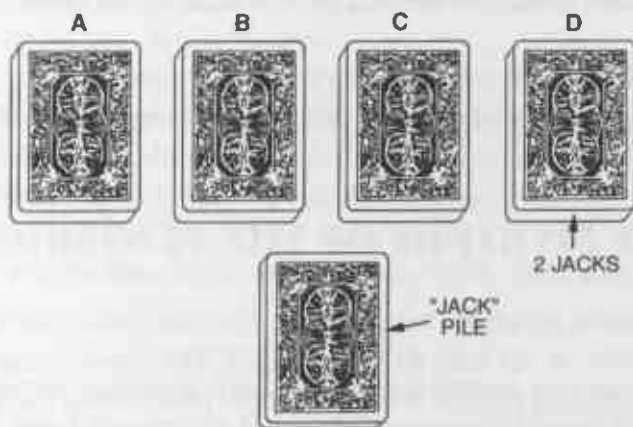


Fig. 1

Pick up the "jack" pile and perform the Diminishing Count as follows: Hold the packet face down in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off three cards one by one into the left hand. The right hand shows the face of its double card, the JS. Drop the double on top of the packet, then lift off the top card and drop it face down onto pile A.

Again take the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb now peels off two cards one by one into the left hand; the right hand shows the JD at the face of the double, drops the double onto the left-hand cards, then lifts off the top card and drops it face down onto pile B.

Take the remaining three cards in right-hand Biddle grip. Using the left thumb, peel off one card into the left hand, show the JS at the face of the double, drop the double on top of the left-hand cards, then lift off the top card and drop it face down onto pile C.

Finally, the right hand shows the JD as the face card of the double, then places the double face down on top of pile D. All four jacks are now on top of pile D.

Gather the piles one onto the next from right to left, overlapping them. Slowly square the deck. According to your story, the burglars heard an alarm and decided to escape. All went to the rooftop and escaped. Riffle the deck, then deal the four jacks from the top of the deck face up on the table.

TOM HUBBARD'S "KINGS AND COMMONERS"

The following is Tom Hubbard's presentation and handling of my "Trost on Reset," which appeared in my book *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997). Tom has added a nice storyline, several "convincers" in handling and a second, elevator-type phase.

Effect: Four kings and four commoners (deuces) are shown. "*The commoners were always playing games,*" the performer says, "*disguising themselves as kings.*" He shows the deuces have changed to kings. With the game over, they reverted to commoners. (The kings change back to deuces.) Each king now "inspects" the group of commoners, by moving from bottom to top, or top to bottom of the deuce packet. All's well that ends well, and each group ends up in its proper station.

Method: Remove the kings and deuces and arrange them in this order from left to right in a face-up fan: 2C, 2S, 2H, 2D, KD, KC, KH, KS. (In actual performance, the cards do not have to be in this exact suit order; just make sure the deuces are in pairs of color and the kings are in alternating color order.) Discard the rest of the deck.

Show the eight cards in a face-up fan. As you close the fan, get a left little-finger break beneath the four kings and first deuce, the 2D in this case. "*These are the kings . . .*" you say. The right hand lifts off the five cards above the break and tables them face up. "*And the deuces are the commoners,*" you say as you Elmsley Count the three deuces as four. Place the deuces face down on the table.

"*The kings were upstairs in the castle and the commoners downstairs.*" As you say this, pick up the "king" packet and place it face down on the deuces. Pause, then say, "*The story will begin.*"

Act I: Pick up the packet and hold it face down in the left hand. The right hand lifts off the top two cards as one in Biddle grip; then place the next three cards in an overlapping spread beneath the double (Figure 1). Turn the right hand palm up to display the four kings. As you lay them back onto the left-hand cards, get a left little-finger break below the top three cards. Square the cards and lift off the top three, supposedly all four kings. Flash the king on the face of the right-hand packet (KC) and place the cards face down on the table.

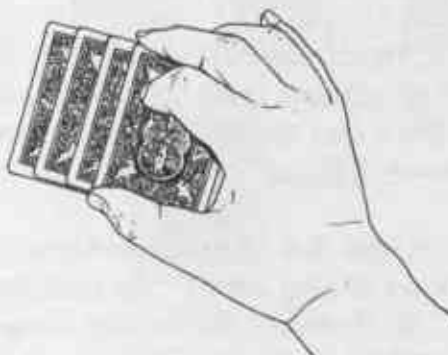


Fig. 1

Now focus on the commoners and patter that they are having fun together. Turn the packet face up and perform a Jordan Count. (See Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work.) *"They were running around playing games,"* you say. Elmsley Count to show the deuces again.

Turn the packet face down. *"This commoner is announcing a game—which is to disguise themselves as kings,"* you say. Move the top card to the bottom without showing its face. Now show the in-hand packet as four kings using the Diminishing Count: Hold the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off the top three cards one by one into the left hand; turn the right hand palm up to display the KH (double card). Drop the double face down onto the left-hand cards, then deal the top card face down on the table.

Take the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. Peel off the top two cards singly into the left hand and show the face of the double card in the right, the KS. Drop the double onto the left-hand cards and thumb off the top card onto the first tabled card.

Take the packet in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off one card face down into the left hand. The double card is placed onto the single card in the left hand, overlapping it to the right; the spread is lifted, the KH and KS are flashed, then these three cards are squared and dropped face down on top of the two tabled cards.

"When the game is over, they are back the way they were—the commoners." Turn the packet face up and Elmsley Count to show the deuces. *"They returned to the castle,"* you say as you table the packet face down. Pick the "king" packet, flash the KC on the face and drop this packet face down on top of the deuces. *"They are back together,"* you say.

Act II: Pick up the packet. The right hand lifts off the top two cards as one, then places the next three cards in an overlapping spread beneath the double as you did earlier (Figure 1). Turn the right hand palm up to show the four kings. The left hand places the "commoner" packet (three cards) face down on the table.

Turn the kings face down and square them. Deal the top three cards face down into an overlapping row from left to right on the table. *"The fourth king became suspicious and went back to the castle to check out the commoners,"* you say as the right hand flashes the face of the double card (the KS, in this case) and drops it face down onto the "commoner" packet.

Pick up the "commoner" packet and openly move the top card to the bottom. Riffle the packet for effect, then show the king has apparently returned to the top. Deal the king face up on the table.

"The other three kings checked out the commoners as well," you say. Pick up the card at the right end of the three-card row on the table and, without showing its face, place it on top of the packet. Riffle down, then, with the left fingers, slide out the *bottom* card of the packet and deal it face up onto the tabled king.

Place the next king face down on the bottom of the "commoner" packet, which is then riffled. Deal the top king face up onto the two tabled kings.

Reverse count the "commoner" packet of four cards, then pick up the last "king" (actually a deuce) and slide it face down into the center of the

packet. Riffle up and show the king on top. Deal it face up onto the three tabled kings.

"Satisfied that all is well—everything is back to normal, the kings upstairs and the commoners downstairs." Show the four deuces to end.

A TRIPLE TRANSPOSITION

The inspiration for the following came from J. K. Hartman's effect "Triple Cross," which appeared in his book *Trickery Treats* (1999).

Effect: The performer deals four of a kind, say queens, into a face-down pile to his left on the table. Four sevens are dealt into a face-down pile to the right of the queens. The top card of each pile is turned up as an indicator. The indicators are switched, and the queens have followed their indicator. A spectator selects four random cards, which are tabled between the two tabled piles. The top card is turned up. It could be an ace. The ace is switched with the indicator seven, then both values end up with their indicators—a triple transposition.

Method: Secretly get four aces on top of the deck. Ask a spectator to name any four of a kind but steer him away from naming the aces. Assume he names the sevens. Run through the deck, upjog the four sevens and table them face down. Now ask the spectator to name another four of a kind—jacks, queens or kings. Say that queens are named. Upjog the four queens, strip them out and drop them face down on top of the tabled cards. (If jacks, queens or kings are named as the first selection, have any four of a kind in spot cards named secondly to arrive at two contrasting values.)

Turn the rest of the deck face down and, in squaring it, get a left little-finger break under the top three cards. The right hand scoops up the eight-card pile and drops it face up on top of the deck.

Now show each of the eight cards as the Braue Addition is performed: The right hand lifts off all the cards above the break (11 cards) in Biddle grip. The left thumb draws off each face-up card in turn to the left as the right-hand packet is used to lever it face down on top. (This is standard Braue Addition procedure.) As the seventh face-up card is turned face down,

drop the right-hand cards on top, then flip the last face-up card face down on top.

Spread off the top four cards into the right hand, without reversing their order, and drop them face down in a pile on the table. Turn the top card of the pile (a queen in this example) face up as an indicator and deal it above the pile. Now deal off four more cards, reversing their order, into a pile about six inches to the right of the "queen" pile. Turn up the top card of the pile (a seven) as an indicator and deal it above the pile (Figure 1). Set the balance of the deck aside.

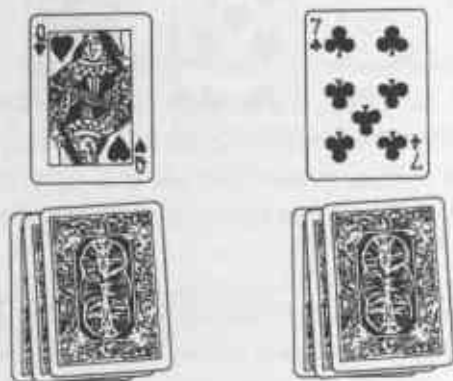


Fig. 1

Switch the face-up indicators, then turn up the cards below the right-hand indicator to show the four queens in this case.

Say that you will need four more cards. Pick up the rest of the deck and hold it face down in the left hand. Perform the first part of the Cut-Deeper Force to show the spectator what he is to do; cut off less than half the deck and turn it face up on top. Now have the spectator cut deeper, into the face-down cards, turn over the cards cut off and drop them back on top. Spread off the face-up cards and put them face down under the deck proper. Deal off the top four cards, reversing their order, face down on the table between the two tabled piles. Turn the top card of this new pile (an ace) face up and deal it face up above the pile.

Switch the face-up ace with the face-up seven in this case, then show the rest of the sevens and aces have transposed to follow their indicator cards (Figure 2).



Fig. 2

MORE ELABORATE VERSION

Get the four sevens to the top of the deck. Upjog the 12 court cards. Strip them out and place them face down at the back of the deck. Turn the deck face down. The courts are now face up on top. Arrange these so that the four jacks are face up on top, the queens below the jacks and the kings below the queens. Spread over the courts and the next three face-down cards. As you square the cards, get a left little-finger break below the three face-down cards. The right hand lifts off all the cards above the break. Lay the balance of the deck aside.

Spread off the four jacks, display them and place them face down under the packet. Repeat with the queens, then with the kings. Drop the packet face down on top of the deck proper. From top down, the order is: 7, 7, 7, J, J, J, J, Q, Q, Q, Q, K, K, K, K, 7, rest of the deck.

Reverse deal three piles of four cards each face down on the table, working from left to right. Turn up the top card of each pile to act as indicators. Ask a spectator to switch any two indicators, then you switch two so that the face-up cards read K, J, Q, from left to right. Show that the jacks and queens have transposed.

State you will do something different with the kings. Perform the Cut-Deeper Force as described above. Reverse deal the top four cards into a

pile beside the "king" pile and turn up the top card (a seven). Transpose the seven with the face-up king, then show that both of these piles have transposed.

THE OUT OF PLACE ACES

The following was inspired by Milt Kort's "That Darned Ace" in his book *Kort* (1999), written by Stephen Minch.

Effect: The four aces are shown and a spectator names one, then all four aces are buried in the center of the deck. A packet of four is now counted, and a king appears face up. The count is repeated twice, and a second and a third king appear face up. The last face-down card is dramatically snapped face up, and it is the spectator's selected ace.

Method: The setup from top down is: X, face-up KC, face-up KH, face-up KS, rest of the deck, face down.

To begin, cull the four aces to the face of the deck. Spread over the aces into the right hand to display them. Have a spectator name any ace. Whatever ace is named, maneuver it to the second position from the face as all four are replaced onto the face of the deck.

The deck is now held face up in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off the four aces one at a time into the left hand. As you do, get a left little-finger break beneath the named ace and, as the next ace is peeled off, Biddle the chosen ace to the bottom of the deck proper.

Set the deck proper face up on the table and lift off half the cards with the right hand. The left hand places the supposed four aces face up onto the tabled half, then the right-hand cards are dropped on top burying the aces.

Pick up the deck and hold it face down in the left hand. From top down the cards read: selected ace, X, face-up KC, face-up KH, face-up KS, the rest of the deck, face down.

The right hand lifts off the top five cards at the natural break where the cards are back to back. If need be, riffle up at the inner end of the deck near

the top until you see the back of the first face-up card, then lift off the top five cards. Discard the rest of the deck.

Elmsley Count the five cards as four to reveal the face-up KS. Count again to show two face-up kings. The last (face-down) card goes to the bottom. "*Two kings*," you say. Elmsley Count again to show three kings face up. (The KH is seen twice.) Immediately drag the bottom card (the KC) to the left with the left fingers and place it on the face of the packet.

Spread the packet from the left hand to right, holding the last two cards as one. Three kings and a face-down card show. The right hand removes the face-down card and snaps it face up, revealing the selected ace to finish. Drop the ace face up on the table.

Square the king packet and drop it face up on top of the deck. The hidden face-down card coalesces with the rest of the deck and you are clean.

THE SLIPPERY ACES

Effect: The four face-up aces are sandwiched between the two face-down red jacks. The sandwich is dropped on top of the deck, then the top two cards are immediately turned face up. They are the two red jacks, but the four aces have vanished! The red jacks are tossed aside, then the deck is ribbon spread face down on the table to reveal the two black jacks face up with four face-down cards between them. These face-down cards are the missing four aces.

Method: My inspiration came from Milt Kort's "Security Express" in his book *Kort* (1999), written by Stephen Minch.

From top down, the setup is: X, face-up black jack, red jack, red jack, black jack, rest of the deck.

Begin with the deck face up. Remove the four aces and table them face up. Turn the deck face down and double cut the top two cards to the bottom. (A black jack is now face up on the bottom.)

Spread over the top two cards (red jacks) and flip them over face up onto the top of the deck. As you do, get a left little-finger break beneath the third (face-down) card, the other black jack.

The right hand lifts off the top three cards in Biddle grip, and now you perform a "mini" Braue Addition: The left thumb pulls the top red jack to the left. It is levered face down onto the top of the deck with the double in the right hand. The double is immediately dropped on top, then the top red jack is turned face down.

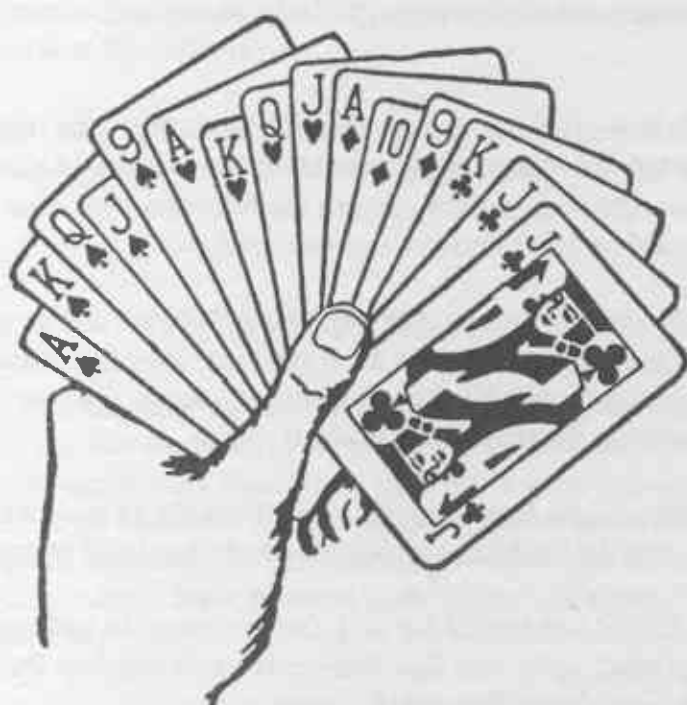
Deal the top card (red jack) face down on the table, then the next card (black jack) face down to the right of it. Supposedly both of these cards are red jacks.

The left thumb pushes the top card of the deck proper slightly to the right; get a left little-finger break beneath it. Now the right hand picks up the four aces, drops them face up onto the left-hand jack, then places the right-hand card on top, forming a four-ace sandwich.

The right hand now picks up the six-card sandwich and drops it on top of the deck; immediately flip over the seven cards above the break and push over the top two cards with the left thumb to expose the two face-up red jacks. Supposedly the aces have vanished!

Toss the red jacks face up on the table. Casually swing cut the top half of the deck into the left hand and place the right-hand half on top.

Pause, then ribbon spread the deck face down on the table to reveal the two face-up black jacks with four face-down cards between them. Turn up the four cards, revealing they are the four aces.



A Pinochle Hand

From Charles H. Goren's *Goren's Hoyle*, 1950

20

Pinochle Puzzlers

"Generally speaking, Pinochle is perhaps more interesting to more people than is any other single card game."

—John Scarne, *Scarne on Cards*, 1949

The tricks in this chapter use a Pinochle deck—a special deck made up of 48 cards in four suits, ace through nine, with two of each card. Pinochle decks are readily available in popular back designs and are as fully accepted for card table use as the ordinary bridge deck.

Since the deck contains duplicates, these are taken advantage of in several of the tricks that use the Gilbreath principle.

The tricks described here begin with four effects using the double sets of kings and queens, then you will find three Pinochle deals and a poker deal, all using a Pinochle deck. Finally, a Pinochle deck is used in a puzzling divination effect.

TRIPLE WEDDING CEREMONY

Effect: Eight kings and eight queens are thoroughly shuffled. The performer then deals a face-down row of seven cards. A spectator marks

any three cards in the row with poker chips. Now a card is dealt onto each of the seven cards, forming seven pairs. All of the unmarked pairs are shown to consist of random cards. The three marked pairs are turned up to show three royal marriages.

Method: Lay out the eight royal marriages from a Pinochle deck face up on the table. Each marriage consists of a king and queen of the same suit. Stack the marriages from top down in C-H-S-D-C-H-S-D order. Now give the packet one reverse faro shuffle. You are set. The rest of the deck is not used.

Begin by showing the packet to be a mixture of kings and queens. The suits rotate so the packet can be Charlier shuffled and cut any number of times.

Deal a right-to-left row of seven cards face down on the table. Have a spectator place a marker (a poker chip or coin) above any three of the cards in the row.

Hold the remaining cards face down in the left hand in position for the glide. Deal a card face down from the bottom of the packet onto each card in the row. Deal from left to right along the row. Glide on any marked card. You will have two cards remaining in your hand. Drop this pair face down at the right end of the row.

Turn over all pairs not marked to show mixed marriages or pairs of kings and pairs of queens, then turn over the three marked pairs to show that each is a royal marriage.

PINOCHLE MARRIAGES ROUTINE I

Effect: Eight kings and eight queens are shuffled together. The performer removes a queen and a king, then ribbon spreads the rest of the packet face down on the table. A spectator inserts the queen and king face up into the spread at any two points. The packet is picked up and dealt in pairs. The pairs with the face-up cards are shown to be "odd" couples, just as predicted by the performer.

The procedure is repeated, but this time the performer claims that "regular" couples will show up. Each couple this time consists of a king and queen.

The packet is cut in half, each half ribbon spread on the table, then the spreads are pushed together, definitely interlacing the cards. Each pair is shown; some are "odd" couples, some "regular." Cupid, the JH, is passed through the packet, then the pairs are turned up and all the couples are "regular."

Method: This routine is based on Karl Fulves' "The Omega Bet" from his book *More Self-Working Card Tricks* (1984). (Fulves' trick first appeared as "Odds on Favorite" in *The Pallbearer's Review*, July 1969.)

To set up, remove the eight kings and eight queens from a Pinochle deck and alternate them in one packet. Place a JH face down on the table to one side. Discard the rest of the deck.

Phase One—Odd Couples: Hold the king-queen packet face down in the left hand. With the right hand, lift off cards in groups of two or three and show that you hold kings and queens. (You don't want to disclose that the kings and queens are alternated.) Give the cards a Charlier shuffle.

Spread the packet face down in the hands and have a spectator touch the back of any card. Outjog the card touched and the card below it. The right hand lifts off this outjogged pair, along with the cards above it, and sets the pair face down on the table (Figure 1). The rest of the right-hand cards are placed *below* those in the left hand. The packet has been unobtrusively cut at that point.



Fig. 1

Ribbon spread the packet proper face down from left to right on the table. Pick up the top card of the tabled pair, turn it face up and ask a spectator to insert it face up into the upper part of the spread. Then hand him the other card of the pair so he can insert it face up into the lower part of the spread (Figure 2).

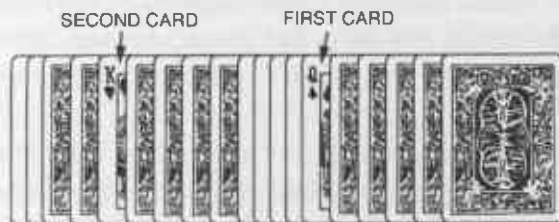


Fig. 2

Gather the spread and hold it face down in the left hand. Spread off the top two cards into the right hand without reversing their order. Deal them face down on the table at position A, as shown in Figure 3. Continue dealing pairs at position A until you come to the pair with a face-up card. Deal this pair above the cards at A to position B.

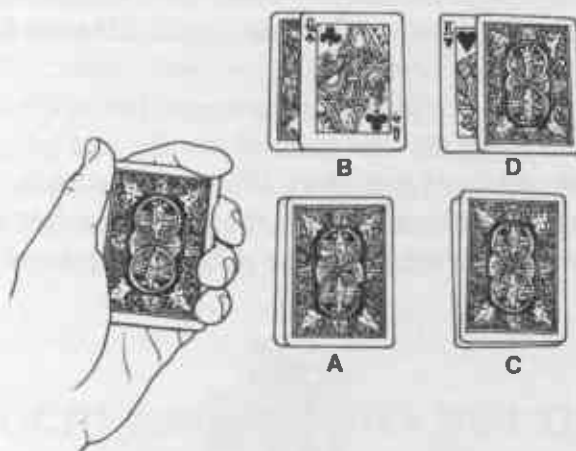


Fig. 3

Now start a new pile of pairs at position C, which is to the *right* of the pile at A. When you reach the pair with the face-up card, deal it above the cards at C to position D. You will have a few cards remaining in the left hand. (See Figure 3.) *"I suspect you may have formed two odd couples,"* you say. Turn up the face-down card of each pair to show two "odd" couples. One pair will be two kings, the other two queens.

To reassemble so that the kings and queens alternate, the right hand uses the top card of C to scoop up pile C, which is then dropped onto pile A. The left-hand cards are dropped on top of the tabled cards and all picked up. (Actually, once you scoop up pile C, the packets C, A and the cards in the left hand can be stacked in any order.)

The right hand now picks up a card from D and places it face up onto a card at B. This pair is dropped face down onto the stack. The stack is in alternate queen-king order and there is still a queen and king face up on the table.

Phase Two—Regular Couples: Overhand shuffle the packet by running any odd number of cards (three, five or seven), then throw the rest of the cards on top. Repeat the shuffle any number of times. The kings and queens remain alternated.

Glimpse the bottom card of the packet, then ribbon spread the cards face down from left to right on the table as before. If the glimpsed card was a queen, have the face-up queen inserted first, face up into the upper part of the spread; if it was a king, have the face-up king inserted first, face up into the upper part of the spread. Now have the remaining king (or queen) inserted face up into the lower part of the spread.

Gather the spread and deal the pairs as in Phase One, but this time two "regular" couples are shown—a king and queen in each pair. Assemble the left-hand cards and piles A and C as in Phase One, then drop the K-Q at B and the K-Q at D face down on top.

If you began this phase with a queen on the bottom of the packet, then arrange these last two pairs with a queen on the face of each before dropping them on top; if you started the phase with a king on the face, then make sure the king is in the face of each of the two pairs before dropping them on top. The kings and queens now alternate throughout the packet once again.

Phase Three—Cupid Takes Over: Charlier shuffle the packet. Reverse count the top eight cards into the right hand. Each hand then ribbon spreads its cards face down on the table next to each other as shown in Figure 4. Now push the two spreads together so that the cards interweave. (This is

the Curry "spread shuffle," and it is another way of working the Gilbreath principle.)

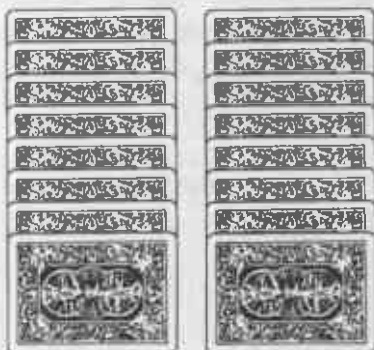


Fig. 4

Square the packet and hold it with the faces toward you in the left hand. Spread over the card at the face slightly. If the two cards at the face are Q-Q or K-K, proceed. If the pair at the face is a king and queen, double cut the face card to the top (rear) of the packet. Spread off the two cards at the face of the packet into the right hand. Show the face of the pair and deal it face down onto the table. Repeat by showing each of the other pairs and dealing them face down one on another into a tabled pile. You will show a K-Q, Q-K, K-K or Q-Q as you point out there are odd couples and regular couples.

Pick up the tabled pile and fan the cards face down in the left hand. Explain that the JH is Cupid. The right hand picks up the JH and inserts it face down into the fan so it is *eighth* from the top. Leave the JH outjogged. Use the Simon Aronson Mark-a-Place Move (see Appendix, *Volume 1* of this work) as you turn the JH face up; the packet has been cut secretly.

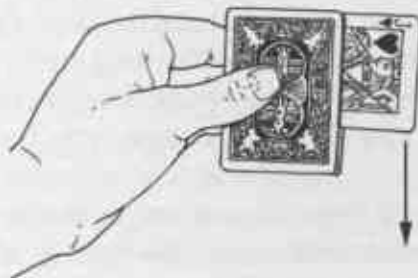


Fig. 5

The JH is still outjogged. As you hold the packet in the left hand, the right fingers and thumb grasp the JH and pull it to a horizontal position as shown in Figure 5; the JH pivots on the side of the left second finger. The right hand now slowly slides the JH toward you and out of the inner end of the packet.

"Cupid causes the kings and queens to form marriages," you say. Lay the JH aside, face up, then turn the packet face up and deal the pairs of K-Q (or Q-K) from the face of the packet, laying them face up on the table into two rows of four.

PINOCHLE MARRIAGES ROUTINE II

Effect: A packet of kings and queens is shuffled. Each pair is shown to be a mismatched marriage (a king and queen of different suits). The JH (Cupid) is passed through the packet, changing it to eight royal marriages.

Now the kings and queens are openly dealt face down into two separate piles. One pile is dropped onto the other, then the JH is passed through the packet again. Again, all are royal marriages.

Next, the kings and queens are mixed together again, then dealt into a pile with a spectator calling "switch" during the deal. In each instance, the cards are switched to further mix the packet. The pairs are shown mixed. More cards are switched, then all the cards are shown to be royal marriages.

In an additional phase, the cards are mixed, and each pair is shown to be mismatched and deliberately laid on the table still overlapped. The pairs are not squared, but simply riffled. Surprisingly, each is now a royal marriage.

Method: The eight kings and queens from a Pinochle deck are set up from top down: KC, QC, KH, QH, KS, QS, KD, QD, then repeat this sequence with the other eight cards. Switch a king and queen of, say, two pairs so they read Q-K instead of K-Q. The JH is lying face down to one side.

Phase One: Hold the packet face down. Give it a Charlier shuffle, then hold it in the left hand with the face of the packet toward you. Push over the face card with the left thumb. If the suits of the two cards at the face are

different, proceed; if not, get a left little-finger break beneath the card at the face and double cut it to the top (rear) of the packet. Now the two cards at the face have different suits.

With the face of the packet toward you, thumb over the two cards at the face into the right hand. Show the pair is mismatched—K-Q of different suits, K-K or Q-Q—then deal the pair face down on the table. Repeat by showing each pair to be mismatched. All the pairs are dealt face down into a tabled pile.

Pick up the packet and fan it face down in the left hand. The right hand picks up the JH (Cupid) and inserts it face down and outjogged *eighth* from the top of the packet. Now turn the JH face up as you call attention to Cupid. As this is done, perform the Aronson Mark-a-Place Move. This cuts the packet imperceptibly. The JH is still outjogged but is now face up. Hold the packet square in the left hand with the JH outjogged. The right fingers and thumb grasp the JH and pull it to a horizontal position; it pivots on the side of the left second finger. The right hand now slowly slides the JH toward you and out of the inner end of the packet. Lay the JH aside, face up. Now turn the packet face up and deal the K-Q (or Q-K) pairs face up into two left-to-right rows. The suits of each pair will match. This is a very strong effect!

Phase Two: Assemble the pairs so the colors alternate two black suits, two reds, two blacks, two reds. Then apparently split the pairs as follows: Hold the packet face down in the left hand in position for the glide. Deal two piles alternately left and right face down on the table. Silently count as you deal. Glide on the count of 2 and 6 as you deal the first eight cards; continue to deal, starting the count at 1 again, and again glide on 2 and 6. Drop one pile face down onto the other.

Pick up the JH and simply run it face up horizontally through the packet for effect. Turn the packet face up and deal out the pairs face up on the table, showing again that all are royal marriages.

Phase Three: Gather all pairs so the red and black pairs alternate. Turn the packet face down. Charlier shuffle twice and have the cards cut.

Explain the "Swindle Switch" procedure by dealing the cards into a tabled pile, "switching" two (or three) cards at random. Repeat by having a spectator call the "switches" as you deal.

Pick up the packet and hold it with the faces to you. Check to see if the bottom two cards are different suits. If they are, proceed. If they are the same suit, double cut one card from face to the top (rear) of the packet. Spread off the pair at the face of the packet into the right hand. Show it to be a mismatched pair and deal it face down on the table. Repeat by showing each of the other pairs to be mismatched and deal them face down one on another into a tabled pile. Use the top card to scoop up the pile. Riffle the cards for effect, then turn the pile face up and deal the cards in face-up pairs around the table to show all are now royal marriages.

Additional Phase: This phase uses Tom Hubbard's clever handling:

Gather the royal marriages so the colors alternate. To complete the setup, you now reverse count the cards from the left hand to the right, not singly, but in groups of 3-2-2-2-2-3. This is done under the guise of mixing the cards. Here is the procedure: Hold the cards fanned with the faces toward you in the left hand. With the right thumb and fingers, draw off the first three cards as a unit from the face of the packet into the right hand; next, draw off two cards as a unit onto the face of the first three cards; draw off two more, two more, and so on, until you have three cards remaining in the left hand; draw off these last three cards as a unit onto the face of the others. (Note: The above procedure can also be performed with the cards face down; it makes no difference.)

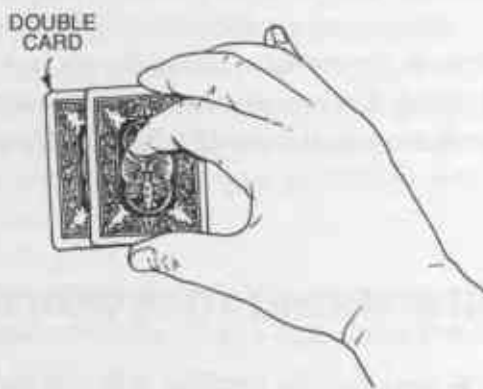


Fig. 1

Hold the packet face down in the left hand and obtain a left little-finger break under the top three cards. Push the top card to the right with the left thumb; with the right hand, lift off the top three cards as two in Biddle grip (Figure 1). Show the face of the pair(?). It may be a king and a queen but not of the same suit or color, or it may be two queens or two kings. A royal marriage will *not* show. Place the pair(?) face down on the table, unsquared. Now lift off the next two cards in overlapped condition. Show the mismatched pair and place it face down directly on top of the tabled cards. Repeat with four more pairs, placing each face down onto the pile. Push the top card of the last three cards to the right, grip these three cards as two (as in Figure 1), show the face of this pair(?) and place it face down on top of the pile.

The right hand picks up the pile in Biddle grip. The left hand approaches and grips the packet as shown in Figure 2. As it does, the left fingers, with a light touch, secretly slide the bottom card to the right. This action is hidden by the packet. Riffle the ends of the packet with the right fingers, then set the packet, still unsquared, face down on the table.

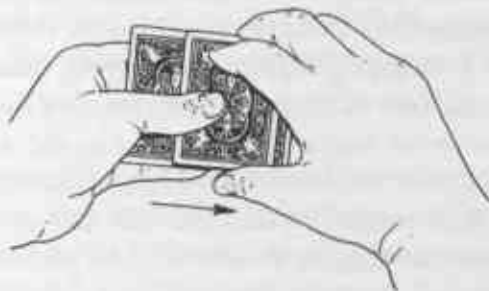


Fig. 2

Using the right thumb, lift the inner end of the top two cards and deal this pair face up on the table. It will be a royal marriage! Continue by dealing off the other seven pairs face up to show each is a royal marriage.

PINOCHLE MARRIAGES ROUTINE III

Effect: A Pinochle deck is riffle shuffled, then the eight kings and eight queens are removed. These are mixed and seven cards are dealt into a face-down tabled row. A spectator pulls any card toward himself, then a card is

dealt onto each of the seven cards, forming seven pairs. The six pairs not selected are shown to be mixed. The selected pair is the only royal marriage. The random pairs are gathered, shuffled and one pair selected. The pairs not selected are shown to be mixed. Again the selected pair is the only royal marriage.

The mixed pairs are gathered, then single cards are dealt into a pile, and the spectator calls for switches several times; the performer switches two cards each time. Despite this mixing, all of the pairs are now royal marriages.

In the final phase, the packet is thoroughly mixed, then dealt into two piles. The spectator eliminates either pile. The remaining pile is dealt into two piles, and the spectator eliminates one of these. The remaining cards are dealt into two piles, and the spectator eliminates one pile so two cards remain. The discards are shown to be mixed, while the remaining pair is the only royal marriage.

Method: To set up, remove the eight kings and queens from a Pinochle deck. Arrange them in marriages from top down: C, H, S, D, C, H, S, D. Make sure that some marriages read K-Q and others Q-K. Give the packet a reverse faro shuffle. Place this group on the bottom (face) of the Pinochle deck proper.

Begin with the deck face down in the left hand. With the right hand, lift and show the faces of the cards in bunches. In this way, the setup of kings and queens will not be obvious. Set the deck face down on the table and cut off less than half so you do not cut into the king-queen setup. Riffle shuffle the halves together, then give the deck a complete cut.

Explain that you will use just the kings and queens. Fan the cards with the faces to you and upjog the kings and queens as you come to them. Silently count them to make sure you get all 16, then strip them out and discard the rest of the deck.

Phase One: Show that you have kings and queens, then turn the packet face down and Charlier shuffle. Deal a face-down row of seven cards from right to left on the table.

Have a spectator select any card in the row by pulling that card toward himself halfway out of the row. This done, hold the rest of the cards face down in the left hand in position for a glide. Deal cards from the bottom of the packet, from left to right, dealing one card onto each card in the row. When you get to the selected card, glide and deal the next bottom card onto the selection. Continue to deal, dealing the glided card and any other cards needed to complete the row of pairs. You will be left with two cards in the left hand.

Turn the left hand palm up and take the face card of the two into the right hand. Display the two cards as not being a royal marriage. Place the right hand's card under the left hand's card, thus switching the positions of these two cards. Lay this pair, fanned, face up at the right end of the row. Now turn up the six pairs not selected and show they also are not royal marriages. Finally, turn over the selected pair, showing it is the only royal marriage.

Leave the selected pair on the table and stack the other pairs face up one onto the next, starting at the right end of the row and working to the left. With the packet face up, double cut the face card to the top (rear). All of the pairs are now royal marriages ready for Phase Two.

Phase Two: Turn the packet face down and give it a False Charlier shuffle, retaining its order. The packet remains in royal marriages.

Explain that you will deal the cards in pairs, and the spectator is to nominate a pair before it is dealt to the table. Slowly deal the pairs face down into a tabled pile. Lay the selected pair aside face down and deal the rest of the pairs one by one onto the dealt pile.

Pick up the pile and get a left little-finger break beneath the top three cards. Push over the top card about an inch to the right with the left thumb. The right hand lifts off the top three cards as two in Biddle grip. Show the faces of the two cards are not a royal marriage. Place these cards face down on the bottom of the packet. The rest of the pairs are dealt into a face-up pile on the table to show that none are royal marriages.

Turn the selected pair face up to show it is a royal marriage, then lay it aside face up. Pick up the packet and double cut the face card to the top (rear). The pairs are now royal marriages.

Phase Three: Turn the packet face down and run through the Curry Swindle Switch procedure with the spectator calling the switches. Turn the pile face up and deal the cards in royal-marriage pairs, scattered face up on the table.

Phase Four: Stack all eight royal-marriages face up one onto the other so the colors are mixed.

Turn the pile face down and reverse faro shuffle, then give the cards a Charlier shuffle and a cut.

Still holding the packet face down, deal the cards into two face-up piles with eight cards in each. Deal alternately left then right as you would in a two-handed card game. Have the spectator indicate which pile to eliminate. Pick up the selected pile, turn it face down and drop it aside.

Pick up the remaining pile of eight, turn it face down and Charlier shuffle and cut. Deal these cards alternately into two face-down piles. The spectator tells you which pile to eliminate. Pick it up and drop it face down onto the cards already eliminated.

You are left with four cards. Again Charlier shuffle and cut, then alternately deal them into two piles of two cards each. The spectator eliminates one pile which is dropped onto the discards. Pick up the discards and fan them face up to show a mixture.

Dramatically turn over the remaining pair to show it is the only royal marriage.

Note: The credits for the various phases of this routine in order of appearance are:

- 1) A variation of Bob Mason's marketed item "Brain Buster" (1974), which in turn is based on Stewart James' "Figgarow," which first appeared in *The Linking Ring*, August 1969, and later in *Stewart James in Print: The First Fifty Years* (1989).
- 2) Inspired by Peter Duffie's "Eleven Plus" from his book *Card Compulsions* (1985).

- 3) Paul Curry's "Swindle Switch" incorporated in his trick "A Swindle of Sorts" in his book *Paul Curry Presents* (1974) and later in *Paul Curry's Worlds Beyond* (2001).
- 4) Peter Duffie's concept originally described in his trick called "The Ninth Card" in *Abracadabra*, No. 2590, September 16, 1995, and later in a trick titled "All the Fives" in his book *Effortless Card Magic* (1997).

PINOCHLE PENTAQUIN

This effect was inspired by Peter Kane's "Mister-ee Five by Five," which appeared in his book *Kane* (1982). Peter's trick and mine are based closely on Howard Adams' classic effect "Cidentaquin" with ESP cards that was first published in *Genii*, August 1970.

Effect: The performer removes 25 cards from a Pinochle deck. He thoroughly shuffles them and has a spectator remove one card at random. The rest of the cards are divided in half and cards from each half are turned face up in unison. Two cards of the same value appear—then two more cards of the same value as the first two appear on the face of the dealt piles. The unknown selection is also the same value—a five-way match!

Method: Set up 25 cards from a Pinochle deck from top down: 10, J, Q, K, A, repeated five times. Discard the rest of the deck.

Ribbon spread the 25 cards face up on the table to display them. Gather the spread, turn it face down and mix the cards with one or two reverse faro shuffles. False shuffle them further, using the Charlier shuffle. Give them one or two straight cuts.

Ribbon spread the cards face down on the table, have a spectator select any card and lay it aside face down, without looking at it. As you gather the spread, cut the deck at the point where the card was removed.

Now reverse deal 12 cards face down into a tabled pile and set the other 12 cards face down next to the dealt pile. Using both hands, deal a card

from each pile face up in unison above the face-down piles. The third pair dealt will be matching values. Leave the pair on the face of the dealt piles and start to deal two new piles in unison face up below the first two piles. When five more pairs have been dealt, two more cards of the same value as the first two will appear.

Finally, turn the unknown selected card face up to reveal a five-of-a-kind coincidence. Figure 1 shows the layout.

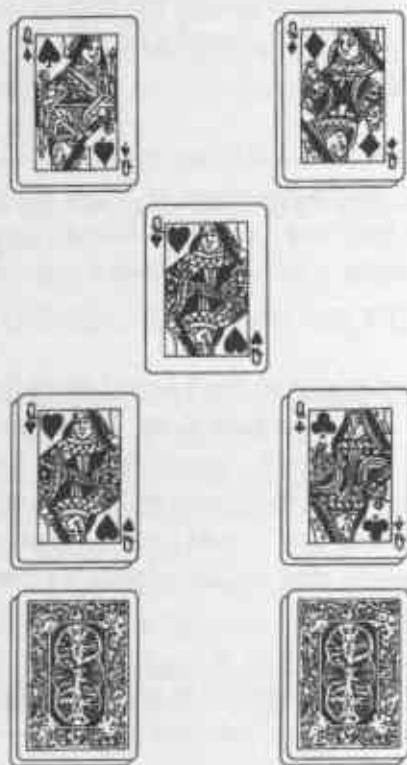


Fig. 1

PINOCHLE DEAL

Effect: This is a very strong Pinochle demonstration. In effect, the performer shuffles a Pinochle deck, then divides it into three parts so three spectators can each shuffle a third. The deck is assembled, then the performer deals four hands of Partnership Auction Pinochle. The hands are

just average. The hands are gathered, and the deck is mixed once more. Another four hands of Pinochle are dealt, and the performer holds a double flush in diamonds and double pinochle, all worth about 1,800 points. This is a fabulous hand, putting him well over the game of 1,000.

Method: To set up, remove the following 12 cards from a Pinochle deck: 10D, 10D, JD, JD, QD, QD, KD, KD, AD, AD, QS, QS. Mix them and place them on the face of the deck.

Begin with a false shuffle, retaining the bottom 12 cards. The Bottom Stock Control, explained in the Appendix of *Volume 1* of this work, works well.

With the face of the deck toward you, spread off the 12-card setup at the face into the right hand. Hand this group to a spectator for shuffling. Divide the rest of the deck in half and hand a portion to two more spectators for shuffling. Say, *"If I shuffle, you would think I was cheating, so you three shuffle."*

Assemble the three portions so the 12-card setup is on the bottom. False cut if you want. Now deal four hands for Partnership Auction Pinochle, dealing three cards at a time. The fourth hand is dealt to yourself. Each hand receives 12 cards. Show the hands to be ordinary, devoid of a lot of melds. *"This is about what you would expect,"* you say as you point out any melding combinations that might appear by chance—a marriage, a pinochle, and so on.

Gather the hands one onto another in any order, then double cut the top three cards to the bottom. Finally, perform an up-the-ladder false cut.

Deal out four hands once more, dealing by threes. Pick up your hand as you say, *"I would make diamonds trump. And here is about as good a hand as you could hope for."* Lay down: a double flush: 10D, JD, QD, KD, AD, 10D, JD, QD, KD, AD (1,500 points); a double pinochle: QS, JD, QS, JD (300 points)—a total of 1,800 points. This puts you well over the game of 1,000.

GILBREATH PLAYS PINOCHLE

Effect: A Pinochle deck is shown to be well-mixed, then a spectator gives it a riffle shuffle, and the performer gives it a cut. Four hands of Pinochle are dealt, but no player holds much meld. The hands are gathered, the deck is mixed and four more hands are dealt. The performer's hand is very strong, containing about 390 points in melds—a very good start to winning the game of 1,000 points.

Method: This version depends on the Gilbreath principle, which works beautifully with a Pinochle deck because of duplicate cards. This is different (and easier) than “Pinochle Deal,” described in *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997).

Here is how to set up. Using a standard 48-card Pinochle deck, remove the following 12 cards:

10D, JD, QD, KD, AD, AC, AH, AS, KC, KH, KS, QS.

These cards should be mixed. Now remove the same 12 cards and arrange them in *reverse* order of the first 12 cards. Both of these 12-card setups are placed separately face down on the table. Add 12 X cards to the top of each setup. Memorize the face card of one-half deck (say the KH) and drop it face down onto the other half.

To perform, remove the deck from its case and ribbon spread it face up on the table to show the cards mixed. Split the deck in half at the KH so the 12-card setups are again at the face of each half.

Place the halves face down on the table in preparation for a riffle shuffle. Have a spectator riffle shuffle the halves together and square the deck. Pick it up and give it a false cut.

Patter about the game of Pinochle and how cards are melded. Deal in threes for a four-handed game, dealing the fourth hand to yourself. Each hand receives 12 cards. Show the hands are ordinary, containing only a few melding combinations. Gather the hands, placing one on top of another in any order.

False shuffle if you want, then double cut the top three cards to the bottom. Deal four hands again, dealing in threes as before. You can show that hands No. 2 and No. 3 have little or no meld, but do not show hand No. 1; it could contain a lot of meld. Pick up your hand, declaring that you will make diamonds trump.

Lay out your melds as shown in Figure 1. These are the melds you will have: Flush: 10D, JD, QD, KD, AD (150 points); 100 Aces: AD, AC, AH, AS (100 points); 80 kings: KC, KH, KS, KD (80 points); pinochle: JD, QS (40 points); simple marriage: KS, QS (20 points) for a total of 390 points.



Fig. 1

EXCHANGE PINOCHLE

Effect: A Pinochle deck is shuffled, then, as in Partnership Auction Pinochle, the performer deals a round of three cards to all four players, including himself. Now he deals a second round of three so each player now has six cards. He explains that the players will each get a chance to switch his cards for the performer's. The performer asks a spectator who will exchange first. He exchanges with the player named. Another round is dealt, and the spectator decides who he wants to exchange with the performer. This exchange is made. The final round is dealt, and the remaining player exchanges with the performer.

The performer picks up his hand and melds a minimum of 290 points, plus his partner's meld. (The opponents have little or no meld.) The performer and his partner are well on their way to winning the 1,000-point game.

Method: The principle used here was first published by Karl Fulves in an exchange poker deal titled "According to Hoyle" in *The Pallbearer's Review*, November 1968, and later in his book *The Magic Book* (1977). I applied Fulves' principle to Pinochle.

A standard 48-card Pinochle deck is arranged from top down:

AD, JC, QH, 9D, AD, 9D, QS, KH, 9S, 10H, JC, 9H,
KC, AS, 9C, 10D, QC, AC, 9S, QD, JS, 10H, 10C, JH,
9C, AH, 10C, QD, JD, QH, AS, KC, 10S, JS, AH, 10S,
QC, KH, AC, KS, KD, QS, JD, KS, KD, 9H, 10D, JH.

You will also need three poker chips (or coins) for markers.

To begin, give the deck a false riffle shuffle, then give it a false cut so the order is maintained. Ribbon spread the deck face up on the table to show it is mixed. Scoop it up.

As in four-handed Partnership Auction Pinochle, deal in groups of three to each of the four hands, dealing the fourth group of three to yourself. See Figure 1. Now deal a second round of three to each hand. Cards can be flashed if you want. There are now six cards in each hand.

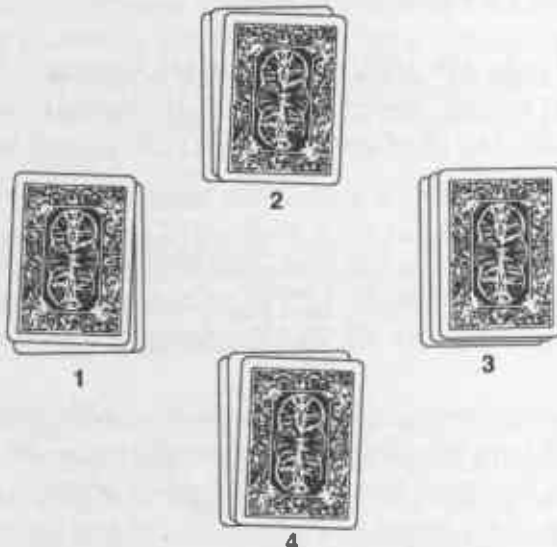


Fig. 1

Explain that each of the other players will have a chance to exchange his cards once for yours. It doesn't matter which player exchanges cards on each round as long as a different player exchanges on each round and as long as each player exchanges only once. Ask a spectator which player should exchange first, player No. 1, 2 or 3. Whoever is named, exchange

your six cards for his. Assume that you exchange with player No. 1. Place a poker chip beside hand No. 1 to indicate it has been exchanged.

Now deal another round of three cards to each hand and let the spectator decide which of the other two hands is exchanged for yours. In this case, he can choose player No. 2 or No. 3. Say that he decides No. 2 exchanges. Switch No. 2's cards for yours. Place a chip beside hand No. 2.

Deal the final round of three cards to each hand. Exchange your cards for the hand that has not yet been switched—in this case, switch with No. 3 and place a chip beside hand No. 3.

Pick up your hand and state that you will make trump, for you will always have the following number of points in meld, depending on which suit you hold and make trump:

Clubs: Flush: AC, 10C, KC, QC, JC (150 points); 100 aces: AS, AH, AC, AD (100 points); simple marriage: KH, QH (20 points); Dix (9 of trump): 9C, 9C (20 points) for a total of 290 points.

Diamonds: Flush: AD, 10D, KD, QD, JD (150 points); 60 queens: QD, QC, QH, QS (60 points); pinochle: JD, QS (40 points); simple marriage: KS, QS (20 points); Dix (9 of trump): 9D, 9D (20 points) for a total of 290 points.

Spades: Flush: AS, 10S, KS, QS, JS (150 points); 80 kings: KC, KH, KS, KD (80 points); pinochle: JD, QS (40 points); simple marriage: KD, QD (20 points); Dix (9 of trump): 9S, 9S (20 points) for a total of 310 points.

Show that your partner (hand No. 2) *could* have additional meld: If *clubs* are trump, he will have two simple marriages and a pinochle or at least two simple marriages; if *spades*, he will have a flush or at least a royal marriage, a simple marriage and a pinochle; if *diamonds*, he will have no meld.

Add the meld that you and your partner have in the trump suit.

Now turn up hands No. 1 and No. 3 to show that your opponents have *no meld* in the trump suit!

This makes an impressive deal, especially to those spectators who play Pinochle.

Notes: If you declare a flush, you may not also declare the royal marriage it contains. The game is played to 1,000 points.

PINOCHLE POKER DEAL

Effect: The performer patters about five players who wanted to play poker but had only a Pinochle deck. A Pinochle deck is riffle shuffled by a spectator. The performer deals five poker hands (without cheating), and the hands are ordinary. The deck is assembled. The performer shuffles it this time and deals five hands. The other four players each get a ten-to-ace straight while the performer wins with four (or five) nines.

Method: Pinochle Poker is a game actually played by gamblers with five of a kind as the highest hand. It is listed in Carl Sifakis' book *The Encyclopedia of Gambling* (1990). Harvey Berg is the only other magician I know of who does a poker routine with a Pinochle deck. His trick, titled "Pinochle Poker," was published in his book *Wanderings* (1997).

To set up, remove the eight nines from a Pinochle deck and lay them aside. Now arrange the rest of the deck in 10-J-Q-K-A order, repeated eight times. Suits are immaterial. Hold the deck face up and reverse deal 20 cards into a face-up pile on the table. Place four nines on the face of each half and place one half onto the other. You are set.

Begin by saying, "*Five players wanted to play poker, but the only deck available was a Pinochle deck.*" Split the deck into two halves so four nines are on the face of each half. This can be done by riffing up at the inner end of the face-down deck until you spot the first nine at center. Have a spectator riffle shuffle the halves together but not square the cards. Pick up the deck and spread it in your hands to show that the cards are fairly interlaced; as you do, get a left little-finger break above the bottom five cards. Square the deck and reverse double undercut the five cards below the break to the top.

Deal five poker hands of five cards each, dealing the fifth hand to yourself. Say, "*You have fairly shuffled the cards, and without cheating,*

the hands will be ordinary.” Pick up two or three hands, show them briefly to be ordinary and drop them onto the rest of the deck. Drop the remaining hands on top in any order.

Give the deck a brief false overhand shuffle, or an up-the-ladder false cut is effective.

Now deal out five hands again. Place the rest of the deck aside. The first four players will each have a ten-to-ace straight. Deal each straight face up on the table in ten-to-ace order. You will win with four or five of a kind—the nines.

Notes: Stud (one card face-down and four face-up) is an effective way to deal the final round of five hands. The hands build, and then you show that each of the first four players has just the right hole card to fill his straight, while you win with the four or five nines.

Each straight could consist of the 9, 10, J, Q, K, then you could deal yourself four or five aces at the finish.

Patter about “crooked” and “straight” dealing, then show the four straights on the last deal.

ESP + PINOCHLE

Effect: The performer shows a standard Pinochle deck consisting of 48 cards in four suits, ace through nine, with two of each card. The performer fairly riffle shuffles the deck, then passes out six cards each to five different spectators. Each spectator confirms that he has a pair—two cards of the same denomination—in his hand. If he does not have a pair, he discards his hand. Starting with spectator A, the performer holds spectator A’s hand of cards out of sight beneath the table and, through ESP, names the pair of cards. He is correct! Now, with the cards still out of sight, the performer finds one of the paired cards by “feel” alone and tables it face up. The tests are repeated successfully with each of the other four spectators holding a pair.

Method: This is my version of Karl Fulves’ “ESP + Math” using a Pinochle deck instead of ESP cards. “ESP + Math” first appeared in *The*

Pallbearer's Review, February 1968, and later in Fulves' *More Self-Working Card Tricks* (1984). ("ESP + Math" was also marketed as "ESP Miracle" through Louis Tannen, Inc. in 1973.)

My Pinochle-deck version was inspired by Arthur MacTier's "Cabaret E.S.P.," published in his *Card Concepts* (2000). MacTier's version used a special deck of regular cards made from ten decks. This version requires only a standard 48-card Pinochle deck.

Set up a Pinochle deck from top down in cyclic order: Q, A, 10, J, 9, K, Q, A, 10, J, 9, K, and so on, throughout the 48-card deck. Suits are not considered. Now, with the deck face up, reverse deal a pile of 23 cards face up on the table. Pick up the tabled pile and drop it onto the left-hand cards. You are ready to begin.

Spread the deck face up in the hands and explain that it is a Pinochle deck and consists of 48 cards, the nines through aces, in four suits, with two of each card. In the center you will see a K-Q-K sequence. As you square the deck, get a left little-finger break beneath the center queen.

Now turn the left hand palm down and drop the bottom portion of the deck face down on the table, cutting at the break. Set the top half beside it in position for a riffle shuffle. Riffle shuffle the halves together. Make sure that it is a good, even shuffle. Square the deck.

Assume the five spectators you use are spectators A, B, C, D and E, from your left to right. Pick up the deck and spread off the top six cards and hand them to spectator A. The next six cards are fanned off and handed to B. The next six to C, the next to D and finally six more to spectator E. Table the rest of the deck to one side.

Due to the Gilbreath-related principle, each group of six cards will contain a pair (two cards of the same value), beginning with a pair of *queens* in the first set of six. (It is possible, due to an uneven riffle shuffle, that some of the hands will not contain a pair. That situation is covered below.)

As you turn away, ask each spectator to fan his cards to see if his hand contains a pair—any two cards of the same value—like two jacks or two tens, for example. Have each spectator remember the value of his pair. If a spectator's hand does not contain a pair, have him discard his cards.

Begin with spectator A. Patter about ESP and being able to identify cards by feel. Have spectator A drop his cards face down into your left hand. Hold the left hand with the six cards under the table. Announce that you get the impression that there are two queens. (Always name queens for spectator A.) *"Is that right?"* you ask. Naturally the spectator agrees. Now say, *"I'm going to see if I can identify a queen . . . Yes, I think I have one."* Remove the *top* card of the packet, bring it forward, then turn it over and table it face up. Spread the other five cards face up and show there is a second queen in the hand. As you do, quickly determine the *missing* value, say a nine, then table these cards face down, overlapping the face-up queen.

Turn to spectator B. You will now know from glimpsing the missing value from A's hand that there is a pair of nines in B's hand. Have spectator B drop his cards onto your left hand, then repeat the same procedure: Announce, in this case, that there is a pair of nines, then bring the top card into view and deal it face up on the table, proving your "sensitive" touch has located a nine. Show the other five cards, note the missing value, then move on to spectator C and repeat the same procedure.

Repeat the exact same procedure with spectators D and E to finish.

Notes: Let's say that the missing value in spectator C's hand is a queen, indicating that the pair of cards in D's hand would be queens. But assume that D had no pair and discarded his hand. Simply move on to spectator E and name the *same* pair as you would have named for spectator D—a pair of queens.

You can allow a spectator to perform the riffle shuffle himself if you feel that his shuffle will be an even one.

21

Packet Tricks - Part 2

"Seeing some of the recently advertised Nick Trost routines performed produced an odd reaction. Since they rely in the main on Gaffed Cards (a phrase which causes purists to swoon) the effects are clean, fast and uncluttered. The odd reaction stems from the fact that no tricky false counts are used. Since we are talking here about small packet tricks, the absence of intricate counts may almost be regarded a 'revolutionary' approach."

—Karl Fulves, *Epilogue*, No 20, March 1974

This chapter includes several of my marketed packet effects, including "Ace in the Hole" and "Horsin' Around," two very popular items.

FOOL'S MATE

Here is an effect that was worked out after learning of Marlo's Orlam Subtlety and of Billy McComb's "McCombical Prediction" effect. (I marketed "Fool's Mate" in 1974.)

Effect: The performer displays eight blue-backed and one red-backed card. He shows the red-backer is an ace—his prediction card—which is tabled aside face down. A spectator freely selects one of the blue-backed cards, but it does not match the performer's prediction; it is a king instead of

an ace. This is puzzling, for now the rest of the blue-backed cards are shown to be aces! To rectify the situation, the performer changes his prediction card, an ace, to a king. Now his prediction card matches the spectator's selection!

Method: You will need nine cards: one red-backed card, cut short (say the KS), and eight blue-backed cards, say four KS's and four AD's. Arrange the cards as in Figure 1.

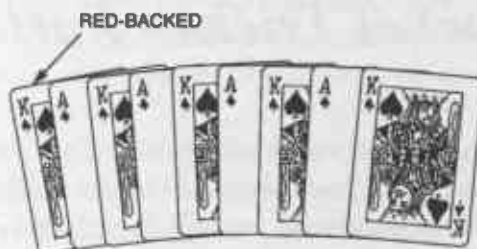


Fig. 1

Begin by fanning the packet face down between the hands, pointing out that all the cards are blue backed except one. Square the cards and hold them face down in the left hand. With the right hand, lift off the top two cards as one (Figure 2). This is easy since the red-backed card is short. Rotate the right hand palm up, displaying the AD. Explain that the AD is your prediction card. Replace the double card on top of the packet, then deal the red-backed card face down to one side on the table.

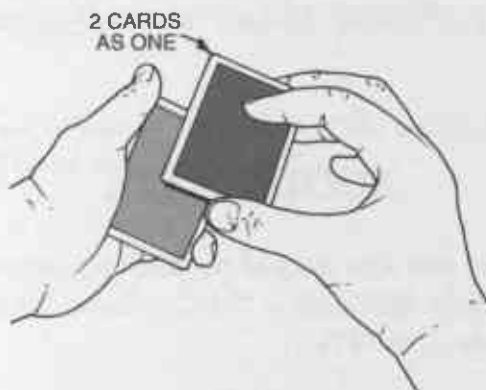


Fig. 2

You now force a KS. These are at even positions from the top of the face-down packet. A spectator names a number from, say, 1 to 10. If he names an even number, say 6, move five cards one by one from the top to

the bottom and turn up the sixth card and deal it face up on the table. If an odd number is named, say 5, move five cards one by one from top to bottom and deal the *next* card, the top one, face up on the table. (This is really the sixth card.) In any case, a KS will be turned up.

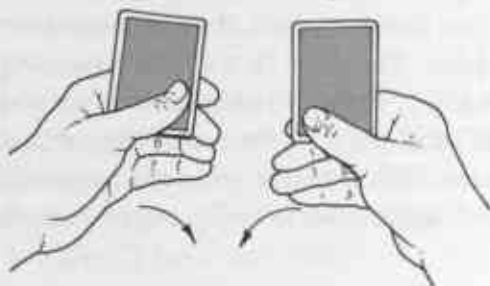


Fig. 3

Feign surprise. *"That's strange, I can't understand why you didn't get an ace because these are all aces."* As this is said, the remaining blue-backed cards are shown to be AD's, using the Olram Subtlety: Hold the packet face down in the left hand so that it extends about two-thirds of its length beyond the left forefinger (Figure 3). Thumb off the top card into the right hand, gripping it as in Figure 3. Rotate both hands inward, showing two AD's (Figure 4). Turn the hands palm up so the cards are face down and, at the same time, deal the top card of the left-hand packet and the right hand's card face down on the table, one onto the other.

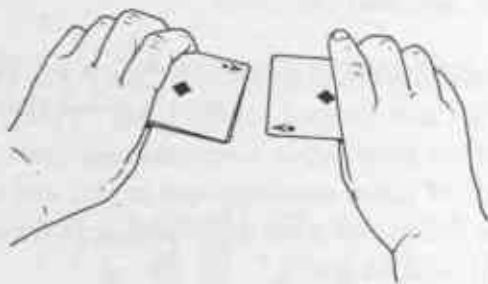


Fig. 4

Repeat the actions two more times, showing two AD's each time and dealing one card from each hand face down onto the tabled cards. Turn the left hand back up, showing the last card to be an AD, then drop it face down onto the tabled cards.

Explain that something must have gone wrong because the spectator's card was supposed to match your prediction card. Then, as if it has just

occurred to you, say, "*Well, I can always change my prediction card—then they'll match.*" Rub the spectator's card on the back of the red-backed card, turn up the red-backer and show it has "changed" to a KS.

Note: Here is another way of performing the Oloram Subtlety, suggested by Al Thatcher: As you deal two cards at a time face down on the table, deal them into separate piles. Show the face of the remaining single card, slide it under the left-hand pile, square it, then turn it over and hold it face up in the left hand. The AD will show on the face. Now, with the right hand, pick up the remaining three AD's from the table one by one and place them face up onto the left-hand cards. This visually emphasizes that all seven cards are AD's.

MISSISSIPPI POKER

This is one of the easiest and most entertaining of all poker deals. The performer shows a deck similar to the ones used by the old-time Mississippi gamblers—just nines through aces. He plays two-handed poker with a spectator, and he always wins—time after time. He gives the spectator increasingly better chances to beat him, but no matter what the spectator does, he can't win. The performer lets him shuffle, deal and even select his own cards—still the spectator can't win.

Method: This routine is based on the Ten Card Poker Deal, first described in Arthur Buckley's *Card Control* (1946) titled "Poker." In the Ten Card Deal, three cards of the same value repeated three times, plus an odd card, are used. Two hands of poker are dealt, one to you and one to a spectator. The principle is this: No matter what other four cards the spectator has, if he gets the odd (Jonah) card, he loses.

This routine uses two groups of nine cards. One group consists of three nines, three jacks and three kings; the other group consists of three tens, three queens and three aces. Place one group onto the other and carry them in an oversize plastic wallet. (In previous routines, the odd card was a marked card. Here, the odd card changes—as you will see—thus making the routine more deceptive.)

Phase One: To begin, remove the cards from the wallet. Explain that poker was first played as a "cheating game" on the Mississippi riverboats. "It was played with nines through aces—the minimum amount of cards needed to make any kind of poker hand from one pair to a royal flush and anything in between," you say. Spread the cards face up briefly to show that you are using the nines through aces.

"We're going to play a hand of poker, and I'd like to show you that I can win no matter who shuffles the cards or who deals." Split the packet so the nines, jacks and kings are in one group, the tens, queens and aces in the other. Hand a spectator either group. "You shuffle those cards and I'll shuffle these," you say as you shuffle your nine cards.

"Now let's trade cards and shuffle once more." (Do so.) This way you've shuffled all of the cards." Drop your shuffled cards face down on the table and have the spectator do likewise. "If you will, place one group onto the other," you say, "and deal us each five cards as in poker—one to me, one to you—and so on."

When he has done this, say, "Before we turn up the hands, I can tell you that I've got you beat . . ." Pick up the spectator's hand, turn it face up and spread it on the table, remarking on its rank—one pair, two pair, and so on. Turn up your hand and show you have him beat. "All right, I won that hand, but let's try again."

The position of the odd card among the dealt cards is the first card in the spectator's face-up hand. See Figure 1.

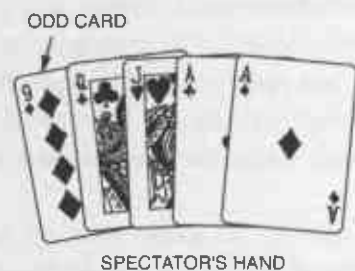


Fig. 1

Phase Two: Pick up your hand and drop it face up onto the spectator's hand, then scoop up both hands together. Turn these cards face down. The odd card is now on top. Have the spectator shuffle the undealt cards (the

eight cards he is still holding), then drop them face down onto your packet. Hand him all the cards and have him deal two hands as before.

"I think I've got you beat again," you say confidently. Turn the spectator's hand face up and spread it on the table, remarking on its rank. Turn your hand face up and say, *"Look what you gave me—the winning hand again. I don't think you understand. I want you to win. Let's try it again."*

The position of the odd card is the same as in Figure 1.

Phase Three: Drop your hand face up onto the spectator's hand, as before, and scoop up both hands. The odd card is on top. Overhand shuffle the odd card to the bottom, then back to the top. As you do this, have the spectator shuffle the undealt cards. This time, drop your cards face down onto his. (The odd card is now on top of the combined packet.)

Take the cards from the spectator and say, *"This time, I'll do the dealing."* Deal the top card face down to the spectator and the next card face down to yourself. Stop and say, *"To give you a better chance to win, I'm going to show you the next card."* Lift the top card so he can see its face. *"Who do you want me to deal this card to?"* Deal it to whichever hand he indicates. *"All right, how about this next card. Who do you want me to give this one to?"* (Show the spectator the next card.) *"Do you want it, or should I take it?"* Deal it to the hand he chooses.

Continue showing him cards and dealing them to the hand he chooses until one of the hands has five cards. Complete the deal so the other hand has five cards. Place the undealt cards aside.

"Okay, let's see what you gave yourself." Turn the spectator's hand face up and spread it on the table, calling out its rank. Then turn up your hand, showing you have him beat. *"No, you don't seem to understand, I want you to win."*

Note the position of the odd card. It is the card at the face of the spectator's hand. See Figure 2.

Phase Four: Pick up your hand, slide it face up *under* the spectator's hand and turn these cards face down. The odd card is now on the bottom. Shuffle

it to the top. As you do this, ask the spectator to shuffle the undealt cards. When he has finished, have him drop his cards face down onto yours.



Fig. 2

"To make this even simpler, we'll use just ten cards—ten cards that you've shuffled." Deal the top ten cards one at a time face down into a pile on the table. Place the remainder aside. Pick up the ten-card pile and hold it face down in dealing position. (The odd card is on top.) *"I think the reason you can't win is that it's a memory problem. You're having trouble remembering which cards you've dealt to whom."*

"This time, we'll play stud poker. I'll deal us each a hole card. (Deal a card face down to the spectator and one to yourself.) I'll even give you an edge by letting you peek at my hole card. (Show him your hole card.) Now I'll show you each of the other cards and deal them face up so everyone can see them, and you'll have no memory problem." Show him the cards one by one and deal them face up to the hand he chooses until there are four face-up cards in each hand.

"I'll even make it easier for you. You can switch any of your face-up cards for any of mine if you want." After he has made any switches, turn up his hole card and call out the rank of his hand. Now turn up your hole card and show that you have won again.

"I don't know what else I can do. You just don't want to win, do you?"

Phase Five: Scoop up both hands so the odd card is on top. (The odd card is the spectator's hole card.) Shuffle the odd card to the bottom, then back to the top. Hand the spectator the face-down packet.

"I'm going to let you choose your own hand, and I won't even touch the cards." Direct him to deal the top card (the odd card) face down in front of himself on the table. He is now to shuffle the remainder, then deal another

card face down on top of the first. He is to shuffle, deal another, shuffle, deal another, shuffle and deal one more so he has dealt himself five cards. Have him place the remaining five cards face down in front of you for your hand.

Ask the spectator if he would be willing to bet on this last round. Whatever he says, turn up his hand and spread it face up on the table, calling out its rank—one pair, two pair, and so on. Then, before turning up your hand, say, *"I don't understand. I want you to win, but you gave me -----."* Here you name the rank of your hand. This is easy to do, for if he has a pair, you will have two pair; if he has two pair, you will have three of a kind; and if he has three of a kind, you will have a full house. Turn up your hand to show you have won.

Here is the reset: The odd card is on the face of the spectator's hand as in Figure 2. Scoop your hand face up under his and turn these cards face down. (The odd card is on the bottom of the packet.) Drop these cards face down onto the undealt cards and you are reset.

Notes: When showing your hand, take only the cards from your hand that will beat the spectator's hand and lay them face up on the table. In this way the spectator rarely sees all the cards from one group at one time, and it helps conceal the use of the odd card.

The idea of using two groups of nine (18 cards) instead of one group for the Ten Card Poker Deal is original with me. I showed the idea to Stewart Judah and he developed the first three phases of the routine described here. Later, I added the last two phases—presentational ideas coming from Bruce Bernstein and Harry Lorayne.

"Mississippi Poker," marketed in 1989, is an extended version of my "Eighteen Card Poker," which appeared in *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997).

Additional Phase: This phase can be performed near the end of the routine. It seems very fair since the spectator gets a choice of all five of his cards. The concept is described within Ernest Earick's trick "Double Damned," which appeared in his book *By Forces Unseen* (1993), written by Stephen Minch. Earick's idea of using two odd (Jonah) cards works very well with the set of 18 cards used in "Mississippi Poker."

Each nine-card group is shuffled by the spectator, who then drops one group onto the other. Take the 18-card packet. In an overhand shuffle, run four cards and throw, then run four more cards and throw. Now give the cards a False Charlier shuffle, retaining the order of the packet.

Explain to the spectator that you will play a hand of five-card stud poker. Point out that he will select his face-down hole card, then the rest of the cards will be turned face up and he will select his other four cards. Fan off the top two cards face down into the right hand and ask the spectator to choose one for his hole card; the card not selected is dealt face down in front of you for your hole card. Invite him to change his mind if he wants and switch his hole card for yours. You must keep track of which of the two cards the spectator settles on for his hole card—the *top* card or the *bottom* card of the original pair.

Emphasize that the rest of the cards will be turned face up before they are dealt. There are two ways the next eight cards can be dealt: If the spectator took the *top* card of the pair for his hole card, you must now use the cards from the *top* of the packet. These are turned *face up* in pairs. The spectator gets a choice of either card of the pair for his hand, and the other face-up card is dealt to your hand. Continue the same procedure until you each have five cards.

On the other hand, if the spectator took the *bottom* card of the original pair for his hole card, then work from the *bottom* of the packet: Turn the packet face up and offer him either of the two cards on the face of the packet for his hand; you take the remaining face-up card for your hand. Continue this same procedure until you each have five cards.

At this point offer the spectator the opportunity to switch any of his face-up cards for any of your face-up cards. Switch the cards he wants.

Once the spectator has finished choosing his hand, recap how fair the procedure has been: He has decided throughout the five cards for each hand. Finally, turn over his hole card, then yours to show that you have won.

CARD CLONING

This effect was inspired by Roy Walton's trick "Imperfect Clones," published in *The Complete Walton, Volume Two* (1986).

Effect: The performer shows three cards used for Three-Card Monte—two jokers and the 5H. "The odds," the performer says, "are two to one against you guessing which card is the five of hearts. But, if another five of hearts could be cloned, then you'd have an even chance of winning." The performer counts the cards, and a second 5H appears. Now when the cards are counted again, a third 5H appears, making the odds 3 to 2 in the player's favor. Then another 5H is cloned, and the player has odds of 2 to 1 in his favor—there are now two jokers and four 5H's. Finally, the performer changes the two jokers into 5H's, making the game a sure thing!

Method: You will need six cards, two double-faced joker/5H's and four regular 5H's. Set up the packet from back to face: 5H, 5H, 5H, joker/5H, joker/5H, 5H. (See Figure 1.)

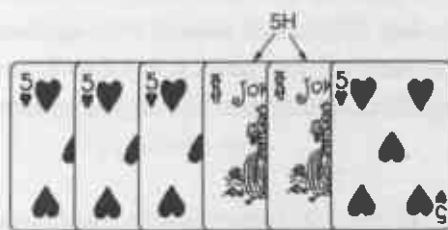


Fig. 1

Start with the packet face up in the left hand. Perform the Flushtation Count to show three cards: 5H, joker, joker. This last joker (with three other cards) is placed under the other two counted cards.

Explain that in Three-Card Monte the player is to find the odd card, the 5H. Fan over the two cards at the face of the packet, holding the last four cards as one. Display the 5H between the jokers. "Wouldn't it be great if we could clone another five of hearts so there would be two fives of hearts and two jokers. Then you would have an even chance of picking out the red card." Square the packet, then perform an Elmsley Count. The second 5H appears between the jokers. Fan over the joker at the face and the next two 5H's, holding the last three cards as one. Two 5H's are displayed between the jokers.

The right hand deals one of the 5H's face up on the table. Show the other 5H between the two jokers. Square the packet. *"It would even be better if we could clone another five of hearts, the odds would be three to two in your favor,"* you say. Square the cards, Elmsley Count and another 5H appears between the jokers. Fan to show four cards, holding the last two cards as one. Deal another 5H face up on the table with the first.

"Of course, if I could clone another five of hearts, then the odds would be four to two, or two to one in your favor," you say. Elmsley Count, then fan the cards to show two 5H's between the jokers.

The right hand deals the joker at the face of the fan on the table, then takes the next card, a 5H, scoops it under the tabled joker (double-facer) and flips over both cards. (This is the Wild Card Move.) Deal the other joker on the table, then use the second 5H to scoop and turn over both cards.

With the right hand, pick up the two 5H's laid aside earlier and place them face up into the left hand. The right hand rubs one of the tabled pairs, then turns up the face-down card, revealing two 5H's. The right hand places this pair onto the left-hand cards. Repeat by rubbing the second pair of tabled cards, showing two 5H's, then placing them onto the left-hand cards.

"Of course, the best odds would be if all the cards were fives of hearts, then there would be no way you could lose." As this is said, perform the Oloram Subtlety, apparently showing the backs of all the 5H's, then dealing them face up into a pile on the table. The right-hand card should be dealt to the table first each time.

Square the packet, turn it face down and pocket it. A back will show on top of the packet.

TWISTING 1-2-3-4

Effect: The blue-backed ace, two, three and four of clubs are shown. One by one in numerical order, the cards turn face down as the packet is counted. After the fourth count, the 4C is turned face up and it has changed

to the 4H. Not only that—the ace, two and three are now all hearts. Also, the backs are shown and they have changed from blue to red.

Method: You will need a blue-backed AH, red-backed AC and three double-facers: 3C/4H, 2C/2H and 4C/3H. Set up the packet as shown in Figure 1.

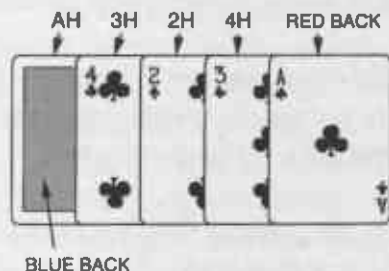


Fig. 1

Start with the packet face up in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb counts the AC, 3C and 2C one at a time in fan formation into the left hand; the 4C (double) is slipped beneath the 2C (Figure 2).



Fig. 2

Square the packet, give it a twist, then count the cards one by one in fan formation into the left hand to disclose one face-down card, apparently the AC (Figure 3).

Square the packet, give it a twist and count the cards into the left hand as before. Apparently the 2C has turned face down. Repeat the procedure again to show the 3C has apparently turned down.

Square the packet and count the cards once more, peeling off the AC, 3C and face-down card into the left hand. It appears that the 4C has turned

face down. The 2C (double) is slipped beneath the face-down card, and the packet is squared. The left forefinger buckles the bottom card as the right hand turns over the top four cards as one bookwise to the right to reveal the 4H.

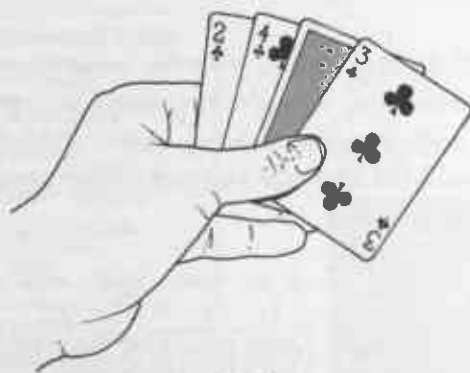


Fig. 3

The right hand grips the packet in Biddle grip. Now perform the Flushtration Count to apparently show a red back on the 4H, 3H, 2H and AH (double). The AH (double) is placed face up beneath the packet to finish the routine.

Turn over the packet so it appears to be face down and pocket it.

RAZZLE-DAZZLE

Most ideas work out in a relatively short period of time—but not this effect. It was developed over a period of several years. While I was attending a convention several years ago, an acquaintance described an effect to me that he had seen Alex Elmsley perform the night before at a party: Five jokers were shown, and each time one of the cards was substituted for a joker with a different color back, the backs of all five cards changed to that color. This was repeated again and again. The idea intrigued me. I later found out this was Elmsley's trick "Dazzle," which first appeared in his lecture notes entitled *Cardwork* (1975). It was based on his Everchange Count, which I found difficult. The method I later worked out is much simpler, and the ironic twist is that it is based on the standard Elmsley Count. I marketed "Razzle Dazzle" in 1981. Here is the effect—a series of five changes:

Four face-up cards are shown. One card is turned face down, then all four turn face down. The backs of the cards now change color—from all blue to all red—then to plaid (green) backs, then to picture backs. For the surprise finish, the cards are dealt on the table and each has a different back. The cards are then examinable.

Method: You will need six cards with the same face (say the AC): two blue-backed, one red-backed, two plaid- (green) backed and one picture-backed (preferably with a white border). Also needed are two double-backed cards, one red/blue and one red/plaid. The cards are carried in a two-compartment plastic wallet.

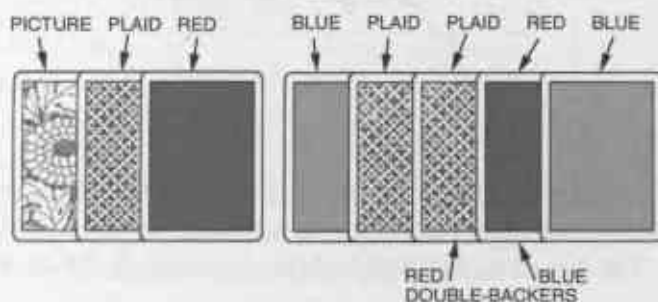


Fig. 1

To set up, arrange two face-down packets so the backs read from top to bottom: *Three-Card Packet*: red, plaid, picture. *Five-Card Packet*: blue, red/blue (red side up), plaid/red (plaid side up), plaid, blue. See Figure 1. It is also helpful in recalling the setup and routine to use a Q-Card. This is reproduced in Figure 2. Slip the three-card packet face up into the left side of the wallet and five-card packet face down into the right side (Figure 3).

Start by opening the wallet and laying it on the table so the three-card packet is to your left. Remove the five-card packet, turn it face up and hold it in the left hand. *"A gambler always carries a few extra cards like these. He switches them into a game to improve his hands,"* you explain. Elmsley Count to show four face-up cards. *"These are not ordinary cards, because if you turn one face down . . . the rest follow suit."* Perform a double turnover. Snap the packet for effect, then Elmsley Count, showing four face-down blue-backed cards.

Lift off the top card, flash its face and lay it aside to your right, face down on the table. With the right hand, remove the bottom card from the three-card packet in the wallet. Flash the red back and lay it face up onto

the left-hand packet. "If the gambler is in a game where red-backed cards are used . . . he simply changes his cards from blue to red," you say as you perform another double turnover. Elmsley Count, showing four red-backed cards.

Nick Trost's "RAZZLE-DAZZLE" Q-CARD

SET-UP: Top to bottom - all face down -
 3-Card Pkt.: Red, Plaid, Picture
 (Face up in wallet)
 5-Card Pkt.: Blue, Red/Blue (Red up),
 Plaid/Red (Plaid up), Plaid,
 Blue (Face down in wallet).

ROUTINE: Remove 5-card pkt. Elmsley Count
 face up. Double turnover - Elmsley Count -
 all face down!
 Discard top card. Lay red card from wallet
 face up on top. Double turnover -
 Elmsley Count - all Red!
 Discard top card. Lay Plaid face up on top.
 Double turnover - Elmsley Count and in-jog
 face-up card. As you pull it out and
 show Plaid-back, get break under top card.
 Place Plaid face down on top.
 Lift all 2 as 1 and discard. Lay Picture-back face
 up on top. Turn it down. "Three-Fist" Move
 Elmsley Count shows 4 Picture-backs.
 "Three-Fist" Move - Deal 4 different backs in
 overlapping row.
RESET: Scoop 4 tabled cards and drop face
 down on discards. Reverse order of pkt.
 Fan all 5 top cards and slip face down in
 wallet. Slip 3-card pkt. face up in wallet.

Fig. 2

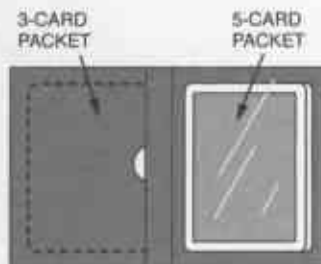


Fig. 3

Lift off the top card (the red/blue double-backer) and deal it aside on top of the tabled blue-backed card. With the right hand, remove the bottom card of the two in the wallet. "At times the gambler may need a back like this," you say as you flash the back, showing a plaid (green) back. Lay the card face up onto the packet and perform another double turnover. Elmsley Count. When you count the third (face-up) card, in-jog it about half an inch, then count the fourth card on top (Figure 4). Three plaid backs will appear. Place the packet in the left hand. With the right hand, lift and slide out the

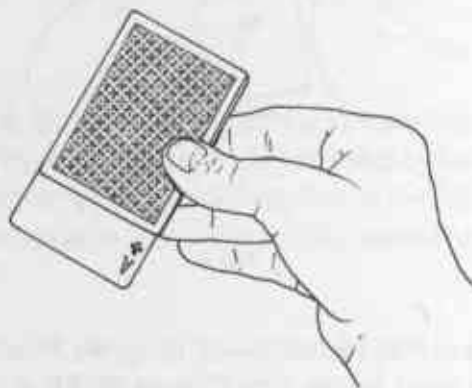


Fig. 4

face-up card; at the same time, get a left little-finger break under the top card. Turn over the face-up card, showing another plaid back, then lay it face down on top of the packet.

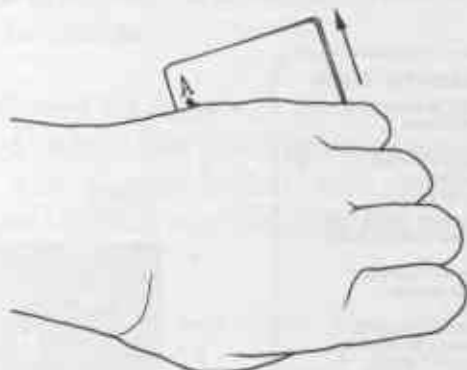


Fig. 5

With the right hand, lift off the two cards above the break as one and lay them aside onto the first two discards. The right hand removes the last card from the wallet (picture back) and flashes its back as you say, "*Or, sometimes in a game of bridge, the back may look something like this.*" Lay the card face up on top of the left-hand packet, then turn it face down in the same manner as the previous double turnovers. Perform a through-the-fist flourish by turning the left hand palm down and pushing the packet through the fist with the left thumb (Figure 5). Remove the face-up packet with the right hand and lay it face up into the left hand.

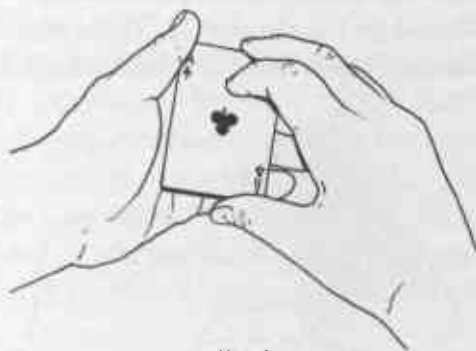


Fig. 6

Show the cards as four picture backs, using the Flushtstration Count: Hold the packet in right-hand Biddle grip (Figure 6); lift it, displaying the back

(Figure 7), rotate the hand palm down and, with the left thumb, peel off the top card into the left hand (Figure 8); lift the packet and show the back again, rotate the hand palm down and peel off the next top card into the left hand. Continue by showing the back again and drawing off another card. Show the back on the last card and drop it on top.

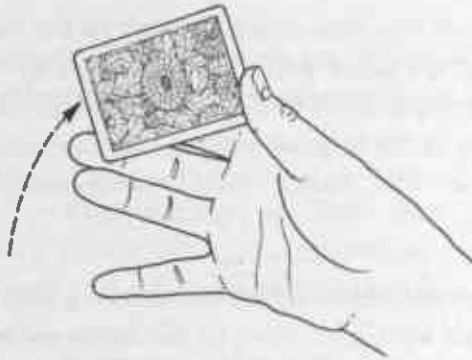


Fig. 7

"But the best cards for the gambler to carry would be a set like this," you say as you perform a through-the-fist flourish, turning the packet face down. Deal the cards face down into an overlapping row on the table to show four different backs for the climax. These four cards can be examined.

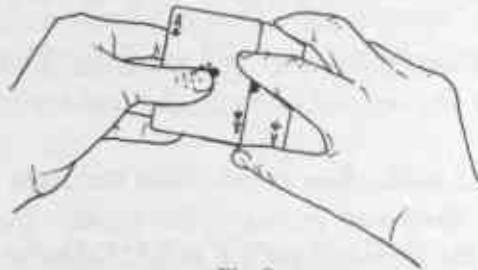


Fig. 8

To reset, scoop up the four tabled cards and drop them face down onto the discards. At an opportune moment, reverse the order of the face-down packet. Fan off the top five cards, slip them face down into the right side of the wallet. Turn the remaining three face up and insert them face up into the left side of the wallet.

AL THATCHER'S PRESENTATION

Al's setup and reset are a little different; he added a really practical way to get set for the double turnovers, plus he came up with a clever patter theme. Here is Al's routine:

To set up, arrange two face-down packets so the backs read from top to bottom: *Three-Card Packet*: picture, plaid, red. *Five-Card Packet*: blue, red/blue (red side up), plaid/red (plaid side up), plaid, blue. (This packet is in the same order as in the original setup.) The three-card packet is placed face down in one side of the wallet, while the five-card packet is placed face up in the other side.

Remove the face-up five-card packet and hold it face up in the left hand. Say, *"I've found that with four cards of the same value—like these—they tend to follow the leader . . ."* Perform an Elmsley Count to show four duplicate cards (say AC's). Injog the third card slightly (about 3/16 of an inch) as you count.

"For example, if I turn one card face down—they all want to follow the leader and turn face down." Do a double turnover (easy because of the injogged card) to bring a blue back into view. Elmsley Count again to show four face-down blue-backed cards. Again injog the third card slightly.

"This also works with the backs," you continue. *"If I take a red card and put it with the blues, the rest follow the leader and become blue-backers."*

Lay the top card aside, face down. With the right hand, remove the bottom card of the three-card packet in the wallet—the red-backed card. Lay it face up onto the left-hand packet and do a double turnover. Elmsley Count, showing four red-backed cards. (Again, slightly injog the third card counted.)

Lay the top red card aside onto the tabled blue card. *"If I put a green (plaid) card with the red . . . they all change color—even this one!"* As this is said, remove the green plaid card from the wallet, lay it face up onto the packet, double turnover and repeat the Elmsley Count. The procedure is a bit different here. The third card counted will be face up. Outjog the face-up card about an inch, then injog the fourth card slightly. As you say, *" . . . even this one,"* grip the packet in the left hand and, with the right hand, remove

the face-up card and show the green plaid back. Lay this card face down on top of the packet. Lift off the top two cards as one with the right hand and lay the double card face down onto the discards.

Say, *"I've found that it works just as well with a picture back. Put it with the rest of them and they all follow the leader—all are picture backs."*

Lay the picture-back card face up on top of the left-hand packet, then turn the single card face down in the same manner as the previous double turnovers.

Now perform the Rumba Count to show four picture backs. (See Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for a description of the Rumba Count.) The four cards are dealt into a face-up pile on the table.

Finish by saying, *"But if you separate the cards . . . they revert back to their original form."* Pick up the pile of face-up cards and deal them face up into a left-to-right row on the table. Work from left to right, turning over each card in turn, showing four different backs for the climax.

To reset, work left to right in the row: Pick up the picture back, drop it onto the green plaid, then drop both onto the red. This is the three-card packet. Slip it face down into the wallet. Drop the remaining card in the row—the blue-backer—face down onto the discards. Reverse their order at your convenience. This is the five-card packet. Slip it face up into the wallet.

4-GONE CONCLUSION

Effect: The performer shows four of a kind—say four kings and four face-down prediction cards. A spectator names any king—say the KH. The performer lays the kings aside, then shows his prediction cards are each lettered "KH," the same as the named king! But that's not all—the KH vanishes from the king packet and appears among the prediction cards. The prediction cards are dealt face up and they spell "GONE." This, the performer says, is a "four-gone conclusion."

Method: For “4-Gone Conclusion” you will need four blank-backed kings, one of each suit. With a marking pen, letter each on the back with its own value and suit as shown in Figure 1. (The KC, for example, would have “KC” lettered on the back.) You will also need four blank-faced cards with G-O-N-E lettered on the faces—one letter per card. Arrange the cards as in Figure 1. The cards lettered KC, KD, KS and KH can be in any order. Square the cards and turn the packet face down endways so the tops of the letters are toward you.



Fig. 1

Begin by fanning the packet, showing four face-up kings and four face-down prediction cards. Ask a spectator to name any one of the four kings. Say he names the KH. Shift the named king to the second position from the right end of the fan (Figure 2). Square the packet and hold it in right-hand Biddle grip with the kings showing. You now perform the Biddle Move, as follows: The left thumb pulls off the first king into the left hand. Pull off the next king (KH) onto the first, holding a minute left little-finger break beneath it. As you pull off the third king (Figure 3), the right-hand cards are momentarily over the cards in the left hand. With the right thumb and fingers, pick up the KH under the right-hand cards; at the same time, the left thumb draws off the third king into the left hand. The fourth king is counted off the top.

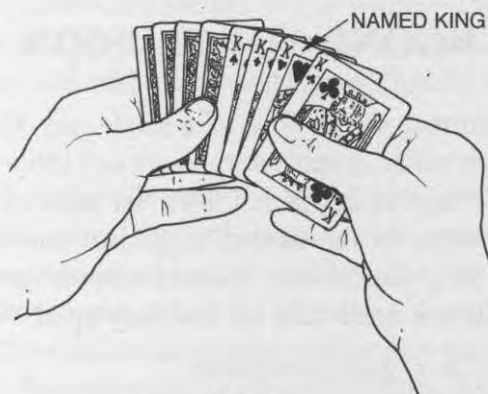


Fig. 2

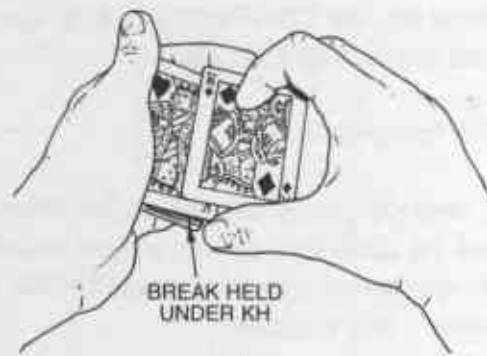


Fig. 3

Name each of the kings as they are counted off. The king packet (minus the KH) is laid aside to your left on the table. The KH is now the bottom card of the right-hand packet.

You now show that "KH" is apparently lettered on the face side of each of the four prediction cards, using the Flushturation Count: Hold the five cards in right-hand Biddle grip. The right hand turns palm up to show "KH" (Figure 4); turn the hand palm down. The left thumb peels off the top card face down into the left hand. The right hand again turns palm up to show "KH"; the hand turns palm down and the left thumb peels off the top card into the left hand. Repeat the moves once more. The right hand shows the last two cards as one and drops them face down on top of the left-hand cards. Apparently all four prediction cards show "KH."

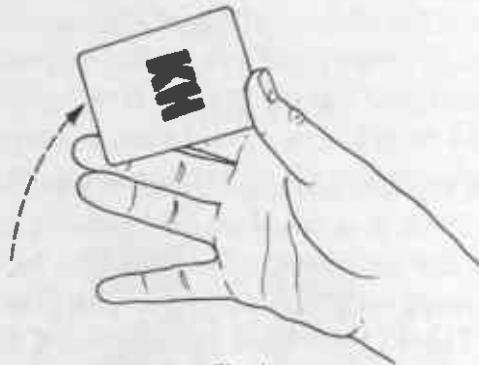


Fig. 4

Square this packet and table it face down to your right. Now pantomime the action of invisibly transferring the selected card (KH) from the king packet to the prediction packet. Spread the king packet, showing there are just three kings. (You can pick them up and drop the one by one face up on

the table, proving there are just three cards.) Pick up the prediction packet and spread it to reveal the face-up KH.

Drop the KH with the other kings.

For the climax, snap the prediction packet for effect, then turn it face up sideways and deal the cards face up into a right-to-left row on the table (Figure 5). From the spectators' view, the word "GONE" is revealed. "... *A four-gone conclusion!*" you exclaim.

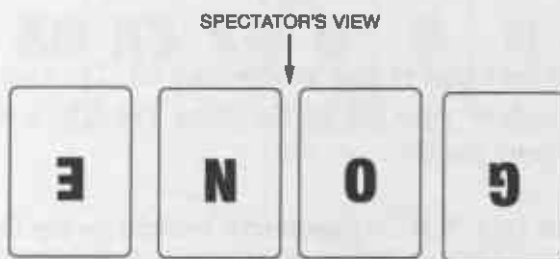


Fig. 5

Note: I marketed "4-Gone Conclusion" in 1991. The original version of this effect appeared as "Triple-Climax Mental Effect" in my column in *The New Tops*, November 1977. In that version, the last four cards changed to jokers.

4 FLUSH!

This was one of my first marketed tricks. It was marketed by Haines' House of Cards in 1970. It is based on Ed Marlo's Olram Subtlety. (The Olram Subtlety was first described in *The New Tops*, November 1965.) It is a Wild Card effect using six cards. The performer shows five blank-faced cards and one 4S. The 4S is brushed against two of the blank cards and they change to 4S's. This is repeated with the other blank cards and, at the finish, all six cards have changed to the 4S—a four flush. No double-faced cards are used, and yet the spectators seem to see the face and back of every card.



Fig. 1

Method: You need six cards, three regular 4S's and three fake cards, each being a blank-facer with a 4S pip in one corner (Figure 1). Arrange the six cards as in Figure 2, the blank fakes alternating with the fours. There should be a regular 4S on the face of the packet.

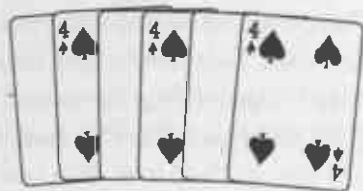


Fig. 2

Begin by holding the packet face down in the left hand so the blank part of the fakes are away from you. Fan the packet so the backs can be seen, remove the bottom card (a regular 4S) and place it aside, face down. Square the other five cards and hold them face down in the left hand. The packet should extend two-thirds of its length beyond the left forefinger as shown in Figure 3. Explain that you will use five blank cards. Thumb the top card into the right hand, gripping it as in Figure 3. Rotate both hands inward, showing what appears to be two entirely blank cards (Figure 4). The fingers cover the fake pips. Turn the hands palm up so the cards are face down and, at the

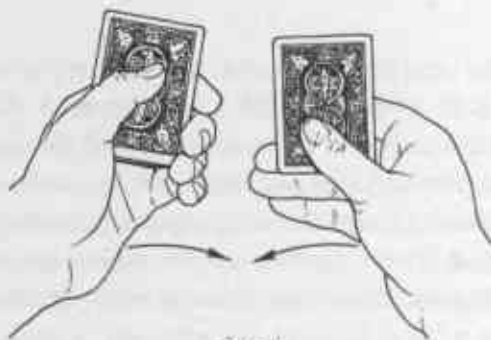


Fig. 3

same time, deal the top card of the left-hand packet and the card in the right hand face down side by side on the table. (This is Marlo's Olram Subtlety.)

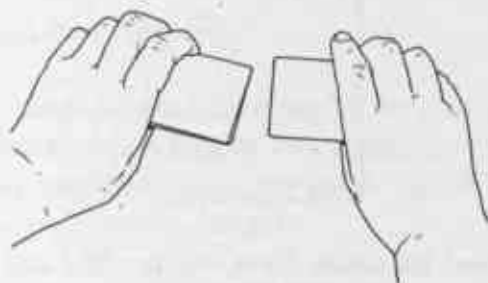


Fig. 4

Repeat the above actions once more, showing two more blank(?) cards. Deal one card from each hand face down onto each of the two face-down tabled cards. Turn the left hand back up, showing the remaining card to be blank(?), then turn this card face down and use it to scoop up the two face-down cards on the right. Square this three-card packet (all fake cards). Turn the packet end for end and place it aside, face down to the right on the table.

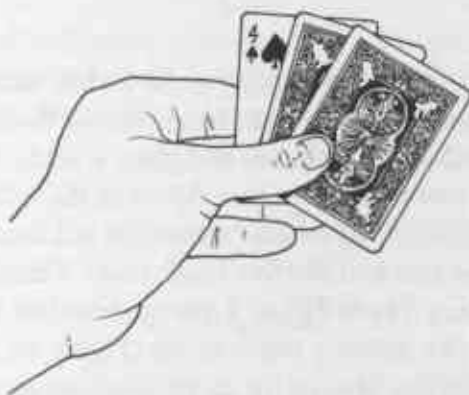


Fig. 5

Next, pick up the card placed aside at the start of the routine and show it to be the 4S. Hold it face up in the left hand and use it to scoop up the two face-down cards (regular fours) on your left. Hold the cards, fanned in the left hand (Figure 5). Explain that you will now cause these two blank cards to change to fours. With the right hand, grasp the face-down card at the right end of the fan, brush it across the face-up four, then turn it face up, showing it has "changed." Replace this four face up between the other two cards.

Repeat with the other face-down card, "changing" it to a four, so you now hold a fan of three face-up fours in the left hand.



Fig. 6

Slip these three face-up cards under the three face-down cards on the table and scoop them up. Display the six cards in a fan (Figure 6), saying, *"Three fours and three blank cards."* Square the cards and hold them in the left hand in dealing position. With the right hand, grip the outer end of the packet and turn it over end over end toward you (Figure 7). Fan the packet, showing three blank cards face up and three face-down cards. Square the cards and hold them in the left hand.

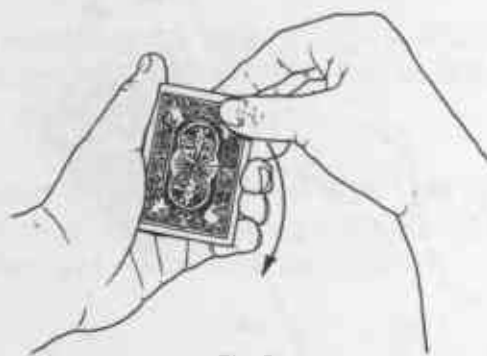


Fig. 7

Now, apparently turn over the packet as before but perform the Carlyle False Turnover that simply turns the packet end for end: Drop the left thumb under the left side of the packet and flip it over sideways to the right. When the packet is nearly over, grasp it at the outer right corner between the right thumb on top, first and second fingers underneath (Figure 8). Lift the packet with the right hand and, in a definite upward motion, turn it end over end toward you and place it into the left hand. Properly executed it appears

that you have simply turned over the packet. Immediately spread the cards, showing three fours (fakes) and three face-down cards.

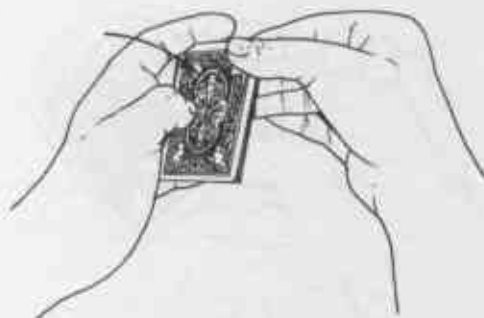


Fig. 8

Remove the face-down card at the right end of the fan and brush it across the faces of the face-up fours(?). Turn over the card and show that it also has “changed” to a four. Replace this card face up in front of the fake fours (Figure 9). Repeat the procedure, “changing” the remaining two face-down cards into fours. Replace each into the fan so at the finish the regular fours alternate with the fake cards. You end up with a fan of six fours—a four flush!

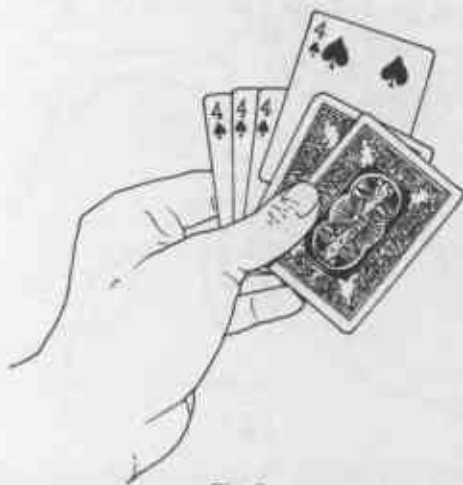


Fig. 9

The cards are now set for a repeat performance.

Note: “4 Flush!” is currently available from L & L Publishing.

ACE IN THE HOLE

"Ace in the Hole" was the first trick marketed in 1974 when I began marketing my own tricks. It has been extremely well-received and has probably outsold all my other packet tricks.

The only trick I can recall that resembled "Ace in the Hole" was an effect called "Jack Pot" advertised as a Dai Vernon favorite and marketed by Harry Stanley in 1955. The trick did use split cards—half-face, half-back and was a changing poker hand, but I don't think this trick was an inspiration for "Ace in the Hole." Instead, I feel my earlier ideas of using split cards with the Carlyle False Turnover inspired the development of "Ace in the Hole." It became a firm favorite with many, including Stewart Judah, Al Thatcher, Harold Martin and Tom Hubbard.

Effect: The performer shows five cards dealt in a game of stud poker—one down and four face up, without a pair in the lot. The hole card is no help, so it is laid aside. When the other cards are shown again, they have changed to three aces. And the hole card, when turned up, has now changed to the fourth ace.

Method: This requires an AC with a 3C index; three double-faced cards: 4D half-back/AH, 8H half-back/AS, 10D half-back/AD and any regular card, preferably a court card.

To set up, arrange the cards in a fan (Figure 1) so they read from left to right: AC with 3C index in the lower right corner; 4D half-back; 8H half-back; 10D half-back; and regular card, face down.

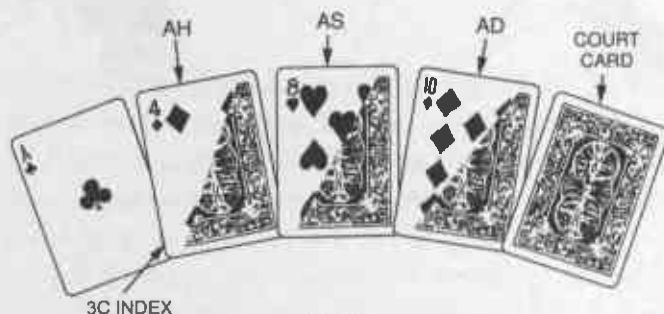


Fig. 1

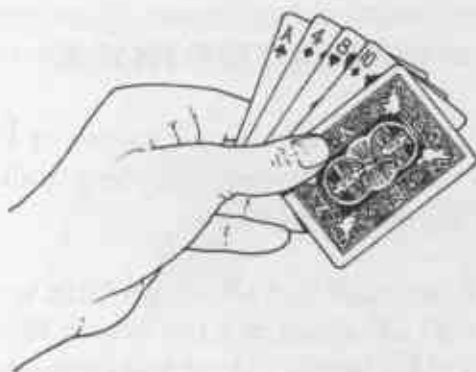


Fig. 2

When ready to perform, fan the cards and explain you were dealt this hand in a game of stud poker (Figure 2) and you did not have a thing—not even a pair. Say, “*And my hole card didn’t help either.*” Square the cards and hold them in the left hand in dealing position. Perform the Carlyle False Turnover that simply turns the packet end for end: Drop the left thumb under the left side of the packet and flip it over sideways to the right. When the packet is nearly over, grasp it at the outer right corner between the right thumb on top, first and second fingers below (Figure 3). Lift the packet with the right hand and, in a definite upward motion, turn it end over end toward you and place it into the left hand (Figure 4). Properly executed, it appears that you have simply turned over the packet. Immediately spread the cards, showing the 3C as your hole card and apparently four face-down cards.

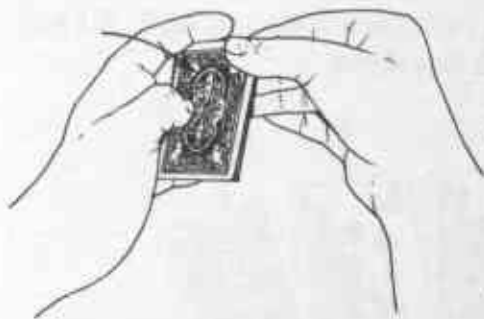


Fig. 3

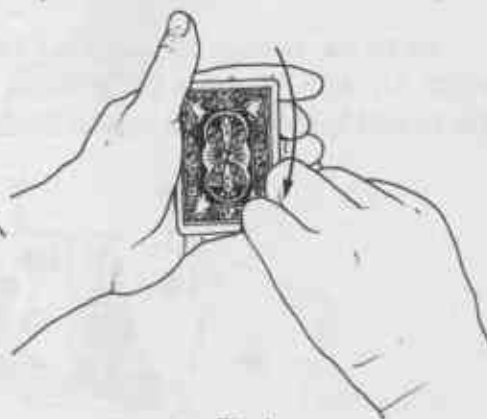


Fig. 4

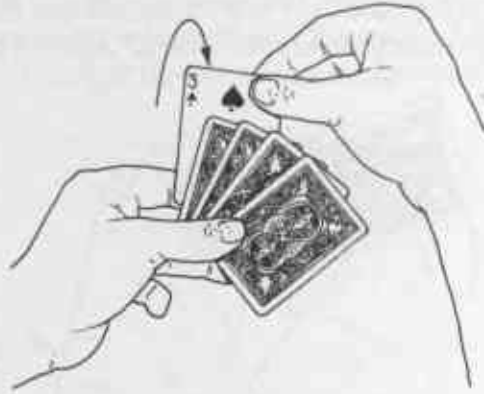


Fig. 5

With the right hand, grasp the 3C (Figure 5) and lay it face down on the table. (No need to hurry here—the face of the card will not be seen.)

Square the other four cards and hold them in the left hand. *"With a hand like that,"* you continue, *"I decided to change them into something better."*



Fig. 6

Lift the packet with the right hand, rub the face of the packet on the left sleeve, then turn over the packet sideways, revealing the AH at the face. Slowly fan the cards in a wide fan, showing three aces and one odd card (Figure 6). *"Now, I had something to play with,"* you say. *"And with a hand like that, it never hurts to have an ace in the hole."* As this is said, reach down with the right hand and grip the sides of the tabled card at its inner end between the thumb and second finger; the forefinger rests on the back of the

card (Figure 7). Flip the card over sideways, face up, showing the AC for the climax. The right thumb covers the fake 3C index (Figure 8).

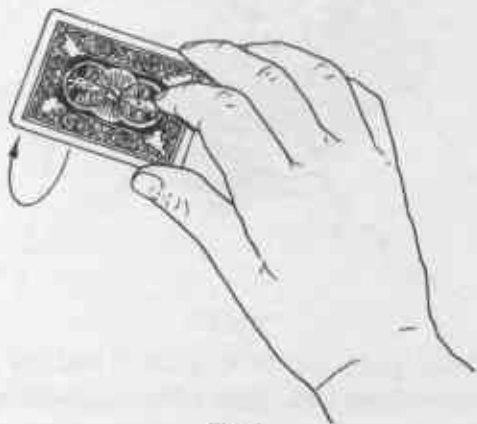


Fig. 7

Slide the AC under the four cards in the left hand, then all the cards can be fanned and shown front and back.

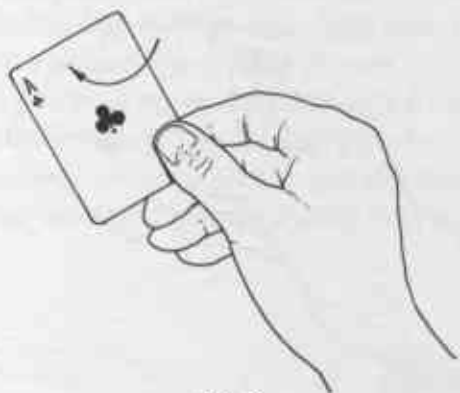


Fig. 8

To reset, square the packet, turn it over endways so the aces are face down, remove the top card, turn it over end over end and place it face up underneath. The cards are now set as in Figure 1.

Notes: Here is Mike Boden's method for "changing" the hole card: The left hand lays the four-card fan face up on the table, then the right hand picks up the face-down hole card and lays it across the left fingers with the 3C index toward you. Perform a through-the-fist flourish (without turning over the card) so the face-down card emerges from the left fist. The right

hand grips the end of the emerging card between the thumb and second finger, with the forefinger resting on top (Figure 9). Snap the card face up, revealing the AC. (The right thumb, of course, covers the 3C index.)

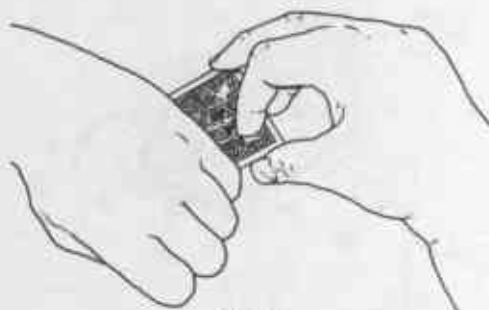


Fig. 9

Roger Divella suggested this addition: After fanning and showing the face-up fan of cards at the finish, tilt the hand so the backs are to the spectators as you square the right edge of the fan on the table. This flashes the backs in a subtle manner (Figure 10).

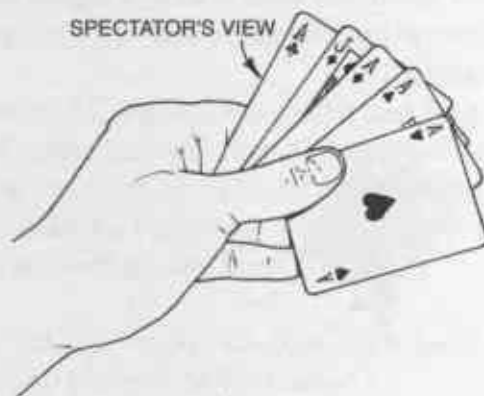


Fig. 10

AL THATCHER'S ROUTINE

Al's routine features a visible one at a time change of indifferent cards to aces, and a comical finish of five aces.

The regular card is the AC, which gives you five aces for the finish.

Set up as usual with the regular AC face down on top. (The 4D, 8H and 10D can be in any order.)

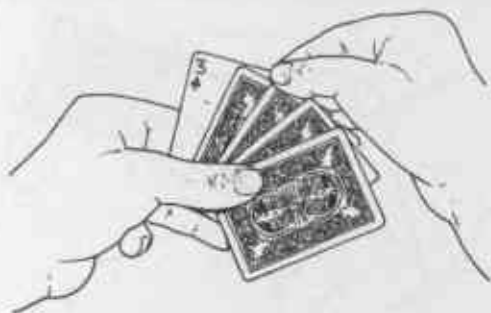


Fig. 11

Fan the cards, showing your stud poker hand of four face-up cards, an AC, 4D, 8H and 10D. Perform the Carlyle False Turnover, then fan the cards to show that the 3C—hole card—is no help. With the right hand, grasp the 3C at the outer left corner, thumb on the 3C index (Figure 11). Pull it out of the fan, turn it face down and table it so it is angled as shown in Figure 12. The 3C index corner is toward you, so that when you pick it up later, you will know where to grasp it.

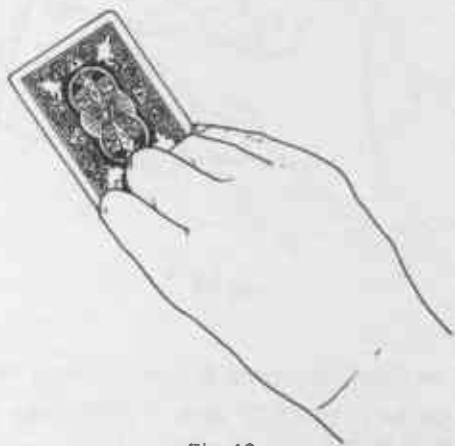


Fig. 12

With the left hand, hold the fan of four as in Figure 11, brush the faces of the cards against the right sleeve. The right hand then pulls out the card at the left end of the fan (as in Figure 11) and deals it face up on the table, overlapping the hole card to the left. One of the indifferent cards has apparently changed to an ace. Repeat the brushing and dealing with each

of the next two fake cards, showing they have apparently changed to aces. Deal each succeeding card from right to left into an overlapping row as shown in Figure 13.

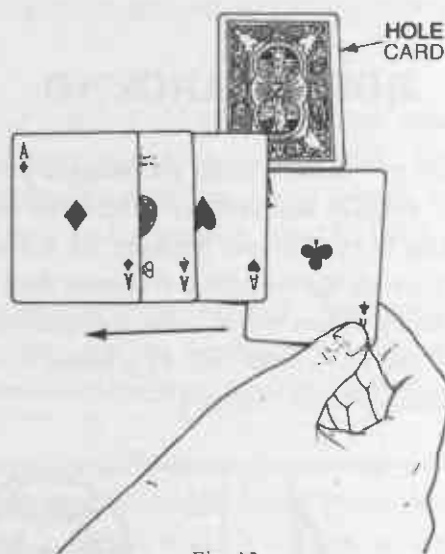


Fig. 13

Brush the regular AC against the sleeve and snap it face up with the right hand. Slide it under the right edge of the three face-up fakes, as shown in Figure 13, and scoop them up. (Leave the hole card on the table.) Square the four cards and, with the right hand, turn them over endways toward you and lay them face down in the left hand.

With the right hand, grasp the face-down hole card (AC/3C) as in Figure 7, then snap it face up to show the fifth ace.

"That's one time I went too far," you exclaim. Place the fake AC face down on top of the left-hand cards, (the AC index at the outer end), then fan the cards, exposing five backs. Lift the fan, showing the five aces once more. *"They had some silly rule about five aces weren't allowed in a poker game. Did you ever hear of such a thing?"* Then you laugh, square the cards and put them away.

To reset, hold the packet face down, rotate (twist) it end for end, then with the right hand, grasp the top card at the outer right corner, thumb below,

first and second fingers above, turn it face up (stud fashion) and place it face up on the bottom of the packet.

HORSIN' AROUND

Effect: Three cards are shown, each picturing a part of a cute, topless pinup girl—her head, middle and bottom. The head and middle parts are dealt on the table, while the performer pockets the bottom part. A spectator tries to guess the location of the middle but cannot find it because it is now in the performer's pocket. When the middle is placed on the table with the rest of the cards, all three form a cartoon of a horse's head. The performer says that he has just been "horsin' around."

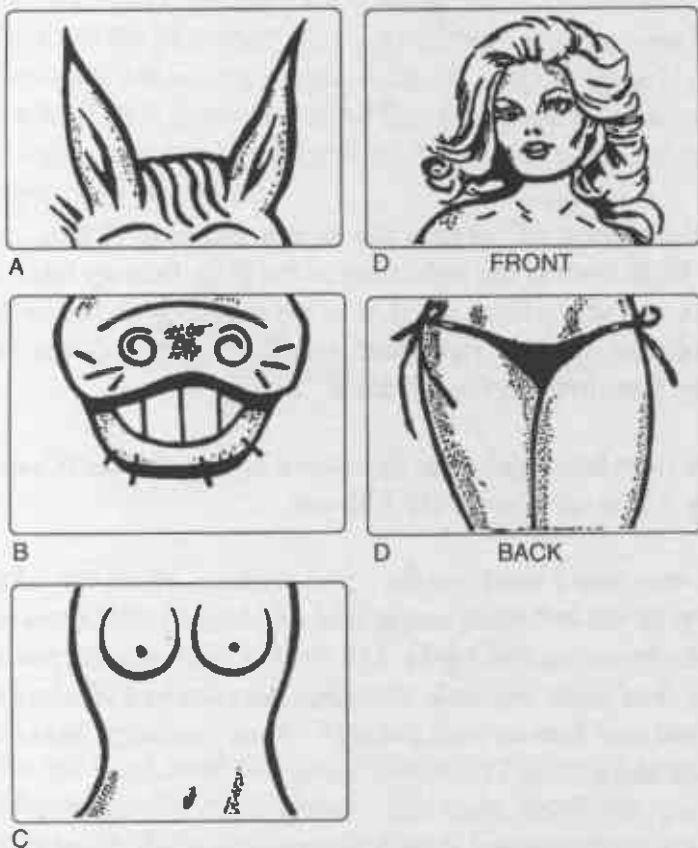


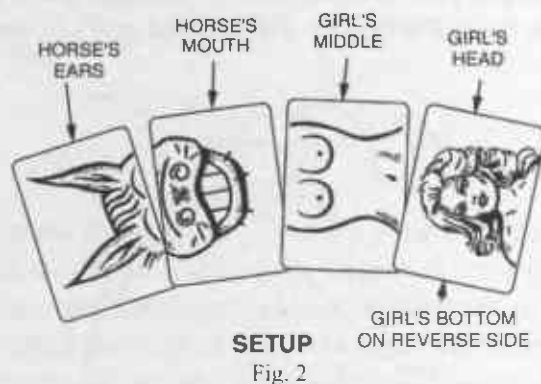
Fig. 1

Method: This trick was inspired after reading an advertisement in a 1971 Supreme Magic Company catalog for a platform effect called "Horse Play." In that trick, a replica of a chosen card appeared on what seemed to be a picture of a spicy pinup girl, but actually it turned out to be a picture of a horse's head.

"Horsin' Around" uses a pinup girl, which apparently changes to a picture of a horse's head in a close-up card trick. The method is based on the half-glide principle introduced by Larry West in his "Gourmet Mouse," a packet trick marketed by Emerson & West in 1977.

After I marketed "Horsin' Around" (in 1978), several magicians suggested ideas to improve the handling, notably Al Thatcher and Mack Picknick. Their ideas have been incorporated into this description.

Required are four specially-printed cards: card A: horse's ears; card B: horse's mouth; card C: girl's middle; card D: double-faced card, showing a girl's head on one side and a girl's bottom on the other. See Figure 1. Arrange the cards in a fan, reading from left to right: horse's ears, horse's mouth, girl's middle, girl's head. The top of each picture is to the left (Figure 2). Square the packet and turn it face down sideways. The cards are now held face down in dealing position in the left hand.



To begin, stand with your right side to the spectators. Start by saying, "Here's a little guessing game with three cards . . ." Show the packet as three face-down cards by pushing over the top two cards with the left thumb into the right hand, holding the last two cards squared as one (Figure 3). After showing apparently three face-down cards in a fan, square them.

2 CARDS HELD AS ONE



Fig. 3

"This is a little trick with a girl cut into three parts. There's the head . . ." Rotate the left hand palm down; the right hand, removes the girl's head (Figure 4); rotate the left hand palm up and place the girl's head onto the back of the face-down packet to display it (Figure 5). *"... the middle . . ."* Rotate the left hand palm down and glide back the bottom card with the left fingers; the right hand, removes the top three cards as a block, which is kept squared; rotate the left hand palm up and place the block of three cards as one onto the girl's head. Square the packet and display the girl's middle. *"... and the bottom,"* you continue. Rotate the left hand palm down. The right hand, removes the girl's bottom. Rotate the left hand palm up and place the girl's bottom onto the girl's middle. Display the girl's bottom.

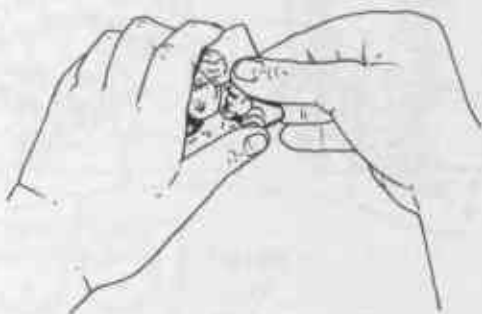


Fig. 4

(Note: In showing the three parts of the girl, the left hand can swing out to show the art head-on to the spectators. Also, as the middle is shown, hold it momentarily below the girl's head before adding it to the packet. Likewise, when showing the girl's bottom, hold it for a moment below the middle to show how it forms a picture of the girl's body.)



Fig. 5

Turn the packet face down sideways and hold it in the left hand. The right thumb pulls off the top card, sliding it forward until it clears the end of the packet. Call it the head and deal it face down to the left on the table. Pull off the second card in the same manner, calling it the middle and deal it about three inches to the right of the tabled card. (Note: This method of dealing off cards gives you complete control of the last two cards, which are held squared as one in the left hand.)

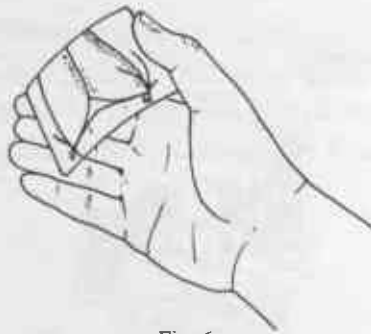


Fig. 6

Say, ". . . and the bottom, I'll put in my pocket." The right hand grips the last two cards as one in Biddle grip, fingers at the outer end, thumb at the inner end. The right forefinger presses on the back of the double card. Rotate the right hand palm up to show the girl's bottom (Figure 6). Insert the double card back out into the outer left breast pocket. Pull up the outer card (girl's middle) about halfway from the pocket and leave it protruding (Figure 7).

Say, "Now I'll switch the cards around as in Three-Card Monte . . ." Place the left fingers on the card at the right (horse's mouth); cross the right hand in front of the left, placing the right fingers on the card at the left

(horse's ears). See Figure 8. Switch the positions of the cards, sliding the ears to the right and the mouth to the left.

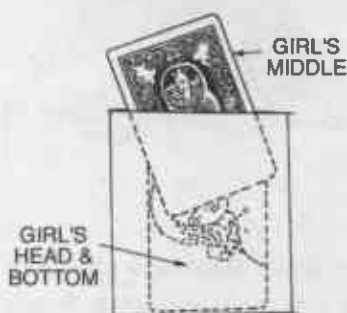


Fig. 7

Repeat the above switch, moving the cards back to their original positions.

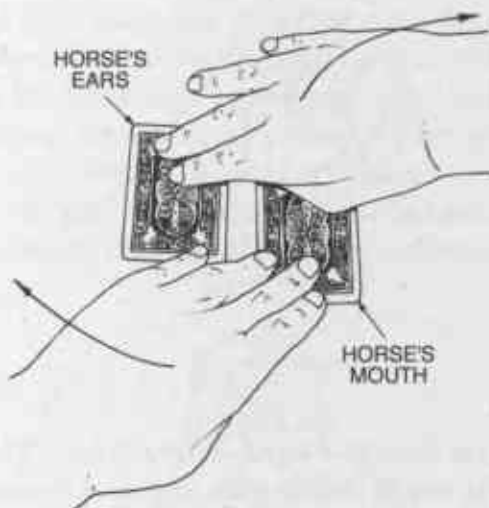


Fig. 8

Now place the fingers on the cards as in Figure 8 once more. This time, switch the cards but continue sliding the cards until they are in the positions shown in Figure 9—about three inches apart with the long sides of the cards toward the spectators. Lift the hands.

Continue: "Now the question is . . . if I put the bottom in my pocket, can you tell me where the middle is?" Whatever the spectator replies, say, "No, the middle's up here!" Remove the protruding card from the pocket with

the right hand, show the girl's middle and place it face up between the two tabled cards (Figure 10).

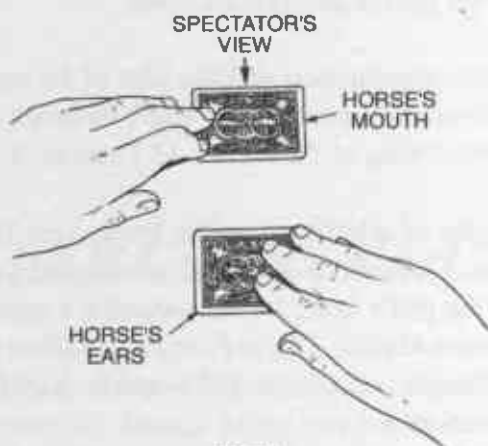


Fig. 9

To finish, say, *"I know you're probably anxious to see the complete picture, and I really wasn't trying to fool you. Actually, I've just been horsin' around!!!"* The right hand turns the two face-down cards face up end over end (lengthwise), completing the picture of the horse's head.



Fig. 10

The cards can now be left on the table for examination.

To reset, pick up the middle and lay it onto the mouth; pick up both of these and lay them onto the ears. At an opportune moment, add the girl's head to the face of the packet and you are reset.

Notes: The monte presentation and the idea of laying the cards so that the art is oriented toward the spectators is Mack Picknick's. The handling of the packet and the pocketing of the card is Al Thatcher's.

Here are a couple of additional patter lines: Tim Deremer opens by saying, *"I have here a picture of a famous movie star. Can anyone tell me who she is?"* (Show the girl's head, let the spectator's guess, then continue.) *This is Farrah Fawcett-Majors. This is Farrah . . .* (Show girl's head again.) *and these are her faucets . . .* (Show girl's middle.) *and this is her major part!* (Show girl's bottom.)

Tony Lewis uses this line: *"You've heard of cutting a girl in two . . . well, I've got a girl cut into three parts . . . She's very nervous about the act . . . in fact, she's simply going to pieces . . ."*

"Horsin' Around" is currently available from L & L Publishing.

22

ESP Cards - Part 2

"Certain universities undertake elaborate and expensive studies in an effort to determine whether one human being can transmit thoughts to another. 'Extra-sensory perception,' they call it."

—Paul Curry, *Magician's Magic*, 1965

The tricks in this chapter appear to test a spectator's psychic abilities. There are matching effects with ESP cards, effects where a spectator locates five cards of the same symbol, mind-reading routines and a triple coincidence with two ESP decks. One of my favorite effects in the chapter is "The Ultimate Cidentaquin." Be sure to give it a try; I think you will find it effective.

TRIPLE MATCH BY DESIGN

Effect: After a spectator shuffles an ESP deck, the performer tables a prediction card face down. The spectator then deals a pile, stopping at any point. He then redeals his dealt cards into two piles. The prediction card is shown to be, say, a cross. Then the top cards of the spectator's piles are turned up. Each of these is also a cross—a triple match!

Method: Have a spectator shuffle an ESP deck. Explain you need a prediction card. Fan the deck with the faces toward you until you spot a matching pair of symbols—say two crosses. Place your right forefinger on the back of the pair. Continue fanning until you see a card matching the pair, in this case another cross. Upjog this card, using either the left hand or the right. The right forefinger is still against the initial pair. Draw the right hand away so the matching pair of crosses is at the top (rear) of the right-hand cards. Move the right hand up and grasp the top of the upjogged card by placing the right forefinger against it. Draw the card out and set it face down on the table. The right-hand cards are now placed behind the left-hand cards. The deck is squared and turned face down. The matching pair of crosses is now on top of the deck, and the third cross (your prediction card) is face down on the table.

Hand the deck to the spectator and ask him to begin dealing cards one at a time into a face-down pile on the table. Once he has dealt a few cards, tell him he can stop dealing at any point.

When he stops, ask if he wants to deal a few more or replace some of his dealt cards. When he is satisfied with his stop point, he is to lay the rest of the cards aside.

Have him pick up the dealt pile and redeal it alternately into two piles. This done, recap how fair everything has been: He initially shuffled the deck. He then dealt and stopped anywhere he wanted, then formed two piles. Turn over your prediction card to show a cross. After a pause, turn over the top card of each pile to reveal matching symbols—in this case, two more crosses.

Note: The subtle way of culling the matched pair to the top of the deck is Thomas Henry's. He described it as the "Zenner Cull" in his excellent book titled *Handbook of ESP Card Mentalism* (2000).

ESP JUMBO SPLIT

Effect: Spectator B cuts off about a third of a shuffled ESP deck and hands the rest to spectator A. Each counts his cards and remembers his number. The halves are combined, then the performer tables a prediction

card to one side. As he counts cards face up, spectator A remembers the symbol at his secret number. This done, B remembers the symbol at his number. Each spectator then tables his symbol. When shown, they are both identical—say stars. The prediction card is shown. It is also a star!

Method: The title for the following trick comes from “Jumbo Two-Way Split,” a trick I marketed in 1974. The mathematical principle of forcing the same card on two spectators was developed by Professor Sydney Lawrence and first appeared in a trick titled “Controlled Thoughts” in his *Ten Self Working Master Effects* (dated about 1910). Later tricks using the principle were Fred Smith’s “The Smith Myth,” published in Hen Fetsch’s booklet *The Five O’ Fetsch* (1956) and Stewart James’ “Split Second” in *The New Tops*, December 1962, and in *Stewart James in Print: The First Fifty Years* (1989).

To perform, a spectator on your right shuffles an ESP deck. Call him spectator B. He is to cut off about a third of the deck and hand the rest of the cards to spectator A on your left. Each counts his cards and remembers the number. Say A has 16 cards and B has 9. Each shuffles his cards.

Take A’s cards (the larger portion) and hold it face down in the left hand. The right hand takes B’s cards. Glimpse the symbol on the face (say it is a star) and drop them face down on top of A’s cards in the left hand.

Explain that you will make a prediction. Fan the deck with the faces to you. From the bottom portion, remove a duplicate of the symbol you noted—a star in this case—and lay it face down on the table.

Hold the deck proper face up. Explain to spectator A that you will count through the cards and he is to remember the symbol at his number. Count aloud from 1 to 24, dealing cards one at a time from the face of the deck into a face-up pile on the table. Turn your head aside as you do so that you cannot see the cards. Spectator A remembers the sixteenth card—a star.

Pick up the deck proper and repeat the same procedure for spectator B. Deal the cards one at a time from the face of the deck into a face-up tabled pile. Count the cards aloud as you deal. He will remember the ninth card—the same star. When you have dealt over half the cards, ask if he has noted a card yet. If he has not, continue counting, but since he had the smaller number, he probably has noted his card. In that case, drop the remaining

cards onto the face of the deck proper and hand it to him. He is to remove a card bearing his symbol and table it face down.

Spectator A then takes the deck proper, removes a card with his symbol on it and tables it face down. The rest of the deck is laid aside.

Have each spectator turn up his symbol; they are both identical—stars. Turn up your prediction card and show it is also a star. A three-way match!

FACE-TO-FACE COINCIDENCE

The inspiration for this effect was Peter Duffie's effect "Carter's Fooler" in his book *Hidden Agenda 2* (1994).

Effect: A spectator shuffles an ESP deck and cuts it into three packets. The performer tables a prediction card face down from each packet. He then picks up one of the packets and begins peeling off cards face down into his left hand; a spectator picks up one of the prediction cards and drops it face up into the packet at any point. The same procedure is repeated with the other two packets. The packets are assembled, then ribbon spread on the table. All three face-to-face pairs are removed. When turned up, all three are matched pairs.

Method: Have a spectator thoroughly shuffle an ESP deck, then cut it into three approximately equal face-down packets on the table. We'll call the packets A, B and C, from left to right. Pick up packet A and fan it with the faces toward you. Note the card on the face, then look for a duplicate symbol. If one is found, upjog it, remove it and table it face down above position A. Replace packet A face down in its original position.

If there is no duplicate of the face card, find any two matching symbols, say two squares, upjogging the one on the *left*; the right hand cuts off all the cards in front of the matching symbol (the other square), removes the upjogged square and deals it face down on the table (Figure 1). The right-hand cards are placed *behind* those in the left. Lay the packet face down in its original position on the table. There is now a square face down on the table and the face card of the packet is a square. Repeat the same procedure

with the other two packets. Turn the three prediction cards face up. The layout is shown in Figure 2.

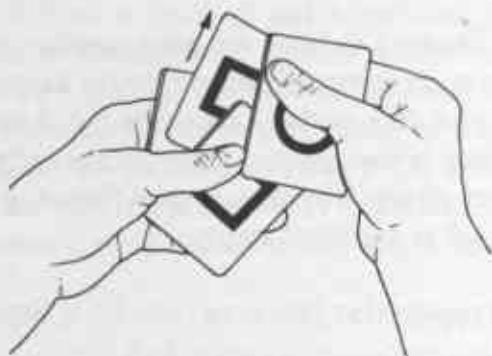


Fig. 1

Pick up packet A and hold it face down in right-hand Biddle grip. Have the spectator pick up the card above position A. Now peel off cards slowly one by one into the left hand with the left thumb. Have the spectator drop the symbol face up onto your left-hand cards at any point. When he does, drop the right-hand cards on top. This places the two matching symbols face to face. Replace the packet at position A.

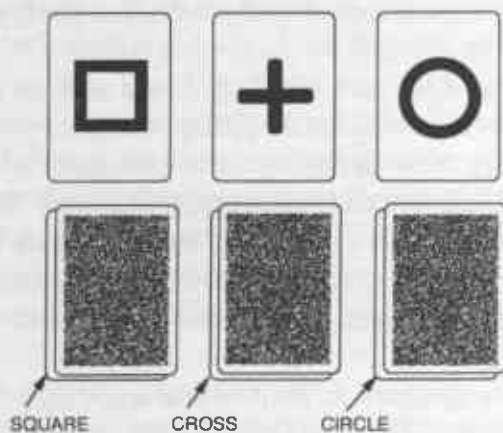


Fig. 2

Pick up packet B and repeat the same procedure. Once the packet is assembled, drop it onto packet A. Repeat the same procedure with packet C, then drop it onto packet B-A.

Ribbon spread the deck face down on the table, showing the three face-up cards in the spread. Remove each face-up card along with the card face

to face with it. Turn over the three face-down cards, showing three matched pairs.

Note: Another handling to bring the pairs together is this: Place each of the three face-up cards on top of their respective face-down packet, then have the spectator give each packet a complete cut. Assemble the packets in any order. The deck is then given a complete cut of two, making sure a face-down card ends on top. The deck is now ribbon spread on the table. The trick is concluded as described above.

This effect first appeared in *Precursor*, No. LXV, September 1988.

A MATTER OF DESIGN

Effect: From a shuffled ESP deck, the performer tables a prediction card face down. Spectator A then deals a face-down pile, stopping at any point. Spectator B picks up the dealt pile. Now each spectator deals his cards alternately into two tabled piles. The prediction card is shown to be a square. Amazingly, the top card of each of the four dealt piles is a square.

Method: Have an ESP deck shuffled. Fan it with its faces toward you and look for a pair of matching symbols. Say you spot two squares; cut them to the top of the deck. Now upjog the other three cards of the same symbol (squares) as if you are deciding on a prediction card. Strip out all three, moving them to the face of the deck, then lay the face card of the deck face down on the table for your prediction card. You now have two squares on top, two on the bottom and one tabled face down as your prediction card.

Hand the deck to spectator A. He is to deal a pile face down on the table, stopping where he wants. Have spectator B pick up the dealt pile. Now each spectator deals the cards he holds alternately into two face-down tabled piles.

When the dealing has been done, turn up your prediction card to show a square. Now turn up the top card of the four dealt piles to reveal four more squares.

A FIVE-SYMBOL MYSTERY

Effect: An ESP deck is shuffled and a spectator inserts a card face down into the deck as the performer spreads it. The card inserted (a star, for example) is turned face up. The face-up card and the face-down card above and below it are set aside. The performer now begins to deal a face-up pile, counting aloud backward from 10 to 1. The spectator stops him on any number, then the card at this number is laid aside. The same procedure is repeated so another card is laid aside. All five cards selected are shown to be stars.

Method: Set up an ESP deck from top down: two stars, ten X cards, star, ten X cards, two stars.

Begin by giving the deck a False Charlier shuffle, retaining its order. Hand the top card, a star, to a spectator. He is to insert his card face down into the deck near center as you spread the cards face down in your hands. He is to leave his card outjogged. Perform the Simon Prophecy Force, turning the inserted card face up. Spread to the face-up star. The right hand sets the face-up star and the face-down card above and below it (two more stars) on the table. The right-hand cards are replaced below those in the left hand. The order of the deck from top down is: ten X cards, star, ten X cards, star.

You will now use the LaGerould Countdown Force to force the other two stars: Have the spectator think of a number from 1 to 10 inclusive and stop you on his number as you count aloud backward from 10 to 1. Deal a face-up pile from the top, counting 10, 9, 8, 7, and so on. Say the spectator stops you on 5. Deal a corresponding number of cards (five in this case) into a face-down pile on the table. The last card dealt (a star) is laid aside face down.

Drop the undealt cards onto the dealt pile of face-down cards and repeat the procedure. Have another number from 1 to 10 inclusive thought of. Again deal, counting aloud backward from 10 to 1, dealing directly onto the original face-up pile. Stop on the thought-of number. Then deal a corresponding number of cards into a face-down pile and place the last card dealt aside. It will be a star. Assemble the deck proper and set it aside.

Reveal all five selected cards to be stars.

TROST ON HEN FETSCH'S "SYMBOLIC"

Effect: The performer and a spectator each shuffle five different ESP cards, one of each symbol. The performer removes one of his cards as a prediction and tables it face down. The spectator selects one of his cards sight unseen. It is placed with the performer's card. These two cards begin a pile of pairs. Four more pairs are selected, the performer always placing his cards onto the pile first. When the five pairs are shown, they all match.

Method: Hen Fetsch's "Symbolic" was marketed by Gene Gordon in 1955. It was a very effective routine. One of the drawbacks was that it used a waxed card. The handling here uses a regular ESP deck, and there are no waxed cards. It incorporates ideas of Jon Tremaine and Larry Becker.

To begin, fan an ESP deck with the faces to you. Cull two circles to the face, then cull a cross, waves, square and star to the face in any order. Spread off the bottom six cards into the right hand, roughly square them and drop them face up on the table. Now upjog one of each of the five symbols from the rest of the deck (in any order), strip them out and drop them face up onto the tabled cards. Discard the rest of the deck.

Pick up the 11-card tabled packet, holding it face up in the left hand. Deal the five symbols on the face of the packet face up into an overlapping row on the table. (These will be the spectator's five cards.) Hold the remaining six cards in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off four symbols one by one in fan formation into the left hand, then the circle (double) is placed on the face of the fan. You are displaying two sets of five different symbols.

Square your cards and have a spectator pick up the tabled set. You each shuffle your cards, but you use a slip shuffle to retain the circle on the bottom of your packet.

Instruct the spectator to deal his five cards into a face-down row on the table. Ask him to think of any position—1, 2, 3, 4 or 5.

Lay one of your circles face down on the table as your first prediction. The spectator pushes the card out of the row at the position he thought of. Drop your tabled card face down onto his. The spectator's remaining four cards are turned face up. Note the missing symbol, say a star. Hold your

cards with the faces to you and shift cards from face to back one by one until the star appears. Drop it face down onto the pile as your second prediction.

The spectator thinks of one of his *four* remaining symbols and drops his thought-of card face down onto the pile. Say he chooses the waves.

Shift your cards from front face to back, remove the waves and drop it face down onto the pile as your third prediction. The spectator turns another of his cards face down (say the square) and drops it onto the pile.

Shift your cards so the duplicate of the card just added by the spectator (the square) is at the back of your three cards. Fan over the card at the face of your cards, holding the other two as one. Show your cards are the same two symbols as the spectator's two remaining cards (Figure 1). Square your cards, hold them with the faces to you and shift cards singly from face to back until the square is on the face. Deal it face down onto the pile as your fourth prediction. Hold your last two cards as one. The spectator now turns one his two remaining cards face down and drops it onto the pile.

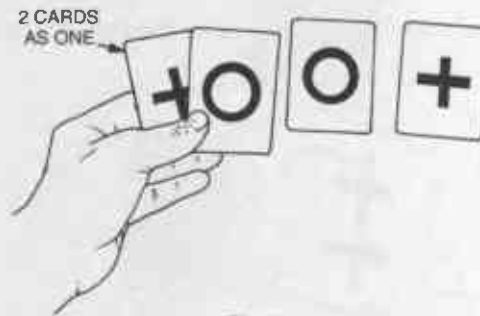


Fig. 1

If the spectator's final card and the card at the face of your double *do not* match, drop your double face down onto the pile and his last card face down on top. If the spectator's final card and the card on the face of your double *match*, pick up his card and place it on the face of your double. Show both cards match, then square them, turn them face down and hold them in right-hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off the top card face down into the left hand as you say, "*These last two cards match.*" Place the single below the double and drop all three cards face down on top of the pile.

To end, pick up the tabled pile and hold it face down in the left hand. The left thumb pushes over the top two cards into the right hand where

they are held in Biddle grip. (Figure 2). Turn the right hand palm up to show the matching symbols (Figure 3), then drop them face down on the table. Repeat with the next three pairs, dropping them onto the tabled pair. For the final pair(?), push over the top card, taking the last two cards as a double. Show the matching symbols, then drop these cards face down onto the tabled pile to end.

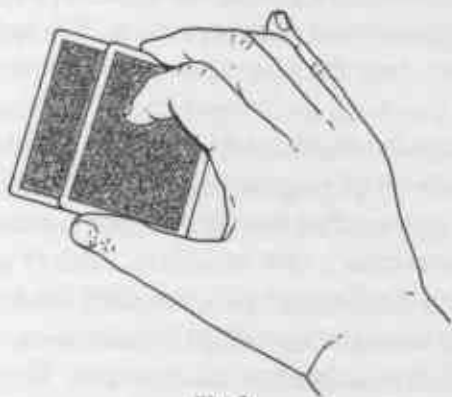


Fig. 2

Scoop up the cards and drop them onto the rest of the deck.

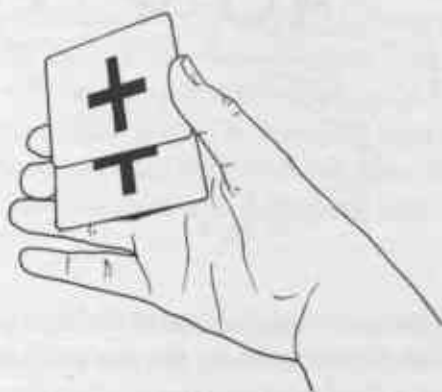


Fig. 3

ESP PARADOX OF PAIRS

Effect: An ESP deck is shown in pairs, each pair consisting of two different symbols. The performer now deals pairs one by one face down into a tabled pile. A spectator designates any three pairs, which are put aside.

The pairs not selected are shown to consist of two different symbols. Then the selected pairs are shown. They consist of matching cards.

Method: Set up an ESP deck from top down: two circles, two crosses, two waves, two squares, two stars, two circles, two crosses, two waves, two squares, two stars, circle, cross, waves, square, star. Cut the square and the star at the face to the top (rear) of the deck.

To begin, hold the deck with the faces toward you. Spread off the two cards at the face of the deck into the right hand; show this pair consists of different symbols and deal it face down on the table. Continue by showing that six or seven more pairs each consist of different symbols and deal them face down onto the first pair. Drop the balance of the deck face down on top.

Pick up the deck and hold it face down. Give it a False Charlier shuffle, retaining its order.

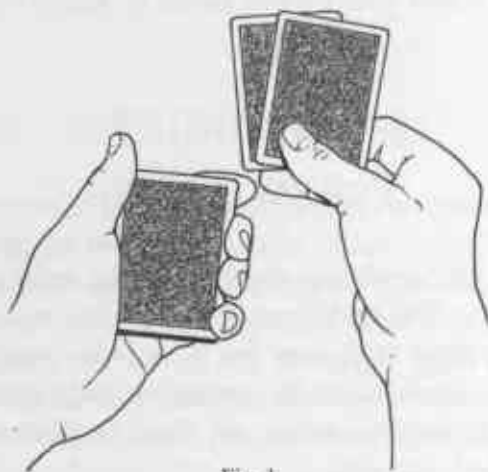


Fig 1

Explain that you will deal pairs from the top face down on the table, and a spectator is to select three of the pairs. The left thumb pushes off the top two cards, and they are held fanned in the right hand as shown in Figure 1. Turn the right hand palm up to show the face of this pair, then deal it face down on the table. Continue to lift off pairs, without showing their faces and deal them slowly face down onto the first pair until one is selected. Place the selected pair in front of the spectator. Continue to deal and have two more pairs selected, placing each in front of the spectator. When you reach the

last three cards, push over the top card with the left thumb, holding the last two cards as one. Show these cards as two different symbols and drop them face down onto the tabled pile.

Pick up the tabled pile and show pairs from top down in the same way: The right hand takes the top two cards, turns palm up to show the face of the pair, then deals it face down on the table. Repeat, showing every pair to be mixed. When you reach the last three cards, push over the top card with the left thumb, holding the last two cards as one. Show these three cards as two different symbols and drop them face down onto the tabled pile. This packet can now be ribbon spread face up on the table to show a mixture of symbols.

Finally, turn over the spectator's three selected pairs to show each one is a matched pair!

Note: Bob Longe's "The Lonely Pair" in his book *Easy Card Tricks* (1995) is a similar effect with regular cards. In Bob's trick, only one pair was selected.

ESP SWINDLE

Effect: Twenty ESP cards are shown in pairs, each pair consisting of two different symbols. The performer now deals the cards into a tabled pile and switches two or three cards here and there as he deals. Now a spectator calls out which cards to switch as the performer deals again. Seemingly, the symbols should be thoroughly mixed, yet when the pairs are dealt out, each pair contains matched symbols.

Method: Arrange a packet of 20 ESP cards in pairs of symbols so no four of the same symbol are together. Also make sure the top and bottom pairs are different symbols.

Start by giving the packet a Charlier shuffle, then hold it face up in the left hand. With the left thumb, push over the face card to the right so you can see if the bottom two symbols are different. If they are different, proceed. If they are the same, double cut the bottom card to the top (rear) of the packet.

Holding the packet face up, fan off the pair at the face, show the symbols are different, then deal the pair face down on the table to begin a pile. Continue showing mixed pairs and dealing them face down onto the tabled cards. After showing nearly all the pairs, drop the remaining cards face down on top.

Pick up the packet and double cut the top card to the face. (The symbols are paired once again.) Now demonstrate Paul Curry's Swindle Switch, dealing all 20 cards face down one by one into a tabled pile, "switching" two or three cards several times per the Curry technique. (See the Appendix in *Volume 1* of this work for a description.)

Once a spectator understands how the cards will be switched, pick up the dealt packet and deal it into a tabled pile again, this time having the spectator call the switches. After this "mixing," turn the pile face up and deal off the cards in pairs, showing each contains matching symbols.

SYMBOL SENSE

Effect: An ESP deck is mixed and tabled. Spectator A then cuts off a few cards and holds the packet against his chest so the face card is hidden. Spectators B and C do the same, leaving the performer a few cards. He asks each spectator to remember the symbol at the face of his packet. Each spectator then shuffles his packet. The performer takes the first spectator's packet, studies the cards, then tables one card face down for him. He repeats the same procedure with the other two spectators. Each spectator names his symbol, and all three of the performer's cards prove correct.

Method: Set up an ESP deck in cyclic order.

Start by giving the deck a Charlier shuffle, then have a spectator give the cards a cut. We will call the three spectators who will select cards spectators A, B and C. Hold the deck face down in the left hand and ask spectator A to cut off a few cards, say six or seven, and hold the face of the packet against his chest so that you cannot see the face card.

Spectator B also cuts off a few cards, and spectator C does likewise, leaving you a few cards. Ask each spectator to look at the symbol on the face of his packet and remember it. Demonstrate how they are to look at their bottom card by looking at the bottom card of your packet; remember this card. Say that you looked at waves.

Now each spectator is to shuffle his cards. You shuffle yours as this is said, then place your cards aside. Take A's packet and hold it in the left hand with the faces to you. Begin spreading cards from the left hand to the right. As the first card is spread, say to yourself the next symbol after the one you are remembering; in this case, since you are remembering waves, you would say *square*. Then for the next card, say *star*; the next, *circle*; the next, *cross*; and so on, in the standard cyclic order. The symbol you say to yourself on the last card of the packet will be the name of the spectator's symbol. Remove a corresponding symbol from the packet and table it face down in front of spectator A. Discard the rest of his cards.

Take B's packet and follow the same procedure. Begin your "count" with the symbol following A's symbol. So if A's symbol was a square, start the count of B's packet with the next symbol in rotation, the star. Lay down a card corresponding to the last card counted for spectator B. Discard the rest of his cards.

The same procedure is followed for spectator C. Take his packet and fan it with the faces to you. Start your count with the next symbol after B's symbol. If B had waves, then start your count with a square. The last card counted will tell you which symbol C looked at. Lay a corresponding symbol face down for C and discard the rest of his cards.

All that remains is to build up the mind-reading aspect of the trick, then disclose all three cards after each spectator names his "thought-of" symbol.

Note: This effect is based on a trick with regular cards and the Eight Kings arrangement, shown to me by Al Thatcher. The basis of the method can be traced to Ed Marlo's trick "A Miracle with Cards" in *Ibidem*, No. 8, December 1956, but whoever came up with the idea of reciting the sequence of the setup to yourself is not known. It could have been an Al Thatcher idea.

TRIPLE ESP DIVINATION

This effect is based on a Gilbreath-related principle used in Karl Fulves' "ESP + Math," which first appeared in *The Pallbearer's Review*, February 1968, then later in his book *More Self-Working Card Tricks* (1984). It was also marketed by Louis Tannen, Inc. as "ESP Miracle" (1973).

Effect: This is a two-phase routine: An ESP deck is given a legitimate riffle shuffle, then a packet of cards is dealt face down on the table in front of each of three spectators. As the performer turns away, each spectator notes the top card of his packet, then shuffles his cards. The performer faces front, picks up the packets in turn, studies them and lays down one card from each. They are the three noted symbols!

Next, spectator A picks up his symbol and drops it face up at any point into his face-down packet. Spectators B and C do the same with their cards. The deck is assembled, then spread. Each face-up card and the card face to face with it are removed and shown. All three pairs match!

Method: An ESP deck is set in cyclic order.

Phase One: The deck can be Charlier shuffled and cut. Now hold the deck for an overhand shuffle. Run ten cards, injogging the tenth, and throw. Hold the deck face down in the left hand. The right thumb pushes down on the injogged card, getting a left little-finger break above it.

Cut the deck at the break, taking a half in each hand. Give the cards a *good, even* riffle shuffle. Make sure the cards are interwoven, throughout. Square the deck.

Pick up the deck and hold it face down in the left hand. Deal the top *six* cards face down in front of spectator A. Deal the cards one onto another, reversing their order. The next *five* cards are dealt face down on the table in front of spectator B. Then *five* more cards are dealt face down in front of spectator C. See Figure 1. Place the rest of the deck aside.

As you turn your head aside, each spectator notes the top card of his pile and shows it to those nearby. Each is then to replace his card, pick up

his pile and shuffle it. Finally, each replaces his pile face down in front of himself on the table.

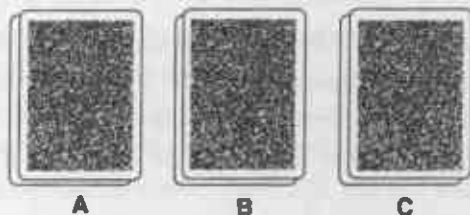


Fig. 1

Recap the fairness of the situation: The deck was shuffled and three piles were dealt. Three spectators each looked at a card, then shuffled his cards. "*With ESP, I'll try to find these symbols,*" you say.

Pick up pile A. Spectator A's card will be the only symbol duplicated. As you remove one of the duplicates, make sure its matching symbol is on the face of the other five cards. Lay spectator A's card face down in front of him, then table the five-card pile face down below his card.

Repeat the same procedure with spectator B: Pick his pile, lay one of the duplicate symbols face down in front of him, making sure the matching symbol is on the face of the other four cards, then table them face down below his card. Repeat the same procedure with spectator C. (Figure 2 shows the layout.)

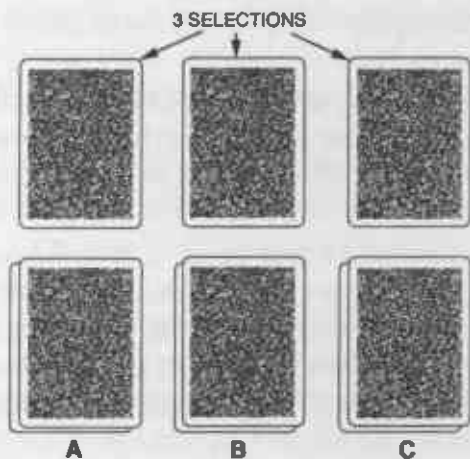


Fig. 2

Have each spectator in turn name his symbol. Turn each of the single cards face up to reveal that you have located their symbols.

Phase Two: Pick up the discard pile and deal three cards apiece onto each of the three piles. The idea is to make the three piles nearly equal so there are seven or eight cards in each.

Pick up pile A. Overhand shuffle, slipping the bottom card so that it remains on the face. Hold the packet face down in right-hand Biddle grip. With the left thumb, slowly draw off cards one by one into the left hand. Spectator A is to drop his card face up onto the left-hand cards at any point. After he does, drop the right-hand cards on top. This puts his symbol face to face with a duplicate symbol. Replace this pile on the table.

Repeat the same procedure with spectator B; he drops his card face up into pile B. Then spectator C drops his card face up into pile C. Now stack the piles one onto another in any order and ribbon spread the deck face down on the table. Push out each face-up card together with the card face to face with it (Figure 3).

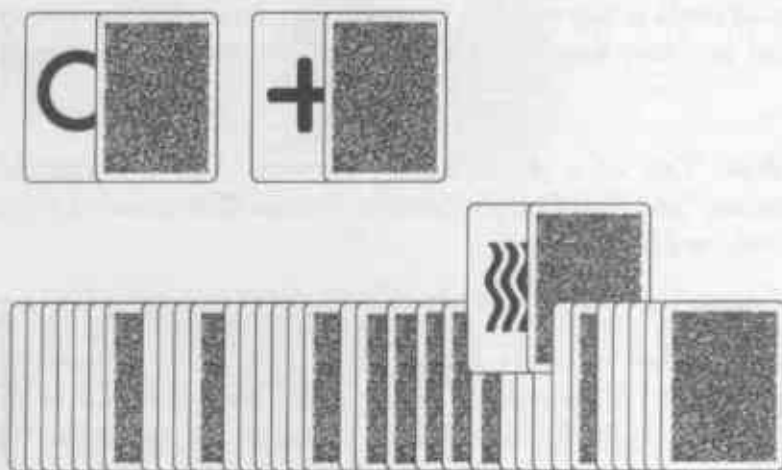


Fig. 3

Turn over the face-down card of each pair in turn to reveal three perfectly matched pairs.

Note: Here is an alternate method for beginning Phase One: After the riffle shuffle, double cut the top card to the bottom of the deck. Now deal

five cards for all three piles instead of six-five-five. Continue with the rest of the routine as described above.

This routine is similar to "Triple Psychometry" described in *Volume 3* of this work.

THE ULTIMATE CIDENTAQUIN

Effect: A spectator freely selects any card from a shuffled ESP deck. His card is laid aside face down. The rest of the deck is divided into two piles. The performer mixes one pile by dealing and switching cards at random. Both piles are dealt in unison to show different symbols in *every* pair. The performer then deals one pile, making any switches of cards called for by the spectator. Now when both piles are dealt, two pairs match—both pairs are circles. The spectator's selection is shown and it also is a circle!

The spectator then selects either ten-card packet and again calls for switches of cards at any point as the performer deals. The top two symbols are turned up—they match. Against all odds, all the other pairs in the piles match!

Method: This is a routining of Howard Adams' beautiful trick "Cidentaquin" and Paul Curry's Swindle Switch. This is one of my favorite effects with an ESP deck.

"Cidentaquin" by Howard Adams was first marketed by him in 1968 and later published in *Genii*, August 1970. Paul Curry's Swindle Switch first appeared in "A Swindle of Sorts" in his book *Paul Curry Presents* (1974). (Details on the Swindle Switch appear in the Appendix, *Volume 1* of this work.)

An ESP deck is set up in cyclic order.

Phase One: The ESP deck can be Charlier shuffled and cut. Hold the deck face down in the left hand. Spread the deck face down from hand to hand and have a spectator touch the back of any card. Lay the card aside face down and casually cut the deck at the point the card was removed.

Reverse count 12 cards face down into a pile on the table. Set the other 12-card packet face down beside the first pile. It makes no difference which packet was reversed, the left or the right.

Pick up the *left* packet and hold it face down in the left hand. You now demonstrate the Swindle Switch, dealing cards face down on the table and "switching" them at random. Deal slowly, and on a "switch" of the top two cards, deliberately duck the right-hand card under the left, holding the two cards near you, then reach forward and drop the pair onto the dealt cards. Finish "switching" or dealing the rest of these cards.

Using both hands, pick up the top card of each pile and deal them face up above the piles, as shown in Figure 1. Continue to deal all 12 pairs, commenting that none of the pairs of symbols match.

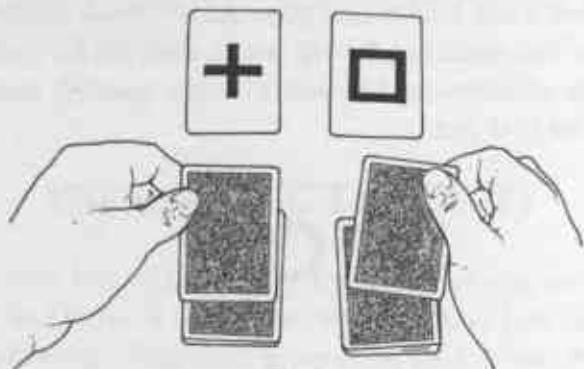


Fig. 1

Turn both piles face down. Pick up the pile on the *right* and hold it face down in the left hand. Now, as you deal the cards into a face-down pile on the table, a spectator is to call out "switches."

This done, you begin dealing pairs face up above the piles, commenting that none of the pairs match. When you reach the *fifth* pair, it will match. Deal the matching pair. Continue to deal, but overlap the next pairs slightly onto the matching pair as shown in Figure 2. This leaves the matching pair visible. Continue dealing pairs until the second matching pair has been dealt. The remaining four cards are turned over and laid face up on the table to show that these two pairs do not match. The two matching pairs will be the same four symbols. Turn over the spectator's original selected card to show that it is the fifth matching symbol! See Figure 3.

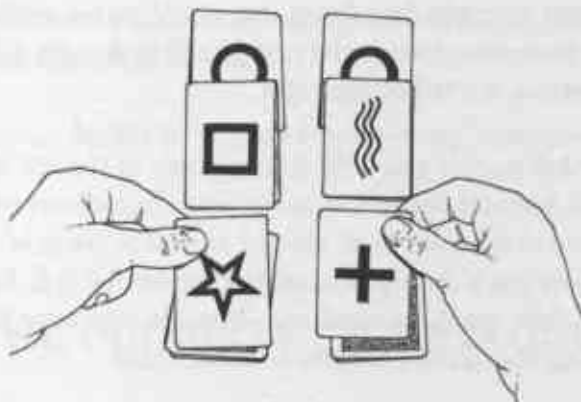


Fig. 2

Discard the spectator's original selected symbol and the two non-matching pairs. This leaves two ten-card piles face up on the table. Pick up either one, square it and hold it face up in the left hand. Double cut one card from the face of the packet to the top (rear), then set the packet face down on the table. The other ten-card packet is simply squared, turned face down, and set beside the first one.

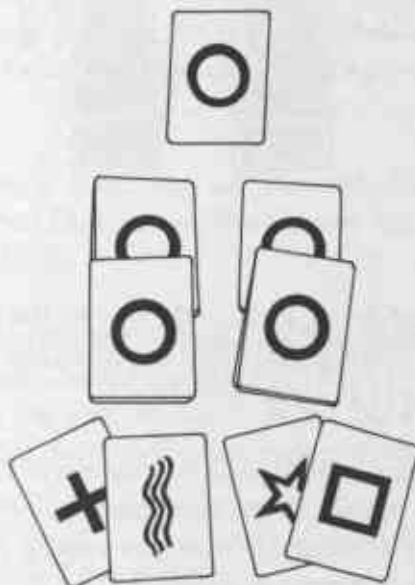


Fig. 3

Phase Two: Have the spectator select either face-down packet for one more Swindle Switch sequence. Pick up the packet he selects and hold it face down in the left hand. Carry out the Swindle Switch procedure, having

the spectator call "switches" for these ten cards. Comment about the long odds of the two top symbols matching. Using both hands, deal the top cards face up above the piles. They match! Pause for the effect to register, then continue to deal the rest of the pairs face up at an accelerated pace. Slow up on the last pair—then turn it face up to show the last matching pair. All the pairs have matched!

Notes: Drop one ten-card pile onto the other. Place the five cards laid aside in the same order as the symbols in the deck proper. Drop them onto the deck proper and now the entire deck is reset in cyclic order.

From cyclic order, you can now perform "Million to One ESP" in *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997), page 286.

The above routine could be performed with a Pinochle deck, the 10, J, Q, K, A, repeated five times.

ESP DOUBLE THOUGHT

Effect: An ESP deck is cut in half and a spectator takes either half. He removes a card and tables it face down; the performer does the same, laying down any card from his half. Each looks at his card, buries it in his half and shuffles. The halves are traded. The performer claims he will try to find the spectator's card, while the spectator tries to find the performer's. Both cards are tabled face down. The spectator names his card and the performer has found it; then the performer names his card, and somehow the spectator has located it!

Method: This is based on Al Koran's "Double Thought," which appeared in his book *Professional Presentations* (1968), edited by Hugh Miller. Originally performed with regular cards, it is a strong effect using ESP cards.

You will need a marked ESP deck. Royal Magic makes a marked ESP deck that is marked on the backs in the upper left and lower right corners for the five symbols.

To begin, a spectator shuffles the ESP deck and cuts it in half. He picks up either half, and you take the other one.

Tell the spectator to spread his half face down, remove any card and lay it face down on the table. You do the same, laying down any card from your half. As you do, read the back of the spectator's card and remember the symbol, say a circle.

Now tell the spectator to look at the face of his card, without letting anyone else see it, then he is to place his card into his half and shuffle it. Explain that you will do the same with your card. Pick up your card, pretend to note it, bury it in your half, then shuffle your cards.

Give the spectator your half and you take his. Explain that you will try to find his card, while he is to remove a card which he thinks you may have selected from the half he now has and lay it face down on the table.

Go through your cards and remove his card, which you know is a circle since you read the back of his card. Lay it face down on the table.

Whatever card he lays down for you, quickly read the symbol from the back, say waves.

Ask him to name his card. When he says "*Circle*," turn up the card you laid down for him, showing the circle. Now, for your card, name the symbol you just read, waves in this case, as the card you looked at. Turn up the card he laid down for you to show that he did select waves for you.

TRIPLE SYNCHRONICITY

Effect: A red-backed ESP deck is shuffled. A spectator selects three cards, which are placed sight unseen into a blue-backed deck. The performer then removes three blue-backed cards and cuts them into the red deck. Both decks are spread face down, revealing three odd-colored cards in each. When these cards are turned up, amazingly they consist of three matched pairs of symbols.

Method: This effect is an ESP card version of my "Kings Royale," which appeared in my book *The Card Magic of Nick Trost* (1997) using regular cards.

You will need two ESP decks, one red-backed and one blue. (Royal Magic makes red- and blue-backed decks.) Remove a circle, cross and waves from both decks. Set up the decks as follows from top down: Red deck: 22 red-backed cards, blue-backed circle and cross. Blue deck: 15 blue-backed cards; red-backed circle, cross and waves; 7 blue-backed cards; blue-backed waves. See Figure 1.

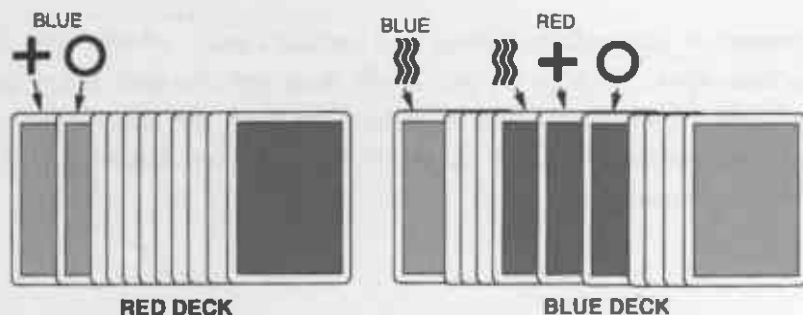


Fig. 1

At the outset, both decks are lying face down on the table. Pick up the red deck, turn it face up and fan it to show a mixture of symbols. Square it, then turn it face down.

Give it a brief overhand shuffle, retaining the bottom two blue-backed cards, using the Bottom Stock Control.

Spread the cards face down in the hands, taking care not to expose the two blue-backers. Invite a spectator to touch the backs of three cards. As he touches each card, remove it and drop it face down on the table. Square the rest of the red deck and set it aside face down.

Pick up the blue deck and hold it face down in the left hand. Lay the three red-backed cards on top, holding a left little-finger break beneath them. Double cut the three red-backers to the bottom. Immediately spread the blue deck, showing three red-backers near the center. (These are actually the three red-backers that were already in the deck.)

Square the deck. Explain you will remove three blue-backers. With the right thumb, riffle off *four* cards at the bottom of the deck, three red-backers and one blue. Hold a left little-finger break above them.

Lift off all the cards above the break with the right hand and set them aside. This leaves four cards in the left hand. The right hand picks up this packet and places it face down on top of the red-backed deck. Give the red deck a complete cut, which brings the three blue-backed cards together in the center. Ribbon spread each deck face down on the table. Three odd-colored backs will show in the center of each deck.

"Remember, you selected three red-backed cards, which were placed into the blue deck," you point out. Slide them out and turn them face up to show a circle, cross and waves. Now turn over the three blue-backed stranger cards in the red deck to show they are also a circle, cross and waves—a triple match.